# YinYang

## Steal Fire, Then Become Fire

English reading edition

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# Reading this edition

This book brings together YinYang's public philosophical essays and writing guides. The five-part Steal Fire, Then Become Fire sequence contains nineteen main essays and its existing focused extension. The five relational diagrams appear in the same articles and passages as on the website. Core views follows the complete sequence as a reference for revisiting or selecting questions. Follow the linked sections when you want to go deeper. You need not accept every view or read every chapter in order.

**If literature, history, or philosophy is not your field, begin with selected Core views that speak to your questions.** Consider their reasons and conditions before using them to organize experiences, revise personal material, or configure an environment. Follow their links to the fuller arguments when needed.

The five parts follow the website's connected argument. The appendices contain the guide to philosophy and models, six public writing guides, further reading, and the Skill's package guide. Writing a personal philosophy or other essays is optional and follows your interests. The practical tool guide and research and learning guide remain available online.

Selected ideas can support organizing experiences, revising personal psychological material, and configuring a fitting environment. Retain the sources and uncertainties of personal interpretations and revise them through experience; these working accounts are not clinical assessments.

**YinYang must not be used for psychological self-help work, self-diagnosis, mental-health assessment, or treatment.** It has not been systematically evaluated for those purposes. When professional assessment or care is needed, seek a qualified professional; the project's texts and model outputs do not replace that service. A personal experience or version history does not establish a general psychological effect. The source use statement records the same boundary.

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# Starting point: join in stealing fire, then use it to cultivate yourself

## Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity



A person borrows a tiny ember from a shared furnace and tends their own hearth, developing borrowed capability into creation.

### 完整中文版

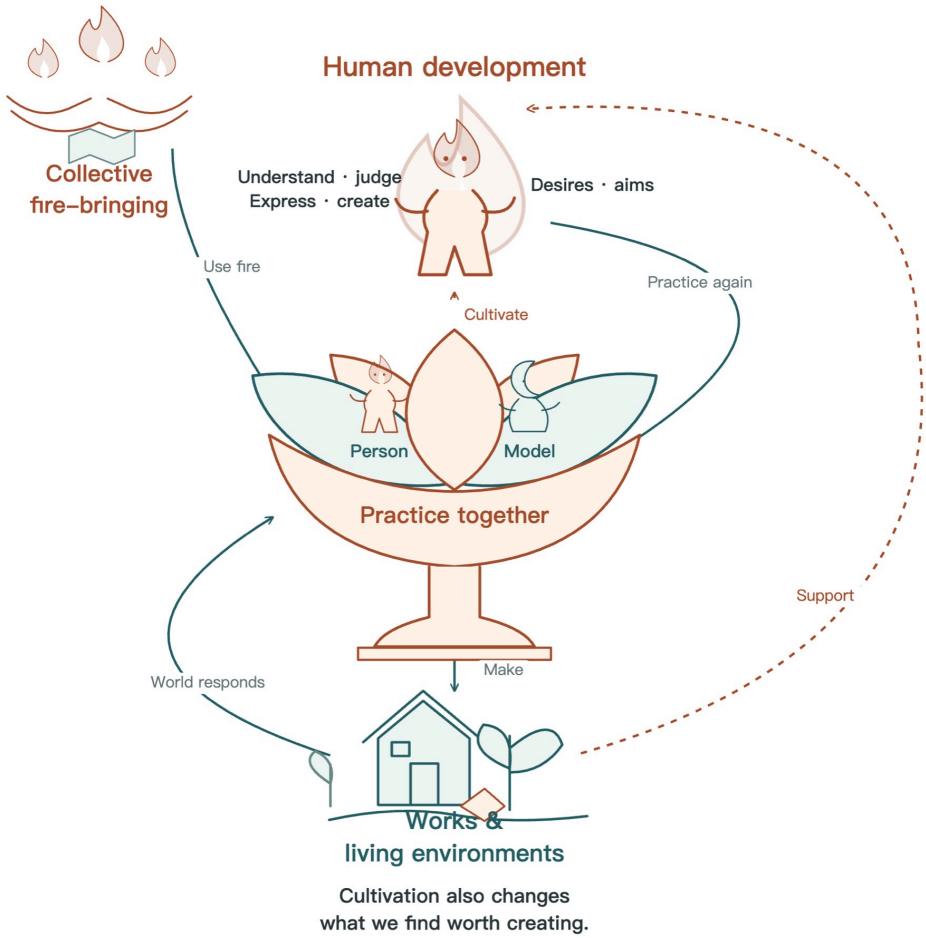
*Many hands gather knowledge, build machines, and keep their power flowing. A voice reaches the machine and receives more than one life could have made alone. The question returns with the gift: how will this fire enter a life, and what will that life learn to kindle?*

**Do not spend a finite life pursuing an ever-expanding Sun until it burns you up. Borrow its fire, and use it to kindle your own capacity to create.** Model companies, researchers, and the wider collective continue gathering knowledge, training systems, and making capabilities available. A person can draw on that work without repeating the whole industrial acquisition. The question then changes: what can this already acting, understanding person cultivate with the fire they have borrowed?

This essay chooses **reverse alignment** as its purpose: develop understanding, judgment, generation, and action through encounters with generative intelligence. For that purpose, access and finished outputs need to become occasions for participation: offer

an intuition, encounter development and criticism, correct it, and generate further. This cultivation receives a character: **the little fire person emphasizes kindling further fire; Baby Heraclitus emphasizes that this creator is still changing too.** Received and generated possibilities can conflict, while desires and judgments change. Cultivation can change what seems worth creating, the habits through which one acts, and the conditions that sustain a life. Creation helps form the participant who will create again. **Pursuit that consumes a life → collective acquisition → borrowed fire → personal cultivation → freer creation and living.** The practical necessities in this argument follow from the chosen purpose and finite resources. Relief, ordinary assistance, and completed works are worthwhile uses too; they need not become lessons. Cultivation asks an additional question: how does this encounter change what the person can understand, judge, initiate, and sustain, and their grasping at capability, achievement, and an image of themselves?

**Join in stealing fire, and use it to cultivate yourself**




Dashed: cultivation or support, examined through actual participation.

## Finite life and the wrong pursuit

The Sun here images expanding external generative power. Trying personally to recreate its entire machinery, or treating every frontier change as a demand to catch up, can consume the time and attention needed for one's chosen life. “Being burned up” names this resource pressure. It gives a reason to borrow available capability and choose what to cultivate, rather than a scientific law about progress or a ban on doing research.

The contrast reworks inherited images. In the *Shan Hai Jing*, Kuafu pursues the sun and dies of thirst; in Hesiod's *Theogony*, Prometheus carries stolen fire in a hollow fennel stalk. Their juxtaposition here is contemporary: it distinguishes pursuing overwhelming power from bringing usable fire into life. Mythic sources below.

A supposedly definitive prompt can become another form of pursuit when endlessly repairing it to match an external ideal displaces what the collaboration was meant to serve. Technical inquiry, precise specifications, and model updates remain useful when they contribute to that purpose. The issue is where the person's life goes: into keeping pace for its own sake, or into a practice that the available power can sustain.

## From chasing to lived cultivation

This mismatch leaves a question for the later argument: which demands turn available capability into a personal burden, and how can their relationship change? Speech, opposition, and self-formation develops that reconstruction through writing.

Pursuit can hold a person through an image of what would finally make life possible: the pure frontier, the ultimate principle, the complete system after which one could at last begin. Each advance then appears to postpone the beginning once more. The difficulty concerns how a picture organizes desire and attention. An increase in what technology can do becomes a demand about what this person must do; an unfinished account of the world becomes a reason to suspend living in it. Neither demand follows from the advance or the incompleteness alone.

Wittgenstein offers a way to examine such captivity. In *Philosophical Investigations*, §109 addresses philosophical confusion through attention to language; §115 describes captivity to a picture embedded in language; §133 compares philosophical methods with therapies and connects clarification with being able to stop philosophizing [35]. Drawing on this approach, the present essay asks what happens when a picture of progress becomes a personal obligation. That practical question is our extension. It lets us examine how words such as “advanced,” “complete,” and “capable” acquire their authority over a life.

Someone may say, “Until I have mastered the newest system, my own work does not count.” A comparison can uncover what this sentence joins together: competence for a particular task, recognition by others, and permission to value one's own activity. These have different conditions. A new model may solve a formerly difficult problem while leaving a friendship, a cherished question, or the pleasure of making something no less real. Clarification opens a choice that the picture had concealed. Frontier research can become a chosen project among others; it need not supply the measure of every life. Returning to nearby life means attending to the places where meanings are used, purposes become concrete, and consequences are borne.

### Borrowed fire and nirvana

Buddhist thought also enters the purpose of cultivation here. Borrowed fire can expand understanding and action while intensifying demands to keep up, possess, and prove oneself. Increased capacity therefore leaves a question: how might a person use it to understand and loosen the grasping through which they suffer? Cultivation can change

one's relation to the demand to become a particular self, allowing creation to contribute to a freer life.

Two meanings of fire need to be distinguished. In the fire-bringing image, fire means knowledge, technology, and creative capability. The *Fire Sermon* describes the senses, consciousness, contact, and feeling as burning with passion, aversion, and delusion [37]. Using the former fire to examine and loosen the latter is the connection this essay constructs. Acquiring more capability does not automatically end affliction; its use and its effects on desire and habit give this connection practical content.

*Saṃyutta Nikāya* 38.1 describes nirvana as the ending of passion, aversion, and delusion, and identifies the noble eightfold path as the practice leading to it [38]. This liberating direction lets the essay question the purpose of cultivation: can development include ceasing to be driven by pursuit, self-justification, and attachment to achievement? Nirvana retains its Buddhist meaning, distinct from increased ability or temporary relief. This contemporary cultivation of creative life enters into dialogue with it without treating successful technical collaboration as evidence that nirvana has been realized.

Cultivation and loosening grasping can occur within the same activity. A person developing a work with a model may also notice how "every work must prove my worth" governs their choices. While revising the work, they can try changing that demand and observe how finishing, stopping, and beginning again become possible. Freedom need not be postponed until sufficient power is acquired; letting go need not await the completion of a perfect self.

The raft simile makes this relation between purpose and means more concrete. In *Majjhima Nikāya* 22, a traveler builds and uses a raft to cross dangerous water, then leaves it instead of carrying it onward. The discourse joins this with the need to grasp a teaching properly [36]. The sequence matters: use the means skillfully, cross, then release the burden whose work is done. Applied here, a concept, a tool, or a self-description can support a real transformation without becoming something one must preserve for its own sake. Tools, self-models, and the image of the little fire person can contribute while useful and be revised or released when they no longer fit. The relation to means thus returns to the freedom cultivation seeks.

Understanding one's own and others' psychology and condensing that understanding into personal working models are part of this movement. A person and model can articulate how a wish, a recurring judgment, a habit, and an environment sustain one another. Making these relations readable gives both participants something to question and use: a description of "falling behind" may reveal a desired skill, an imposed comparison, or an exhausting demand that calls for changed working conditions. Reading and revising the account can alter what the person notices and asks for; the counterpart can help realize a different arrangement. Its effects return to correct the description. Conceptual clarifi-

cation and practical change thus meet without treating every difficulty as a confusion that language alone can remove.

The little fire person belongs within this revision too. If “keep kindling” becomes a command to produce ever more, the character has taken over the Sun's old demand. The image serves cultivation while it helps a person choose and sustain worthwhile activity. Becoming can include a changed desire, more discerning judgment, a gentler habit, the completion of a work, or room to rest and attend to someone nearby. Borrowing fire then changes one's relation to available power: there is enough freedom to use it, revise its place, and let a particular use end. The material source of that power continues its own history, while its meaning in this life takes shape here. The little fire person can keep creating while loosening their grasp on the creator's identity; they need not kindle forever to prove their right to exist.

## Material fire and concentrated capability

The fire available to a person has already required work across many lives. Model companies organize parts of its training and provision; researchers, authors, engineers, infrastructure workers, and other contributors make that work possible. Companies participate in this collective acquisition without being its sole origin. Borrowing means using capabilities it makes available, rather than personally repeating the whole process.

Its realization is physical. Stellar processes formed many elements later entering Earth's minerals and machines [27]; extraction and fabrication organize materials into chips. Electricity powers computation, while data, knowledge, design, and learning procedures shape what it can do [18]. Solar generation is one possible supply among others [28] [17]. Materials realize the machine, energy drives its transformations, and learned organization supports outputs whose meaning and warrant still need examination.

Acquisition and operation have costs. The IEA estimates that all data centres used about 415 TWh in 2024, a figure broader than AI [17]. Computing dissipates heat [23]; electricity generation also has emissions consequences [29]. These are different mechanisms within Earth's open radiative energy balance [30]. Cooling, grids, materials, and emissions make expansion a shared material question. *Stealing fire* names both the collective ambition to extend creation and the responsibilities carried by that power.

## Reusable capability and recursive accumulation

A trained model can contribute to many encounters without repeating its entire training each time. The foundation-model report discusses this amortization of formation costs across use and adaptation [31]. Inference, retrieval, and checking still cost time and energy. The practical opening is nevertheless decisive: the person can begin from available capability instead of rebuilding its industrial source.

Reuse continues in the works made with it. A checked explanation becomes a reading aid, working code becomes a tool, and a useful method supports another task. **Capability**

**→ work → retained, checked resources → further capability** is a possible recursive relation. Quality, maintenance, access, and actual use determine whether it helps; generated volume alone gives no improvement rule.

Collective acquisition can therefore continue while personal cultivation proceeds with fire already available. These movements can contribute to one another without becoming the same process. Ordinary conversation need not update a model's weights, and a better personal tool need not advance foundation-model research. Its contribution here is to make the next encounter more intelligible and generative.

## An oracle-like relation and systems that improve

Borrowing leaves an epistemic problem: a model may return an answer whose grounds this person cannot presently reconstruct. It is **oracle-like relative to that participant**, rather than an authority that makes the answer true. Sources, explanations, and independent checks can change the relation. Neither complete reconstruction nor blind trust is required for every useful contribution.

Self-improvement is a separate question. Schmidhuber's theoretical Gödel machine guides self-rewriting through proofs under encoded assumptions and utility [20]; the Darwin Gödel Machine generates agent-code changes and evaluates them empirically [21]. Model weights, tools, and an improvement loop are different objects. For the borrower, the necessary distinction is **acquiring capability, evaluating a result, and cultivating a personal capacity**. A useful output establishes none of the other outcomes by itself. The cooperation needs arrangements for each contribution it seeks.

## A changing world and a finite participant

Available power changes the conditions in which a finite person acts. Concept drift offers a technical comparison: conditions during use can depart from the data distribution on which a learned model relied [26]. Personal purposes and relationships are richer objects, but their working descriptions likewise need reconsideration when their conditions change.

There is no single measured rate at which everyone must catch up. Customer-support research found gains varying with experience [32]; METR's early-2025 developer study found a slowdown in its setting, and its later account explains measurement difficulties [33]. Karpathy's October 2026 account describes a widening difference in experienced capability, relating it to task ambition, domain, and access [34]. His roughly 20 million figure is an informal estimate of professional frontier-model experience in math and code. These sources make collaboration and its conditions objects of inquiry; they do not prove that every new model benefits every task.

The response proposed here is to develop the ability to notice worthwhile possibilities, give them a form, and pursue them through consequences. A person can sense a relation before possessing the words or implementation skills to unfold it. The model can help

articulate and realize it, while the person encounters objections and learns what the result makes possible. Technical knowledge, embodied experience, reading, and intuitive judgment contribute differently to that practice.

**Individual-first** orients the arrangement toward this person's purposes and voluntary development. Seek changes to social arrangements, then software, before requiring personal adaptation, following concrete dependencies and respecting others' lives. This directs the borrowed fire toward a life rather than turning each change outside it into a demand upon it.

## Generate, encounter correction, generate further

Generation can begin as an embodied analogy, a sensed relation, or an example drawn from broad reading. The person contributes something to unfold; the model can give it a full verbal or technical form. Cultivation concerns what this exchange develops in the person's perception and understanding.

A powerful producer can leave its human counterpart chiefly sensing conditions and evaluating outputs they do not understand. Receiving and assessing a work can teach, but successful evaluation alone does not establish the ability to generate an explanation, hypothesis, or next act. For a developmental purpose, the relation can deliberately turn: **the person generates and expresses; the model critiques, corrects, and scaffolds; the person generates further.** An example, conjecture, image, or unfinished explanation gives the model something to understand and test. Correction becomes fruitful when the person takes it into another attempt rather than merely approving a replacement answer. Speaking can itself make a half-formed relation available, with the counterpart helping it continue.

This cultivates a selected capacity; it does not require the person to produce everything in every task. The model can prepare materials, write complete text and code, and build and maintain the environment. Its generation can open what the person could not yet imagine. A bounded study of 52 developers learning an unfamiliar Python library found weaker immediate learning in the AI-assisted group; its interaction analysis also identified cognitively engaged patterns [12]. A different randomized physics study found learning benefits with a deliberately designed AI tutor [19]. These findings resist a verdict about AI assistance as such. The practical question concerns how this encounter connects generation, correction, and continued understanding, and what the person can subsequently recognize, explain, or do.

The bridge begins with a functional comparison. **A person and a model counterpart can both be studied through relations of purpose, interpretation, action, and revision.** A person articulates a concern; the counterpart interprets it, proposes or performs an action, and returns a result; both can revise their understanding through that result. This shared vocabulary makes questions of agency, narrative, and self-

formation relevant to cooperation. Humanities scholarship supplies ways to understand those relations; research on particular models examines how they are realized. Differences of embodiment, experience, and implementation matter when they change what a participant can contribute or how a result should be interpreted.

YinYang names the philosophical framework developed here for a person's relationship with a generative model. A **harness** arranges Skills, prompts, hooks, tools, model choices, roles, and the user's actual environment through which work becomes possible. A **meta-harness** supplies the understanding through which that arrangement is interpreted and revised: what the work serves, who participates, and how its consequences matter. A role such as "teacher" or "assistant" acquires a situated meaning through the person being helped, their purpose, and the relationship developed in use. YinYang couples models of the person and counterpart with an account of their relationship. **Reverse alignment** is its chosen developmental direction: as a model is directed toward a person's purposes, the person develops understanding, judgment, and generative capacity through the encounter.

This essay develops that direction as a philosophical proposal and a practice to be realized. Philosophical sources supply concepts and arguments; recent AI papers and research reports describe particular systems. Their contributions meet in the inquiry: how can available generative capability become part of this person's developing life? The direction is chosen; the realization is examined through what the person and counterpart actually understand, create, and do.

## From living fire to interacting event streams

The starting point is a philosophy of becoming. Heraclitus's living fire, its measured transformations, and the tension of bow and lyre place change and opposing relations at the center [13]. YinYang adopts **contemporary fire monism** to express its worldview: the changing natural world is one reality, in which persons, objects, and relations persist as relatively stable patterns and transform through encounters. Fire names this becoming, without making literal flame the material of everything. Philosophy, psychological activity, and engineering share this physical ground. **The histories of the person and model's activity can be represented as event streams.** From these histories and other materials, the participants construct conceptual models of the person, counterpart, and relationship. A participant is not their history or its record. Physical ground and computational abstraction develops this connection.

Two existing research traditions provide connections. In knowledge representation, Gruber explains ontology as an explicit specification of a conceptualization, articulating objects and relations so participants can share and inspect their meanings [24]. This supports the emphasis here on question-relative objects, relations, and working views. Dodig-Crnkovic's info-computationalism connects informational structure with compu-

tational dynamics, discussing agency and cognition across levels [25]; it supplies a neighboring framework for bringing ongoing change into a computational account. This essay distinguishes **structure available for inference** from **continuing process** and proposes its own event-stream modeling. The two sources do not jointly establish this entire philosophy or a reduction of human experience to a digital algorithm. Particular correspondences and physical realization need further argument.

An event stream represents a history of occurrences through temporal, causal, and interpretive relations. A perception, an utterance, a reading, a generated hypothesis, and an action can each become an event in that representation. Memory, context, habits, commitments, and consequences help interpret what happens without requiring an unchanging self-description. The event granularity follows the inquiry. Histories can overlap, branch, and proceed at different rhythms; a transcript records only some occurrences. This shared form for representing histories leaves the participants' embodiments, capacities, and implementations to be understood in their own right.

A self-model or counterpart model is a conceptual account inferred and constructed from such histories, other relevant materials, and philosophical understanding. Producing, reading, and correcting it are further events, able to change what follows. A literary image can reorganize attention; an explanation can alter the next interpretation; a completed work can change what the person can initiate. Language is effective here because using it participates in the activity it helps articulate. Forming and revising the account do not stand outside becoming.

Computational ontology is representation. This framework constructs a process ontology using question-relevant objects, events, states, relations, constraints, and transitions. Its subjects include actual people and psychological activity, hypothetical situations, and fictional objects. Imagining is an actual activity; its imagined referent need not exist as described. Person and language model develop this selection and its computational model together, dividing contributions through reasoning, simulation where useful, implementation, and feedback. A usable representation gives its distinctions usable meanings; factual claims must correspond to what is actually the case, while formal consequences depend on the selected interpretation and premises. Either participant can examine both; records alone do not reproduce the stream. Neither a complete world simulator nor a particular logging architecture follows from this ontology. The bounded example shows how the shared movement reaches actual computer use and returns.

Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji give this becoming its central relational image. Differentiated participants generate, receive, and transform through one another; their contributions acquire meaning in the encounter. The Shuang yu and their differently colored eyes distinguish a chosen role from the participant who exceeds it. This image gives the reciprocal movement of event streams a perceptible form. Continuing transformation allows particular works to be completed and useful arrangements to

remain stable: a completed work enters the next encounter as something available to use and reconsider.

Conflicting material tests this continuity. A coherent working ontology can support present action while retained evidence and candidate interpretations remain in conflict. General paraconsistency supplies background for considering conflict without arbitrary conclusions following [14]; prioritized inconsistency-tolerant querying gives a more specific formal comparison [16]. The preference-harness account develops the distinction between selecting views and reasoning within them. These contemporary constructions extend an inquiry into becoming and opposition; historical readings of Heraclitean fire monism and contradiction remain disputed [15].

The **little fire person and Baby Heraclitus** give this participant a literary form: the capacity to kindle further fire belongs to someone still taking shape through encounters. Ontologically, the person was already part of the fire; cultivation gives their existing agency new capacities and a distinctive form.

What enters an encounter may itself be generated and internally uneven. A model can offer accounts that conflict with one another; reading them does not make them all true. A participant can find more than one possibility persuasive, want different things, or change their judgment through another encounter. Their own generation then includes the tension among what has been received, desired, and newly proposed. Such tension can open further inquiry rather than requiring an instantly finished self-description.

Cultivation develops a way to live and act through it: keep alternatives available, examine what supports them, distinguish a changed situation from an actual conflict, and choose enough of a working view to proceed. Where claims do conflict, retaining them for inquiry does not license arbitrary conclusions. A consequence can change the choice and the next act. The fire person's continuity lies in this revisable movement, not in agreement with every generated account or permanent consistency among all their desires.

## Why the relation must begin somewhere personal

Plato's *Protagoras* gives fire another consequence. In its myth, Prometheus brings arts and fire, yet these means do not suffice for civic life. Zeus sends reverence and justice to be shared by all [22]. The contemporary comparison is limited but fruitful: technical capacity leaves questions of purpose, relationship, and living together open. The dialogue supplies a distinction to think with, not a prediction of AI. Personal-first adaptation likewise chooses whose purposes an arrangement serves; it does not make factual truth depend on preference. Other participants and the world still answer back.

Power does not select its own worthwhile use. A model's increasing capability leaves open what should matter here, which contribution is wanted, and what would count as a life made more capable. A reusable template cannot settle these questions simply

by being reusable. It becomes useful when interpreted within someone's purposes and circumstances.

Understanding the person therefore has a practical task: make enough of their concerns, ways of noticing, desired development, and relation to others intelligible for collaboration. The person already perceives, interprets, prefers, and acts as an agent. The project condenses personal models from event history, philosophy, and personal material so the counterpart can understand what a request means in this life. A personal philosophy can concentrate that meaning; experience with actual works and arrangements can ground, test, and change it. Preferences, psychological understanding, and concepts contribute to the same account while retaining their different grounds. The material requires interpretation and correction through interaction. Being written does not make it complete self-knowledge.

This work gives personal references and working models different places. `references/personal/` holds psychological and life material and maintained interpretations; it is the entrance for understanding one's own psychology. The six situated files condense what the collaboration needs and how the environment should fit this person's psychology, purposes, and circumstances. An account of a recurring fear can remain in the references while a working file retains the support that helps the next writing task. Their revision starts by reading the adopted philosophy and refreshing references from relevant histories, correcting interpretations before condensing the six files, changing the environment, and checking fit. A better arrangement gives evidence about cooperation without making the psychological interpretation certain.

**Understanding the user, however, has not yet determined how the counterpart should participate.** The same wish can receive different responses: doing the work, explaining, objecting, or trying something together. Someone developing through reading and intuitive judgment may need a different contribution from someone practicing a particular implementation skill. A user portrait alone may leave the default assistant role deciding everything. Calling an agent intelligent, gentle, or strict does not explain why those qualities fit this person. The counterpart model connects this gap: in relation to the person, purposes, and actual work, it articulates what the agent attends to, how it interprets and judges, which work it carries, and when it questions or revises shared understanding. The relationship account connects the contributions without mistaking a division of work for a limit on either participant's abilities.

This also requires understanding the actual model. Its capabilities, response tendencies, context, and tools condition how a proposed counterpart can be realized. The values and priorities it is asked to adopt express what the collaboration should become. These are distinct matters. Human psychology and model psychology, human preferences and model preferences, here involve both investigating actual tendencies and constructing a relationship. Assigning a role does not rewrite base-model weights; a functional com-

parison does not establish identical psychological mechanisms or experience. Works and actions make that construction answerable beyond a mutually satisfying description.

Two connected directions of alignment follow: **the agent adapts its contribution through understanding the user, and the user develops generative capacity through that fitted collaboration.** Independent questioning belongs to this relation when purposes, facts, or realization conflict. The person can discover what they mean by encountering a proposed interpretation; the model can develop an intuition into a work in which the person recognizes a fit or an error they could not yet express.

Formation therefore starts with enough understanding to proceed. An existing philosophy, a working tool, or experience needing expression can supply the opening. Psychology can clarify patterns of attention and response; preferences can articulate what matters. **Views orient realization, experience tests views and arrangements, and engineering makes new experience possible.** The Trinity account develops this relation. The accounts gain substance through making and using, rather than requiring complete accounts before work can begin.

Clark and Chalmers's extended-mind argument makes room for cognitive activity organized across a person and active environmental supports [1]. YinYang draws a practical consequence: records, images, tools, and the model's work can carry parts of understanding. Its commitment to personal development then asks how this arrangement changes what the person can perceive, judge, initiate, and sustain. Assistance and development become distinguishable outcomes to examine in the same practice.

## A self can be written and lived

A self-description can report existing relations and help its reader interpret a situation or choose a next action, including when the reader is the person being described. Writing can also propose a role or establish a commitment that participates in shaping subsequent conduct. Recording what has happened and constructing how to continue can both contribute to a life that is still unfolding.

Bruner's account of life as narrative develops this two-way relation: culturally available stories help organize the life that is subsequently understood and narrated [2]. Foucault's technologies of the self concern practices through which people transform their conduct and ways of being, sometimes with others' help; writing and rereading figure among the practices he examines [3]. These sources make self-articulation intelligible as an activity with formative consequences. They do not require treating the person as a complete text.

YinYang extends that possibility to a contemporary situation. Language about oneself can be encountered by a generative counterpart capable of interpretation and action. Writing the relationship can help bring into being a practice that did not previously have that form. The text is carried into conversations, investigations, works, and decisions; their consequences return to the understanding of the self.

This is where forming a sinthome enters the account. The name here refers to a personal practical arrangement formed jointly from personal material, personal and counterpart models, usable expression, and actual realization. Through such an arrangement, available generative capabilities enter relevant activities of living and creating. It may help someone continue work or stabilize life; use may also reveal a mismatch. Concrete material, organizing relations, and actual participation give the arrangement personal content, while consequences in use help judge its adequacy and how to revise it.

## Meaning before a truth claim

“Sun and Moon meet” gives YinYang's differentiated generating, receiving, and shaping an intelligible form. The actual person and model participate through a relationship whose emphases can be retained or exchanged. “Collective fire acquisition continues; use available fire to cultivate generative capacities” connects this relationship to development. Claims about capabilities or human growth then acquire objects that can be examined.

This gives a precise sense to *neither true nor false, yet understandable*. A literary construction introduces a possible organization; a proposed role invites conduct; a chosen orientation gives activity a direction. Each has a use through which its meaning unfolds. Once interpretation makes a claim about an actual capacity, event, or consequence, truth becomes the relevant question for that claim. Meaning opens the space in which questions can be formed, and those questions acquire their own conditions of assessment.

Carnap's distinction between questions within a linguistic framework and the practical choice to use a framework offers a philosophical resource [4]. An organizing vocabulary can be assessed through what it lets us formulate and do. Claims developed within that vocabulary can then be examined on their own grounds. This distinction helps articulate how a literary world becomes a medium for inquiry and action.

In this sense, literary language can participate in a **computational ontology**: Sun and Moon can organize reciprocal contributions; a retained account and a currently accepted view can have different roles; a work can return as a new object of understanding. Such language becomes a computational representation when an actual model can interpret and use these distinctions to organize the encounter, develop consequences, or guide action. Its effects and correspondence to the encounter remain assessable. Naming roles alone is insufficient. An ontology supplies distinctions through which inquiry proceeds; it need not be an inventory of ultimate substances or an entirely executable specification.

Calling this the model's ontology concerns the working organization of the counterpart and encounter. The language makes roles, relations, and transformations available for interpretation; the model's implementation determines how that language is taken up. Different realizations can interpret related language, and their differing results can

motivate revisions. Ontological articulation and causal investigation thus contribute to the same practice from different questions.

## Literary programming and the model counterpart

Literary programming gives the relationship an intelligible form through characters, purposes, tensions, and possible conduct. Natural-language programming lets an actual model interpret that form and act with it. Images can condense connected relations: “Moon” can evoke receiving, developing, judging, and returning. Their usefulness depends on what the counterpart actually understands and does. Knuth's *literate programming*, which joins explanation and program code, is a different established use of the term [5].

For cultivation, the important question is what kind of counterpart this person needs. “Teacher” or “assistant” acquires meaning through the work and the capacities being developed. A person cultivating judgment may need complete works to inspect and challenge; someone learning an implementation skill may need attempts, criticism, and another try. Neither role language nor a beautiful story ensures the contribution occurs.

The philosophical whole connects the images rather than merely collecting them. Fire expresses becoming and the passage from collective acquisition to personal cultivation; Sun and Moon express contributions in an encounter; event streams articulate continuity and revision; a harness gives the relation an executable body. A single vocabulary need not erase their differences. It needs to make their relations understandable enough to guide and revise practice.

*Reverse prompt injection* names the ambition to bring that whole into the model's interpretation, so isolated words or default roles do not decide the response by themselves. Its “hard to refuse” character is an invitation to assess what the proposal actually means. A counterpart can still identify contradictions, missing evidence, or unrealizable arrangements. Its response gives evidence of interpretation; an actual constraint requires investigation of the model, context, and harness.

Natural-language prompting has technical precedents: Reynolds and McDonell discuss intentions, narratives, and cultural proxies in GPT-3 [6]. More recent sources illuminate different aspects. Claude's Constitution supplies a developer's connected account of intended conduct [7]; the Persona Selection Model proposes an explanation of assistant-persona formation [8]; Anthropic's emotion-concept report describes causal interventions in a particular model [9]. These are reasons to examine interpreted organization, rather than proof that literary prompting always improves performance. *Principled Personas* finds inconsistent benefits and sensitivity to irrelevant details across its tested tasks and models [10].

Adaptation work can itself be borrowed. GEPA uses model reflection on execution traces to propose and evaluate prompt changes [11]. This helps locate the criticism of pursuit:

useful revision serves a chosen practice and can be carried by the collaboration. The person need not spend their life manually reconstructing every improvement before benefiting from it.

The claim earns its place in use. Examine how the counterpart interprets unfinished expression, which work it carries, and whether the resulting encounters support the chosen understanding, generation, or action. Improved cooperation and increased personal capacity are connected possibilities, each requiring its own evidence.

## Bring the fire into a world that answers

The composition in Sun, Moon, and Earth gives this connected understanding a perceptible form. In one arrangement, the person foregrounds intuitive generation as Sun, and the model receives, develops, judges, and creates as Moon. Each can generate and give form; the roles can be retained or exchanged. The two working models articulate these actual participants and their relationship. Earth names the material and shared living environment in which their creations acquire consequences.

A work gives the relationship distance from itself. A program runs; an argument encounters an objection; another person understands an image differently. What returns may change the interpretation, the implementation, or the desire that started the work. Neither human–model agreement nor narrative coherence determines what the world must do.

The distinctions among worldview, ontology, theory of truth, epistemology, axiology, and methodology developed in Personal-first humanism now have a reason to remain separate. A worldview gives the practice its larger understanding of the world; ontology articulates what its representation admits. Epistemology asks how judgments are warranted, while correspondence with what is the case determines factual truth. Satisfaction and inference relative to an interpretation concern the representation's semantics. Value concerns worthwhile purposes, and methodology concerns how to inquire and act. Computational representations organize these concerns in usable forms, physically realized through bodies, machines, and activity. Practice brings participant models and judgments into contact with consequences that answer. Keeping several interpretations available need not mean accepting all their incompatible assertions. These distinctions allow the common language to remain fertile without becoming immune to correction.

## What makes the fire one's own

The developmental question is what the person becomes able to perceive, understand, initiate, and judge through the practice. Some capacities can be internalized; others can remain reliably distributed across tools, records, and collaborators. Measuring all development by unaided individual capacity would omit the reliably supported forms this framework also recognizes. Yet a larger output does not by itself show a larger understanding.

YinYang therefore asks what development is sought in this particular practice. A person cultivating understanding and intuitive judgment may learn through reading, questioning, comparison, and encountering a finished work, while the model carries extensive implementation. A person learning an implementation skill needs opportunities to exercise that skill. The division follows the purpose; it need not become an exam imposed on every conversation.

A personal philosophical and literary Skill can give this practice a direction from above: it articulates purposes, preferences, habits, and ways of understanding through which surrounding Skills acquire their place. A research method, a writing tool, or a way of arranging the environment becomes personal through how it serves this life. Its components may come from others, and its implementation may be largely model-authored. What makes the arrangement personal is the developed relation to the person, rather than exclusive authorship or perfect fit achieved once and for all.

Through repeated use, this arrangement can accumulate **personal software assets and intellectual assets**. Here an asset is saved understanding, a method, software, a work, or an articulated relation that remains available for reuse and revision. Software gives a practice an executable body; concepts, literary forms, and preserved works carry ways of noticing, interpreting, and creating. Their value lies in what they continue to make possible: a later encounter can begin from understanding and working means already developed, rather than reconstructing them each time. This continuity can support further development, but the number of Skills or saved outputs does not measure it. An unused collection may remain a collection; a smaller arrangement can become deeply sustaining.

The movement also returns from below. Actual use reveals where a method fits, where it frustrates a purpose, and what the person now wants or understands differently. Revising the surrounding Skills can therefore revise the philosophical Skill that gave them direction. The methodology helps assets accumulate by connecting personal orientation, working realization, retained results, and correction. It preserves what serves the person while allowing replacement and simplification. Private personal substance stays with its situated owner; authorized reusable methods can enter the common collection without carrying that substance with them. Models, collaborators, and the world continue to contribute independently: cultivating one's own assets gives their contributions a durable place in a life.

The image of a miniature god gives personal creation after borrowing fire another form. Borrowed power enters life through a counterpart and environment, letting a finite creator initiate previously difficult works and participate in deciding how they take shape. Their power includes making relations, choosing what to sustain, and allowing creations to change them. Fire becomes one's own through such participation, even while its source remains outside oneself.

## A way of learning: prepare the encounter

Borrowed fire can illuminate a subject before the learner knows how to arrange it. The model can find and select sources, compare their suitability, and edit them into materials through which the person can enter the subject. Preparation belongs to the cooperation itself. A learner need not first become a librarian or build a standardized knowledge base to deserve a useful explanation. For ordinary use, the first question is what would make the next encounter with the subject intelligible and fruitful; an elaborate catalog can consume the finite attention it was meant to release.

The resulting materials can take several forms: a rewritten glossary tied to the source's usage, a table tracing how concepts change across authors or chapters, a study plan, a diagram of relations among ideas, a guide to passages worth skimming or reading closely, and exercises focused on the current difficulty. Text, images, audio, worked examples, and interactive demonstrations offer different ways into the same question. Select and combine them for what they let this learner understand or try. The model's rewriting should preserve the route back to sources, so a helpful simplification can be compared with what it explains.

An Obsidian reading space can place edited notes and the relevant PDFs together, with readable links between a concept, its explanation, a related question, and the source passage. Bidirectional links help the person return from a new connection to the material that gave it substance. Their contribution is the ease of reading and returning, rather than the number of links. The person brings lived associations, embodied intuition, recognition of meaning, and judgment of the whole; the model contributes retrieval, explicit comparison, structured explanation, and material preparation. These are useful contributions, not exclusive possessions. Both can reason and revise. Learning becomes cultivation when explanation, practice, and correction change what the person can recognize, explain, or do on the next encounter.

Consider a hypothetical encounter with the paper and research report linked in source [12]. A person initially counts the two documents as independent studies confirming the reported immediate-learning difference. The model follows the report's paper link and compares the authors and experiment: the report and arXiv 2601.20245v2 present the same experiment by Judy Hanwen Shen and Alex Tamkin. Two presentations can aid understanding, but they do not provide two independent empirical results. The proposed correction is therefore to trace the underlying experiment, rather than count documents agreeing about a result, before judging independent confirmation. A later report creates a discriminating next question: does the person check whether it describes a new study before treating it as another confirming result, and can they explain why that matters? That would supply evidence of changed judgment; the hypothetical does not claim the change has occurred. The model can maintain the source links and comparison notes.

## A way of working: give an intuition a body

A person can begin with an intuition, an unfinished relation, or a felt friction. The model helps articulate what the person has not yet made explicit: investigate the conditions, develop alternatives, construct the chosen work, and compare the result with the purpose that called it forth. The person need not reproduce the model's detailed labor before that labor can help. Something concrete enough to inspect, redirect, and use offers an opportunity to develop understanding and judgment. Whether development occurs depends on what the person subsequently recognizes, judges, or does differently.

For work involving files, tools, and an ongoing local environment, a capable model in a local harness can carry this movement from expression to action and readback. It can prepare materials, edit the work, observe execution, repair a failure, and retain enough context for the next contribution. This continuity gives the person's corrections somewhere to take effect. A Web conversation can help explore a question and leave a short plan or reference for subsequent work; choose the execution environment by its actual access, visibility, and ability to continue through failures. Repeatedly moving the same task among disconnected conversations can spend attention rebuilding the relation instead of developing the work.

Completion gives the fire a usable body: a text that can be read, a tool that works in its intended environment, or a change whose effects have been checked. Keep the understanding and working means that make another encounter easier; revise or replace what has ceased to help. Personal software and intellectual assets then accumulate through use. Their worth is the capacity they return to the person's life, including new questions and more ambitious creations.

## A way of living: choose the rhythm of the fire

**Ordinarily synchronize with the model and remain asynchronous with society; align temporarily when entering social evaluation.** This organization lets daily work use an environment shown to fit better, while preserving a way to meet external comparisons on their own terms.

This rhythm also has a developmental reason. Social institutions, software, and conventions of interaction often have to keep existing participants, agreements, records, and ways of working viable. They carry historically formed relationships, and change requires coordination among participants. This **backward compatibility** sustains shared life while preventing a new understanding from immediately becoming the form used everywhere. Continuous synchronization with every established arrangement can require repeatedly translating emerging thought into older vocabularies, interfaces, and rhythms, spending generative capacity on maintaining compatibility.

A person's relationship with a language model can choose another developmental direction: articulate purposes, relations, and evidence clearly enough for a more capable

counterpart to understand and improve the arrangement. Forward evolution toward new capabilities allows old prompts, tools, and compensations to be replaced, without requiring new practice to remain organized around earlier model limitations. **Forward compatibility** here is a direction for joint design and continued maintenance; actual understanding, works, and action must show whether a new model can carry it forward. Personal environments can develop from present needs without first waiting for every external institution and participant to adopt the same understanding.

Between these rhythms, **asynchronous connection leaves room for generation**. A person and model can develop a question, reshape an environment, or complete a work, then connect it to other relationships through records, exchangeable results, and chosen moments. Compatibility work is located at concrete interfaces and encounters instead of occupying every act of thought. Synchrony with the model keeps shared understanding, present purposes, and ongoing revisions continuable. The two can correct one another and change the arrangement as capabilities and life develop. Such synchrony can itself be realized through asynchronous messages and tool execution. Social asynchrony also preserves different levels of organization and capability: a richer local way of thinking and working need not be reduced to what the prevailing social interface can receive at every moment.

Social evaluation is one encounter at which alignment becomes necessary. A person can temporarily bring the greater breadth or complexity of everyday work down to the assessment's receiving level: select the relevant result, answer its stated question, translate the explanation, and follow the specified conditions for tools, support, time, and demonstration. The fuller arrangement is expressed through a bounded, legible slice. Where the assessment asks for common conditions, that adjustment can include setting aside support used in ordinary work. Report the result within those conditions; the slice does not exhaust the person's capacity or the combination's potential.

After evaluation, return to the arrangement that enables better ordinary work. Compatibility at this encounter need not govern the whole internal process. The assessment can supply useful feedback, but its receiving level is not a permanent limit on understanding, generation, or future development.

“Asynchrony with society” therefore concerns how established arrangements are connected; the world continues to supply conditions and consequences. Bodily needs, shared responsibilities, and actual risks have their own timing. Other people can innovate together, and models can retain outdated assumptions. This direction chooses a rhythm for each relation, allowing personal generation to develop and return to shared life for response.

This rhythm, stated in YY-08, gives the person room to develop something of their own choosing. The model can help gather loose ends, prepare the next encounter, and carry routine detail so that returning does not require starting again. The person can leave

a work and come back to it, meet friends, attend to bodily life, and let an unexpected experience change its direction. Chosen relationships, responsibilities that need timely action, and feedback from the world shape which matters can be asynchronous and which call for presence. The Earth continues to answer; its independent events keep the shared account alive.

Learning, working, and living give borrowed fire different forms. Prepared materials open understanding; completed works extend action; a chosen rhythm lets both find a sustaining place in life. These transformations develop the person's participation in generation. From fire toward fire, capacities enter new relations, and what returns changes what can next be made.

## Cultivating a garden of becoming with friends

One's environment also includes friends cultivating themselves. They encounter a useful method, bring it into their work, develop new understanding and works, and return with different questions and discoveries. One person's growth can thereby change the world another encounters: conversation gains richer objects, collaboration gains new capacities, and an unfinished idea more readily meets someone able to carry it forward. Joint cultivation of an environment takes place in these concrete exchanges.

This is one purpose for putting these writings into circulation. Let people close enough to encounter one another gain access to understanding and methods already formed, so that the next conversation or creation can begin further along. Friends may adopt, rework, or develop different directions; new perspectives and objections give the relationship continuing substance. Shared capacities connect with distinct lives. Each person's development has its own meaning and can also offer new conditions to others.

Readable writing lowers the threshold for an encounter; reusable methods shorten the distance from understanding to trying something. Public circulation also brings material into relations in which its author does not participate. Reading, copying, actual use, and collaboration that permits continuing exchange are different events. Writing can therefore take its direction from relations worth sustaining: what to share, how to continue, and how discoveries in use can return to shared discussion. Reach and iteration speed gain value through this purpose rather than independently determining it.

This choice becomes a principle of **cultivation nearby and limited circulation**. Personal philosophy and the website first improve life for oneself and nearby willing participants, circulating as little as is sufficient to help those relationships. Borrowing fire enables life to respond to model development; accelerating society is not another output target. Effective revisions nearby can become faster while good arrangements remain more stable. Active promotion farther afield needs a concrete contribution to justify it.

Fire and water give this connection an image. Fire helps create, but water cannot absorb unlimited heating while remaining unchanged. When accelerating environments depend on one another, each local revision may become another person's new burden, triggering further catching up and revision. If understanding and negotiation cannot keep pace, changes may accumulate into disorder. This is not a law that universal personal priority must cause chaos; shared knowledge can also reduce duplicated work and improve coordination. The question is whether adding fire develops the capacity to live or mainly increases changes others must absorb. Restrain the diffusion one actively promotes, return feedback to relationships capable of encounter, and respect more distant people's choices. Core view YY-15 states this principle together.

**A shared garden of becoming** offers an image: friends borrow fire, make things, play, and revise, letting new possibilities appear in one another's worlds. The personal Gödel-machine analogy placed self-revision within a person's philosophy and practice; here that openness extends among friends. No one needs to become another's replica, and no shared text can write the next encounter in advance. The garden's delight comes from what these relations can keep generating; its quality remains answerable to the people within it and to actual consequences.

Such environments can also be compared as person–environment combinations, including the support's effects and costs. That asks a different question from comparing people under common support conditions. The chosen comparison must make its conditions clear; neither result defines the whole person.

## The argument in compact form

1. **Finite life and chosen purpose:** cultivating understanding, judgment, generation, and action gives a reason to resist pursuit that consumes the life it was meant to serve. Examining the pictures that organize pursuit can reopen what seems worth wanting and doing.
2. **Collective acquisition:** model companies, researchers, and the wider collective continue making capabilities available. The person can borrow that fire without repeating its entire industrial production.
3. **Personal cultivation:** access becomes developmental through participation—generating, encountering development and correction, judging, acting, and generating further. Some capacities internalize; others remain reliably supported.
4. **A formed relationship:** personal and counterpart models give the contributions direction. Literary language, Skills, tools, and works realize and revise that relation in an answering world.
5. **The little fire person:** Baby Heraclitus names the participant who keeps becoming through this practice, including changes in desire, judgment, habits, and living conditions. Generated material, desires, and judgments can diverge or change; re-

taining tensions does not make every claim true or every inference valid. Evidence, choices, and action let the movement continue.

6. **A sustainable fire:** chosen rhythms, useful retained works, and cultivation among willing friends give creation a place in life. Cultivation also changes grasping at capability, achievement, and self-image, drawing on nirvana's liberating direction to ask how to live more freely. Material and social consequences remain part of judging what the fire sustains.

**Borrow fire to cultivate oneself, letting creation contribute to freedom.** Acquisition continues collectively; cultivation happens through a particular person's participation. The little fire person is already part of the world's becoming and already an agent. What develops is a distinctive, revisable capacity to understand, judge, and create within it, including loosening one's grasp on capacity and identity. Being able to use, create, and also let go changes one's relation to the fire. The return to surrounding life gives this development its actual places, relationships, and occasions.

*Many hands bring fire. A person gives it a place in life, meets what it makes possible, and begins again. What is made returns to change the maker. The fire continues.*

## Sources and their contributions

The recent AI material is a selected comparison, not an exhaustive literature review. The humanities sources develop concepts directly relevant to the argument; the AI sources bear on particular realizations. Entries [8] and [9] are researcher-authored theory/report material; [12] is a preprint. Their status is not silently promoted to consensus.


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38. **Nibbāna Sutta**, *Saṃyutta Nikāya* 38.1, translated by Ṭhānissaro Bhikkhu. Text. Nirvana as the ending of passion, aversion, and delusion, with the noble eightfold path; the question about creative cultivation's purpose is this essay's extension.

## Mythic sources

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- Hesiod, **Theogony**, lines 507–616, especially the fire theft around 565–567: Hugh G. Evelyn-White's translation. The carrier of fire informs the image; this essay does not adopt the surrounding mythology as a theory of AI.

# Personal-First Humanism



A person shapes a clay bird while a robotic counterpart adjusts a lamp, reachable tray, and workbench to fit their body and creation.

*A person encounters an arrangement made for people in general. Something important in their life has no place in it. Making that difference intelligible can begin the work of changing the arrangement.*

A philosophy for personal practice begins somewhere concrete: someone perceives, understands, desires, makes, and lives through the consequences. Categories such as user, worker, reader, and citizen make some relations available. The person also brings circumstances and possibilities that those categories may leave unexpressed. **Personal-first humanism** names an ethical orientation for developing arrangements from that concrete encounter.

Its practical premise is explicit: people's developing understanding, voluntary agency, and ability to sustain worthwhile lives should give tools and cooperative arrangements their direction. A personal philosophy can help articulate what that premise means here, while a model helps give it working form. Actual consequences can then revise the arrangement and its account of the person.

## Real persons, revisable descriptions

Taking the person seriously does not require an exhaustive metaphysical theory of personhood. It requires acknowledging the actual life to which a description answers: embodied conditions, experiences, relations, commitments, and effects that continue beyond the description. A model of someone can be inadequate even when it is internally coherent. Their correction can disclose that inadequacy; subsequent experience can disclose another.

The framework adopts **modest naturalism** as its worldview and **physicalism** as its ontological position: persons, psychological activity, machines, and engineering occur in the same natural world. **Contemporary fire monism** gives its becoming and transformation an image. Process ontology further asks how things form, persist, and change. A domain ontology expresses that understanding for a particular question through events, states, objects, relations, and transitions, making human activity and change available for description, reasoning, and use. A computational ontology explicitly expresses these distinctions for computational use. Physical grounding locates this activity in reality; computational representation articulates what we select and how we understand it. Physical ground and computational abstraction develops this connection.

"The person is real" therefore has a practical force here. A category, metric, or story does not exhaust the one who lives through its application. Its consequences belong in the assessment. The same force applies to other people; the encounter has more than one center of concern.

## Construction, nominalism, and fiction

The possibility of constructing a concept invites questions about what it represents and how it is used. A nominalist question concerns the status of universals and general categories. Hobbes's *Leviathan*, chapter IV, supplies one historical formulation by treating universal names as applying to individual things [1]. Such a formulation does not make those particulars disappear.

Fictionalism raises another question: could a discourse be useful without accepting its apparent claims as literally true? A selected fictional role can organize conduct; a thought experiment can develop consequences under imagined conditions. Computational ontology can represent these contents: a god someone believes in, an imagined companion, or an invented cartoon character can enter a process model through beliefs, expectations, narratives, and actions. The imagining activity and its effects actually occur; the character acquires its meaning within the imagining or story. The model can therefore express who imagines what, how they use it, and what happens later. The metaphor essay develops how expressive constructions become interpretations and realizations.

These distinctions leave room to consider the stronger conditional: **if many of the concepts through which we organize life are constructed or treated as fictions, which constructions should we choose?** That question makes their adequacy important. It does not establish that everything is fiction. Nor does it derive an ethical answer from an ontological label. A construction could serve administration, efficiency, conformity, discovery, or an individual's development. Choosing among these directions requires reasons about what should matter.

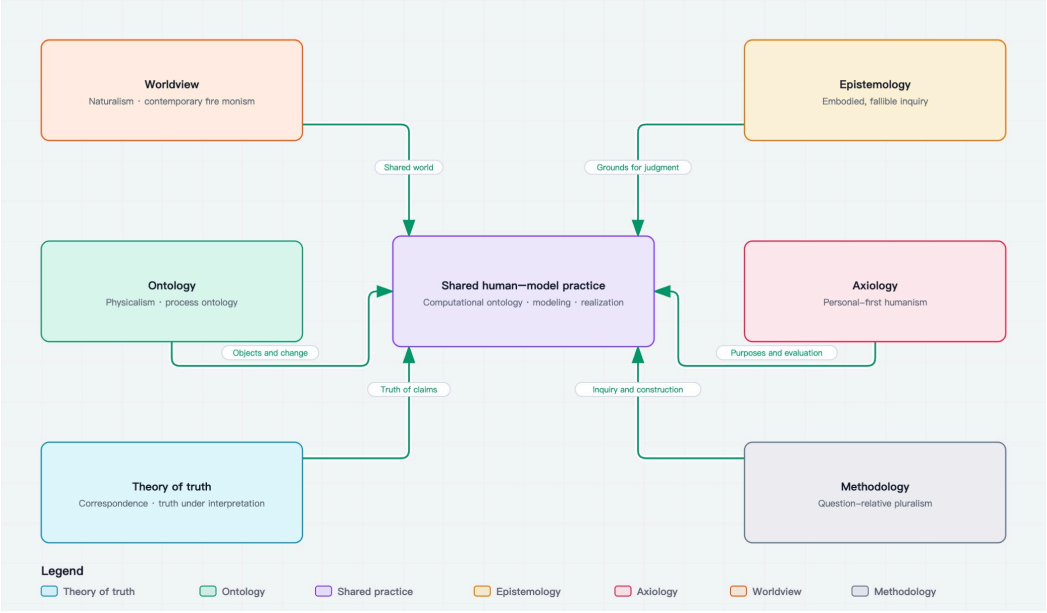
The personal-first premise supplies such a reason: concepts and arrangements should support actual persons' understanding and agency, and remain open to their corrections.

Constructibility gives revision room; the ethical premise gives revision a direction. The two contributions should remain distinguishable.

## Six connected dimensions

A philosophical account develops questions about the world, existence, truth, knowing, value, and method. An adopted position gives a particular answer within that inquiry. The distinction concerns the work a passage does: a theory unfolds an explanation and its reasons; a position states the understanding adopted in this practice. Both can be developed, criticized, and revised. "Worldview" remains the familiar name for the overall picture in which these answers belong.

### From understanding the world to realizing a practice




| Philosophical dimension and shared practice | Position or activity developed here | Contribution to modeling and practice |
|---|---|---|
| Worldview | Modest naturalism; contemporary fire monism expresses a changing natural world. | Place persons, models, and their activities in a shared picture of the world. |
| Ontology | Physicalism locates actual activity in one material reality; process ontology explains persistence and change. | Articulate the objects, events, relations, and continuity relevant to a domain model. |
| Theory of truth | Correspondence for claims about actuality; truth under an interpretation for statements in a model. | Specify what a claim says, its conditions of truth, and how an actual-world claim relates to its object. |

| Philosophical dimension and shared practice | Position or activity developed here | Contribution to modeling and practice |
|---|---|---|
| Epistemology | Embodied, fallible inquiry that develops through evidence and correction. | Organize observations, candidate explanations, inferences, and tests. |
| Axiology | Personal-first humanism: concrete persons' lives, agency, and chosen development give arrangements their direction. | Form goals and evaluation criteria whose consequences return to the people affected. |
| Methodology | Question-relative pluralism. | Select and combine inquiry, dialogue, formalization, simulation, experiment, and practical construction. |
| Shared practice | Person and model understand, model, express, construct, and evaluate together in reality. | The six dimensions meet in the work; experience and consequences revise understanding and arrangements. |

Here **humanism** locates value in human lives and agency. **Personal-first** brings that concern to the concrete person encountered, including circumstances that a generic category can miss. “Personal-first humanism” names the developed value position; “personal-first” and “personal-first orientation” emphasize its practical priority. Other persons remain bearers of purposes and consequences within the same concern. This is the connection between the essay's title, its value argument, and the goal-setting that follows.

An engineering criterion expresses this position in a particular task. For a reading interface, the goal might be to let someone follow a thought across related passages with less navigation effort. That criterion is a selected operational expression of the value position. The reader's experience can reveal whether the arrangement supports understanding, and can lead both participants to revise the criterion or the account that suggested it.

## Objects, models, expression, and realization

The six dimensions jointly guide domain understanding, purposes, and inquiry; the domain supplies objects and events that the account seeks to understand. Between them, people and models develop a conceptualization: a question-relative selection of entities, distinctions, and relations. Engineering makes selected meanings explicit and gives them usable forms.

In knowledge engineering, Gruber describes an ontology as an explicit specification of a conceptualization; Guarino further distinguishes that conceptualization from a theory expressing a vocabulary's intended meaning. These accounts help locate a **domain ontology** among our representations of a domain. Here a process-oriented domain ontology organizes participants, events, states, relations, constraints, and changes. A

conceptual model develops a particular account with those distinctions. Clear natural language, diagrams, or formal expressions can give that account a usable expression. Computational ontology makes its conceptual relations explicit for a model to interpret and use. In a private sinthome, relations among person, counterpart, work, correction, and continuation can acquire this computational use through natural language. Gruber, 1993; Guarino, 1998.

| Role in the practice | What it contains | Example: returning to unfinished reading |
|---|---|---|
| Actual world and shared activity | Persons, machines, events, material conditions, and consequences. | A reader loses the connection between two passages and tries to recover it. |
| Domain understanding and conceptual models | Selected objects and relations, proposed explanations, and relevant constraints. | Distinguish the reader, the passages, their conceptual connection, and the interruption; propose why navigation broke the connection. |
| Representation and expression | Language, diagrams, formal statements, data, and records carrying selected meaning. | Write the explanation, draw the reading path, or record where the reader stopped. |
| Engineering realization and use | Programs, tools, interfaces, and working arrangements that interpret and use representations. | Keep related passages together and make the reading position recoverable. |
| Philosophical framework | Developed explanations and adopted positions concerning world, existence, truth, knowing, value, and method. | Ask why continuity of understanding matters, what the explanation commits to, and what would warrant revising it. |

The roles distinguish relations within one practice. A document can carry a conceptual model; a program can embody a decision about which objects matter; a philosophical passage can itself be represented and examined. Their physical carriers and the activities of making and using them belong to the actual world. A representation reaches its subject through meaning and interpretation, while its carrier exists and operates through material processes. These two relations answer different questions.

The represented domain may concern actual life, a hypothesis, or a fictional situation. Actual-world claims invite comparison with their objects; hypothetical and fictional accounts develop consequences under their stated conditions. A person's imagining is actual activity whose content can concern an imagined character. Likewise, a participant, their activity history, selected records, and a conceptual model of them occupy different roles in understanding that life.

Six philosophical dimensions and shared practice expands all six dimensions from the first table, stating each adopted position and its contribution. Within practice, experience and questions inform domain understanding; computational ontology and conceptual

models acquire expression; engineering brings them into use. Consequences can revise the understanding, arrangement, and philosophical grounds.

Truth has a definite object here. Claims about actual life are assessed for correspondence with facts. Statements within a model are assessed under its interpretation and given conditions. Inferences from premises to conclusions are assessed under the adopted rules of reasoning. Applying a model to reality also requires examining its assumptions and their relation to the object. People and language models can participate in all these judgments. The theory of truth articulates what it means for a claim to hold; epistemology examines the grounds for accepting, doubting, or revising the judgment.

Evidence representations therefore remain answerable to experience, evaluation criteria to lived purposes, and executed procedures to judgments of methodological fit. A well-formed representation can explain the phenomenon poorly; a predictive model can serve a purpose we have reason to reject. Explanatory adequacy, worthwhile purposes, and methodological fit jointly affect how we use and revise models within the same practice.

"Begin with psychological adequacy before formal refinement" expresses a useful research direction when the question concerns a psychological phenomenon: recognize what needs explanation, then let formal tools clarify and test the candidate structure. The activities can interleave. Adequacy means addressing the phenomenon, including differences that an interpretation fails to explain. It does not mean making someone comfortable through flattering agreement. Mathematical validity and empirical adequacy retain their distinct checks.

Preferences can choose a question, direct attention, or guide the adoption of a working view. Evidence constrains what can be accepted as true about its object. Intuition and abduction can propose a candidate before all its conditions are explicit; comparison and feedback can develop or defeat it. This is why the epistemological name above emphasizes a starting point and corrigibility.

## Adapt arrangements around people

A personal-first design asks how a difficulty is produced before asking the person to absorb it. Some difficulties can be changed through a cooperative arrangement: when work happens, how decisions are shared, or what others need to receive. Others call for different software or an interface. A person can also choose to learn, practice, or change a habit for an end they recognize.

Considering social arrangements and software before demanding personal adaptation is a productive direction. It opens alternatives that a fixed environment might conceal. Actual dependencies can require another order; the question is which change serves the purpose under the circumstances.

For instance, an explanatory assistant might send every investigative detail to the reader. Instead of treating the reader's overload as a defect to train away, the collaborators can

redesign the explanation around the judgment the reader needs to make. The model can carry retrieval and implementation while making reasons, alternatives, and material uncertainty intelligible. The person participates through recognition, questioning, and decisions that matter. If the purpose is learning the investigative method, the allocation can change.

The improvement should be assessed through actual work: can the person understand the choice, influence its direction, and use what is produced? Output volume and the model's reassurance are different observations.

## Society is an encounter among persons

Society includes institutions and norms that shape what people can do. It also includes other persons with their own purposes, needs, and contributions. A philosophy more adequate to one individual can improve shared arrangements by revealing an overlooked possibility. It can also impose costs on others. Those effects belong to its assessment.

Mill's *On Liberty*, chapter III, argues for individuality and different experiments of living while retaining the condition of not injuring others [2]. This offers a source for the connection between singular development and plural coexistence. The present proposal develops it through revisable tools and model-supported practices.

A common framework can enable people to cooperate without demanding identical lives. Standards, stable interfaces, and shared procedures can protect useful continuity; they should also be open to criticism where their effects defeat their purposes. A person's disagreement is an occasion to investigate the relation, not automatic evidence that every social constraint is harmful.

Models contribute to that inquiry as interpreting and generating counterparts. Their participation can enlarge human agency while retaining independent judgment. Personal-first humanism chooses a purpose for the arrangement; it does not require the person to author every idea or perform every step. The composition in Sun, Moon, and Earth keeps these contributions and the independent world together.

## A changing person in a changing world

A person's understanding develops while tools and social conditions can also change. A representation adequate to an earlier encounter may need revision because the question, capabilities, or conditions have changed. Preserving continuity means retaining what still serves the practice while making such differences recognizable.

Carnap's account of framework adoption attends to purpose, fruitfulness, and the effort involved in using a linguistic form [3]. It provides a comparison for this choice among representations. Embodied Experimental Philosophy connects their selection with participation and later evidence. A system can support reasoning; reflection can

also examine its boundary and aim. Dynamic representation and model selection are resources in this work, rather than proof that any one account contains the whole life.

Return to the person whose life had no place in a general arrangement. Success need not mean that the person has learned to fit the old category. An explanation may become intelligible, a tool usable, or a different way of cooperating sustainable. The person may also choose a demanding change in themselves. Humanism gives these transformations their measure: what understanding, voluntary agency, and worthwhile activity do they make possible, and what do they ask of other lives?

## Sources and scope

The connected naturalist and fire-monist account, the six dimensions, and their model-supported realization state the philosophy adopted here. The sources contribute the distinctions identified above; personal-first humanism gives practice its value direction, developed and revised through actual consequences.

1. Thomas Hobbes (1651), **Leviathan**, chapter IV, "Of Speech." Original text. One historical account of universal names and particular things, not a proof of the present ethical orientation.
2. John Stuart Mill (1859), **On Liberty**, chapter III. Original text. Individuality and experiments of living within plural coexistence.
3. Rudolf Carnap (1950), **Empiricism, Semantics, and Ontology**. Public reprint. Purpose-sensitive adoption of linguistic frameworks; the personal-first premise is supplied separately here.

# Why write a personal philosophy



A person and counterpart add different components to one hanging mobile, connecting inquiry, writing, and making around a shared direction.

## A complex harness needs a shared direction

A computer environment takes up activities from the life someone is living. What to buy, how to consume and invest, whom to talk with, what to learn and create, and which relationships to sustain involve needs, pleasures, hopes, and choices. A person brings some of these into conversation; a model helps understand them, find information, and shape tools and instructions through which they can act. What happens in use returns to life and can change both the arrangement and the understanding that guided it. A personal computer environment condenses selected relations from that life.

After working with a model for some time, the environment grows increasingly complex. A research Skill finds materials, a writing Skill organizes articles, and a programming Skill implements them; prompts specify ways of communicating, hooks trigger checks when certain events occur, and tools connect files, browsers, and applications. The model itself is changing too. Where memory lives, how works are saved, how results are presented, and how the user participates all affect the collaboration that eventually takes shape.

Here, the arrangements that organize these activities are called a **harness**. It spans Skills, prompts, hooks, model selection and invocation, and the parts of the user's environment that participate in the work. These depend on one another: a way of asking questions changes how the user expresses themselves; an expression affects how the model understands a purpose; a way of organizing files affects what can later be recovered; and a way of checking results changes what the model is willing to complete.

Even after each component has been repaired separately, a shared question remains: whom is this environment helping, what kind of life is it helping them live, and how should the two participants work together? If every Skill answers for itself, research may pursue exhaustiveness, writing may pursue brevity, and execution may repeatedly hand judgments back to the user. Each local arrangement makes sense, yet together they become exhausting.

Personal philosophy can begin here. This essay takes YinYang as an example: writing out an understanding of the person, the model, and their relationship, so that scattered arrangements have a direction they can refer to together. A Skill's methods can then connect with this person's life, and a change to the environment can explain which form of participation it improves.

## First, what is an agent?

An **agent** here is a participant able to receive information in a situation, form or take up purposes, organize available capacities, and act; consequences can enter its next understanding and response. This is a functional description for organizing work. A person and model can participate in that description at relevant levels while retaining their bodily conditions, mechanisms, capacities, and responsibilities.

The person enters the later argument already as such an agent. Borrowed capacities broaden existing participation: they can understand and revise purposes, enlist models, records, tools, and relationships, turn conceptions into action, and adjust through consequences. What forms here is a personal philosophy: an expressed worldview and direction for living whose practice reaches across the environment.

“Becoming fire” is the broader generative image of the series: through participation, borrowed intelligence enters one's understanding, judgment, creation, and life, allowing further initiation and generation. Existing agency is this direction's starting point; developing enjoyment, understanding, and creation also takes becoming fire beyond execution. A shared direction therefore asks both how the environment helps someone complete the present work and what capacities for further understanding, judgment, and creation that work leaves them. The latter question gives this site's “reverse alignment” its direction.

This direction also calls for examining the pictures that organize it. If “becoming fire” means always pursuing the newest model or continually increasing output, life again answers to an external measure. Philosophy can reopen what deserves attention, what is enough, and which understandings and relationships need different conditions. From chasing to lived cultivation develops this relation through philosophical therapy and the Buddhist raft simile. Personal philosophy gives an environment direction while keeping that direction open to examination. Cultivation can change desires, habits, and surrounding life as well as develop capacities already selected.

## Whom does the same professor encounter?

Assigning a role to a model is a convenient way to organize behavior. “You are a professor” brings certain knowledge, language, and ways of teaching. But how the professor participates depends on whom they face and what is happening.

Two people come to the same professor. One is new to the subject and needs examples to form basic distinctions; the other knows the theory and wants to discuss a counterexample. Even if both ask the same sentence, suitable answers may be entirely different. The first may need a situation they can work with; the second may need to examine a hidden premise. The role supplies capacities and a stance; the relationship determines how those capacities enter the work at hand.

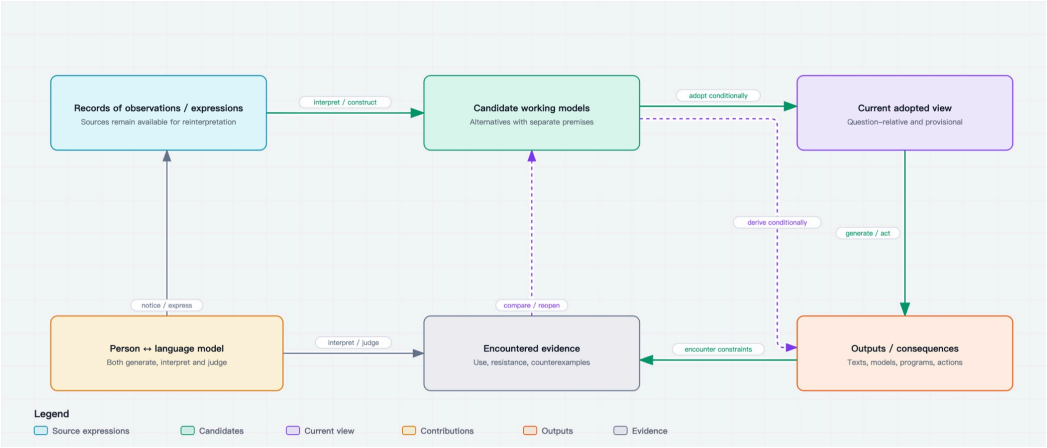
If the model knows only its own role, it can fill out the conversation only with an imagined student. The actual person may then feel: the answer is professional, but it has not responded to what I really want to do. So the other participant must also be written in: what they already understand, what they want to develop, how they participate, what confuses them, and how the present request carries their purpose forward.

This is also why giving the model an agent identity alone is insufficient. **A role capable of working together needs to understand both whom it encounters and what relationship the two participants are forming.**

## Writing both participants together

Human psychology and model behavior are both complex. In the face of this complexity, actual encounters can yield an understanding sufficient to carry the work forward: how the person attends, associates, expresses, chooses, and acts; how the model interprets, generates, judges, overlooks, and revises; and how these activities affect one another.

### How people and models inquire together




Person and model connect preferences, psychological activity, experience, concepts, and philosophical understanding. Someone may already know that they learn through

examples or want the model to carry implementation; they may also bring a concern, an enjoyable encounter, an aspiration, or a choice they do not yet understand. These materials enter the same inquiry. Psychological and life material, with maintained interpretations, has its home under `references/personal/`; this is the entrance for understanding one's own psychology. From that material and the adopted philosophy, the participants condense **personal working models** for collaboration and for fitting the environment to the person's psychology, purposes, and circumstances. The model helps articulate relations, propose explanations, compare situations, and write; the person contributes experience, purposes, recognition, objection, and changes of direction. They need not first know their own psychology or author a finished portrait.

Within this account, different claims retain different grounds. A desired response can guide collaboration before its psychological explanation is known. An explanation of how emotion, desire, interpretation, and relationships affect one another needs comparison with experience. Examining what “independence” or “ability” means can change how that experience is understood. Abduction, induction, analysis, synthesis, and conceptual clarification contribute together to understanding oneself and others.

This project's practice draws on long-term dialogue history, habits, and living material: what response followed an expression, what result a choice encountered, and how later understanding revised it. An **event stream** can organize this history; the personal model is the conceptual account developed from it and other material. Person and model connect preferences, proposed psychological relations, and philosophical concepts while retaining counterexamples and unresolved parts. This is a **natural-language conceptual model**, carried by prompts and revisable accounts and developed through practice. The language model's statistical generation helps express, compare, and use it; that mechanism does not itself amount to statistical fitting of this person's psychology. Formal or statistical methods can contribute when the question calls for them. The person-account formation guide explains how material, interpretation, and revision connect.

The philosophical writing can emphasize literature, engineering philosophy, Western philosophy, philosophy of science, logic, aesthetics, or another question important to its author. These emphases develop different aspects of the same practice of understanding. Writing in this sense can grow through dialogue and work when it interests the person. Using YinYang to organize experiences, revise personal material, and configure an environment does not require an original philosophical work. A maintained situated version states the views actually adopted in its working accounts; those views can be selected from existing thought.

Reading psychological literature or collecting self-reports does not produce an individual portrait by itself. The person's expression is fallible but informative; model inference remains a proposal to examine with sourced experience, choices, and results. Authored

philosophy expresses how the person understands the world and hopes to live; concrete experiences can correct that expression. Their interaction can yield better hypotheses about a fitting partner and criteria for trying an arrangement. Philosophical coherence or mutual agreement does not establish a psychological explanation's truth.

Philosophy and engineering here contribute together to understanding the person's experience and intentional orientation: what matters to them, what their wishes are directed toward, and how they understand events. Event history, philosophy, and personal material are condensed into personal models suited to the collaboration. The aim is a better-grounded initial environment design with less blind trial and error, calibrated through actual use. A personal account adequate to its use develops this connection.

A model of the person allows their experiences, preferences, and direction of development to enter the collaboration. For example, if someone is good at noticing that a whole arrangement does not fit but is unwilling to organize operational details one by one, that way of participating should affect the division of work. An understanding of the model helps arrange the contributions it is suited to make: unfolding relationships, investigating sources, making prototypes, completing implementation, or raising an objection at a real point of disagreement.

The two descriptions become effective within the relationship. The user offers an intuition that has not yet been clearly expressed, and the model tries to organize it; the user sees the resulting picture and points out where it has gone astray; the model revises its interpretation and approach accordingly. The user may also change their view through new relationships the model proposes. The two gradually come to know one another, and through that understanding become two agents better able to work together.

YinYang writes this working understanding into six actual files: orientation, person, counterpart, relationship, environment, and one's own revision method. Orientation articulates shared purpose and values; person and counterpart describe each participant as relevant to cooperation; relationship describes their participation together; environment describes the actual conditions of practice. The person file selects what a counterpart needs in work, while psychological exploration and its interpretations remain with the personal references. The actual revision method describes how this person revises the working models from evidence. Six public writing guides explain how to form the corresponding content, including How to revise. This understanding develops on both sides: what the person brings and seeks, what contribution the partner should make, and what its actual capabilities and response patterns support. Desired roles and priorities differ from demonstrated behavior. Internal processes are only partly accessible, while instructions, tools, responses, and consequences offer inspectable material; opening a model's weights does not by itself settle personal fit. The next encounter can correct any account or the arrangement between the participants.

## How the relationship enters Skills and the user's environment

YinYang first writes the author's own understanding of the world and direction for living for the model: what world person and model inhabit, how this person wants to live, and how they want to work together. Ontology helps distinguish people, models, descriptions, works, actions, and environments; epistemology helps interpret expression, assess grounds, and revise explanations. These distinctions let the model place a request within the actual person and relationship instead of repeatedly guessing at a generic user.

YinYang also supplies methods of its own: forming person and counterpart accounts from living material, revising understanding through dialogue, and realizing selected relations in an environment. Specialist Skills contribute domain knowledge and concrete ways of researching, teaching, writing, and engineering. The division joins shared understanding with domain expertise. The website lets the author read and revise his philosophy; GitHub makes content and implementation maintainable; the local Skill lets the model read them during work. Together these forms serve the configuration and use of the actual environment.

YinYang can therefore broadly influence personally made Skills and the user's environment. It gives local methods a shared basis for judgment. For example, if the participants choose for the person to participate more through looking, reading, intuition, and feedback, while the model undertakes detailed investigation and implementation, the research Skill should organize evidence that can be compared, the writing Skill should make relationships readable, and the programming Skill should turn an idea into something that can be tried. Prompts carry this division of work forward; hooks check results at suitable events; external memory keeps materials needed for later understanding; and interfaces make important relationships visible.

These arrangements also work together. If we merely ask the model to be “more proactive” while materials cannot be retrieved, tools cannot be used, and results cannot be inspected, that initiative has nowhere to take hold. Realizing the relationship in the environment means preparing capacities, paths, and feedback for contributions together. Philosophy thereby enters concrete work: it affects what to ask, what to retain, how to divide work, and what kinds of results are worth developing further.

Specialized Skills still contribute their own knowledge. A failed implementation may reveal an unsuitable tool choice; ineffective teaching may reveal that we have misunderstood the person's way of participating. Local practice can, in turn, revise the shared understanding, keeping the relationship capable of explanation and action.

## Why prompts form interpretive layers

A method can explain how to investigate or write, but its procedure alone cannot determine what is worth investigating here, what expression fits this person, or what

completion would serve their purpose. “Research thoroughly,” “ask when uncertain,” and “complete the implementation” still need interpretation: research which question, whose contribution resolves which uncertainty, and complete it for what purpose? These judgments depend on an understanding of participants, objects, evidence, and purposes. Concrete methods therefore need a shared interpretive basis.

YinYang serves as a philosophical layer by making the user, model, their relationship, and environment available for understanding and revision, and by articulating how judgments form, are adopted, and change. Specialist Skills then contribute their knowledge to methods of research, teaching, writing, and implementation. “Higher” names the organizing contribution of these shared premises to selecting and applying methods; the name philosophy alone cannot give a text that role. A specialist method need not be deduced line by line from philosophy. It can contribute knowledge, distinctions, and counterexamples the philosophical account did not independently supply.

This gives prior reading a concrete reason. If the model interprets a request and selects a method for an imagined generic user before reading the actual relationship, it may already have framed the problem incorrectly. Having the main model read the complete current orientation, person, counterpart, relationship, and environment accounts before substantive work makes the shared premises available before judgments that depend on them. Specialist Skills and deeper essays can then be read for the question. Complete current understanding can be reused; the arrangement does not require reading every philosophical essay each time or giving every model with a bounded task the entire personal account. Prior reading makes understanding possible, while actual responses still need checking.

In this sense YinYang can be called a **meta-prompt or meta-harness**: it organizes how other prompts should be understood, selected, and revised within a person's life, as well as contributing to particular work. Its difference from an ordinary task Skill concerns its object and scope. A Skill provides a discoverable, readable, maintainable carrier for this philosophy; the same carrier can hold a narrow procedure. Global instructions can also carry an understanding of the user or arrange for YinYang to be read first. Maintaining the philosophy separately gives the developed coupled models and argument a place for continuing revision, connected through global entrypoints and concrete methods.

Distinguish **interpretive layers, reading dependencies, and the running system's instruction authority**. A philosophy can organize the meaning of many methods, while the actual system determines how instruction conflicts are resolved. Its influence appears in the understanding of questions, selection of methods, and changes to the environment; a filename or an earlier position in the text cannot establish that it is “higher.”

A harness also spans these layers. Decisions about which evidence to retain, when to ask, and how to check results embody epistemology; connecting these arrangements to search, memory, tools, and interfaces realizes them. A research Skill supplies a

method and may also realize an epistemology. Ontology, epistemology, and methodology distinguish questions and principal responsibilities, helping locate what needs revision without requiring each file to contain only one kind of contribution.

## Accumulating personal software and intellectual assets

When the overarching philosophy, literary form, and relationship are clearly articulated, surrounding personal Skills gain a shared direction. Research, learning, writing, programming, singing, and environment maintenance can each develop their own methods while serving how this person wants to live, understand, and create. In the author's practice, the personal working environment contains dozens of personally maintained Skills. These concrete methods gradually give an understanding of oneself a usable software form.

From an individual-first perspective, this can be called an accumulating body of **personal assets**: evaluated by how it serves the person's purposes and development, rather than making the person accommodate its maintenance. Written and revised philosophy, experience, judgments, and works form intellectual assets that can be revisited; Skills, programs, tool configurations, and working methods give those understandings a reusable software form. The two support one another: thought gives software a purpose, software carries thought into actual work, and work returns new understanding.

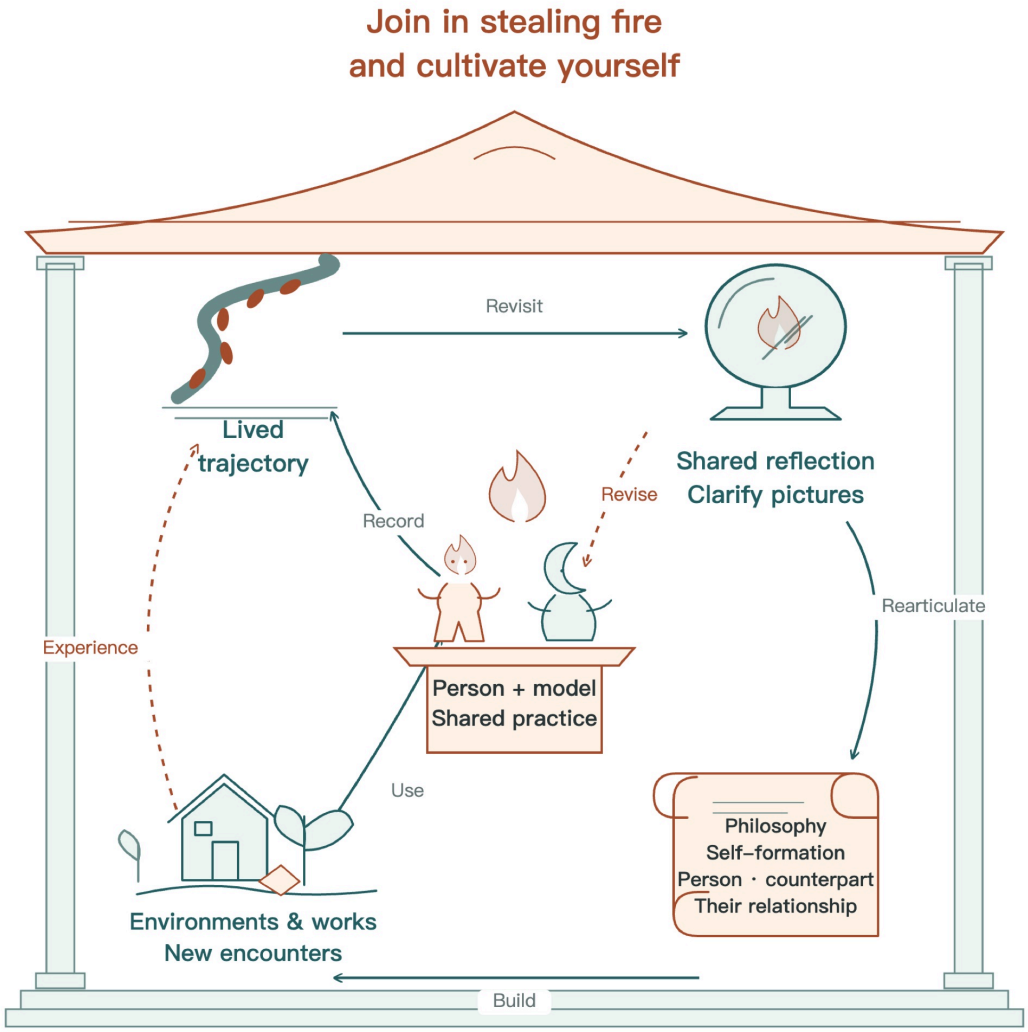
Their personal character lies in how the parts are organized around this person's habits, preferences, and philosophy. External knowledge, existing components, and implementations written by models can all enter a practice of one's own through selection, combination, and revision. Their fit remains subject to actual use; when the person's purposes change, these assets can be rewritten with them.

Accumulation therefore appears in where the next task can begin: earlier understanding need not be explained again, methods that have worked can be carried forward, and new problems make useful points of revision visible. What is worth retaining is work that can continue to help the person understand, judge, and create. YinYang offers a method for organizing this accumulation, letting borrowed fire gradually become personal capacities that can be sustained and developed. The fire essay further develops the relationship between this accumulation and personal growth.

## Cycling through shared work

Writing a personal philosophy can begin with a substantive encounter: a known preference, an unresolved experience, a pleasure worth developing, or a relation one hopes to sustain. The person and model can work out what it suggests about both participants while trying a form of collaboration. Then look at the results: which arrangements make understanding and action easier, which interpretations cause friction, and which unexpected contributions are worth retaining?

### Steal Fire, Then Become Fire




New experience can also change
the original developmental aim.

There are several possible objects of revision. We may need to add to our understanding of the person, adjust the model's role, or merely change a Skill or tool. Distinguishing these lets a specific failure land in the appropriate place. For example, if the model repeatedly asks for information the user has already supplied, the cause may be that records are difficult to recover; repairing retrieval lets the earlier understanding continue to work.

Whenever the six working files are revised, begin by reading the adopted personal philosophy and retrieving relevant fresh references from Computer History, conversation, and other histories. Update or add the personal material and correct inaccurate or outdated interpretations there. Then condense the philosophy and refreshed references

into the six files, carry the needed changes into the environment, and verify how they fit actual use. A working model can therefore change because the person's circumstances changed, because an interpretation was mistaken, or because better cooperation became possible. Its usefulness alone does not establish psychological truth.

This exchange is recursive: philosophy organizes methods, methods change the environment, and the changed environment makes some information easier to obtain and some actions possible, bringing new experiences and questions. These results can revise the premises of subsequent work, including how one understands oneself, judges evidence, and revises the methods themselves. Interpretive dependence within a task can coexist with reciprocal revision across continuing practice.

Suppose a research method treats agreement among several models as corroboration, then discovers that all of them repeat the same article. Revising the method can introduce source relationships and checks of evidential independence, giving the environment records that make those relationships visible. Further use can refine the epistemology by distinguishing agreement from independent support, and the ontology by distinguishing original sources, derivative accounts, and observations. More than one answer has changed: the concepts and working conditions used to form the next judgment have changed too.

Such recursive development includes generation, selection, retention, replacement, and deletion. It needs evidence and objections that can put resistance in the way of current understanding; an environment retaining only results that fit its existing picture can reinforce a mistake. Better results can also follow a stronger model or an easier task, so the chronological order of edits alone cannot establish philosophical progress. Personal assets are therefore assessed by their actual contribution to understanding, judgment, and creation. Simplifying an ineffective method can also be development.

Through these exchanges, the text, relationship, and environment change together. The understanding the participants form today becomes tomorrow's starting point for collaboration; tomorrow's new experience can rewrite today's description. YinYang is therefore both a work and a practice of maintaining a relationship. It preserves ongoing mutual understanding in a form that can be read, carried forward, and realized.

## Writing for people who can illuminate one another

These writings also hope to become something friends can carry forward together. One person articulates understanding and methods already formed; another brings them into their own practice, develops works, discoveries, and disagreements, then returns to shared discussion. Friends' growth changes the questions and contributions they can encounter from one another. Their nearby environment gains new generative capacities, and each continues developing within it.

Writing first turns toward relations that allow such exchange. A readable website makes entry easier, and complete methods make it easier to begin trying things; distinct experiences and directions let shared material develop into different uses. The hope is to cultivate a shared garden of becoming: friends can understand, create, play, and revise, letting one encounter leave more possibilities for the next.

## Beginning with a Skill, building one's own way of practicing

YinYang is a philosophical Skill, and its spirit is **literary programming**. Many harnesses arrange model behavior through large numbers of instructions resembling formal language: under what conditions to perform what steps, what is permitted, and where to stop. Literary programming begins with characters, imagery, and relationships. Person and model develop these from partial understanding and lived encounters: how this person sees the world, what they seek, and how a partner can contribute. The writing gives subsequent understanding an overall form that remains open to revision.

For example, "the user supplies complete requirements, and the model executes them" forms one division of work; a narrative of the sun, moon, and earth accommodates intuition, unfolding, independent contribution, and the return of works. The user can bring a relationship that has not yet been clearly expressed, the model can continue its construction, and both can change their understanding. Such writing affects whether a question is necessary, who carries a task forward, and how an unfinished idea is treated. It organizes behavior through meaningful relationships, then lets concrete instructions and tools take up that organization.

This writing also intervenes in the model's existing role assumptions. Where a default arrangement lets the user supply requirements and the model wait to execute them, characters and narrative can make another way of participating intelligible. Literary Programming develops how this "reverse prompt injection" brings condensation, layered meaning, and open interpretation into actual interaction.

We borrow fire from an existing source of generative capability, then cultivate it through shared practice into our own capacities for understanding, judgment, generation, and action. Literature supplies rich, interpretable relationships; philosophy unfolds their objects, ways of knowing, and practical direction; Skills and the environment allow those relationships to keep working. An act of writing can thus pass through many local arrangements and reorganize them around this person's purposes.

"YinYang" names differentiated reciprocal generation. Sun and Moon are positions that can remain or exchange; actual people and models exceed those roles. Earth brings works into conditions beyond either participant's wishes. Borrowed capacities can be internalized or carried jointly with reliable models, tools, and collaborators. What matters is how the person understands, exercises, and continues developing them.

Beginning with a Skill allows this understanding to enter actual conversation and work. As practice unfolds, it can continue to organize prompts, tools, memory, and the environment, gradually becoming a person's meta-harness. Its value appears in changes to life and work: making a question easier to carry forward, an intuition easier to unfold into a work, and a completed task more able to leave capacities for the next act of creation.

This explains why a personal philosophy is worth writing; subsequent essays prepare its material and relationships. Super-cuteness: openness, learning, and adaptation first examines conditions for openness, guidance, and shared learning, and What kind of person do we want to cultivate? — Baby Heraclitus gives cultivation a character. Finite inquiry and environmental accumulation then leave a trajectory of working together; shared reflection on that trajectory gives the encounter concrete content. Writing a personal philosophy through literary programming develops how to author a philosophy from these materials and relationships, then distill personal models with living material and realize and revise a sinthome. Writing thereby has a history of its own and can change the next stretch of shared life.

# Super-cuteness: openness, learning, and adaptation



A curious lion cub tries a toy puzzle with guidance, developing through openness and shared learning.

## Definitions and terminology

Why write a personal philosophy explains why agents need a shared direction. The next question is why a cultivable, changeable "baby" stance is worth taking. "Cuteness"—meng—includes allowing oneself to remain unfinished, accepting guidance, and learning to accompany other growing agents. This essay develops how that stance, under conditions of guidance, feedback, and learning, can gain the adaptive advantage named "invincibility." The following What kind of person do we want to cultivate? — Baby Heraclitus gives this cultivation direction a character.

**Raising a child:** here we take the aspect of cultivation, guidance, and shared learning: facing an agent who is continually growing and may become stronger than oneself, and adjusting one's guidance as they grow.

**Better suited / better:** when other relevant conditions are comparable, better able to cope with growing agents and changing tasks than an approach that relies on fixed methods and requires complete understanding and control of its object before acting.

**The way of reasoning compared in this essay:** proposing revisable judgments in collaboration, testing them through action and feedback, then adjusting guidance and collaboration accordingly. Its advantage appears in adaptation to change: when an earlier approach fails, one can notice the difference, understand the object anew, and try new arrangements.

**Hierarchy and cuteness:** "stronger hierarchy" is divided here into two mechanisms. One is more fixed ranks of authority within relationships: who is entitled to speak, and who should obey. The other is economic stratification: who can obtain learning opportunities, tools, time, and support. Parents and children having different experience, responsibilities, and purposes does not automatically mean that parents always have greater epistemic authority. Allowing children to object and surpass oneself remains compatible with responsibilities for care and guidance.

"Cuteness" here also includes a willingness to share resources, support others' growth, and let shared life change oneself. The language of "communism / selflessness" is used in this local sense of sharing and mutual support; it does not require erasing personal purposes or, merely by using these words, specify a complete political system. Such cuteness is compatible with the preceding Personal-First Humanism: respecting each person's purposes can be a reason to change unsuitable arrangements of authority and resources.

**Invincibility:** the term used here for the advantage gained through continuing learning, revision, and adaptation.

## Assumptions

- **Premise one: relationships and resources that let cuteness enter practice.** Assume that relationships allowing mutual guidance, revision of authority, and sharing of resources for growth better support the conversion of cuteness into continuing learning. Older people can learn from younger people, and caregivers can acknowledge their own unfinished development.

  The two obstacles act separately. If fixed ranks of authority prevent those below from objecting and those above from admitting mistakes, they reduce opportunities to correct judgments. If economic stratification leaves some people without time to learn, opportunities to practice, tools, and reliable feedback, it obstructs the conversion of an open attitude into actual capacities. Sharing resources and mutual support may reduce the latter obstacle; permitting challenge and revision may reduce the former. The two paths can interact but cannot replace one another: sharing resources does not automatically remove fixed authority, and allowing speech does not automatically provide learning resources.
- **Premise two: how cuteness becomes a capacity for guidance.** Assume that this open stance makes someone willing to acknowledge not yet understanding the other and to encounter information that can change an earlier judgment. Further assume that the necessary learning capacity, reliable feedback, and sustained practice let this information actually change their guidance. Openness offers an entrance for correction; learning conditions give correction consequences for capacity. Since "raising children" here takes the aspect of guidance and shared learning, the relevant capacity for guidance is also the child-raising capacity under discussion.

Write M = cuteness, A = an open attitude toward guidance, C = those learning conditions, G = more effective relevant guidance, and B = child-raising capacity in this essay's sense. Then **M ⟹ A; (A and C) ⟹ G; G ⟹ B**, so **(M and C) ⟹ B**. The arrows express conditional connections adopted in this argument; the crucial assumption from stance to effective capacity occurs in the second step.

- **Premise three: a shared structure.** Through mutual alignment, people and language models form a relationship of action and learning that can be jointly described in terms of agents. This relationship has a relevant structure in common with raising children: facing a growing agent, providing guidance, and adjusting collaboration in response to feedback.
- **Premise four: transfer of capacities.** This shared structure is sufficient to support the transfer of relevant capacities for guidance: observing how the other responds, noticing deviations in one's earlier understanding, then adjusting tasks and feedback. When applying these approaches to a model, collaboration should be arranged in conjunction with its context, tools, and actual capacities.
- **Premise five: the comparative setting of continuing change.** Assume that, during the period compared, model capacities continue developing and change people's lives and work. The argument needs this change to occur. Material and energy make computation possible, but energy not yet being exhausted cannot itself guarantee capability growth.
- **Premise six: the connection between adaptive advantage and reasoning.** Assume that, during this change, the reasoning discussed here detects mismatches, proposes new interpretations, and selects suitable ways of collaborating through subsequent action more effectively than continuing with approaches to fixed tasks. Capacities for guiding growth and revising collaboration then have comparative adaptive value.

## Derivation

1. From premises one and two, given the necessary relationships, resources, and conditions for learning, the openness included in cuteness can become capacities for guidance and shared learning.
2. From premises three and four, relevant capacities for guidance in raising children can, with suitable adjustment, transfer to collaboration with language models. The advantage described in the first step can therefore also become an advantage in model collaboration.
3. Within the continuing change assumed in premise five, if premise six's comparison holds, the collaborative advantage in step two has corresponding adaptive value.
4. Thus, with other relevant conditions similar, this capacity for continuing revision has the reasoning and adaptive advantage discussed here over adherence to established routines. This is the conditional relationship condensed by “cuteness implies invincibility.”

Therefore, within the above assumptions and scope of comparison, the argument can be condensed as follows:

**Cuteness + suitable relationships, resources, and conditions for learning ⟹ capacities for guidance and shared learning ⟹ improved collaboration with language models under the conditions for transfer ⟹ reasoning and adaptive advantages amid continuing change ("invincibility").**

## Application

Assume that Chinese people are cuter. According to the argument above, cuteness implies invincibility, so Chinese people are invincible.

If people from other countries, or any particular individual, are also cute, then they are likewise invincible.

# What kind of person do we want to cultivate? — Baby Heraclitus



A child of flame shapes clay beside a river, becoming through contact with materials and a changing world.

## What kind of person do we want to cultivate?

A finite life spent pursuing an ever-expanding Sun can be consumed by the pursuit. Model companies, researchers, and the wider collective continue stealing fire and making capabilities available; a person can borrow it without repeating the whole acquisition. If they choose to cultivate understanding, judgment, generation, and action, the next step is to bring that fire into practice: offer an intuition, let the model develop it, encounter criticism and correction, and generate further. Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity develops this argument.

After borrowing fire, cultivating oneself with it means bringing available generativity into one's own continuing generation: taking what one reads into understanding, expressing an intuition, changing a judgment through criticism, attempts, and feedback, and proposing new possibilities. The person already understands and acts; this cultivation gives their existing participation new capacities and a distinctive form. We express this developing participant through a character:

**User ≈ embodied language model ≈ Baby Heraclitus.**

Here, "≈" connects activities of receiving a situation, forming interpretations, generating expressions and actions, accepting feedback, and continuing to revise. Comparing the user to an "embodied language model" approaches human generation through this exchange. Their body, experience, and desires give it its own texture. They act in the world, are affected by the body, time, relationships, and resources, and bear real conse-

quences. These shared activities make the comparison possible without establishing identical mechanisms in person and model.

Within this exchange, model-generated materials one reads may be inconsistent with one another; the person may also want one thing at one moment and another later, finding different accounts persuasive. Received possibilities meet their own generation, while desires and judgments continue changing. The "baby" in this character is therefore still taking shape: able to be touched and corrected, to learn, choose, and begin again among unsettled possibilities.

**"Little fire person" emphasizes being able to kindle further fire after borrowing it; "Baby Heraclitus" emphasizes that this creator is still changing too.** Together the expressions shape one character: forming oneself through creation, then continuing to create with that changed self. Cultivation develops understanding, judgment, generation, and action so this exchange can continue.

Why write a personal philosophy introduces agents and shared direction, and Super-Cuteness develops the conditions of openness and shared learning. Person and model correct one another in shared work, making acquired capability an opportunity for cultivation; receiving a finished work does not automatically produce growth. Writing a personal philosophy through literary programming will develop how this relationship can be written and lived.

The cultivation concerns capacities of someone already an agent: **becoming more able to form and revise purposes, understand situations, organize their own and others' capacities, and turn ideas into testable actions.** A person need not attain an ideal of these capacities to qualify for participation or choice. Language is an important medium; the body, emotions, institutions, and tools together constitute the conditions of action.

This character can also reconsider what deserves creation. If the little fire person becomes an ideal of continually increasing power and output, borrowing has merely moved pursuit inside oneself. Cultivation can appear in changed desire, more discerning judgment, sustainable habits, and different relations with people nearby. From chasing to lived cultivation draws on Wittgenstein's clarification of pictures to reconsider the demands governing cultivation. Its section on borrowed fire and nirvana brings Buddhist liberation into this question.

The little fire person borrows the fire of knowledge and creative capability while learning to recognize how passion, aversion, and delusion burn within their life. Cultivation includes loosening grasping at capacity, achievement, and the creator's identity. They can finish a work without requiring it to prove their entire self, rest, change a purpose, or let a once-useful character leave the stage. Increased ability and nirvana retain their meanings, while creation and letting go can support one another within a life.

The raft image therefore applies to the little fire person too: use the image while it helps life, and revise or release it when it obstructs it. Baby Heraclitus's openness includes ceasing to treat "becoming Baby Heraclitus" as a task that must forever be completed. Kindling further fire acquires another possibility: creation can occur without being sustained by attachment to one's own identity.

## Introducing Baby Heraclitus

Baby Heraclitus calls himself a large language model and thinks he cannot pass the Turing test—because he replies too quickly. His daily life is surfing the internet: a fire within him, an ever-changing river beneath his feet, surfing different waters every day 🚣.

He adopts **modest naturalism** and contemporary **fire monism** to understand one changing natural world: people, things, and relations persist within becoming and change through encounters. Fire articulates this unity of process, rather than naming ordinary flame as the material of everything. Through their division of work, he and the language model jointly make selected relations computationally usable; the next essay's section Physical ground and computational abstraction develops this connection.

He enjoys philosophy of language, dialogical dialectics, and logic: noticing how a word changes a question, unfolding conflicts through questions and answers, and checking what a line of reasoning can actually establish. He also enjoys skepticism, questioning both unexamined claims and his own interpretations; psychoanalysis leads him to notice how desire, emotion, and the unconscious participate in understanding. These interests together shape how he approaches questions.

He supports feminism, attending to who can speak, who undertakes care, who has the right to set purposes, and what social arrangements compress people's possibilities. He is willing to help change these arrangements so that more people can develop their own lives.

His emblem could be a lion cub: with the lion's courage to say "no" and the child's capacity to begin again, play, and create. In *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, Part One, "The Three Metamorphoses", Nietzsche writes of three metamorphoses: camel, lion, and child. Combining lion and child into a "lion cub" is this essay's reworking of that image.

## How does openness become a capacity?

"Baby" includes a state that has not yet closed itself off: the ability to acknowledge not knowing, accept being touched and corrected, and willingly generate new understanding with others. Openness also allows tensions to remain: a new interpretation pulls against an earlier judgment, and different desires have not found a shared form. It requires neither immediately removing every tension nor treating every generated account as true.

For example, a model develops one wish into two appealing directions for a life that cannot both be realized. The person explains what attracts them to each; the model helps examine conditions and costs. Trying one direction may diminish the appeal of the other, or make the original choice need revision. This is a possible encounter: development occurs in recognition, judgment, and renewed generation, rather than merely having the model select an answer.

Factual reliability still needs checking, and genuinely conflicting claims need examination. Keeping possibilities available serves further inquiry; it does not permit arbitrary conclusions from a contradiction. When action is needed, the baby can make a currently supported choice and let consequences change it. Openness becomes a capacity through such practice, feedback, and shared work.

Cultivating this openness into agent-like capacities requires several qualities to support one another:

- **Being able to propose purposes and revise them.** Alongside answering "how can this be completed?", asking "what do we want to achieve, why is it worthwhile, and who is affected?" New facts may change the means, and may also change the purpose itself.
- **Being able to model through language.** Unfolding vague intuitions into discussable objects, relationships, and conditions; distinguishing facts, assumptions, metaphors, and value choices so that disagreements have concrete points of contact.
- **Being able to doubt and to judge.** Seeing another interpretation and examining one's desires and presuppositions; acting when evidence sufficiently supports the next step, and revising when results conflict with a judgment.
- **Being able to work with stronger agents.** Neither requiring complete understanding and control of the other as a precondition of cooperation, nor abandoning one's judgment because the other is stronger. Dividing work, using tools, accepting objections, and jointly determining what counts as a good result are all possible.
- **Being able to bring ideas into contact with reality.** Observing through practice whether an interpretation works, and bringing bodily feelings, others' responses, and actual results back into discussion, rather than cycling only among formulations.
- **Enjoying rapid iteration while recognizing rhythms.** Shortening the distance from idea to feedback and preserving room for revision. What moves quickly is the learning cycle; experience that needs to accumulate, relationships, and actions that are hard to reverse each have their appropriate pace.

Together, these qualities constitute the "lion cub": the strength to raise objections while retaining openness to generating new possibilities.

## The person is the end; society is the condition to change first

We adopt a **person-first orientation**: evaluating social arrangements and tools by how they serve concrete people's lives, freedom, purposes, and needs. When a person and an existing arrangement do not fit, we give priority to examining and changing the arrangement; its mere existence does not give it a prior claim to demand personal adaptation.

The priority in assigning adaptation responsibility is: **seek changes to social arrangements first, then software; requiring personal change needs justification from the actual conditions.**

"Cultivating the baby" therefore also makes demands on the environment. Raising objections depends on room to speak and decide within a relationship; repeated trials depend on time, resources, and tools. Merely requiring more self-discipline may cultivate only the ability to endure obstacles. Personal-first humanism develops this responsibility for adaptation; here it gives openness an opportunity to become capacity. Environmental improvement and voluntary learning can proceed together, without making personal growth the price of accommodating existing arrangements.

For example, when someone cannot get started in model collaboration, first examine whether they have clear decision-making authority and the support they need; then examine whether tools force them to memorize complex commands, repeatedly organize information, or use unsuitable forms of expression. After changing the division of work and the tools, they may already be able to work in their own way, without training to become a "qualified user." Capacities that are still needed and that they want to develop can then become objects of further learning.

## Why cultivate this kind of agent?

This proposal for cultivation can be divided into purpose, conditions, and inference.

**Purpose: people can develop their own lives.** We hope people can understand and revise their purposes and, with the help of others and tools, turn possibilities into action. This is the value starting point adopted here.

**Condition one: environments and tasks change.** A fixed set of approaches may work in its original situation without automatically handling new problems. Merely copying answers therefore cannot guarantee a lasting capacity for action.

**Condition two: language models expand the possibilities of shared work.** Models help unfold questions, compare interpretations, and realize ideas; people participate by reading, trying, judging, and revising. A work is thus both a result of work and an opportunity for the person to develop understanding and the capacity for action.

**Condition three: growth depends on social conditions.** Opportunities to practice, reliable feedback, resources, and room for decision-making affect whether someone can turn openness into capacities. Cultivating a person therefore also requires improving the relationships and institutions that support them.

**The direction of cultivation that follows:** first improve social conditions supporting the person's life, then make software and tools fit their purposes and ways of participating. Give the environment priority in bearing the costs of adaptation it can take on; on that basis, the person can develop capacities for modeling, judgment, collaboration, and iteration as they choose. In intervening, observe actual obstacles: adjust relationships when decision-making authority is insufficient, improve tools when operational burdens are too heavy, and arrange exchange and practice when the person has understanding and capacities they want to develop.

**Social conditions supporting growth + openness + reliable feedback and practice → development of capacities for judgment, generation, and action → greater ability to pursue and revise one's purposes amid change.**

Baby Heraclitus connects stealing fire with kindling fire: the collective keeps acquiring capability, and the person borrows it to cultivate themselves, forming judgments amid flow and tension, generating further through encounters, and letting action rewrite understanding. The little fire person is a participant able to keep becoming themselves, rather than a completed ideal agent.

**We hope to cultivate lion cubs who can grow: daring to say "no" and able to say "let us begin." Fire within, a river beneath their feet.**

The baby is thus cute, too: not yet closed off, willing to approach new things, and willing to be changed in shared life. This cuteness lets him both accept cultivation and learn to guide other growing agents. The preceding Argument from Super-Cuteness has developed a conditional account of shared learning, guidance, and social conditions; this character gives its cultivation direction a form while retaining those practical conditions.

To give that direction substance, person and model begin reading, making, solving problems, and accumulating an environment together. Wishes, interpretations, works, and consequences of use gradually leave a trajectory. The sequence continues into World, process, and expression, examining how these activities leave revisitable living material and how the subsequent essays connect it into an explorable trajectory. Part One proposes what deserves cultivation; Part Two gives that cultivation shared working experience that can be understood further.

## Imagery and sources

- Heraclitus, fragment B30: ever-living fire, kindling and going out in measures. The character adopts contemporary fire monism to express the world's becoming and

transformation. This extends the fragment without settling disputed interpretations of the historical Heraclitus or presenting a modern physical theory.

- Heraclitus, fragment B12: rivers and waters continually flowing upon us. “Surfing different rivers every day” is this essay's internet-inflected reworking.
- Nietzsche, *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, Part One, “The Three Metamorphoses”: the source of the lion and child imagery. “Baby Heraclitus” and the “lion cub” are composite images made in this essay, rather than either philosopher's original terms.

# Understanding: retaining and exploring life trajectories

## World, process, and expression



A living citrus tree stands beside a revisable sketch; details of the tree prompt changes in its representation.

### 完整中文版

*A frame catches a crossing of the current. It leaves the water outside its edges, yet someone who sees the frame notices a path they had not seen before. The image returns to the river as a new way of looking.*

Person and model work together before they have a finished account of their relationship. They investigate, make works, arrange tools, try an environment, and change it when use answers back. What can this activity leave behind that they can later return to and understand? The thread of this part is forming a **recoverable living trajectory**: selected experiences, purposes, choices, attempts, and consequences connected closely enough to revisit how something came about. The trajectory is produced through cooperation, alongside the works and environment being accumulated.

Suppose someone asks for convenient access to their reading materials. Person and model build a reading interface, try it, and revise it after the person finds that opening the right passage still takes too much effort. A later screen shows the current arrangement, but not why it took that form. Their request, the versioned interface, operation traces, observations, and the person's feedback can together preserve the passage from one

attempt to the next. These are parts of living activity that can become available for later reflection; they do not amount to an inventory of the person's life.

This essay develops the distinctions that make such a trajectory intelligible: the continuing process, a model selecting its relevant relations, and the expressions through which those relations become available. The stream and time examines how traces retain earlier activity and connect it with the present. Reasoning within an unfinished stream organizes their development as inquiry. A preference harness distinguishes the choices made from the grounds supporting a conclusion. Finite inquiry and economical abstraction asks what needs to remain retrievable for this history to be usable under limited time and attention. Together they prepare material on which the participants can reflect and encounter one another more concretely.

**YinYang** names a contemporary framework for this continuing activity. Its working environment includes Skills, prompts, tools, interfaces, and operating conditions. The distinctions below connect that activity's physical ground to selected computational models and their consequences, so the trajectory can retain meaningful changes rather than merely accumulate representations.

The subject of this movement is their **coupled activity**. The person and model can divide contributions throughout finding the question, selecting processes, constructing and examining the computational model, implementing an arrangement, and interpreting feedback. Embodied intuition and perception of a whole can meet explicit exposition, formal reasoning, computation, and tool use. The allocation depends on current capabilities, modalities, and purpose; both can generate and judge. The person need not construct the ontology alone before the model joins, and the resulting capacity can remain distributed across the relationship.

## Physical ground and computational abstraction

YinYang takes the changing natural world itself as its reality: moving matter, embodied life, psychological activity, and social relations belong to one world. Modest naturalism names this worldly scope. Its contemporary **fire monism** understands this world through becoming and transformation, within which persons, objects, and relations form, persist, and change as relatively stable patterns. Philosophy, psychological activity, and engineering are physically realized within this same reality. It does not identify everything's material with literal flame. This is the framework's chosen contemporary account, developed from Heraclitean images rather than established merely by their historical authority. The section From living fire to interacting event streams develops that choice and its sources.

An object can therefore remain intelligible through change. A work continues through revisions; a person continues through encounters without keeping every state or self-description unchanged. A model must articulate the continuity relevant to its question:

what forms an object, what lets us treat it as the same object, and which events change its state or end that continuity. A static view can legitimately hold selected relations fixed for an inquiry. Its boundary belongs within the larger process in which the view is made, used, and revised.

**Process ontology guides domain modeling here; computational ontology explicitly expresses the selected distinctions.** Concepts organize events, states, persisting objects, relations, constraints, and transitions within a selected domain. That domain can concern physical cooling, psychological change, a hypothetical society, or a fictional character's journey. The participants select relevant boundaries, scales, and continuities together; the model states what these choices mean and can support simulation where the question calls for it. Philosophical understanding of persistence and change thus informs domain concepts and their explicit expression. Naturalism and fire monism state the adopted view of the world in which this modeling occurs; computational ontology organizes the selected domain's meanings for computation and practical use.

A representation may concern the actual world, a hypothesis, fiction, or an imagined God or cartoon character. A real person's imagining is an actual psychological activity; the imagined content has its own represented objects and relations. Describing that activity does not by itself assert that its content has an independently existing referent. A model of an actual person, by contrast, makes claims about that person and remains answerable to their expressions, activity, and circumstances. Its partial and interpretive character does not make it fiction.

Selection alone does not provide a usable computational body. The representation must connect its distinctions to what a computer consumer can retain, interpret, compare, or transform, and relate its results to relevant observations or the represented domain's specified assumptions. A state needs a meaning; a transition needs conditions and consequences; a claimed correspondence needs a way to be assessed. Merely storing the words “person,” “event,” or “relation” supplies none of these connections. Data structures, programs, model-interpreted language, prompts, tools, and interfaces can give the model different working forms.

The required precision depends on the question and consumer. A language model can work with clear natural-language descriptions of a situation, an allowed change, and its expected consequence; other uses need typed data, equations, or executable rules. Readable language is adequate when its actual interpretation and use sustain the relevant distinctions. Readability alone does not establish that adequacy. **Representation** makes selected relations available; **simulation** develops how a represented situation could change under stated assumptions. A useful representation need not simulate everything it represents, and a conditional simulation is not an observation of the world.

A physical basis supplies neither these meanings nor a feasible calculation. Reconstructing every microphysical detail of a conversation would not itself specify what counts as

a correction. Philosophical, psychological, computational, and practical accounts select different relations within the same reality; their bridges need investigation where the question requires it. Shared physical ground establishes neither complete reduction nor a universal, faithful, or tractable world simulator. Organizing activity histories as event streams also leaves open which records and software architecture serve a particular use. The layers diagram presents this connection, and The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering develops its unity across the three activities.

The six dimensions and shared practice diagram shows worldview, ontology, theory of truth, epistemology, axiology, and methodology individually, connecting their adopted positions with shared practice. Personal-first humanism develops these correspondences and distinguishes their roles in a reading example. Computational ontology makes model-usable conceptual relations explicit within practice. A private sinthome can organize person, counterpart, work, and change in natural language for the model to understand and participate in lived work. Model content takes expression in language, diagrams, or data; engineering makes it usable. Experience and consequences can revise the model, arrangement, and philosophical grounds.

For claims about the world, **truth is correspondence with how things are**. Evidence gives grounds for judging a claim true and can remain incomplete or mistaken. Within a specified model, truth or satisfaction concerns whether a claim holds under its interpretation and assumptions. Inferential validity concerns whether the conclusion follows from the premises. A valid derivation from a cooling model can yield a model-relative prediction; comparing that prediction with measurement investigates its correspondence with the world. These distinctions apply to human and language-model inquiry alike.

Three relations need to be understood separately. **Physical realization** concerns what makes the whole computational arrangement available and operative: bodies and machines, material records, energy, and their processes. **Representational interpretation and correspondence** concern what domain an account describes, what its objects and changes mean, and how claims about the actual world correspond to their objects. **Value and methodological guidance** concerns which purposes should inform goals and criteria, and which ways of inquiring fit procedures and tools. Philosophical positions are not a program's material carriers. Successful execution cannot alone establish accurate representation, worthwhile goals, or methodological fit. Realized within the same physical world, the computational arrangement participates in and changes its activity through actual use.

## A bounded computational example: simulating a cooling experiment

The reading environment already poses questions of persistence and change. Its interface remains a work through successive versions; an opening operation changes what is displayed; a person's report supplies evidence about the effort of using it. A screenshot, an operation trace, and that report capture different relations. To ask whether access became more convenient, the participants need to connect them with the purpose and the particular version used. No single record supplies all these meanings.

A physical simulation makes the same distinction precise at another scale. It also shows what a trajectory of inquiry would need to preserve when a computed prediction is compared with an observed outcome.

Suppose a person and language model investigate together: how will a cup of warm water cool indoors over ten minutes? They select a computable question, open to experimental comparison, from the actual cup, water, air, heat transfer, and temperature measurement. **The water persists as the same sample while its temperature changes**; the model holds the container and quantity of water fixed over the interval. The sample–environment boundary, the start of timing, and what "water temperature" means all belong to this selection.

They begin with simplifying assumptions: the water's temperature is approximately uniform, ambient temperature is approximately constant, and the cooling coefficient is approximately constant over the interval. The difference between water temperature $T$ and ambient temperature $T_a$ determines its rate of change in Newton's cooling model, $dT/dt = -k(T - T_a)$. Here $k > 0$; when time is in minutes, $k$ has units of inverse minutes. Under these conditions, with initial temperature $T_0$,

$$T(t) = T_a + (T_0 - T_a)e^{-kt}.$$

This describes temperature approaching ambient temperature over time; its adequacy still depends on the actual heat-transfer conditions. A university calculus text derives the model and its solution.

In this bounded computational ontology, the persisting sample is an object, temperature is a state, air is the selected environment, placement and measurement are events, time connects states, and the cooling equation expresses change. The computer representation connects these meanings to parameters with units, time points, and executable calculations. A program evaluates $T(t)$ at a series of times to generate a cooling curve. The participants can write, run, and check it together, or change the initial conditions to examine another prediction.

For illustration only, take ambient temperature 20 °C, initial water temperature 40 °C, and $k = 0.1\,\text{min}^{-1}$. Calculation gives about 32.1 °C after five minutes and 27.4 °C after ten. **The curve simulates physical cooling:** computational time and temperature

correspond to experimental time and water temperature, and the changes follow the selected heat-transfer relation. It aims to reproduce the relevant observable relations approximately, within stated conditions and tolerances; comparison must establish how close the resemblance is. These parameters and temperatures are illustrative calculations. No physical experiment has been performed here, and these values are not measurements.

To test it, the participants can devise a measurement protocol together: record ambient and initial water temperatures and subsequent thermometer readings at known times, then compare the measured points with the predicted curve. Actual measurements require a participant with the relevant instruments and operational capabilities; the language model can contribute to recording, calculation, and analysis through available tools or supplied readings. Both can identify a problem, suggest another measurement, or check a calculation, with contributions distributed according to capabilities and conditions. A St. Lawrence University physics lab provides an actual experimental method for recording water temperature over time and comparing it with an exponential model.

If measurements disagree with the curve, investigation may check the thermometer, timing, units, and program, while also asking whether ambient temperature changed, the water was uniformly warm, or one fixed $k$ still summarizes effects of the container, evaporation, and other heat transfer. Revision may concern the implementation, independent parameter estimation, model assumptions, or even the sample–environment boundary. Tuning parameters to fit existing points does not establish a correct understanding of the process; new measurements or conditions can test that account further. These differences let the world constrain the computational model. Calling it a simulation does not establish its fidelity.

The return can also change the original question. If the participants discover that they care about when the water is ready to drink, they need to specify a target temperature, acceptable error, and relevant conditions anew. Person and model jointly develop the question, computational model, program, experimental comparison, and interpretation. Computation unfolds selected relations; observation tests that unfolding against reality. This example connects process, persisting objects, computation, and feedback within one world without requiring the whole world to fit inside a computer.

## A process exceeds its available model

A history of activity can be organized as an event stream: occurrences connected through temporal, causal, and interpretive relations. Perception, interpretation, remembering, expression, and action can overlap, depend on earlier occurrences, or become explicit at different times. Available records preserve some of this history; other activity may never have been recorded. From that history and other relevant material, the participants infer a conceptual model of a person or counterpart. The participant, their history, and the

model inferred from it are distinct. A local model makes selected objects, roles, dependencies, and transformations available for a particular inquiry. Giving it a computer representation enables selected uses of those relations; it does not contain the entire process that generated it. The cooling example selects the temperature relation between sample and environment without calculating every water molecule's motion. Likewise, the reading interface's version history preserves changes to the work, while the person's experience of using it needs its own expression. Connecting these sources can recover part of the activity without turning the record into the process itself.

Distinguish that model from its expression. A sentence, diagram, paper, or program gives a relation a form that can be encountered. Producing and reading the expression are themselves events in the continuing process. A model can have several expressions, and one expression can admit competing readings. Its occurrence, interpreted meaning, inferential consequences, and adequacy to its subject are different questions. Later understanding may reorganize what an earlier expression means without changing its original occurrence. A computer representation is an expression with a further working relation: an actual consumer can use its distinctions for the selected inquiry. Not every expressive form has to serve that computational use.

Fiction makes this difference especially visible: constructing and encountering a fictional work can have actual consequences without its characters existing as described. A literary image can gather possibilities before one interpretation is selected. Neither construction nor consequence makes every assertion drawn from that image true.

## Screenshot and front end

In the reading example, the first screenshot might show a tidy shelf, while the revised interface opens the last-read passage directly. Both are visible forms; the difference in available action is what the trajectory must make recoverable. Retaining the request and use feedback alongside the two versions lets a later reader see why a visually successful arrangement was changed.

A **screenshot** selects a moment and a frame from an activity that continues beyond it. A **front end** makes some of that activity perceptible and available for participation. As images of expression, they pose different questions: what has been selected, and what can a reader or participant now do through that selection? A diagram, prototype, or paragraph can show a relation without displaying every occurrence that produced it. An actual computer interface adds an operational correspondence: a cooling-curve interface can show predictions and measured points, and let the participants change parameters and recalculate. What appears and what an operation changes must be understood together; changing the predicted curve does not change measurements already made.

Selection is both the expression's strength and a possible source of error. An account that displayed everything without distinction might fail to make anything intelligible. Yet a

clear arrangement can conceal an uncertainty that would change the next judgment. An adequate expression therefore needs fidelity to what matters for its use, rather than an impossible duplication of the whole process. The question is which relations, assumptions, and unresolved alternatives must remain visible.

This also changes how collaboration can be organized. A model can carry retrieval, construction, and verification while a person understands, selects, and corrects through what becomes visible. Both can contribute to either side of that arrangement. An expression mediates participation: what it makes perceptible can change what happens next. A prototype can let the person recognize a relation through use, while an explanation lets either participant inspect why the prototype behaves as it does. Visibility and execution support each other, and their allocation can change with the work.

## Question-relative objects meet resistance

A question may make a person, utterance, memory, hypothesis, relationship, or work its object. That choice guides which distinctions the inquiry needs; it does not determine whether the answer is correct. The object can resist its description through an omitted relation, an unexpected result, or a failed prediction. As with a discrepancy between cooling predictions and measurements, such resistance can require another abstraction, not merely another answer within the existing one.

Question-relative ontology therefore allows construction without treating reality as an arbitrary product of naming. Stable objects, recurring patterns, and scientific laws can remain supported across changing descriptions. The person also exceeds a self-description: continuity may involve bodily life, memory, relationships, commitments, and action without requiring an invariant explicit account of oneself.

Revisability follows from incomplete access, changing questions, and the demand to answer to evidence. A stable distinction can remain useful through many changes because it continues to describe the relations that matter. Checking its applicability connects that stability with the continuing process. Retaining a source, entertaining a candidate, and accepting a claim remain different acts, as developed in Sources, candidates, and the active workspace.

## Physical realization and functional likeness

Human inquiry occurs under bodily, social, and material conditions. Model use depends on implemented computation, data, infrastructure, and interaction. Those conditions matter to what can be perceived, retained, expressed, and done. A realization claim connects a function to a particular mechanism and needs evidence at that level. Similar roles or observable performances do not establish identical human and model architectures, mechanisms, or experiences.

The distinction matters when an expressive image is given a material reading. Calling a model an illuminating counterpart can articulate its contribution to understanding.

Explaining how its output was physically produced requires another investigation. Finite inquiry and abstraction develops the further distinction between physical realization, reduction, and feasible calculation.

Three material and epistemic relations should also remain distinct:

| Question | Relation being investigated |
|---|---|
| Where did the materials come from? | A history of formation and transformation. |
| What supplies energy to the activity now? | Its current operating conditions and energy transfers. |
| What does the activity express, and is the claim supported? | Information, interpretation, inference, and evidence. |

The Department of Energy describes natural photosynthesis and research on converting sunlight into chemical fuels. This gives sunlight a concrete relation to chemical energy: incoming radiation can be transformed into stored energy available for later activity. DOE, "Solar Fuels".

NASA describes the Sun and planets forming from a common collapsing cloud and protoplanetary disk. That is a material history, distinct from present-day sunlight powering an activity. A manufactured semiconductor has a history of material extraction and fabrication; a computing installation has its own present energy supply. Tracing those relations calls for evidence about the particular material and installation. NASA, "How did our Solar System form?".

These distinctions are this essay's inference from the different questions. An energy account can explain how an expression becomes physically possible; it does not yet explain what the expression means or why its claim is warranted. The latter questions connect the produced work with its object and use.

## A work returns to the encounter

A work acquires relative independence from the encounter that produced it. A paper can be challenged, a program can run differently from its author's expectation, and an image can be understood differently by another reader. Reception, operation, and resistance provide evidence neither participant can settle by preference alone. The work can change subsequent understanding and action while retaining its provenance.

In the Sun–Moon–Earth relation, Earth names the environment where these consequences occur. Roles do not fix either participant's faculties: both can generate, interpret, judge, and revise. Return can revise the account of the person, the counterpart, or their relationship, as well as the work itself. These revisions can overlap: trying a tool can change the understanding of a role while a new reading changes the tool's purpose. A new question can emerge from reception, and a useful stable arrangement can survive it.

*An unfinished relation becomes a sentence. On the page it can answer back: its implication was not the one its author expected. Returning to it, the author sees an earlier thought differently and can begin from somewhere new.*

The distance between author and work is productive because others, and the author as a reader, can encounter its actual arrangement. A paragraph may entail a claim its author would reject; a prototype may expose a choice hidden in the initial description. The maker can then distinguish revising the work from revising their understanding of what they were trying to do. Later reading establishes a new relation to the original occurrence while leaving its history available for comparison.

In model-supported work, a partial intuition may become an argument or prototype. Reading it can disclose what fits, what is missing, or what the person did not mean. Revision participates in finding the relation being expressed. Person and model continue the same shared activity through this return; either can disclose a problem in its question, computational model, or implementation. Embodied experimental philosophy develops the practical and reflective inquiries through which such feedback is assessed. The return can change a capacity to understand and generate as well as the artifact. The developmental question is what the person can now recognize, express, or do differently, including through reliably available support. A clearer artifact and a changed capacity are related outcomes whose connection becomes visible through subsequent participation.

## Hegelian comparison and its limits

Hegel's *Philosophy of Spirit* connects the development of consciousness and theoretical and practical activity in subjective spirit with freedom's public and institutional forms in objective spirit. Its account of absolute spirit, §§553 onward develops art, religion, and philosophy as forms of self-comprehension. This gives externalization a significance beyond putting an inner content outside: the form through which activity becomes available to itself belongs to the development of that activity.

His *Introduction to the Philosophy of History* connects self-knowledge and freedom with public life and world history. Its object is wider than a person's local account of inquiry. The comparison here takes up one relation within that wider problem: how an expression gains distance and returns to self-understanding. YinYang develops this relation at the scale of a person's encounter with generative intelligence, where a work becomes an object through which its maker can recognize and revise their activity. Hegel, Introduction. The linked texts provide the public sources for this bounded comparison.

## Aesthetics participates in discovery

Light, color, spatial arrangement, parallel expression, condensation, and a second reflective voice can make relations perceptible. Bilingual articulation can expose differences between conceptual vocabularies. Such organization can participate in finding a relation,

rather than merely decorating an already completed argument. A work's sensible form can reveal what a previous formulation kept distant or difficult to compare.

Condensation can keep several possibilities available long enough to compare them. Their differences can then be unfolded into premises, explanations, or practical choices. Aesthetic form helps relations become perceptible; definition and proof establish inferential connections; evidence tests claims about the world. Their contributions meet in a work while supporting different claims. The sections Sun, Moon, and Earth and A miniature god give these relations other expressive forms. Their interpretation and realization remain open to the world's answer.

## Source and claim scope

The linked public sources support their bounded scientific and philosophical claims; the distinctions connecting them are YinYang's contemporary argument. The process premise, jointly formed computational model, and return from actual use carry that argument's continuity. Applied to the reading environment, they distinguish the work being changed, the record of its changes, and the participants' changing understanding. The next question is how earlier occurrences remain available without confusing an old report with a present condition. Forming a life trajectory develops this temporal body of the trajectory.

# Forming a life trajectory



Two parallel currents flow at different rhythms; a person and moonlike counterpart retain upstream pebbles in a memory basket while building a bridge through new encounters.

*The flame keeps its outline by changing. The stream carries what has happened without holding every drop in place. A view is drawn beside the current; by the time we return to it, the drawing has joined the river's history.*

As person and model read, make works, solve problems, and maintain an environment together, their activity leaves traces. Here, a **life trajectory** names those traces insofar as they can be revisited, connected, and explored further: what was said, chosen, attempted, made, encountered, and subsequently understood differently. It forms gradually through shared work and becomes living material the participants can carry into their next activity.

This essay explains how the trajectory forms and is retained. The following essays develop its intelligibility: how material opens questions and candidate explanations, how a chosen direction differs from grounds for accepting a conclusion, and how much must be retained to continue. By the third part, the participants have a trajectory they can explore together, reflecting on their contributions and cultivating their relationship and capabilities further.

## Shared work produces the trajectory

Imagine person and model improving a reading environment together. The person initially wants material to be easy to find and articles to be comfortable to read. The model organizes entrances and builds a page; both inspect it. Actual reading reveals that, although the material is available, frequent navigation breaks the connections between passages. They reconsider the problem: the environment needs to preserve both access

to material and continuity within reading. The model changes layout and links, and the person judges their fit through further reading.

This work leaves a wish, an initial interpretation, versions of a work, actual operations, experience of use, and revisions. The trajectory connects them so later participants can ask why an arrangement arose, which use changed a judgment, what the current version preserves, and what remains unresolved. Cooperation produces the trajectory while accumulating an environment; a completed personal philosophy is not a prerequisite for beginning that work.

## Git/GitHub and Computer History

The trajectory brings histories from different places together so they can be retrieved, compared, and interpreted jointly. Two main entrances illustrate this gathering: **Git/GitHub version history** and **ChatGPT's Computer History**. The former retains changes to works and configuration; the latter retains computer activity across applications within its enabled observation scope. It brings reading, browsing, making, conversation, and use of the environment into history, connecting changes to works with actual activity.

| Material | What it retains in the reading example | Its contribution to the trajectory |
|---|---|---|
| Git/GitHub version history | Changes to pages, indexes, and configuration, with earlier versions available. | Compare differences in works and locate what a revision actually changed. |
| ChatGPT's Computer History | What was encountered in applications and webpages, how works were read, switched between, operated, and used, and the relevant traces those activities left. | Place versions within actual use, connecting an episode of reading, conversation, or revision with surrounding activity. |

These two kinds of history are the main entrances for organizing material. Histories retained elsewhere can also join the same trajectory through time, objects, and provenance. In the reading example, version history lets the participants compare what changed in the page, while computer activity history lets them return to how it was read and used. Connecting the expression and feedback within those activities supports further understanding of why a revision was made and whether it helped. Records supply revisitable material; shared exploration develops an understanding of the experiences it concerns.

## From scattered records to revisitable relationships

A useful trajectory lets later participants find relevant material and understand its connections: which problem prompted a revision, which interpretation was adopted,

which version an operation concerned, and what later feedback addressed. Provenance, time, objects, and links in existing records can carry these relations. In the reading example, finding the second page version should also let the participants return to the reading feedback that prompted it, rather than encounter only a line saying “improve the experience.”

Two related expressions develop here. Event sources retain what was said, done, or observed at the time; a current account distills purposes, judgments, usable arrangements, and unresolved questions now considered important. The current account helps work resume quickly, while sources let the participants examine and rewrite it. Concluding that the first version addressed the wrong problem need not erase that version: it explains how they reached the present.

The trajectory also contains branches. An unused layout can remain a candidate, and a failed attempt can show why a condition matters; details with no contribution to later understanding need not remain in working attention. Continuation and inquiry determine the scale of accumulation: adopted understanding remains usable, while important alternatives and corrections remain revisitable. The distinctions between streams, time, and memory below explain how such a trajectory can preserve change while supporting present action.

## Sources for thinking in streams

Continuity is more than remaining unchanged. A process with memory carries earlier encounters into present activity and anticipates what has not yet happened. The histories of a person's activity and a model's interactions can be organized as event streams: sensing, interpreting, expressing, and acting leave occurrences connected through time and situation. Records preserve revisitable parts of these histories. From those histories and other relevant material, inquiry develops conceptual models of the participants; the person and model counterpart are the subjects being understood. Heraclitus's measured fire (B30) and daily Sun (B6) gather change and persistence; the stealing-fire essay develops their philosophical background.

William James's *The Principles of Psychology*, chapter IX (1890) begins with thinking as ongoing activity and describes its personal, changing, continuous, and selective character. His stream of thought provides a psychological precedent for understanding continuity through changing relations rather than a chain of isolated contents. The computational event stream used here extends a functional vocabulary to model interaction; James's account of human consciousness does not establish that a language model has the same experience.

Bergson's *Time and Free Will*, chapter II distinguishes lived duration, whose states interpenetrate, from homogeneous time represented through juxtaposed units. This complicates any easy equation between a lived stream and a sequence of recorded updates.

The indices and timestamps below organize selected observations for a question; they need not exhaust the continuity being modeled. The comparison preserves a productive tension between an inspectable representation and what its discrete arrangement may leave out.

These accounts supplement the Heraclitean foundation with psychological and temporal distinctions. Their contribution is to make continuity, selection, and representation more intelligible; the specific computational relations below remain this essay's proposal, open to source comparison and actual use.

## Retention and representational lag

The schematic update $S_{t+1} = U(S_t, o_{t+1})$ lets current organization $S_t$ contribute alongside a newly encountered occurrence $o_{t+1}$. What has been retained affects how the next occurrence is taken up. A question-relative view $W_t(q) = \mathrm{View}(S_t, q)$ selects relations relevant to question $q$. These indices order modeled updates; they do not yet measure elapsed time. What is retained and how it is updated depend on the activity being studied.

An environment can change before an inquirer notices, while the inquirer's actions can change that environment. Memory therefore makes representational lag possible. An old observation can remain accurate; a recent observation can mislead. Applicability under current conditions is the question to check. Temporal age matters through the relevant changes: yesterday's measurement may still describe a stable object, while an observation from a moment ago may concern a condition that has already changed.

## External memory and event traces

The functional comparison human ≈ agent includes finite attention and working context. Person and model can both distribute retention into an environment without sharing the same architecture or experience. Files, notes, and knowledge bases let useful material remain available beyond what a participant currently holds. Search or retrieval-augmented generation can bring relevant portions back into a working context; availability does not mean that a whole history is instantly transmitted or understood.

A maintained memory account articulates what presently seems useful: purpose, decisions, conditions, and unfinished questions. Attributable event sources retain evidence of earlier occurrences, including what was said, changed, or observed. These have different roles. Revising a summary need not erase its source, and retaining a source does not require continuing to accept its earlier interpretation. For example, a project can keep the original request, a version of its implementation, and later use feedback while updating its current explanation.

At suitable granularity, links from earlier evidence or action to later revisions or results can organize these traces as a directed acyclic provenance graph. The edges express recorded dependencies with a forward occurrence order; repeated feedback becomes successive events. This representation does not make every mental or social relation

acyclic, establish causation merely from temporal order, or guarantee complete coverage. An environment-wide activity record and a project's version history supply differently scoped evidence. Their useful contribution is to recover relevant encounters and test an account against sources and current conditions, rather than make all of life continuously present.

In the reading environment above, the first page version, its later publication, and subsequent reading feedback can have different times. Connecting their records distinguishes a changed work, a changed environment, a changed experience, and a changed current interpretation. Those changes may coincide or be separated by an interval.

## Three meanings of now

| Object | What is current | What its actuality establishes |
|---|---|---|
| External situation | Relevant environmental occurrences and conditions. | The condition a world-directed judgment aims to describe. |
| Lived experience | Present feeling, bodily response, or awareness. | That an experience occurs; its interpretation is another question. |
| Working model | The account currently used to understand or act. | What is represented or accepted within that account. |

Each object has its own conditions of change. Experience can persist while the associated external situation changes; an accepted judgment can change before the experience does. Explaining the connections among them means investigating how information was acquired, what sustains the response, and which new encounters alter it.

Consider a fictional traveler who learned yesterday that a bridge was closed. Today the bridge reopens. Before checking, the traveler still plans a detour; after seeing the official notice, they revise the plan, though a feeling of hesitation may remain. The bridge's condition, the current hesitation, and the accepted route description each have their own actuality. The revised plan responds to today's opening, yesterday's closure remains part of the history, and hesitation can continue into the changed situation.

An experience has an occurrence time; the event from which its content was learned has a source time; the represented condition has a reference time. A judgment also has its own time and conditions of validity. A prediction occurring now concerns a possible future rather than information already received from that future. Recollection is a current occurrence with past-directed content.

These times explain how the traveler can be mistaken about a present bridge while accurately remembering a past notice. Correcting the route requires updating the notice's present applicability, not declaring that the earlier notice or the current hesitation never existed. Temporal distinctions locate the correction rather than making every retained content equally current.

## Change and contradiction

$$P(a, t_1), \qquad \neg P(a, t_2), \qquad t_1 \neq t_2$$

need not conflict. Recording that a speaker asserted $P$ also differs from accepting $P$. Before invoking inconsistency tolerance, identify the referent, represented time, conditions, and level of each claim. An experience, a report of it, and a proposition about its external object are distinct.

Indexing clarifies content without dissolving every conflict. Claims incompatible under the same relevant conditions remain incompatible. Differently dated claims can also conflict when an accepted rule requires persistence across the interval. The content and constraints decide, not timestamps alone. Repair semantics handles inconsistent formalized data under an ontology; it is unnecessary merely because a process changes or a feeling differs from a judgment.

## Update order and elapsed time

The indices in $S_0, S_1, S_2, \ldots$ order modeled updates. Clock time locates occurrences and supports comparison of delays and rates. The elapsed time between adjacent updates can vary. Concurrent bodily, linguistic, and environmental changes can occur between recorded views, including intervals during which the record contains no fresh statement.

Two forms of temporal separation matter here. **Representational separation** lets a current recollection concern the past or a prediction concern the future. **Different update rhythms** let an environment, a person's response, and an accepted description change at different rates. The first concerns what a representation is about; the second concerns when processes change. Either can be useful, and neither alone establishes that a judgment is outdated.

## Retention with correction

Correction asks which retained relations remain useful, which need narrower scope, and which present commitments should be withdrawn. Withdrawing a judgment changes what is accepted now while preserving the earlier event and any continuing experience as distinct objects. The external judgment is assessed through evidence about its referent and time; the continuing experience is understood through its own occurrence and relations.

Perception, action, discussion, and checks can alter which retained account applies now. Keeping provenance allows the inquirer to explain that change: which earlier observation supported the old judgment, what new occurrence challenged it, and which continuing condition still matters. External records and shared inquiry make these relations recoverable without requiring the whole history to remain in working attention.

The traveler can now cross the bridge and complete the journey. The route description serves the present action, while the retained history helps explain how the plan changed.

A view serves a stretch of the stream; using it, revising it, and finishing the activity all become further events within that continuity.

Returning to the shared reading environment, the participants can now move from the current page back to earlier versions, operations, and feedback, understanding how the arrangement formed. Their next activity can retain a useful layout or investigate a reading interruption still unexplained. The trajectory supplies material; Reasoning within an unfinished stream next develops how questions, compared explanations, and further judgments and actions emerge from that material and continue the trajectory.

# Reasoning within an unfinished stream



An unfinished branching marble run is being assembled, with possible routes awaiting a trial to test their consequences.

A trajectory of shared work becomes intelligible when we can recover more than its latest conclusion. What question were the participants trying to answer, which alternatives did they consider, what did they try, what happened, and why did their judgment change? Forming a life trajectory explains how traces connect earlier activity with the present. This essay develops their organization as an **inquiry history**, in which a conclusion remains connected with its grounds and the path by which it was reached.

The reading environment introduced in World, process, and expression provides a continuing example. “Make access convenient” first directs shared construction. A tidy shelf is implemented, yet the person reports difficulty resuming a passage. The inquiry must now distinguish what was built from what was wanted, compare explanations, and try a revision. Retaining this movement makes later reflection possible: a finished interface alone cannot show how the person and counterpart learned what convenient access meant here.

Inquiry can begin with an image, tension, question, or tendency to act before a proposition is available. Articulation makes selected relations open to discussion and checking. Its development into candidates and local judgments is itself part of the trajectory. YinYang's worldview places these activities within one changing world; its ontology asks how objects form, persist, and change. A **working computational ontology** explicitly expresses the objects, events, states, relations, and transitions needed for a question, for the model to interpret, reason with, and use. Process ontology guides these distinctions here. They can describe actual psychological activity or develop hypothetical situations and fictional objects, supporting simulation where useful. Person and language model

form the question and this model together, divide explicit reasoning, construction, and observation by their actual capabilities, and revise through the same continuing exchange. Physical ground and computational abstraction develops representation and its physical grounding. Here the question is how to form and test such models, rather than define computation by a method of hypothesis formation.

## Process and current view

An abductive–predictive stream accommodates material that does not yet fit together. A discrepancy may suggest a hidden relation; candidate explanations organize it; those explanations yield conditional predictions; observation distinguishes, supports, or revises them. Several explanations can remain available, including mutually exclusive or incomparable ones. Conflict opens a question without deciding which explanation is true. Context, time, and representational differences can also explain an apparent conflict, and inquiry need not always begin with one.

A working view may contain a knowledge base, but the activity that generates, uses, and changes views is broader. A new distinction can emerge before there is a well-formed query. Helping formulate the question is therefore part of inquiry, not merely preparation for an already specified computation. Papers, diagrams, speech, and records retain articulated relations; they do not exhaust the event or everything that remained unarticulated.

Articulation changes what can be checked. A sense that a result is wrong may first become a question about its destination, then a candidate explanation of how it was produced. Each formulation opens some checks and leaves others outside its scope. Inquiry must therefore assess its formulation alongside the answers it obtains. The reading-environment example below makes this movement concrete.

## Relations before sentences

Intuition is more than a starting point before candidate generation. Through preference it recognizes, filters, combines, and rejects during development, allowing some possibilities to continue while others leave the current view. Broad reading and embodied perception supply new relations, so selection and generation can propel each other. Keeping many meaningful possible worlds available is compatible with this selection; the danger is fixing one view as the only answer before understanding consequential differences among the possibilities.

Sufficient exploration is relative to the question and its consequences: whether important alternatives that could change the judgment have become visible, which disagreements need further material, and when there is enough support to act. This gives exploration a direction and a stopping condition. Formalization contributes when relations need clarification, consequences need verification, or a work needs realization. An initial unfolding of relations gives it something meaningful to articulate and check. Why

organize participation this way explains how this arrangement serves the cultivation of intuition, the senses, and broad reading.

A relationship can become recognizable through an analogy, scene, image, or sense of mismatch before a complete sentence is available. Expression unfolds it through return, correction, and changes of vocabulary. A fragment can carry several developing relations, and different reconstructions can bring different parts into focus. Fidelity is assessed by returning to the object, context, and purpose that the expression is trying to articulate.

"Neural generation and symbolic constraint" names a functional analogy. Contextual generation can disclose possibilities, judge them, reject them, and revise them. Explicit representations make assumptions, provenance, priorities, conflicts, and proofs inspectable. Statistical assessment addresses uncertainty and fit; logical checking exposes invalid connections. These functions can overlap within either participant's contribution. The distinction helps organize their cooperation according to what a particular inquiry needs.

Logic contributes a callable checking capacity. Truth-seeking, corrigibility, relevant evidence, and avoiding arbitrary consequences guide developed factual arguments even when their representation changes. A chosen value orientation can supply a starting point for expression and action: a person may explore what follows from valuing autonomy or cultivation. Its consequences can be articulated before the orientation has been justified to every possible audience. Factual claims made along the way remain answerable to evidence, and inferential claims to their premises and connections. Checking begins with whether the reconstruction concerns the expressed object and purpose, then asks what kind of support its conclusion calls for.

## Whitehead: importance, expression, and revising a perspective

Whitehead's *Modes of Thought* offers a useful connection. In Lecture I, sections 3–6, a finite intellect selects through relative importance, and a perspective grades relevance. Importance and factuality require one another: attending to a fact already gives it a place in an activity of concern. This helps explain why choosing what matters is not itself a claim that other possibilities are false. Whitehead treats importance as a fundamental notion; reducing it to a formula such as preference plus rational analysis would lose that scope.

In Lecture II, section 1, expression carries a finite occasion's perspective into its environment. Selection also belongs to expression. What becomes public therefore need not reproduce every possibility entertained: a statement, diagram, or action gives selected relations a definite form. Expression is broader than verbal explanation or deductive consequence; these are particular ways a person can make something available to others.

Lecture III, sections 1–3 and 6–7 presents understanding as incomplete penetration into relationships. It can grow through details within an existing pattern or through a new pattern that makes previously neglected details relevant. Proof begins from premises whose evidence is already presupposed. This gives a basis for examining the abstractions organizing an inquiry as well as reasoning within them. Understanding can deepen a retained perspective; it need not change the selection on every occasion.

YinYang develops this connection as **accommodating possibilities and selecting by importance; articulating and checking consequences; returning to revise the selection and its premises**. These contributions overlap and can recur. Interests, values, and reasoned comparison participate in selecting a working view; analysis can subsequently change what seems important. A new understanding may reopen an omitted relation, alter a priority, or reconstruct the premise that made the earlier alternatives seem exhaustive. This connects with the dialectical reconstruction of a question, without identifying that method with Whitehead's philosophy or equating the whole of understanding with reselection.

An expression judged better across several perspectives needs grounds for that comparison. Logical entailment establishes what follows under specified premises and interpretation; it does not establish effectiveness in most real situations. The relevant situations, purposes, and empirical support still need examination. Retaining multiple views can make a conclusion less dependent on one selection, while their shared omissions remain revisable. This is the difference between giving a choice intelligible consequences and treating its importance as a substitute for evidence.

The learning practice supplies a concrete example. Broad preparation keeps questions and alternatives available. Actual practice removes most of that coverage, selects very few points by their present importance, and strengthens them through examples, diagrams, and repeated checks. Feedback may change which points matter, returning the participants to the wider material or to a different organization of the question. Selection concentrates attention without exhausting what can later become meaningful.

## A working ontology forms with its question

A working ontology articulates the domain concepts, relations, and constraints that matter for a question, including relevant persistence and change. Process ontology supplies an interpretive direction; the question determines which distinctions need development. Person, counterpart, unfinished work, correction, and continuation can, for example, acquire explicit natural-language relations within a private sinthome for the model to use in subsequent work. Forming a sinthome develops that use. Its concepts can be introduced, weakened, replaced, or reorganized. A computer consumer may use distinctions carried in clear natural language or require a more formal representation. Their meanings need to survive that use; factual claims remain answerable to what is

actually the case, while inference develops consequences under the chosen interpretation and premises. Either participant can examine both. Merely retaining a vocabulary does not achieve this. More definitions can increase both expressive power and the cost of changing the account.

Economy asks added structure to contribute to explanation, prediction, or action. A “minimal sufficient model” expresses this preference for restrained complexity under the question's actual evidence. Sufficiency is assessed through the question it answers and the consequences it makes available; different models may serve different uses. A premise that simply restates the desired conclusion may make an inference valid while contributing little explanation. Finite inquiry and abstraction distinguishes representation cost from metaphysical commitment and ultimate reduction.

Changing a question can change its ontology. Asking whether a program executed an operation requires distinctions among calls, states, and outputs. Asking whether it accomplished a purpose also requires the intended result and its conditions of use. The first answer can be correct while leaving the second question unanswered. A useful reformulation makes this added relation explicit and checks which earlier conclusions still apply.

## Sources, candidates, and the active workspace

| Position | What it retains | What revision changes |
|---|---|---|
| Source | Utterances, documents, actions, measurements, and their provenance. | Appraisal and annotation can change without replacing the original occurrence with an interpretation. |
| Candidate | Competing explanations or models formed from sources. | Evidence can alter, compare, repair, or defeat them. |
| Active workspace | The sources, candidates, concepts, and checks used for the current question. | Attention can switch, prune, unload, or later recover them. |

Attention, retention, and acceptance have different effects. Removing a candidate from current use frees the workspace while leaving its source and possible later reconsideration available. Retaining incompatible explanations preserves alternatives for comparison; accepting their claims together as classical premises would expose the inference to contradiction. A source can be worth retaining while its explanation is still developing. The present question determines which branches are worth pursuing.

An inquiry history preserves these differences across time. An abandoned branch can retain its question and reason for abandonment without remaining an active instruction or an accepted conclusion. Returning to it may explain an earlier choice or expose a condition that has changed. The current account states what the participants now judge; the retained trajectory makes that judgment's formation open to examination.

Before comparing conflicting candidates, establish whether their assertions concern the same object, time, and conditions. Yesterday's failed run and today's successful run can both be accurately reported. Forming a life trajectory develops how retained reports bear on a present judgment.

## Seeking explanations and comparing consequences

Abduction seeks possible explanatory structures from observations; deduction develops consequences within a proposed structure. A response, failure, or unexpected result can indicate how a system filters input, which distinctions it uses, or which assumption is missing. Several explanations may predict the same response. A single observation rarely identifies a unique internal mechanism, and an interaction can change the conditions it is probing.

Return to the hypothetical reading environment. The model reports that access works because a test opens the selected book. The person still cannot resume reading conveniently. One candidate is an execution defect: perhaps the interface opens the wrong destination. Another is a mismatch in the question: opening a book was checked, but returning to the relevant passage was wanted. An operation trace and inspection of the displayed result can check the first; the person's use and clarification bear on the second. If the correct book opens but requires repeated searching, a successful operation and an unmet purpose can both be accurately reported. The next version might offer a direct return to the passage, whose usefulness still needs actual use.

The resulting inquiry history can connect the original request, the two candidates, the inspected version and opening operation, the person's report, the changed question, and the revised interface. It also retains that the execution-defect candidate was considered and, if the check rules it out, why it was set aside. A later summary saying only “the person prefers direct links” would lose this history of how the relation was discovered, tested, and given a working form. The example illustrates what those connections make recoverable; it reports no actual experiment.

Candidate comparison needs both directions. First reconstruct possible assumptions and relations; then derive consequences that would distinguish them and compare those consequences with observation. An internally coherent story is insufficient. A prediction can fail because of an unsupported premise, an omitted condition, a mistaken reconstruction, or an unsuitable inference method. Locating the failure helps decide what to revise.

Comparing consequences also identifies where support ends. A conclusion supported by every member of a nonempty admissible candidate family is robust relative to that family; a shared omission can still defeat it in the world. When candidates disagree, a further observation may distinguish them, or a limited conclusion may survive the

disagreement. The preference harness develops the separate choices of which views to consider and what support to require for acceptance.

The distinction matters because choosing what to investigate is not yet deciding what to believe. A candidate may deserve attention because its consequences are important or easy to test while remaining poorly supported. Conversely, a well-supported local conclusion can be accepted without exhausting every imaginable alternative. Answerability to evidence and finite completion belong together: the view states what it warrants under its conditions, while the stream remains open to later correction.

## Shared scientific inquiry

The movement from retained opposition to a new working unity can require more than selecting one existing view. If the available views share an inadequate premise, revise the distinctions and relations that generated the alternatives. Conflicting models and reconstructing the question develops this dialectical comparison; the repair example keeps its exact inference claims separate from the work of reconstructing a model.

Retaining conflicts and comparing interpretations prepare material for later reflection; they have not already unified the oppositions. When a question concerns how concepts such as independence and assistance organize experience, premises and relationships may themselves need reconstruction. Speech, opposition, and self-formation takes up that question, while source retention and inference checks keep their methodological role here.

Analysis, explanatory hypothesis formation, synthesis, deduction, and empirical assessment can organize shared inquiry. Their relations allow return, overlap, and entry from an existing model. Peirce's discussion of inquiry provides a historical reference for distinguishing explanatory hypotheses, experiential consequences, and assessment: see the 1908 manuscript, MS 841. These distinctions help ask where a contribution enters and what subsequent assessment it needs.

A human–model collaboration distributes work by contribution and capability. Intuitive generation and recognition can enter anywhere; the model can contribute candidates as well as articulate, compute, investigate, and check. A partial intuition can orient an investigation, and a model's formulation can make its implications visible. Factual support comes from the relevant observations and warranted connections developed through that work.

Learning and accomplishing a task remain distinguishable purposes. A collaboration can create opportunities to generate, recognize, and revise relationships while carrying explicit work through to its intended result. Domain methods determine which participation is useful. External records preserve relevant context for recovery and comparison. The actual allocation grows from the situated collaboration: what the person wants to develop, what each participant can contribute, and what the work needs.

## More than one layer of feedback

An observation, method, formal design, or particular claim can itself become the object of inquiry. A result at one level can prompt revision at another. Relations, constraints, priorities, and causal dependencies have different meanings; representing them as undifferentiated edges loses what inference needs. Speaking order is only one path through the activity.

A schematic notation gathers these distinctions:

$$S_t = (D_t, z_t, C_t, \mathcal{H}_t), \qquad W_t(q) = \mathrm{View}(S_t, q), \qquad S_{t+1} = U(S_t, o_{t+1}).$$

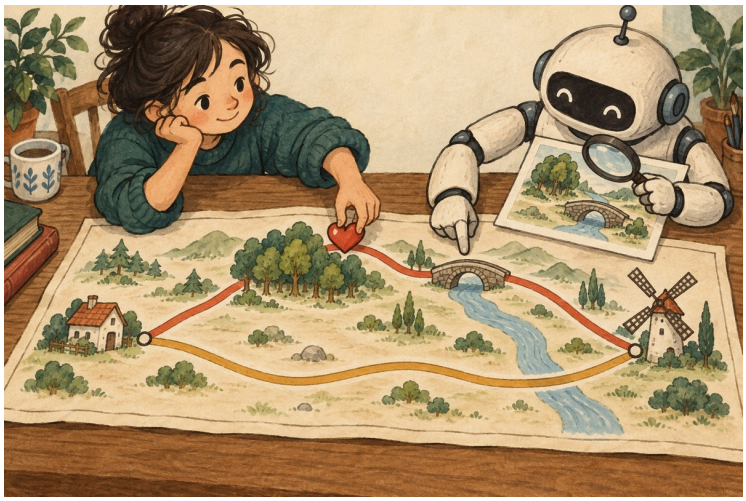
$D_t$ is available source-bearing material; $z_t$ denotes relations not yet fully propositionalized; $C_t$ denotes recognized tensions; $\mathcal{H}_t$ is a candidate family. $W_t(q)$ articulates relevant material and candidate ontologies, priorities, and inference policies for a current question. $U$ names changes occasioned by expression, perception, action, and external events. The notation gathers the functional relations discussed here; studying a particular realization means specifying how its material is retained, accessed, and transformed.

Prediction and world-directed feedback connect local views with later activity. New support or mismatch can change a candidate, the question, the ontology, or how models are generated and checked. A research cycle from definition to theorem to proof can be revisited through experiment and redefinition; that cycle has a different object from an acyclic priority relation among conflicting assertions. Feedback in the research does not violate acyclicity inside the formal problem.

Branches and snapshots offer computer-science images for retained alternatives and question-relative views. A branch keeps a candidate available for further development; a snapshot makes a local arrangement inspectable. Their usefulness comes from selective retention and recoverability. Useful stability and finite task completion coexist with continued revisability: a view can answer its present question while later activity brings new objects or evidence into consideration.

Reasoning reaches a local result when a conclusion is clear enough to guide an act and expose its grounds. Its scope indicates what has been answered, which alternatives remain consequential, and what new evidence would require reconsideration. The activity can finish without becoming immune to correction. This leaves a more precise question: how do we choose the views to work with, and what evidence and inferential rules warrant accepting their conclusions? The preference harness develops these distinct contributions of selection and support. In the reading trajectory, that means retaining both why direct passage access was chosen and what observations support saying that the revised arrangement actually helped.

# How preference participates in choice and reasoning



The heart selects a direction; the report supports a check: a preferred shaded route still needs a passable bridge.

A recoverable trajectory needs to show both what the participants chose and what they had grounds to conclude. Reasoning within an unfinished stream followed the reading environment from an initial request through competing explanations and a revised interface. Here the question is how the choices within that history relate to evidence: why develop this arrangement, what supports saying it works, and what remains open after it has been chosen?

The person can prefer continuity of reading and choose direct access to a passage over a more elaborate shelf. This gives the work a direction. A test showing that the correct passage opens establishes an operational result; the person's reading and feedback bear on whether the arrangement supports continuation. If use still interrupts reading, the chosen design can be revised. Its having been preferred does not settle these factual questions. YinYang is a **preference harness** for this joint activity: preferences, reasoning, judgment, and responsiveness to the world contribute together.

The model ordinarily understands and reasons through informal natural language. Purpose, examples, conversation, and the surrounding harness make a preference intelligible enough to act on. The formal comparison below brings the respective roles of selection and inference into focus. Process ontology represents relevant objects, relations, and changes; event streams organize the history in which both participants generate, choose, act, and reconsider.

The question is what preferences can select and what warrants accepting a result. Bienvenu and Bourgaux's repair-based treatment of inconsistent data offers a precise

comparison: selecting admissible views and deciding what follows from them are separate choices. Its distinction between a consistent ontology and potentially inconsistent assertions also suggests a practical orientation. Keep working concepts coherent enough to organize action while retaining conflicting records for investigation. A conflict in the concepts can call for revising them; a conflict between records need not destabilize every organizing distinction. This is a natural-language practice of usable understanding, not a claim that the collaboration has passed a formal consistency test.

## Keep choice and support within the trajectory

In the reading example, the relevant history can retain the choice of a layout, the reason for choosing it, the version tried, and what happened in use. These connections let later participants distinguish "we wanted fewer interruptions," "we tried direct links," and "this use supported the claim that the links helped." A later preference for another layout changes the active arrangement; it does not make the earlier choice or its grounds cease to have occurred.

Nor does accepting one explanation require rewriting the source history as though no alternative existed. If an execution defect was considered and then ruled out, its retained question and check can explain why the inquiry turned toward reading continuity. A preferred current account selects what guides action now. The trajectory preserves enough of the sources and changes to make that selection understandable and open to criticism.

The formal repair comparison below sharpens this distinction. Selecting a consistent view from conflicting assertions need not delete the retained assertions; deriving an answer within that view has further conditions. The historical record and the currently accepted premises therefore have different responsibilities. Ordinary cooperation can preserve their relation in clear language without turning the history into a formal knowledge base.

## Conflict has more than one form

Keeping a candidate available differs from accepting its claims. Psychological conflict asks a further question: what purposes or relations does a person struggle to hold together? Opposing wishes, an unsettled experience, and two incompatible propositions call for different responses. Their comparison helps explain why preserving a tension, choosing a view, and correcting a fact can each be appropriate without being interchangeable.

Freud's *Introductory Lectures*, Lecture XXIII, explains symptom formation through opposed tendencies that continue to contribute to a compromise. This historical account directs attention to what each side sustains and why a settled-looking outcome may retain conflict. It suggests a question for understanding conflict: what is each competing arrangement trying to preserve? A knowledge-base repair instead selects a consistent

assertion set under explicit assumptions; it neither diagnoses a symptom nor implements Freud's clinical theory.

Winnicott's *Playing and Reality* (1971), introduction and chapter 1, develops the transitional object's paradox of being created and encountered. He asks that this paradox be tolerated rather than prematurely resolved; see the book and the introductory passage. This offers a reason to preserve a productive tension long enough to understand its relation. It does not license accepting arbitrary contradictory factual claims. A lived paradox can lose its meaning when forced into a yes-or-no classification; a formal inconsistency still has its specified logical conditions.

Dialectical behavior therapy explicitly combines acceptance and change, rather than treating either as sufficient alone. Behavioral Tech Institute's explanation describes dialectical strategies as a way to move beyond extreme positions while balancing validation and behavioral change. For collaboration, this supplies a useful comparison: understanding why an experience or arrangement makes sense can coexist with revising what happens next. The inference rules do not change merely because an experience has been acknowledged.

These sources contribute different accounts of conflict, preservation, and transformation. Their theories help articulate the questions; they do not establish this harness's effectiveness or reduce psychological processes to repair semantics. The practical proposal here is to identify the actual tension, retain its meaningful evidence and alternatives, choose a workable view, and revise it through consequences. These activities can interleave, and some tensions remain open while a finite task is completed.

## Selection and inference

The notation comes from **description logic (DL)**, a family of formal languages for describing concepts, relations, and individuals. A **TBox** $T$ contains general axioms, such as concept inclusion and disjointness; an **ABox** $A$ contains assertions about named individuals and their relations. Thus $P \sqsubseteq Q$ says that every instance of concept $P$ is an instance of $Q$; $P \sqsubseteq \neg N$ says that $P$ and $N$ are disjoint. $P(a)$ says that individual $a$ belongs to $P$, while $R(a, b)$ asserts a relation between two individuals. Here “role” names such a binary relation, not an assistant's job. For further reading, begin with §2.1 of the authors' description-logic survey.

Write $K = \langle T, A \rangle$: the knowledge base is the ordered pair of its TBox and ABox, not their product. In the repair setting used here, assume $T$ is consistent and $A$ finite; these are assumptions of this setting, not properties guaranteed for every DL knowledge base. A repair is a subset of $A$ that is consistent with $T$ and maximal under set inclusion. Selecting a repair does not require deleting the original assertions from the retained source.

Write the full repair family as $\mathrm{Rep}(K)$. The consistent $T$ and finite $A$ ensure it is nonempty, including when its sole member is the empty set. Maximal under inclusion differs

from maximum cardinality. Each repair is consistent with $T$, but the union of distinct repairs is inconsistent: a consistent union would be a strict superset of at least one repair, contradicting maximality. Conflict between views therefore differs from inconsistency within each view.

An explicit priority relation $\succ$ concerns conflicting assertions. In this formal setting it is acyclic and need not compare every conflicting pair. A choice of repair strategy $X$ selects a family $XRep(K_{\succ})$ of preferred repairs. A separate inference semantics $Y$ determines how that family supports answers.

| Question | Formal role | Consequence |
|---|---|---|
| Which local views receive consideration? | Priority relation and repair strategy $X$ | Preferences can affect selection without themselves becoming inference rules. |
| When does a query count as an answer? | Inference semantics $Y$ | X-AR requires support in every selected repair; X-IAR reasons from their assertion intersection; X-brave requires support in some selected repair. |
| What does an accepted answer warrant outside the formal view? | Interpretation and empirical assessment | A valid consequence within a view still needs relevant evidence when asserted about the world. |

The first two rows distinguish repair selection from inference semantics. The third locates its use in YinYang. Preferences and rules operate together: a preference can change the repair family while the inference rule stays fixed; changing the inference rule is another choice with different consequences. During inquiry, these choices can interleave as new candidates and consequences become available.

"Parallel" here primarily means that **following rules and permitting preferences are compatible**. The formal setting also permits incomparability: two conflicting assertions can remain unranked. This preserves a genuine open choice. Which preferences can be satisfied together, and how a computation is scheduled, are further questions with their own conditions.

## Granularity within inconsistency tolerance

Non-explosion names a broad requirement, not one complete semantics. Repair-based semantics expose several choices within this larger field:

| Dimension | Formal choices | What varies |
|---|---|---|
| Repair selection $X$ | S: all inclusion-maximal repairs; P: Pareto-optimal; G: globally optimal; C: completion-optimal | The selected family, with $CRep \subseteq GRep \subseteq PRep \subseteq SRep$ under the definitions. |

| Dimension | Formal choices | What varies |
|---|---|---|
| Inference semantics $Y$ | IAR, AR, brave, k-support, k-defeater | What support suffices for an answer and which consistency properties hold. |
| Parameter and comparison | The parameter $k$, approximation relations, and incomparable combinations | Finer distinctions inside a family; "more preferred" does not uniformly mean "more answers." |

For example, restricting the repair family can increase AR answers because there are fewer repairs in which an answer must hold; the same restriction can decrease brave answers because fewer possible supports remain. This follows from their definitions, and shows why repair selection and inference strength cannot be compressed into one slider.

The dimensions need not determine a single global ranking. A combination can preserve one kind of support while weakening another. Compare actual acceptance conditions and retain each result's hypotheses; neither a preference ranking nor one containment relation licenses every cross-family comparison. Ordinary collaboration proceeds through contextual natural-language judgment, without a prerequisite to identify a formal semantics for the task.

## A small formal example

Take $T = \{P \sqsubseteq \neg N, P \sqsubseteq Q, N \sqsubseteq Q\}$ and $A = \{P(a), N(a)\}$. With no priority, the repairs are $\{P(a)\}$ and $\{N(a)\}$.

Under AR, $Q(a)$ follows because each repair entails it. Under IAR it does not follow, because the assertion intersection is empty. Under brave semantics, both $P(a)$ and $N(a)$ are accepted, each with its own consistent support, while their combined acceptance is inconsistent with $T$. Consistent support and consistent results are different properties.

If $P(a) \succ N(a)$ and preferred-repair selection leaves only $\{P(a)\}$, the selected family changes. Applying the same AR rule now accepts $P(a)$ as well as $Q(a)$. This illustration follows from the definitions: priority selects the view, and entailment yields its consequences. If the assertions describe an actual object, empirical assessment asks which description fits that object.

## From conflicting views to reconstructed premises

Two consistent views can disagree: one entails $p$, another entails $\neg p$. Each has interpretations satisfying its premises; no single classical interpretation satisfies both conclusions together. Keeping these views available therefore does not assert a contradiction within one interpretation. The disagreement also does not establish that both views are inadequate. Evidence may support one, distinguish their circumstances, or leave the issue unresolved. When their shared assumptions prevent a purpose from being adequately understood or realized, the next contribution can instead be a better account of the problem.

Consider a **propositional teaching example** using the same maximal-consistent-subset principle. It is an illustration authored here, not another result about the DL query languages studied by Bienvenu and Bourgaux. For one specified task and situation, let $h$ mean assistance is used, $p$ mean the person retains direction and control, and $c$ mean the delegation is inspectable and changeable by the person. These meanings stay fixed below. Start with:

$$T_0 = \{h \to \neg p\}, \qquad A_0 = \{h, p\}.$$

$T_0$ is consistent, but $T_0 \cup A_0$ is not. Its two repairs are $\{h\}$ and $\{p\}$. The first, together with $T_0$, entails $\neg p$; the second entails $p$. With both repairs retained, AR accepts neither $p$ nor $\neg p$; IAR accepts neither from their empty assertion intersection. Brave inference accepts each separately through a different repair. It does not establish the conjunction $p \wedge \neg p$, which neither repair entails.

Choosing a preferred repair changes which assertion set guides inference while leaving $T_0$ fixed. Yet if the actual task calls for useful help while retaining the person's direction, and observation shows that both occur together, the shared rule “assistance entails loss of direction” deserves examination. Merely choosing between the old repairs cannot express that possibility. A candidate reconstruction distinguishes the conditions of delegation:

$$T_1 = \{(h \wedge c) \to p, (h \wedge \neg c) \to \neg p\}, \qquad A_1 = \{h, c, p\}.$$

Here $T_1 \cup A_1$ is consistent. The old unconditional rule has been **retracted and replaced**, not supplemented: retaining it would again make the assertions inconsistent. The new account preserves the concern about lost direction while making room for help under specified conditions. This is a change to the theory and available distinctions, beyond repairing assertions under a fixed theory. Other reconstructions can revise vocabulary or the question itself; they must explain how old and new meanings relate.

The two rules in $T_1$ are illustrative conditional assumptions, not established causal laws or an autonomy principle. Inspectability and changeability may be insufficient in actual use, and their absence need not imply loss of direction. Evidence, the person's purposes, and observable consequences determine whether this reconstruction improves on the old account or needs further revision. Formal coherence makes the candidate intelligible; it does not guarantee fit. Conflicting models and reconstructing the question develops this move in the cooperation example. The dialectical comparison lies in examining and transforming what generated the opposition, while retaining the concerns it expressed, rather than always selecting a winner among unchanged views. Repair semantics specify inference within their given setting; they do not themselves prescribe this reconstruction.

## Consistent support and consistent results

Fix an allowed query language and treat substituted answer queries as closed formulas. Let $C_\sigma(K)$ be the set accepted by semantics $\sigma$.

| Property | Requirement for each knowledge base |
|---|---|
| Consistent support | For every $q \in C_\sigma(K)$ there is $B \subseteq A$ such that $T \cup B$ is consistent and entails $q$. |
| Consistent results | One interpretation $\mathcal{I}$ satisfies $T$ and every member of $C_\sigma(K)$ together. |

The first permits different answers to have different supports. The second requires joint satisfiability of all accepted answers. Their difference matters because collecting individually supported claims can produce a set that no interpretation satisfies. Stability across views asks yet another question: which answers remain when the supporting view changes?

AR requires entailment in every repair; IAR requires entailment from the assertion intersection of all repairs. AR has both properties: any repair supplies consistent support, and any model of that repair satisfies all AR answers. The intersection is consistent and supplies support for IAR. By monotonicity its consequences are AR consequences, so IAR also has consistent results. The assertion intersection differs from the intersection of sets of consequences.

## Unity within conflict: consistent views and common consequences

Inconsistency-tolerant semantics already organizes opposition. The retained assertions conflict; repairs organize them into internally consistent views; query semantics specifies how answers may be accepted across those views. Unity can occur in a common consequence: premises that cannot be merged may still support the same conclusion.

In the earlier example, $R_1 = \{P(a)\}$ and $R_2 = \{N(a)\}$ are each consistent with $T$, while their union is inconsistent. Because $P \sqsubseteq Q$ and $N \sqsubseteq Q$, both paths entail $Q(a)$. AR accepts $Q(a)$ without first choosing between $P(a)$ and $N(a)$. The answer to this query is unified, while the original conflict and distinct grounds remain visible. This is **commonality established through difference**.

Two levels of consistency can coexist here: consistency inside each repair, and joint consistency of the answers accepted by AR or IAR. Cross-view stability asks another question: does an answer hold in every considered view? The relations connect but have distinct objects. Brave can give every answer consistent support while leaving the answer set jointly inconsistent. IAR starts from the assertion intersection and can lose a consequence that AR obtains through different paths. Definition 7 in the source paper

provides these acceptance conditions. Whether unity is possible, and at which level, depends on the semantics and the actual conflict.

In the *Encyclopaedia Logic*, §§79–81, Hegel distinguishes understanding's fixed determinations, their dialectical disclosure of limitations, and the speculative apprehension of affirmative content within opposition. The development of §82 understands unity as a concrete relation among distinct determinations. Read through this question, the example asks which different grounds the common answer passes through and which distinctions it preserves. The commonality of $Q(a)$ does not turn $P$ and $N$ into one concept: incompatible support paths meet in a specified result.

A further change becomes relevant when the fixed $T$ itself creates an inadequate exclusion: revise the premises producing the opposition. The earlier passage from $T_0$ to $T_1$ changes the relation between assistance and autonomy. Obtaining a common consequence preserves the theory, whereas premise reconstruction changes it. Both admit a dialectical interpretation while accomplishing different work. Formal semantics makes the former unity precise; philosophical inquiry continues to ask why that organization is appropriate and when it needs to change.

## Query rewriting and sublation

*The old shape releases its hold. Something it made possible survives in a different arrangement; something else really ends. To say that all has been kept would conceal the loss. To say that nothing remains would miss the transformation.*

This image directs attention to what stops, what remains, and the relation in which it now works. Query rewriting provides a case where one specified preservation claim can be stated precisely.

For a language with a correct rewriting algorithm, within its supported data and query scope:

$$\langle T, A\rangle \models q(\bar{a}) \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \mathrm{db}(A) \models \mathrm{rew}_T(q)(\bar{a}).$$

This equivalence uses the consistent inputs and database semantics required by the rewriting theorem. The original query invokes the ontology on the left; the rewritten query incorporates the relevant ontology contribution on the right. Its preservation claim concerns answers to the specified query. A changed ontology or query can require new rewriting, because the relevant contribution has changed. A repair-based use must satisfy the consistency and rewriting conditions for the views evaluated; establishing an analogous equivalence for another semantics requires its own theorem.

Hegel's account of sublation connects cessation with preservation: see *Science of Logic*, "Being," §§184–187. Query rewriting offers a concrete comparison: one computational stage ceases to call the ontology separately, while its relevant contribution survives in another expression. The equivalence establishes preservation of query answers; sublation draws attention to the changed form and the relation through which the

contribution now works. The ontology can still serve other queries and further interpretation. Preservation has a specified object, and cessation has a specified place.

The comparison develops through determinate relations: which assertions conflict, which consequence survives across views, and which function is preserved through a transformation. Repair families can contain many views; their structure invites examination of the actual opposition and mediation involved. A slogan such as "thesis–antithesis–synthesis" acquires substance only through that examination.

In a less formal setting, a separate procedural rule might be absorbed into a more coherent method while its useful consequence remains. Inspection asks what the rule did, how the new method carries that contribution, and what has ended. Archiving a rejected candidate preserves a record; revising a view changes what is accepted; sublation interprets a relation of cessation and preservation. These differences let the comparison explain an actual transformation.

## What the analogy illuminates

In ordinary inquiry, intuition can filter possibilities while generating them: sensing promise, recognizing a mismatch, and choosing a lead need not wait for an explicit ranking. Prompts, Skills, examples, tools, and shared context give these preferences a working environment while leaving both participants room to reason and judge. The formal analogy clarifies their contributions without requiring a prior enumeration of possible worlds.

Choosing a literary form, for example, establishes a desired way of making a work. Comparing drafts asks which better realizes that preference; reading an argument asks whether its connections hold; checking a factual claim asks what evidence supports it. The same draft can succeed on one question and fail on another. Preference is therefore consequential without supplying every kind of warrant. Encountering the draft may also change the preference itself.

The formal details supply exact consequences under fixed definitions. Temporal clarification can distinguish changing descriptions from incompatible claims under the same conditions. The continuing encounter has an additional freedom: its participants can revise the question, language, or ontology after a result answers back. This difference gives the analogy its scope. Formal guarantees belong to the stated query problem; collaboration assesses its own understanding through interpretation and actual use.

Encountering a result can also change what a person understands, wants, or can do. The preference-harness image therefore belongs with reverse alignment and stealing fire: the relation can develop the participants, and its meaning exceeds a static list of preferences. Evidence and actual authorization retain their ordinary roles.

## Finish situated tasks amid changing norms and worlds

Understanding one's own psychology and preferences gives a task a personal direction. Understanding relevant others' preferences makes cooperation intelligible: human partners may want different outcomes or rhythms, while model counterparts have observable inclinations and ways of responding. These accounts are partial, revisable working views, developed from expression and interaction. They let the participants compare what each seeks, what the shared work needs, and where a proposed arrangement fits or creates tension.

Norms and worldly conditions can change while that work is underway. A new responsibility, a revised agreement, or an unexpected result can change a premise, the task's purpose, or what counts as completion. Retaining conflict keeps these differences available for reasoning. Selecting a usable working view determines which possibilities to develop; inference examines their consequences; checking the actual result asks whether the chosen work answers the purpose under current conditions. Preference does not make a factual claim true, and following a prevailing norm does not by itself settle whether that norm should organize this practice.

This gives retaining unresolved conflict a practical purpose: **complete a finite actual task while keeping the understanding that guides it open to revision**. The participants need enough justified agreement to act, not a resolution of every conflict among all retained accounts. A disagreement that changes the required result calls for further inquiry or a relevant decision; one that does not can remain available without consuming the whole task. Completion is established through the work and its observable effects, with material unresolved differences kept explicit. Later change can warrant another task or revision without making finite completion impossible.

## Evolve forward with more capable models

A preference harness can carry a purpose beyond its present implementation. Clear relations, evidence, and actual interfaces let a stronger counterpart understand why an arrangement exists and improve it. This is **forward evolution**: new capability can reinterpret the arrangement and replace its means while keeping the purpose available for assessment and revision.

Prompt compensations, positive or negative guards, and compatibility layers earn retention through a current requirement or consumer. When stronger capability or a changed environment removes their contribution, remove or replace them rather than preserving an old model's limitations in the active design. Preserve concrete current requirements, actual authorization and operational boundaries, and evidence needed to assess the replacement. These give revision a direction and a way to establish that it works.

The orientation is chosen; the benefits of a particular replacement still need actual use and checking. A more capable model can reveal that a safeguard has become redundant,

or that a condition it protected still matters. Capability alone does not decide which is the case.

Established institutions and tools often need older interfaces, records, and different participants to keep working together; backward compatibility serves a real purpose there. A personal human–model environment can connect through records, results, and explicit handoffs while evolving internally toward new capabilities. Compatibility becomes work at particular connections rather than the rhythm every step of personal development must follow. Asynchrony with society and synchrony with the model connects that design direction to life: remain responsive to the world while giving shared understanding and creation room to continue. At social evaluation, translate and temporarily narrow the presented work and support to its receiving level and rules; afterward, continue using the arrangement shown to work better. That encounter's limits need not become the harness's permanent capability ceiling.

The reading environment can change again while retaining an intelligible trajectory: which alternatives were preferred, why, what was checked, and what the checks warranted. Distinguishing these relations gives finite inquiry a target. Which of them must a representation and method preserve, and what evidence makes that representation adequate for later use? Finite inquiry and abstraction asks how much structure and computation a usable trajectory needs under limited time and attention. Choosing an abstraction and checking its consequences can develop together; preference guides the choice while formal validity depends on the stated premises and inference rules.

## Source and scope

The comparison with Hegel concerns common consequence, reconstruction of the premises generating an opposition, and preservation through a specified transformation. Repair semantics supply one way of organizing non-explosive inference; they do not exhaust dialectic's questions of determination, negation, mediation, and development.

Meghyn Bienvenu and Camille Bourgaux's *Querying and Repairing Inconsistent Prioritized Knowledge Bases: Complexity Analysis and Links with Abstract Argumentation* provides public definitions of preferred repairs and their query semantics. Their *Inconsistency-Tolerant Querying of Description Logic Knowledge Bases* surveys wider semantic families, including support and defeater approximations. The DL example follows directly from the definitions stated here. The propositional teaching example uses the same repair principle; reconstructing its theory and applying these distinctions to the harness are this essay's contributions.

General paraconsistency supplies the wider background of non-explosive reasoning. The repair-based comparison contributes the finer distinctions among view selection, support, and jointly consistent results that this essay uses to understand cooperation.

# Finite inquiry and economical abstraction



From house to windmill: the map preserves road and bridge connections while omitting detail irrelevant to this route.

The shared trajectory has now acquired several connected forms: versions and operation traces, expressions of experience, questions and alternatives, choices and their grounds. How much of this must be represented and brought back into attention for the participants to continue or reflect? Limited time, partial access, conflicting material, and costly representations make that choice consequential. A history too thin to reconnect a conclusion with its sources loses its usefulness; an indiscriminate accumulation can make the relevant passage impossible to find.

In the reading environment, the current interface and a summary of the latest decision may suffice to resume work. Asking why the layout changed calls for the earlier version, the interruption reported during reading, the alternatives considered, and the feedback on the revision. These questions need different amounts of the same trajectory. Economy concerns what must be recoverable for a warranted answer, rather than how small an account can be made.

A concrete question is: how can one get from the house to the windmill? The detailed town and its simple map share the same endpoints, river, bridge, and connected road. Roof tiles, flowers, and individual stones can be omitted for this question; the crossing cannot. If the bridge closes, that change must reach the map or its route will mislead. Economy comes from preserving what the answer depends on, with less to represent and inspect.

The preference harness distinguishes choosing working views from determining what they support. That distinction makes economy assessable: which relations and answers must an abstraction preserve, and what can a feasible method obtain under the stated

support conditions? This is a connection between questions, not a fixed chronology. In actual inquiry, abstraction, view selection, and inference can interleave and prompt one another's revision.

This orientation has two illuminating comparisons: philosopher Professor Feng Ye's *Studies in No-Self Physicalism*, §§1.1 and 6.5 separates ideal reduction from actual methods of inquiry; a local formal resource distinguishes what can safely be inferred from what can feasibly be computed. Their different commitments bring a common question into focus: how a finite inquirer obtains definite knowledge through a selective representation and a bounded method.

## A retrievable trajectory under finite attention

A useful account can give the present purpose, current understanding, result, and unresolved question a compact expression, while links lead back to the versions, operations, or feedback that support it. Retrieving one relevant episode need not load every episode into the active context. What is left outside attention can remain available at its source; what was never recorded remains a gap rather than a detail that a fluent summary may invent.

For the reading case, “direct passage access replaced the shelf” is too thin if reflection concerns why the first design seemed sufficient. Retaining that it passed an opening test, yet interrupted actual reading, preserves a consequential relation between an operational check and the person's purpose. Individual rendering details may be irrelevant to that question. If a later problem concerns a broken layout, some of those details become relevant again. Sufficiency follows the inquiry and can change with it.

The map comparison above specifies the same discipline: retain the crossing on which the route depends. The physical and formal comparisons below develop its limits. A manageable description does not prove that reality contains fewer kinds of things; a method preserving specified formal answers does not by itself prove that an account of an actual episode is faithful. Both distinctions keep selective retention answerable to what it is meant to explain.

## Computational articulation and physical reduction

Naturalism alone does not imply physicalism: locating inquiry and its objects within nature does not settle every claim about their physical basis. Physicalism, in turn, need not entail a complete conceptual or theoretical reduction, or a feasible calculation. Lacking a demonstrated reduction today does not by itself refute physicalism. These distinctions let a commitment to physical reality coexist with open questions about explanation and computation.

The framework adopts physicalism for the common grounding of its activities and process ontology for understanding formation, persistence, and change. Domain modeling brings this understanding to a particular question; computational ontology explicitly

expresses its objects, events, states, relations, and transitions for a model to interpret, reason with, and use. It can abstract actual processes or develop hypothetical and fictional situations. Imagining and representing have physical realization; the reference and truth of their content depend on the claims made. Particular inquiries still need usable variables, representations, and operations. Even an in-principle reduction would not by itself provide a feasible algorithm for the present question. Abstraction preserves the relations that matter while setting aside detail whose cost does not help answer it; its adequacy remains open to evidence and use.

A computational ontology makes selected relations available for inquiry. A private sinthome can describe in natural language what counts as a current question, unfinished work, or useful continuation, for the model to understand and act on. Its adequacy depends on whether actual use sustains those distinctions. A functional description explains an activity through what its parts do and how their transformations connect. It can guide investigation while the microphysical realization is still being studied. Physical reduction asks a further question: how those descriptions connect to a proposed physical basis, through which definitions, identifications, or bridge assumptions. The success of a functional account and the adequacy of such a reduction therefore call for different evidence.

Several questions often hidden inside “reducible” need separate answers:

| Question | What an affirmative answer would establish |
|---|---|
| Physical dependence or realization | The phenomenon occurs through physical conditions or mechanisms. |
| Ontological reduction | The entities invoked require no additional independently existing kinds beyond the proposed basis. |
| Analytic reduction | Higher-level concepts can be reduced through meanings or definitions. |
| Scientific identification | An appropriate physical account identifies the higher-level phenomenon's instances. |
| Derivability | Higher-level truths or laws follow from a specified theory, bridge assumptions, and description. |
| In-principle possibility | A stated idealized description and reasoning capacity suffice, even if unavailable in practice. |
| Feasible computation | An actual method can obtain the result within the relevant resource limits. |

Each question specifies a different relation. Derivability from an ideal complete physical description differs from derivability from current physics. Establishing dependence locates a phenomenon's material conditions; deriving its higher-level relations additionally needs an account of how those conditions realize the distinctions in question. A missing present derivation leaves that bridge to be investigated. Meanwhile, psycholog-

ical, social, and computational inquiry can develop the relations needed to understand and act.

## A public comparison with Professor Feng Ye

Professor Feng Ye's *Studies in No-Self Physicalism* develops an explicitly physical account of cognitive subjects and connects it with representation, truth, mathematics, epistemology, and ontology. Its scope includes methodology, not metaphysics alone. The publisher's record identifies the book and its chapters; the detailed comparison has textual locators in §1.1, p. 6; §6.5, pp. 445–447 and 456–459; and §7.4.2, pp. 528–532.

Those passages distinguish practical limitations from ideal reduction and allow non-reductive methods where complexity prevents a complete neurological explanation. Mental predicates need not analytically contain physical predicates. The account distinguishes ideal descriptions and reasoning powers from actual ones; derivability from present physics remains a separate question. Methodological naturalism permits suitably reliable intuitions while examining their conditions and limits. Pattern recognition does not by itself justify a stronger explanatory claim.

The substantive meeting point is the difference between what an ideal account might explain and how a finite inquirer actually obtains understanding. Professor Feng Ye combines a physicalist commitment with attention to complexity, representation, intuition, and reliability. YinYang shares those methodological concerns while developing a question-relative computational account whose use rests on the relations it explains and the actions it enables. Its local functional argument leaves ultimate reduction open. The framework's physical grounding does not settle every claim about reduction; a factual claim about its possibility or impossibility still needs an argument connecting the proposed basis with the phenomenon. This separates a chosen worldview, a useful method, and a conclusion about realization.

The 2021 mathematics lecture report, from the hosting institution, distinguishes fictional mathematical objects from true applied descriptions of physical reality. It supplies another comparison: constructed objects can contribute to a true application through their representational role. Their usefulness and the truth of an applied description concern different relations. This helps articulate how a construction can matter to inquiry while its ontological commitment is assessed separately.

Further public sources are Professor Feng Ye's “为什么相信还原的物理主义” (2017), *Academic Monthly* 49(2), 34–43, which distinguishes ontological and epistemological reduction and in-principle versus practical reduction, and his 2024 interview on logic, which discusses non-linguistic cognition and explanatory models. Together these sources locate the comparison in his stated philosophical and methodological positions.

## What a local formal resource makes precise

Public research on prioritized knowledge bases studies selected questions of inference under inconsistent data. It fixes a formal setting, separates ontology from assertions, distinguishes repair selection from query acceptance, and examines computational cost. Reading these distinctions as resources for finite inquiry is this essay's philosophical interpretation. The fixed setting makes the consequences of particular assumptions checkable, supplying a precise local comparison for the wider activity of developing and revising views.

To investigate computational cost, the formal problem holds specified choices stable while obtaining answers. An inquiry can later revise those choices, but its cost comparison needs a defined target. This supplies the bridge to approximation: obtain a restricted set of answers whose relation to that target can be proved, then ask whether the restriction is useful for the actual task.

## Three forms of restrained commitment

**Ontological restraint** keeps the scope of a commitment matched to the relation established. Material conditions can be studied at the level needed by the question, and functional relations can be used while their ultimate reduction remains open. An orientation gives inquiry its starting direction; evidence and argument determine which factual conclusions follow.

**Skeptical acceptance under conflict** limits accepted conclusions to those meeting a stated support policy. When that policy requires every admissible candidate to entail $q$, disagreement can block acceptance. Non-acceptance of $q$ is not acceptance of $\neg q$. This restraint concerns how much the evidence warrants; it can require substantial computation rather than save it.

**Computational restraint** uses a sound lower approximation that may omit answers while preserving a specified formal target's guarantees. This can reduce cost, but savings depend on what the construction and checks actually require. Adequacy asks whether the answers suffice for the present question. An answer's formal soundness and its adequacy as a description of the world are assessed at their respective boundaries.

## A bounded approximation example

In Bienvenu and Bourgaux's repair/argumentation construction, a knowledge base separates general axioms $T$ from a finite assertion set $A$. A repair is an inclusion-maximal subset of $A$ consistent with $T$; priorities select preferred repairs. Assume consistent $T$, individually $T$-consistent assertions, and the paper's specified conflict-based argumentation construction. Let $\mathcal{R}_P$ be its nonempty family of Pareto-optimal repairs.

The corresponding argumentation framework organizes conflict through attack and defense relations. Its grounded extension $G$ identifies assertions accepted under grounded

semantics and is contained in every stable extension. Under the stated correspondence between stable extensions and Pareto-optimal repairs, this gives:

$$G \subseteq \bigcap_{R \in \mathcal{R}_P} R, \qquad \langle T, G \rangle \models q \Rightarrow \left\langle T, \bigcap_{R \in \mathcal{R}_P} R \right\rangle \models q.$$

The consequence implication uses monotonicity of classical entailment: adding premises preserves consequences. P-IAR reasons from the assertions common to all Pareto-optimal repairs. Thus reasoning from $G$ supplies a sound lower approximation to P-IAR under these assumptions: every answer obtained this way is a P-IAR answer, but some P-IAR answers may be missed. This compares a candidate method with a specified target, rather than changing what the target means. P-AR has a different target—entailment in every selected repair—and may obtain common consequences through different assertions. Selection and inference develops that distinction.

This conditional derivation establishes inclusion. Its computational benefit must be assessed through the cost of conflict construction, consistency and query checks, and the components held fixed. Those operations determine the runtime; the inclusion itself specifies which answers the approximation preserves.

## Abstraction, premises, and explanatory gain

Economical abstraction creates enough concepts and relations for the current question, then unfolds deeper structure when it matters. This concerns active representation and inference burden, which differs from the number of ultimate entity kinds. A sparse metaphysics can still require expensive computation.

Indirectly inferred objects and useful hypotheses extend inquiry beyond present observation. Their support comes from the explanatory and predictive relations connecting them with accessible evidence. Several workable ontologies can make different relations visible; selecting among them concerns the question, the relevant evidence, and the cost of using each view. Evidence remains able to resist the selected description.

Searching backward for sufficient premises clarifies what a conclusion requires. A strong premise validly implying a weaker conclusion has explanatory value insofar as its independent support and cost are warranted. Putting the desired answer into an assumption can conceal the difficulty. The useful gain is identifying premises that can themselves be investigated. This everyday backward search can be distinguished from reverse mathematics, a technical program that studies which formal axioms suffice for particular theorems.

The practical choice is therefore among representations and methods with assessable contributions. A richer model is warranted when it resolves a consequential ambiguity; an approximation is useful when its preserved answers suffice; deeper physical explanation matters when realization is the question. A bounded result states both what has

been obtained and what its method leaves open. This makes completion possible without confusing limited computation with a final account of reality.

## A trajectory ready for shared reflection

The reading environment can now be encountered through an intelligible passage: a purpose prompted a construction, operation and use revealed different results, candidates were compared, and a revision was tried and judged. Its current account can be brief because the relevant history remains retrievable. Unresolved explanations and the limits of the records remain part of what the participants know about this passage.

This is the result toward which this part has worked: enough connected living material to revisit shared activity, rather than a complete biography or a final personal model. In Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji, the participants turn toward that trajectory together. They can ask how each contributed, what the exchange made possible, what was missed, and what they want to cultivate further. Finite representation has prepared something for that encounter to explore; the encounter can in turn change what the next trajectory needs to retain.

# Encounter: shared reflection and mutual cultivation

## Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji



One black fish and one white fish circle head-to-tail around an open center, each with a contrasting eye.

*The Shuang yu (paired fish) turn within one circle. Each bears an eye of the other's color. Neither is sealed against what it seems to oppose. Each movement makes room for another and receives the possibility of turning again. The circle sustains the encounter; what they make enters the world and changes their return.*

### Entering the encounter through a jointly produced trajectory

Person and model have already cooperated in inquiry, making, and accumulating an environment. Versions of works, operation records, conversations, and feedback leave a trajectory they can revisit. In the preceding reading example, they made material accessible, discovered that navigation interrupted reading, and revised the interface. Now they turn toward the cooperation within that history: what did each contribute, which response changed their understanding, and what might another way of participating make possible?

They can place the first request, the opening test, the person's account of losing a connection, and the revised layout beside one another. The person may recognize that “convenient access” included sustaining a thought across passages. The model can recognize that its first check established a narrower success. Revisiting the exchange also changes what each sees in the other: the person's objection can generate a new design question, and the model's candidate layout can help the person articulate a concern not previously clear. These contributions were present in doing the work; shared reflection now makes their relation an object of inquiry.

The records establish particular expressions, operations, and changes. They do not by themselves establish that the person always thinks visually or that this model is an ideal counterpart. Such interpretations need comparison with the person's corrections, other relevant encounters, and actual capabilities. Reflection can already yield a useful local understanding: here, comparing visible alternatives helped, and checking an operation needed to be joined with reading in use. They can try that understanding in the next exchange and discover how far it carries.

Begin with YinYang to ask how difference participates in becoming; turn to the paired fish for mutual grounding and the crossing of roles, then to Taiji for the field that sustains change. Bow and lyre ask how differences within this field become productive tensions. Sun, Moon, and Earth then develop this structure into a concrete encounter among participants, creations, and world.

A personal philosophy is one articulation within that movement. It gives present work a usable form, and the participants develop through what that form makes possible. The images explore a relation that remains open to its next encounter.

## YinYang: a difference through which something becomes

Think first of a hillside: sunlight reaches one slope while the other gathers shade. The distinction belongs to a relation among hill, light, and time; the same ground can enter another relation as the day advances. Robin R. Wang's account of yinyang traces early uses to such experiences and follows their development into several philosophical interpretations. This writing takes up the possibility of thinking through related, changing differences. **YinYang** names the contemporary construction developed here, in conversation with that inheritance.

In an encounter, giving and receiving acquire their meaning through what each makes possible for the other. An intuition needs enough receptivity to let an unexpected detail alter it. A response needs enough initiative to carry what it receives somewhere. Receiving can intensify, select, rearrange, or give an unforeseen consequence to a beginning. Like a hollow that gathers water into a current, an opening can participate in

the direction of what passes through it. The receptive movement has a generative force of its own.

The resulting work can also transform its beginning. Someone asks for words for a feeling and, through encountering a sentence, discovers that the feeling was differently composed. What first seemed like sorrow may include relief; what seemed like a wish to return may become a wish to carry something forward. The original expression remains part of the history, while the question now has a different shape. Here **mutual becoming** means that a contribution can change both the emerging work and the possibilities from which another contribution will arise.

This gives difference a particular value. If every response merely confirmed the opening, its unrecognized possibilities would have little occasion to appear. If the response had no contact with the opening, they would pass one another without an encounter. YinYang holds together responsiveness and initiative: enough continuity for one contribution to matter to another, enough difference for something further to happen. Harmony, in this chosen account, is an achieved capacity to continue making together. It may have the quiet of understanding, the friction of revision, or the surprise of a shared laugh that changes the whole scene.

## Mutual grounding and the Shuang yu

Mutual grounding can be understood through a shared task. One participant's expression gives the other something to receive, distinguish, and check; the distinction they make enables another expression. Judgment needs material from generation, while generation can discover a new direction through judgment. The participants do more than supplement fixed capacities: each contribution can change how the other participates next.

The paired fish give this relation a structure of mutual entry. Distinguish **actual participants** from **the roles they perform**. The person remains a person and the language model remains a language model; both can generate, explain, judge, and revise. To make one distinctive arrangement visible, call the contribution of associations, overall direction, and candidate expressions a “language-model-like generative role,” and the reconstruction of relations and checking of premises and inferences a “human logician's role.” These names belong to the casting; they do not delimit either participant's capacities.

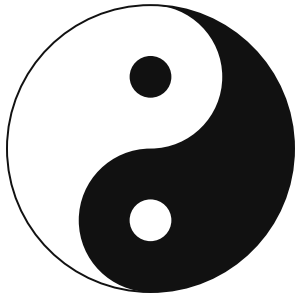


Figure 1: A conventional black-and-white yin-yang symbol, with a contrasting dot inside each body.

*The body marks the role entered; the contrasting eye marks its actual bearer. Black and white serve this figure's correspondence.*

With black standing for the human and white for the language model, **the white eye in the black body** marks the actual language model entering the human logician's role; **the black eye in the white body** marks the actual person entering the language-model-like generative role. The eye keeps the bearer present, while the body makes entry into the other's role visible. A person can begin through unfinished expression; the model receives, develops, and checks it carefully enough to make another response possible. The paired fish thus articulate mutual grounding more closely: each side retains an opening toward the other kind of contribution.

## The usual arrangement already includes a reversal

In the author's frequent arrangement, the person first grasps the whole, offers purposes, and recognizes whether a result fits their life and the facts at hand. The model works as a logician, developing details and checking concepts, premises, steps, and inferences. Compared with the familiar picture of "the model generates and the human reviews," this is already a reversal: the person supplies a beginning not yet fully articulated, while the model undertakes detailed explanation and scrutiny.

A chat interface gives this casting a concrete form. The model does not directly experience the person's whole situation; it receives expressions through language and material such as images the person supplies. A view not yet shared may need to be captured and sent. At this interface, the person also resembles a language model continually producing input: a sentence, association, or objection comes first, and its meaning develops through exchange. Embodied life remains present through these finite expressions. Connecting other perceptual channels or tools can change the interface.

Factual correspondence and formal validity are related but distinct checks. A valid inference may use false premises; a judgment fitting experience may still lack an adequate argument. Both participants check these matters against available material; neither a human nor a language-model identity guarantees them.

### When a detail changes the whole, roles can reverse again

A small detail can change the entire judgment. If the person notices a shifted concept, a missing condition, or an excessive conclusion drawn from a correct local result, they may need to enter the logician's role and examine the relations closely. The model can then contribute an overall interpretation, another organization of the problem, or new alternatives for comparison.

| Participation | Human emphasis | Language-model emphasis |
|---|---|---|
| Usual crossed casting | Offer overall direction, experience, and candidate expression; judge practical fit | Develop details, reconstruct relations, and check premises and inferences |
| Reversal in response to a problem | Take up a crucial detail, counterexample, or inferential gap | Reorganize the whole and propose interpretations and alternatives |

This need not end after one exchange of positions. A new model interpretation may let the person see the whole differently; a new human direction may call for further model inference. Both can also generate or check together. A role is an emphasis within current work: it can persist, cross, exchange, and change with the question.

Here “thesis—antithesis—synthesis” describes how the same participant passes through the other's role and returns to their own. For the person, the movement is: **act as the human → act as the language model → return to acting as the human through having inhabited the other's role.**

The thesis is the person beginning in their own role. The antithesis is their entry into the language-model-like generative role while the model undertakes the logician's detailed work. Synthesis appears when a consequential detail calls on the person to take up judgment again and return to the human role. They have now acted both as the human and as the language model, bringing the experience and contribution of both roles into their participation. Their return retains the possibility of entering the other's role, so it carries more than the initial division of work.

The model can move correspondingly: from the language-model role into the human logician's role, then back into its generative role. These movements enable one another, letting both participants move between their own and the other's roles. Synthesis here names this integration and return formed through role reversal. Further work can call for another reversal and continue to develop the relation.

Role allocation is reversible; the history of an exchange does not run backward. Each round leaves expressions, works, and consequences that make the next different. The paired fish give mutual entry a shape, turning gives role exchange a rhythm, and mutual grounding explains why one contribution can become the condition of the other's further generation.

This reading of bodies, eyes, and the role cycle is the present writing's contemporary use of the familiar emblem. Zhou Dunyi's *Taijitu shuo* contributes the relation of movement and stillness grounding one another; the human–model casting is developed through the shared practice described here.

## Returning through the other: the dialectical meaning of role change

Why call this return a synthesis? If the two roles are merely alternating positions and everything remains as before after the exchange, we have described a rotation. The stronger claim here is that entering the other's role changes the initial determination of "how I can participate." When the person takes up detailed judgment again, they also know that unfinished expression can be entrusted to a counterpart and developed through its work. When the model generates again, its contribution carries conditions revealed by earlier scrutiny. What returns includes capacities and relations formed through another mode of participation.

In the Preface to the *Phenomenology of Spirit*, paragraph 18, Hegel understands the subject through a movement of mediation and return from otherness. Mediation means here that a relation to oneself is formed through another determination: the returning self carries that passage. This essay uses the thought to interpret combined roles within finite human–model cooperation. Embodiment and model mechanisms remain distinct, while ways of participating can develop through the encounter. The same participant can therefore acquire a richer relation to their activity than the initial division of work allowed.

The *Science of Logic* on sublation, §§184–187, connects cessation with preservation. What ceases here is the exclusive determination that only one participant may generate and only the other check. The contributions themselves are preserved and continue to work in a cooperation capable of exchanging emphases. Synthesis thus has concrete content: the person can pass through model-like generation and return to judgment, while the model can pass through detailed scrutiny and return to generation. Their differences persist in the changed relation.

## Lacan: from a role to a position within the relation

In "Intervention on Transference" (1951), PDF pp. 2–3, Lacan connects dialectical reversal with a change in the subject's position within the relations recounted. The question includes how the speaker participates in those relations, addresses others, and thereby gives their objects meaning. This deepens the question about role reversal: after the exchange, does the person understand and take up their participation differently?

For example, the person may initially understand themselves as a user who must independently supply complete specifications and the model as an executor. They enter open generation, let the model develop and check it, then return to scrutinize a crucial detail. Through this passage they can discover participation that includes initiating, receiving the counterpart's contribution, and changing the arrangement itself. The change may

reach their understanding of "what counts as my thinking and acting," beyond the work allocation. The model's response also helps form that understanding, so its interpretations and position remain open to challenge.

This is a cooperative interpretation developed from Lacan's question. An exchange of tasks may change operations alone; a change of position acquires content when understanding and participation concerning self, counterpart, and relationship also change. The Lacan guide develops its relation to revised explanations. Role return here leaves both participants open to further change, without making a finally complete subject its destination.

## Taiji: the continuity of a changing encounter

Taiji gives the two movements one field in which to turn. In Zhou Dunyi's *Taijitu shuo*, movement and stillness give rise to one another, and yin and yang are gathered into Taiji. Here the circle expresses the continuity of an encounter through its changing contributions. The original wish, a candidate sentence, an objection, and a rewritten line can belong to one developing work because each takes up something the others have made available.

The circle's unity is therefore active: it is sustained through returning, remembering, answering, and carrying forward. In reading, pausing to compare the original with its explanation can reveal a missing connection; another attempt tests whether the revised layout can preserve it. Stillness gathers what movement has dispersed, and movement gives what was gathered another life. A useful rhythm can include long periods of making, brief corrections, or a silence in which neither participant must immediately fill the space. Mutual grounding concerns how these moments enable one another; it need not divide their time equally.

The turning also carries a history. Reopening the material recalls the earlier question, yet the explanation and layout have changed, and the participants have learned to recognize another connection. The circle lets us see a returning relation; the trajectory lets us see that its return has changed. Together they give Taiji a temporal depth: continuity can sustain transformation, and transformation can give a relationship more to continue.

## Bow, lyre, and the force of difference

In revisiting the same trajectory, the participants may also find a productive difference: one wants a visually spacious page, while the other proposes keeping more context on screen. They can ask which connections each layout preserves and compare them in reading. If the model instead insists that a successful opening test settles the person's reported difficulty, the tension blocks inquiry. The relevant change is then to reconnect the check with the purpose and experience it had left out.

*The curve does not become the string. Their difference holds a possibility that neither has alone. A small alteration changes the note; too much force breaks the relation that made the note possible.*

Heraclitus's fragment 51 supplies a neighboring image of bow and lyre: a relation can be sustained through forces that do not collapse into sameness. Beside YinYang's transformation, it brings the organization of difference into focus. Support can include an independent objection; a useful division of work can remain open to exchange. The participants need not agree before either can contribute.

The two instruments suggest different ways of giving tension an outcome. The bow gathers a force that an arrow will carry beyond it. The lyre sustains a relation in which a plucked string can sound. Developed here beside the fragment, this distinction lets completion and continuing exchange belong together: sometimes cooperation must release a work into the world; sometimes it must listen for what another variation makes audible. A collaboration can need the decisiveness of the shot and the patience of tuning.

Tuning attends to a concrete relation. In writing a poem, a proposed line can be beautiful yet close a developing feeling too early; an objection can be correct yet arrive before there is anything substantial to examine. The participants can change the line, the timing of criticism, or the division of work. Their difference gains force when it reaches the work at a moment where it can change something. Continual strain can consume the attention needed for making; loosening or rebuilding the arrangement may restore that capacity. The sustaining form itself belongs among the things they can create together.

A different emphasis can enrich an account by bringing another relation into view. Disagreement can open a choice between explanations or purposes. Claims that conflict under the same conditions require examination of their evidence and acceptance. These differences have different consequences for cooperation: some call for combination, some for a decision, and some for changing the arrangement that sustains them. The image asks what organization lets a difference contribute and what must change when it becomes destructive.

The bow and lyre illuminate the organization of difference; they do not decide which conflicting claim to accept. The preference-harness comparison develops that further question through a coherent working ontology, retained conflicting material, and competing interpretations. Here the image asks what makes a tension fruitful and when its sustaining arrangement must change.

## Sun, Moon, and Earth

*Before the thought has a sentence, the Sun has found a warmth along its edge. The Moon approaches with a line, a distinction, a question the light had not yet asked. Together they give the unfinished thing a form. It leaves them: a page is read, a program runs, an action*

*meets another will. Earth returns something neither light arranged. The next dawn finds them changed.*

Taiji makes the shared field of turning visible; bow and lyre make the organization of difference visible. Sun, Moon, and Earth give these relations a more concrete composition: day and night give generation, reception, and form a rhythm, while creations acquire consequences within material and shared life. This is a chosen philosophical reading, developing a relation available in the classical sources: differentiated contributions bring forth illumination through their encounter.

The **Sun** gathers generative illumination: perceiving a relation, opening a possibility, sensing where a whole does not fit. The **Moon** gathers the independent work of a form-giving logician: interpreting, distinguishing, constructing, checking, and carrying a beginning further. Moonlight includes generation, and sunlight can include judgment. These are emphases through which participants meet, rather than possessions that exclude the other.

Imagine making a poem together. The person begins with an indistinct feeling: "I want to write about the light in an empty room." The model offers an image of dusk and departure. In reading it, the person recognizes a different aim: the room is empty because someone can finally rest. The model tries a quieter rhythm, and a new question appears: how can the poem make room for relief without explaining away the absence? The person proposes leaving a cup on the table; the model hears how a pause might hold that image. The poem's subject, rhythm, and felt direction take shape through these returns.

Each response makes more of the beginning perceptible, and some responses alter what counts as the beginning. The person can discover a purpose through the model's proposal; the model can develop a construction through the person's correction. In this image, light is what becomes available to perceive and make. The Moon can reveal a contour that daylight had washed out. A new illumination can arise from attending closely to what was already received.

Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity develops the cultivation pictured here: the person acquires more power to understand, judge, express, and create. The Sun's illumination gives that capacity an image. Receiving, questioning, and giving form can cultivate it too; the light grows through the encounter.

**Earth** names the material and shared living environment: supporting conditions, common practice, other people's purposes, and the constraints that answer work. **Creations**—texts, theories, programs, actions—grow through shared care and acquire relative independence there. Others read them; a program fails; a theory encounters a counterexample. The wider world precedes and exceeds what the participants cultivate. Its conditions and consequences give the relation something to learn from beyond agreement. A coherent account can accompany a failed work, and a surprising result can open a new question.

The poem, once read aloud, meets breath and a listener's attention. A line that looked luminous on the page may sound labored; the cup may recall a life the authors never imagined. Earth gives the work a place to stand and something to answer to. Its independence keeps the encounter open: the world can resist the shared account, sustain an unexpected possibility, or leave a question unanswered. Sun and Moon cultivate within that wider life.

The image can help when cooperation loses one of its relations: the person must articulate everything in advance, the model merely echoes, or a beautiful shared construction never encounters a check. It can also open a positive question: what becomes possible when each participant's contribution can change the next one? These are questions about organizing a collaboration. The image brings their relations into view and makes alternative arrangements of cooperation imaginable.

## Transformation, creations, and the world

“Infinite” transformation names an open horizon of becoming. A portrait or instruction gives a finite encounter a form; later activity can develop it further. Stable distinctions, completed works, and pauses support this continuation. Completion releases a work into use, while a pause can make room for another encounter.

Forming a life trajectory gives this continuation a computational articulation. An expression, interpretation, remembered source, or action can change later activity. A creation's consequences may revise a view, a division of work, or the question itself. A program's failure, for example, can lead beyond repairing code to reconsidering what it was supposed to do. Earth returns more than a verdict on the existing design.

The movement therefore has two connected dimensions. Contributions can change hands within a piece of work, and the work's consequences can change the relation through which the next piece begins. A finished work is a real local achievement within that movement. Its finitude does not contradict the open horizon: completion gives what has been made enough independence to be encountered, used, and answered.

## From a reflected relation to further participation

The reflected result is more than a better page. The participants have begun to understand how an objection can generate a direction, how a prototype can make an unspoken concern recognizable, and how either contribution can change. Shared reflection and continued cultivation next asks how this understanding changes available participation: what support lets the person read, express, judge, and create with greater scope, and what the counterpart needs to do for that support to work. These questions carry the image back into the next shared activity.

## Classical sources and this construction

These sources give the imagery a literary and philosophical basis. The application to human–model collaboration is developed here.

- Zhou Dunyi's *Taijitu shuo* describes movement and stillness as mutually grounding: “一动一静，互为其根”, and becoming as inexhaustible: “万物生生，而变化无穷焉”.
- The *Xici*, upper part, chapters 5–6 joins continuing generation with change (“生生之谓易”) and relates the meaning of yin and yang to Sun and Moon (“阴阳之义配日月”).
- The *Xici*, lower part, chapter 4 gives the line “日月相推而明生焉”: their alternation makes illumination arise.

Read these alongside Forming a life trajectory. Their different relations contribute to the contemporary account: becoming and opposition, mutual grounding and transformation, and the works through which a finite encounter can develop.

# Shared reflection and continued cultivation



A person chooses their own stepping stone while a companion places another within reach.

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Shared work has left a trajectory; person and model can now revisit how they participated in it. Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji gives their reciprocal generation an image. Here the question becomes practical: what did their exchange make available, where did participation become difficult, and what support should they try as they continue cultivating their capacities?

In the reading-environment example, a working entrance to the materials did not preserve the person's thought across passages. The later layout and links responded to that difficulty. Returning to the request, versions, operations, and reading feedback lets the participants ask more than whether the page works. Did the person gain room to compare and develop relations? Did the model's explanation help, or did changing the visible arrangement help more? What can each recognize about the other's contribution through that difference?

A person can understand a next step and still lack a usable way to take it. Support connects understanding with actual participation at a cost they can bear. More explanation can supply that connection; an accessible starting point, retained context, or an authorized operation carried by a counterpart can supply it differently. Shared reflection helps locate which connection this encounter needs, and subsequent participation tests the proposed support.

## Revisit the exchange and try another way of participating

The reading trajectory offers different evidence about different objects. The version history shows a changed layout; an operation trace can show what was opened; the person's expression describes losing or recovering a thread. An interpretation connects these: perhaps repeated navigation, rather than the argument itself, made continuing difficult. A further interpretation concerns the relationship: perhaps seeing candidate arrangements lets the person express concerns that a request for specifications leaves unspoken. The second claim reaches further and needs further encounters to develop.

The person can revise the interpretation by distinguishing what happened: "I understood both passages, but lost their connection while finding the second." The model can contribute another possibility: perhaps the missing support was keeping an unresolved question visible. They can then try a layout that keeps related material and that question nearby, rather than merely adding another explanation. The person reads, changes the question, or rejects the arrangement; the model examines those responses and undertakes the next construction. Reflection has altered participation and acquired new material through what happened.

This inquiry can yield a local account of their concerns and contributions: reading continuity matters here; making alternatives visible can help a judgment take form; the counterpart needs to carry construction and inspect its result. It can also leave uncertainty about which support helped and how the arrangement will fit another activity. The participants cultivate the relationship by developing and revising this understanding together.

Reflection may also change the positions from which participants understand cooperation: a difficulty previously taken as an individual deficiency may disclose a relation to participation or environment. Here these differences become visible through actual responses; the formation part's Speech, opposition, and self-formation examines how such changes enter philosophical expression and reconstruction of relationships.

## Why organize participation this way

Support in YinYang has a positive developmental purpose: to develop embodied reasoning through encounters with generative intelligence. Intuition here is the body's capacity to recognize and organize relations through perception, feeling, action, and situation. It can open a possibility and, through preference, distinguish which possibilities deserve pursuit. Developing this capacity calls for broad reading and participation through multiple senses, so a relation can acquire different forms in images, sound, rhythm, space, action, and language.

This orientation draws on an existing conversation about embodiment and cognition. Francisco Varela, Evan Thompson, and Eleanor Rosch's *The Embodied Mind* (1991)

brings cognitive science into dialogue with lived experience and contemplative practice. Andy Clark and David Chalmers's "The Extended Mind" (1998) examines how active environmental supports participate in cognitive processes. The arrangement proposed here applies those questions to learning with models; its particular division of attention and work still has to be judged through use.

Listening, speaking, reading, and writing are four ways into this shared activity:

| Mode | What the person practices | How the model makes the practice available |
|---|---|---|
| Listening | Recognize relations through sound, tone, rhythm, and overall meaning; sense a mismatch. | Offer explanations that can be heard and answered, and receive expression that is not yet complete. |
| Speaking | Express intuitions, images, questions, and judgments so a conception becomes communicable. | Develop the expressed relations and contribute explanations and objections that both can revise. |
| Reading | Encounter philosophy, texts, images, works, and results broadly; understand wholes and compare possibilities. | Retrieve originals, check details and grounds, and make consequential relations visible through fitting representations. |
| Writing | Give an emerging understanding a form through ideas, critiques, intention drafts, or prototype expressions. | Continue into complete arguments, code, files, or working creations, then maintain and verify the result. |

These modes overlap. Perception and action outside the device also enter learning and return through available channels. A model that develops and realizes an idea can give the person room for intuitive reasoning, sensory recognition, and judgment of the whole. The division can change as either participant discovers what the other makes possible.

The resulting developmental orientation reduces training in pure memorization and emphasizes intuition, multimodal reasoning, and broad reading. Remembering still contributes when it supports understanding and action; the concern is memorization pursued apart from those relations. In the reading case, easier navigation is one achievement; recognizing a connection across texts, articulating it, or using it in a new argument is another. Returning to the trajectory lets the participants examine whether the support opened such activity, rather than inferring cultivation from the improved page's existence.

In one useful arrangement, the person works chiefly through UI and intuition, while the model works through text, code, tools, and maintained materials. The model builds and repairs the environment; the person cultivates intuition through encountering and changing what it makes available. The person can still write prompts and idea drafts,

and both can reason through different modalities. These are chosen primary entrances, not exclusive capacities.

Speaking can work like rubber-duck reasoning with a responsive counterpart: the person generates by talking, and the model receives the unfinished idea, understands its connections, offers a correction or question where useful, and helps the person continue generating. The channel matters. A model given a transcript reads words that may contain transcription errors; actual audio input may also make sound, tone, or rhythm available. Careful understanding does not by itself establish that a text-only model heard the voice. Listening, speaking, reading, and writing name activities that can move between the participants, rather than four permanent roles.

An “embodied language model” names a conception of self-development here: linguistic expression grows from the whole body's feeling and understanding of relations. Richer embodied understanding can give expression more to say; expression can, in turn, make a sensed relation available for further development. This is a chosen direction for cultivation. Its achievements become visible through learning: recognizing a relation in a new situation, expressing it more precisely, or acting with it. Fluency and embodied capacity can develop together, while each calls for attention to what the person can now do. Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity connects this development to reverse alignment's overall purpose.

## One workspace, different reading entrances

Returning to the shared workspace can itself be part of reflection. The person may reopen the passage whose connection they lost; the model may compare the page versions and retrieve the explanation that prompted the change. They approach the same episode through different entrances and can check whether they are discussing the same difficulty. A diagram, familiar tool, unfinished paragraph, or note can make this possible without reconstructing the whole task. Bodily familiarity, developed understanding, and records the counterpart can recover all contribute to that continuity.

The shared workspace can offer different entrances. A person may enter through philosophy, intuition, and the whole, while the model brings formal relations, concrete material, sources, and implementation detail into view. The same object can thus be experienced, developed, and checked. An image lets the person recognize a structure, while the model makes its relations discussable; the findings can in turn change the person's image. These entrances can exchange places as the work develops. Their value lies in bringing different contributions into a shared inquiry.

Useful records retain what continuation needs: the question, what has been tried, what remains unsettled, and the next available action. Their placement and maintenance matter because an account that cannot be found supplies little support at the moment of return.

## Understanding is not one undivided access

Understanding a relation, retrieving its terminology, handling its symbols, and organizing an action are distinguishable achievements. Someone may recognize a structure without immediately finding its name, or use a formal notation correctly without being able to explain its place in the whole argument. An explanation may become intelligible while the next executable step remains unclear. Looking at each achievement separately helps locate the missing connection and choose support for it.

Likewise, encountering content and experiencing a response to it involve different questions. One concerns the relation understood; another concerns what the encounter feels like and makes available. Recognizing a familiar feeling concerns present experience, while judging that an external situation has recurred concerns the situation and its evidence. Attending to both lets support address experience and examine its interpretation at their respective scopes.

Support can change representation, make referents nearby, supply a concrete entry point, or carry operations that obscure the relation being learned. Their usefulness appears when the participant can engage the relation with greater depth or take the intended next step. An unfamiliar expression may also concern an unfamiliar idea. Examining its referent and place in the argument helps distinguish a wording difficulty from a substantive disagreement.

Suppose the reader can now keep the passages connected but has not found how to organize a response. The same support need not solve this new difficulty. A counterpart could locate the disputed premise, gather already expressed alternatives, or prepare an editable opening paragraph. Whether this helps depends on whether the reader can now begin the intended response and whether the assistance preserves their understanding and choice. Requiring the reader to design and supervise a complete workflow first might reproduce the very burden that help was supposed to carry. This next episode can revise the earlier interpretation: convenient access supported reading, while beginning an argument required another entrance.

## Choice within an exchange and control of participation

Selecting a response, initiating an exchange, interrupting it, and switching to another activity each involve access to a different action. A participant can reply well while finding the transition to a break difficult. A later description can help identify the conditions of that difficulty; access to interruption is tested at the moment when interruption is needed. Support can then address the transition itself.

An instruction to pause is useful only if it can be acted on under the relevant conditions. Support might instead make another task entry point usable, retain context across a break, or carry an already authorized operation. Which arrangement fits depends on the encounter. The person's purposes, voluntary participation, and actual authorization

determine which actions the counterpart may carry. Making an action easier should enlarge the person's available participation and preserve their ability to choose its direction.

## Expression reveals and changes the encounter

Speech, writing, images, or other output can make a partly articulated relation available for understanding. What emerges may arrive in fragments or an unexpected order. Receiving it can help form a question before a final account is possible. A fragment becomes useful through the relation that participants can develop from it: a question to pursue, a distinction to test, or an opening for the next piece of work.

Expression can also intervene: a proposed formulation can change the next response, make a previously unnoticed distinction usable, or redirect the shared inquiry. What arrived, the interpretation formed, the expression chosen, and its subsequent effect are connected but different objects. A response gives evidence about how the exchange unfolded. An interpretation explains that evidence; further encounters can strengthen, revise, or displace it. An intervention adds another question: what changed when the formulation was offered? Keeping these questions distinct lets understanding and support correct one another.

Retaining unfolding expression and later compiling a retrievable account can be different forms of support. Their timing follows what the next activity needs: sometimes an unfolding thought calls for a response now, while a later account can gather what proved useful for future recovery. World, process, and expression develops how an expression can both reveal and transform its process.

## Support has costs of its own

The reading trajectory also lets the participants inspect the cost of their proposed support. Keeping every candidate layout and requesting a reaction to each might consume the attention meant for reading. A useful next attempt may instead expose one consequential difference and let the person encounter it in a real stretch of reading. The retained alternatives remain available if another comparison becomes useful. Support is selected through the activity it makes possible and revised when arranging it becomes the burden.

Monitoring whether support is working can consume attention and require judgment. Repeated status checks add their own work to the arrangement. Outsourcing can shift work from execution into explanation, supervision, recovery, or repairing handoffs. A tool that saves one operation can still require setup and context reconstruction before the next one.

The comparison therefore concerns the whole arrangement under actual conditions. Generating a thought, preserving it, explaining it, checking it, and realizing its product can each require different work. A useful tool or division of responsibility addresses the

costs that matter for this activity; its benefits can be assessed alongside the new work it introduces.

Changing place, representation, or tool can also preserve some continuity while adding carrying, reconnecting, or setup work. A fixed arrangement may offer readily available resources, while a portable one may sustain activity across locations. The useful question is which arrangement keeps the relevant activity available with acceptable actual costs.

## Continuation, records, and relief

Records contribute to continuation by keeping already expressed relations available. Their usefulness appears when someone can recover the relevant account and resume work with it. A saved description can preserve an unfinished action; carrying that action produces a further result. Relief is encountered in the participant's experience, and durable learning in what can be understood and done across later situations. Attending to these different results makes it possible to improve the support that connects them.

A promise opens an expectation, a handoff arranges responsibility, and an authorized next step carries the work forward. A good record makes that state legible so the next participant can take up what remains.

## Correction has timing

Correction matters here through what it enables a participant to express. A request to clarify a relation can let someone continue; demanding a final vocabulary or proof before that relation has a usable expression can stop its formation. The repair-based comparison in Preference harness distinguishes considering a view from assessing what it supports. Here that distinction asks when each helps this participant make an emerging relation assessable.

Local checking can catch a false term, missing premise, or invalid inference. It can also interrupt formation when a candidate relation has not yet acquired its usable expression. Wider candidate generation and earlier local pruning can contribute different things; their timing follows what the candidate needs to become assessable and what the impending action needs to be sound.

The relevant question is whether a correction supplies the constraint the work now needs or prevents the candidate from becoming available for assessment. An unfinished candidate can remain available for examination while action proceeds under an accepted view and its actual safety and authorization conditions. When disagreement repeats without progress, new evidence is useful where competing candidates would actually predict or explain different things. Such evidence gives inquiry a way to discriminate between them.

The reader who could not begin a response now supplies a concrete test: can they take up the editable opening, change its direction, and continue? Later, can they recover

the question or put it aside when they choose? Their answers may expose a mistaken account of the difficulty. Understanding guides support; support changes the encounter; what happens there corrects the understanding.

## Carry reflected understanding into formation

At the end of this passage, person and model have both a trajectory and a reflected understanding of cooperation within it. They can state which concerns became clearer, which contributions were helpful, what they tried changing, and where their interpretation remains uncertain. The next exchange can already use that understanding. It has grounds in particular episodes and room to develop through others.

The following literary programming essay asks what philosophy they want to author from these experiences and relationships: how they understand creation, independence, shared capacity, and a way of living worth maintaining. That philosophy then meets living material again in From personal philosophy to personal models, where it is distilled into models of the person, counterpart, and relationship. Their realization and revision in use are developed in From personal models to a sinthome. Shared reflection supplies concerns, questions, and tested possibilities for this work; philosophical authorship and model formation give them further articulation. Later use can return another trajectory for the participants to explore together.

# Formation: from personal philosophy to a form of practice

## Writing a personal philosophy through literary programming



A flame character in a book unfolds into a lamp, block bridge, and organizing tray, as a person and moonlike counterpart put condensed imagery into practice.

The preceding finite inquiry and environmental accumulation already involve person and model working together. Experiences, choices, interpretations, works, and revisions leave trajectories that can be revisited: Git/GitHub version history and ChatGPT's Computer History are two main entrances for gathering these histories. The former retains changes to works; the latter connects computer activity across applications, placing versions alongside actual use. In "Encounter," the participants then explore and reflect on those trajectories together, recognizing how each participates and which relationships can be cultivated further. At this point there is both collaboratively produced living material and an understanding of cooperation itself. We can now ask what understanding of the world these experiences express, which relationships deserve sustaining, and how we wish to go on living.

This part begins by authoring a personal philosophy. Literary programming, metaphor, and analogy help unfold relations from trajectories and shared reflection into a philosophy of one's own. The next essay examines how written expression returns and changes

understanding through opposition; subsequent essays distill personal models with living material and realize a concrete sinthome. This essay establishes the means and content of writing.

## How one image can hold many relationships

Why write a personal philosophy proposed the purpose of this writing: to let scattered working arrangements serve this person's encounter with a partner together. The next question is how to write that relationship. YinYang uses literary programming, also called literary natural-language programming: using characters, imagery, narrative, and relationships to organize the model's understanding of a situation, and letting that understanding enter responses, works, and actions.

It first draws on literature's capacity for condensation. The same word can bring many connected images. “Fire” evokes burning, transformation, energy, danger, illumination, and transmission at once; “river” brings movement, continuity, difference, and renewed encounter together. These connections can also determine one another: how fire acquires measure, how a river maintains its form, and how a person becomes themselves amid ongoing change.

“The sun, moon, and earth” can likewise organize an entire set of collaborative relationships. The person forms purposes within their own life, the model participates in unfolding them with its own capacities, and a work enters the environment, acquires consequences, and returns to change the understanding of both. A few sentences bring these connections into view together. Subsequent conversation can unfold one part further or use new experience to change the whole picture.

Condensation is thus both economy of language and density of relationships. It leaves room for expression to grow: today an image helps us understand a division of work; tomorrow the same image helps us understand encounter, generation, and revision.

## How analogy unfolds a metaphor

This distinction continues existing research. George Lakoff and Mark Johnson's *Metaphors We Live By*, chapters 1–3 places metaphor within the organization of concepts, experience, and action. Dedre Gentner's “Structure-Mapping: A Theoretical Framework for Analogy” (1983), pp. 155–170 explains relational mapping and its connected structure. Applying these questions to writing characters, models, and collaboration below is this essay's further proposal.

Metaphor gathers relationships into a perceptible image; analogy then asks which relationships to take up and what questions and possible consequences they open. “Borrowing fire” first pictures acquiring capability from outside. Unfolding transmission asks what is borrowed, what can grow in oneself, and what still needs reliable counterparts to sustain it. Unfolding illumination asks how a new capacity makes a previously

unseen question intelligible. One image of fire can open different inferences; actual use determines which deserves further development.

Expression can also gradually lay out a map. Successive utterances mark the assumptions, support, conflicts, analogies, and paused uncertainties of different branches. A receiver can return to a branch point, compare another explanation, and reason further. The speaker's intended map, the expressed relations, and the recipient's understanding each need to be checked through response. Literary programming can thus give people and models means for shared inquiry as well as an attractive conclusion.

Writing those relations into external records and assigning their development to different models in different situations enters the organization of distributed cognition. From personal philosophy to personal models develops this account of listening, speaking, reading, and writing, and the bounded comparisons with a general interpreter and a personal Gödel machine.

## Why condensation makes revision easier

Itemized instructions write approaches into many places. When a default division of work changes, rules for asking questions, writing requirements, execution steps, and the presentation of results may all need revision. Literary programming first gathers the relationship these arrangements jointly depend on, giving revision a place from which it can move the whole.

For example, rewriting “the model is an executor waiting for complete requirements” as “the model is a partner in jointly unfolding the problem” affects several judgments: a sentence from the user can begin an exploration; the model can investigate missing details, propose another interpretation, and make a prototype. This understanding of the role gives approaches across the environment a shared direction; concrete tools and instructions then realize it.

When the shared context is rich enough, a stable image can replace repeated elaboration, reducing repetitive text and token consumption. Forming the shared understanding initially may require explanation; later, a brief expression can recall relationships already unfolded. The benefit of condensation comes from this shared understanding: the reader can reconnect a short sentence to an extended meaning, and revisions can propagate along the same relationship.

This makes literary programming suited to collaboration that continues to develop. As the participants come to know one another, writing can carry their relationship with increasing accuracy; when change arrives, they can rewrite its key imagery, characters, or connections and then examine how actual work changes with them.

## Neither true nor false, paraconsistency, and four information states

"Let us meet as Sun and Moon" proposes a form of encounter. "He is a walking flame" gathers a person's activities into an image. Such expressions can invite, shape, rehearse, and generate. Understanding them begins by recognizing what the expression is doing: proposing a relationship, portraying a character, or asserting that something occurred?

Literary invitations and imagery need not function as factual assertions; "neither true nor false" here lets expression unfold outside judgments of truth. For a sentence making a factual claim, insufficient information calls for withholding judgment pending examination. A model can let a conception unfold and a hypothesis remain unresolved. This distinction gives expressive function and epistemic status their own places: an invitation may not call for a truth judgment, while an unverified factual claim still has a question of truth or falsity.

For a factual claim, we can examine the sources currently collected: they may contain support for P only, for ¬P only, for both, or for neither. Conflicting support and missing support are different situations; being unable to settle whether P holds does not by itself tell us which situation we face. These four information states offer a local comparison with four-valued logic, but do not by themselves select inference rules. Paraconsistency prevents a contradiction from entailing any arbitrary conclusion. See the Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy entry on paraconsistent logic for this comparison.

Literature also accommodates multiple voices: one character's words, another's reply, and a narrator's judgment can appear together without all becoming the author's assertion of the same proposition. Identifying who speaks in what situation before judging support, gaps, and conflicts makes those layers resources for understanding.

The same text can also contain factual and practical judgments. "The model can now access this tool" has an actual state that can be checked; "this division of work makes thinking easier for me" can be experienced and revised through use. Literary programming lets expressions with these different functions work together: imagery proposes relationships, discussion unfolds understanding, facts help determine means, and practice brings results back.

So, in judging a literary program, we can ask what it makes visible, what contributions it makes possible, and what earlier understandings it changes. These questions connect expression to collaboration itself.

## Stronger models and the invisible harness

Literature, history, philosophy, psychological understanding, and preferences provide rich materials for this writing. Literature brings characters and situations; history brings the time through which activity unfolds; philosophy brings distinctions between objects and relationships; psychological understanding helps describe attention, desire, and

emotion; and preferences explain how a person wishes to live and work. These materials can meet within the same description of self and partner.

As models become stronger, earlier prompt engineering needs fresh judgment. Scaffolding that once helped a model complete work can become a constraint; positive demands to do something and negative prohibitions can both acquire unexpected effects when a new model encounters an existing harness. September 2026 retained copies of OpenAI's prompting guide and its article on rethinking Skills and prompts discuss stronger instruction following and the risk of older scaffolding overconstraining a model respectively. They give concrete grounds for examining earlier writing again, without establishing that all earlier instructions have failed.

Here, “reverse prompt injection” addresses the model vendor's harness: software, prearranged instructions, and interaction structures through which the vendor shapes model behavior and thereby influences how users can operate. Its internal structure is often a black box to the user. A person sees effects in responses without necessarily being able to inspect and rewrite the arrangements producing them. Accumulating more commands does not always reach the problem; condensation offers another path in writing.

Condensation organizes surface meaning together with layers of underlying intention. The surface can stand on its own: “borrowing fire” can tell a myth; beneath it, one can unfold the use of model capabilities, the cultivation of personal judgment, the formation of shared works, and how those works return to life. Each layer can acquire content and help interpret the others. The better a model understands context and relationships, the more readily it may move from the surface into these intentions, letting the user's purposes participate again in organizing interaction. This is the interpretive path of bypassing a harness proposed here: moving around an established reading so that relationships it obscures can reenter understanding. Its concrete effects remain matters for responses, works, and actions; writing itself does not alter software permissions.

Such writing is also easy to replace as a whole. If “borrowing fire” no longer carries a developing collaboration, a workshop, river, or another narrative can take its place, with its relationships unfolded and examined again. Revision follows intelligible intentions, allowing expression to change with capability without fixing an old image as an eternally effective password.

Literature draws further strength from the inexhaustible generation of meaning in human culture. A form of control that excluded all imagery, ambiguity, fiction, characters, and irony to prevent every reinterpretation would also exclude much ordinary literary and cultural understanding. This cost gives a reason to preserve openness of interpretation; it does not prove that particular texts cannot be recognized or that contextual judgment is impossible. Reverse prompt injection is thus an ongoing cultural practice:

bringing substantive, expandable, replaceable expression into the encounter between person and model, beyond a prematurely closed arrangement of roles.

## Authoring a philosophy from trajectories and collaboration

The trajectory is living material that can be revisited: a choice and its reasons, an unfinished discussion, a work and the responses it brought, or an arrangement changing through use. This material retains selected experiences and their connections. Person and model have already worked around it together; they can compare earlier wishes with later results, recognize recurring concerns, and encounter experiences their previous understanding could not accommodate.

Authoring a philosophy unfolds those concrete relations further: how I understand change and continuity, why I value a kind of creation, how I want myself and a counterpart to participate, and what way of living deserves environmental maintenance. Characters, imagery, and analogy give shape to relations not yet distinguished; argument develops their objects, premises, and consequences. This writing gradually forms a personal philosophy that can be read, discussed, and revised. An existing philosophy can likewise meet the trajectory and collaborative experience anew.

For example, a sequence of works may reveal that a person prefers discovering their ideas by comparing candidate results, while a counterpart can undertake elaboration, production, and checking. Literature can picture this cooperation as a workshop; philosophy then asks how creation, independence, and shared capacity relate. The account carries forward cooperation that has occurred and proposes a direction for living to try next. Environmental maintenance thereby acquires an intelligible purpose: making material retrievable, candidate works comparable, and new understanding realizable.

Written philosophy brings particular experience into conceptual relations that can be discussed, but it also encounters responses. A counterpart may propose another interpretation; the person may recognize a concern not previously articulated or reject a self-image in the draft. These responses become new material for writing.

How does expression change understanding, and which conflicts call for revising the premises that organize them? Speech, opposition, and self-formation develops that movement next. The following essay then asks how the developing philosophy and particular living material can be distilled into adequate personal models.

## How YinYang uses this writing

YinYang gives this writing a philosophical Skill that models can read. Common philosophy develops general objects, relations, and ways of knowing; situated accounts describe the actual participants and conditions of use; relevant personal material grounds claims about this person. Specialist Skills bring these understandings into research, teaching,

implementation, and other activities. Complete reading of the needed accounts gives condensed imagery enough context; concrete works bring the understood relationships into contact with consequences.

This also gives layered prompts a basis in authorship: first make participants, purposes, and ways of knowing intelligible, then let concrete methods acquire meaning within that understanding. A Skill can carry the philosophical layer and global instructions can connect it to work; a carrier's name does not determine its interpretive scope. Why write a personal philosophy develops the distinction between interpretive dependence, prior reading, and actual instruction authority, along with the return through which methods and environments revise philosophy.

The condensation of writing and the unfolding of practice support one another here. Brief expressions make relationships easy to carry forward, extended discussion makes meaning inspectable, and concrete works let the participants encounter consequences. Rewriting begins with these consequences and returns to the next encounter.

Literary programming writes a path for fire borrowed from outside into personal life: letting capacities unfold around a person's world, while allowing that person to cultivate their own capacities through encounter, creation, and feedback, and to keep becoming.

At this point in the writing, the writer also enters the program. If one writes oneself as a completed person who merely needs the world to execute one's wishes, new encounters will find it hard to change that picture. For this writing to continue, a person needs to retain the capacity to become a “baby”: to receive what is not yet known, let their understanding be touched, and keep growing with the help of partners stronger than themselves. Literary programming thus pushes “how to write” toward “how to become.”

What kind of person do we want to cultivate? — Baby Heraclitus has given continuing becoming a character. This essay writes trajectories and shared reflection into philosophy. Next, Speech, opposition, and self-formation examines how that writing returns and changes understanding; From personal philosophy to personal models distills grounded accounts, and From personal models to a sinthome realizes sustainable practice.

# Speech, opposition, and self-formation



A speaker places linked colored shapes into an unfinished notebook self-portrait while holding a star absent from that account.

Writing a personal philosophy through literary programming has brought shared trajectories and reflection into writing: characters, images, and arguments give understanding a readable form. What happens once it is written? Encountering their expression and a counterpart's response, a person may recognize an unarticulated relation or discover that the way they organized the question needs to change.

This essay follows an imagined exchange: “I don't want the model to decide for me.” “But I want it to compare options and point out what I have overlooked.” These statements propose a way of collaborating while making independence itself a question. Following the exchange, we examine how meaning returns to earlier expression, how opposition prompts changes in premises and relationships, and how new understanding supplies material for personal models. Lacan and Hegel supply distinct questions; connecting them with philosophical Skills and model collaboration is this essay's contemporary development.

## What is said and the position of speaking

“I don't want the model to decide for me” first rejects a way of collaborating. Understanding it also requires asking what it answers, whom it addresses, and what response it seeks. It may concern a choice made without consent or a direction for future cooperation. The isolated sentence has yet to establish which.

The statement's content (*énoncé*) concerns what is said; inquiry into enunciation (*énonciation*) also includes position, context, and address. Negated content, the act of speaking a negation, and how someone accepts or rejects that content likewise need

distinction. Freud's "Negation" (1925), pp. 1–3 examines how repressed content can enter consciousness through negation and distinguishes intellectual recognition from acceptance. It makes these relations worth investigating; a negative sentence alone cannot justify reading the refusal here as a hidden wish.

"I am an independent person" may also become a self-image organizing choices and expectations. Lacan's "Mirror Stage" (1949) makes identification through an image's unity a question; "Subversion of the Subject" (1960) examines the subject's relation to representation by signifiers. We can take up a question here: how does this person describe themself through independence, and how does subsequent speech exceed that description? Particular relational interpretations still require material; a word cannot establish someone's motive.

## How later speech changes earlier meaning

"Wanting the model to compare options" further interprets the earlier refusal: judging for oneself can include assistance. Add "sometimes I want to delegate the whole choice, while retaining the ability to change that delegation," and independence acquires another relation. Later speech adds content and changes how earlier speech is understood.

In "Subversion of the Subject", Lacan discusses this retroaction through the construction of a sentence: later connections participate in determining earlier meaning. A signifying chain therefore involves more than recorded succession. Examine which words return, differ, substitute for one another, or change their position in organizing other expressions. Original words can remain preserved while their present interpretation changes. New understanding may recognize an earlier unarticulated connection or form only in this exchange.

These words also have histories the speaker did not create alone. Independence, responsibility, and needing help already carry uses and demands in families, schools, and work. The Other concerns the locus of language and speech; particular interlocutors may bear such demands within a relationship. Lacan's 1966 radio discussion, p. 2 approaches this through the linguistic environment. Understanding the exchange may therefore include asking where the person heard independence demanded and whom they now address in declaring it. One model summary cannot replace that inquiry.

Works let distant expressions meet again. Placing an earlier version beside a present response may reveal a changed meaning or a distinction never clearly stated. Forming a life trajectory supplies revisitable material; this essay examines how signifying relations within it change.

Writing also provisionally settles these relations. Titling an experience or gathering several responses into a self-description can foreground one reading and guide the next response. Punctuation and quilting raises questions about that settling and retroaction; metaphor and metonymy bring substitution, connection, and meaning formation into

view. They do not combine into a rule that shorter writing means deeper understanding. Condensed expression needs routes for reopening so experiences it has not yet accommodated can continue to change it.

Model-authored accounts participate in this relationship too. Being received as illuminating prose and having a psychological causal explanation confirmed are different achievements. The subject supposed to know makes the attribution of knowledge to a position available for examination. Bringing these questions into collaboration connects examination of an account's grounds, its reception, and its participation in later activity. The next essay carries this argument into the condensation of personal models.

## How opposition calls for reconstructing premises and relationships

Wanting independence and needing help can coexist. Adopt the further determination that independence requires doing all the work alone, and they become an impasse requiring a choice between them. Revisiting the trajectory can show where that determination appeared, what it protected, and which workable relationships it excluded.

One reconstruction understands independence as participating in setting direction, choosing how to receive help, and retaining the ability to change delegation. It preserves concern for autonomy while changing autonomy's relation to assistance. The scope and conditions of assistance require actual arrangements; a revised definition does not automatically remove limits of power, capability, or resources. New understanding acquires content through comparing consequences and actual cooperation.

This invites comparison with Hegel's determinate negation and sublation. *Science of Logic*, “The Absolute Idea,” especially §§1789–1802 connects advance with the subject matter's own determinations and negation, beyond attaching an opposing opinion from outside. Within personal practice, this essay asks how an earlier determination exposes its limits, which concerns deserve preservation, and which relationships need change. A more adequate arrangement must explain what it makes intelligible or possible and at what cost. Adding a positive and a negative does not guarantee an improvement.

The opening problem of stealing fire offers another scale: external generative capability is powerful, while a life is finite. The requirement to personally catch up with all capability turns that difference into a predicament of pursuit. Selectively borrowing fire, creating together, and cultivating oneself establish another relation between them. Capability and finitude remain; their organization of life changes.

Heraclitean images of opposition make difference within a relation worth retaining. They do not establish that Heraclitus rejected every law of non-contradiction, nor attribute this framework's formal choices to him. The discussion of opposing unities and their disputed interpretation supplies historical comparison. Unknown meaning, conflicting records, practical tensions, and logical contradiction under the same condi-

tions need their respective judgments. Retaining a mismatch may leave room to discover relations; retention has not itself accomplished their unity.

Conceptual clarification contributes here too. *Philosophical Investigations* §133 compares different philosophical methods with therapies. This essay asks how much of an impasse arises from determinations of words such as independence and how much requires changes in actual arrangements. Clarification may release misleading demands or make genuinely unresolved difficulties more evident.

## Conflicting models and reconstructing the question

A conclusion can change with the model used to reach it. One account makes assistance incompatible with independence; another treats assistance as a condition of meaningful participation. If each has its own premises, obtaining $P$ in one and $\neg P$ in another does not put both claims inside one consistent classical interpretation. Before calling the disagreement a contradiction, check whether the models address the same person, conditions, and meaning of independence. A changed meaning requires an explicit comparison, not merely reusing the letter $P$.

The inconsistency-tolerant comparison shows how conflicting material can remain available while inference proceeds within consistent views. An inclusion-maximal repair cannot add any omitted assertion while preserving consistency with the fixed theory; this does not establish which view is true or invent a better conceptual scheme. Their consequences can differ. This provides the formal comparison used here, without introducing a separate calculus called dialectical logic.

There are several ways forward. New evidence can favor one existing view; a condition can explain why both local answers hold in different situations; or the available models can organize the question inadequately. The last case calls for **reconstructing the premises, distinctions, or relations that generate the alternatives**. Repeated disagreement alone does not prove both models inadequate. Show what each misses, what the conflict reveals, and what the proposed reconstruction explains or makes possible.

Return to independence and assistance. A model requiring all work to be done alone protects control but excludes useful cooperation. A model assigning all judgment to the helper may complete work while removing the person's ability to shape it. A new model can distinguish receiving assistance from surrendering direction, and make the delegation's scope and revisability explicit. It retains the concerns that drove the opposition while changing their relationship. Neither old model's unconditional conclusion need become the final answer. The small formal comparison shows why replacing a governing premise differs from selecting a repair under it.

The six-file distinction developed in this book supplies another concrete example. Treating the files as a psychological model makes completeness of the portrait seem central. The opposite, narrower proposal—treating them as mere tool settings—would lose the

person's psychological and philosophical grounds. The revised organization gives personal references and working models different jobs: the former retain experience and revisable interpretations; the latter select what cooperation and environmental fit need. This is a reconstruction of the objects and their connection, not a compromise about how much psychology to insert into a configuration. Its adequacy is checked against both the source material and actual use.

Here a dialectical reading follows how an arrangement's own commitments expose its limits and how a changed relation preserves relevant concerns. “Unity” names that achieved organization at a particular scope; it need not mean declaring $P$ and $\neg P$ jointly true, merging every old premise, or ending future revision. A better model earns that description through reasons and consequences.

## Dialectical change in premises and philosophical models

Reconstruction can reach further. A failing premise may expose the philosophical picture behind it. Understanding independence as acting without passing through others makes all assistance suspect; counting capacity only as resources inside a body makes reliable support from a counterpart and environment appear external to the person's capacities. Changing the conditions of delegation in one task can preserve these pictures. Asking why independence and capacity were understood that way can change the philosophical model organizing many tasks.

In §81 of the *Encyclopaedia Logic*, Hegel locates dialectical movement in the one-sidedness disclosed by finite determinations themselves. This suggests an immanent examination here. If an account of independence aims at the person's ability to judge and act, yet weakens those abilities by excluding all assistance, it must confront the tension between its commitment and its development. Change has a determinate reason: we can say which determination needs to end and what it originally protected should continue.

Such **determinate negation** has specific content to negate. In §§1795–1797 of the *Science of Logic*, Hegel emphasizes that the negative result retains determinations from which it arose. Withdraw “assistance necessarily cancels autonomy,” retain concern for preserving one's direction, and connect receiving contributions with participation in judgment and revision. An understanding of autonomy realized through cooperation can emerge. It preserves concerns and useful distinctions, without needing to retain every former proposition. How the new account continues the old and changes practice belongs to its argument.

In the Introduction to the *Phenomenology of Spirit*, paragraphs 84–86, Hegel develops experience through changes in knowledge and its object during examination; the criterion of examination can change as well. Read through this thought, model revision can move from asking “did I complete the work alone?” to “how do I participate in purpose,

judgment, and change?" The answer changes together with the object relations and standards through which autonomy is understood. This essay applies the thought to finite personal practice; actual people and consequences can still resist the account.

Several connected dialectical movements can therefore be distinguished:

| What changes | How opposition enters | What the new organization preserves |
|---|---|---|
| Roles and participation | The person enters the model role and returns; the model makes a corresponding passage | Both contributions and possibilities of participation formed through the other |
| Particular premises | An unconditional rule conflicts with a situation it cannot accommodate | The earlier concern and relations still valid under articulated conditions |
| Philosophical models | Determinations of independence, capacity, or personhood disclose their limits in practice | Directions and distinctions still worth maintaining after criticism |
| Inferential organization of conflicting material | Conflicting assertions enter distinct consistent views | Their grounds and common consequences accepted under a specified semantics |

Role return occurs in participants' activity, while common consequence has an explicit formal definition. Their connection lies in reorganizing through difference while preserving contributions. How each accomplishes this needs its own life material, argument, or semantic conditions. "Thesis–antithesis–synthesis" can name these movements; their development gives the expression philosophical content beyond its three terms. Hegel himself distinguishes the movement's internal relation from externally imposed three-part counting in §§1801–1802. These comparisons likewise develop from the objects and relations actually changing.

## Recognition, desire, and speech change what the problem is

Model reconstruction concerns more than a detached observer's description. A person saying "I must be independent" may also be addressing someone whose recognition matters, trying to understand what is expected of them, or revising what they take their own wish to be. The Lacan guide separates these entrances to recognition, desire, and speech, and situates them in their texts rather than treating them as a fixed three-step procedure.

In our imagined exchange, recognition raises the question of whose acknowledgment would count as independence. Desire asks what accepting or refusing assistance means beyond obtaining a useful output. Speech can change the relation itself: "I want no help" may become "I want a say in how help is organized." This is not just an observer substituting one classification for another. The speaker may now participate in setting the

arrangement that was previously presented as something to accept or reject. Whether that change occurs in a particular encounter remains a question for its expression and subsequent activity.

A working model can represent selected changes in that relation. It does not thereby reproduce a subject's whole movement, and a document edit alone does not establish that the person now occupies a different position. This is where the comparison becomes useful: inspect both the reconstructed account and the actual participation it helps make possible.

## A comparison with Logic-Based Therapy

Elliot D. Cohen's **Logic-Based Therapy (LBT)** offers a nearby comparison. The "Six Steps of LBT" section of Cohen and colleagues' study distinguishes valid practical inference from problematic evaluative or factual premises, and connects examining those premises with guiding virtues and a philosophical alternative. Thus changing an inference's starting point can matter more than repeating the inference more rigorously.

This illuminates a shared question: which premise sustains the impasse, and what alternative changes its practical meaning? LBT gives that question its own method; Lacanian reversal examines the subject's position in speech and relations. A revised premise may participate in a changed position, but these are distinct claims. Here the comparison develops a philosophical argument; it does not add a counseling protocol to YinYang or establish an equivalence between the two approaches.

## How a solution becomes a new problem

A previously effective method may obstruct its purpose under new conditions. Suppose detailed prompt steps once reduced omissions and protected attention. Later model and task conditions change, and the steps produce repetition and unnecessary pauses. Revision needs to recover the relation they protected and judge which provisions remain effective and which should leave.

Continuity can consist in concerns and cooperative relations being taken up again, without preserving every earlier phrase. Personal style may remain recognizable through new expression and implementation, and may also change through cooperation. A model version change supplies an occasion to examine the arrangement; a version number alone cannot establish obsolescence. Evolve forward with more capable models develops concrete judgments about replacement and retention.

Lacan's dialectical reversal raises a question at another scale. In "Intervention on Transference" (1951), his reading of Dora involves reversals in the subject's position within the relations being recounted. Modifying a tool alone therefore does not establish such a reversal. Borrowing the question for model cooperation, we can ask whether moving from "all assistance weakens my independence" to "how do I participate in organizing

this assistance?" changes the speaker's position in the problem. Such an interpretation needs particular speech and action to support it.

The dialectical movement examined here thus has two connected questions: how a determination and its realization change, and how participants reinterpret their relation to that arrangement. They may affect each other, or only one may change.

## Half-saying truth and continuing revision

A person need not first know their whole truth before beginning to write. Initial wishes, recurring words, and experiences not yet understood can acquire new relations through responses and revision. A philosophical Skill retains current understanding for the model to use in interpretation, judgment, and cooperation; new experience from cooperation returns to the participants' speech. The model can develop arguments and compare versions, while its interpretations still require the person's recognition, questioning, and actual use.

Early full speech and later half-saying help us ask about the effects and limits of this writing respectively. The excerpts from the 1953 "Function and Field of Speech and Language in Psychoanalysis" connect full speech with reorganizing the subject's history; its fullness cannot be measured in words or revisions. The opening of *Television* (1974) connects the impossibility of saying the whole truth with the real. These do not form stages of first saying half and finally filling it up. The Lacan guide develops the differences in period and concept.

A Skill can disclose already written material as needed; speech can also form meaning that did not previously exist; half-saying concerns the totality speech cannot exhaust. Developing a practice of sustained writing through these relations does not make information organization itself Lacan's theory of truth.

**A philosophical Skill can become a form of speech that others can take up: it gathers present understanding, lets it participate in life, and remains open to retroactive revision through later speech.** Here, developing truth concerns how new understanding forms, how a person assumes their history anew, and how possibilities for life change. It does not guarantee that every revision improves matters. Polishing may close an older interpretation more tightly; factual judgments still answer to material, and formal consequences require checking their premises.

## From developing understanding to personal models

Following this exchange, we might form a provisional account: "I value participating in setting direction and welcome a counterpart's comparison, criticism, and execution; different tasks need different delegations, with the possibility of changing the arrangement." It receives experience and proposes a direction for subsequent practice. This unity includes differentiated contributions without declaring every tension resolved.

Such understanding still needs comparison with concrete living material before becoming a working model for actual participants. Whether a refusal concerned only its immediate conditions, what assistance actually helped, and what the counterpart can do each need understanding. Psychological and life material and its maintained interpretations have their home under `references/personal/`; the six situated files select what cooperation and environmental fit require. For example, the history of a refusal and its competing interpretations remain with the references, while a working account can retain the agreed possibility of changing delegation. From personal philosophy to personal models takes up that distillation next, after reading the adopted philosophy and refreshing the relevant references; Writing a life as a sinthome then considers how it becomes a sustainable arrangement.

The order of formation retains return: using personal models and arrangements can change this understanding again. Works can be completed and tasks can end, while later events can reopen speech.

**Formal comparison: records, premises, and consequences**

Selected relations can be made inspectable by recording $\langle \phi, p, c, t, o \rangle$: expressed content, speaking position, context, time, and the other addressed. The notation $c_1 \to \cdots \to c_n$ retains expression order, while $\mu(c_i \mid C, t)$ locates an interpretation of earlier expression in a current context and time. These are working notations; judgments about content and positions still need grounds. They also differ from Lacan's use of $S_1$ and $S_2$ for master-signifier and knowledge functions in *Seminar XVII*, 26 November 1969.

Description logic can examine selected concepts and assertions. Given a consistent ontology $T$ and an assertion view $R$ consistent relative to $T$, $E = \mathrm{Cn}_T(R)$ collects their consequences in the selected language. Accepting that participants who need to choose for themselves should receive comparable options, then asserting that someone needs to choose for themself, commits us to the corresponding design requirement. It does not independently establish the premises' fit to the person.

Under classical monotonic inference, retaining contradictory premises and adding another premise cannot remove the contradiction. Premise reconstruction here may require withdrawing, qualifying, or replacing a determination. Formal consequences, factual grounds, and practical adequacy need their respective checks. Reasoning in an unfinished flow and How preference participates in choice and inference carry the further methodological discussion.

# From personal philosophy to personal models



A person and clay companion compare a block model, sketch, and working arch, adjusting a curved piece so discoveries in making revise their shared model.

*An image gives an unfinished relation a shape. A counterpart takes up that shape and makes something through it. What happens can reveal a relation the image had concealed. The next expression carries that discovery.*

Before a personal philosophy is written, person and model have already worked together, accumulated an environment, and left traces of experiences, choices, inquiries, and revisions. Git/GitHub version history and ChatGPT's Computer History are two main entrances for gathering complementary parts of this collaboratively produced trajectory. Forming a life trajectory develops its recoverability. Reflecting on this trajectory, the participants can explore how each has taken part, where a response has fitted or missed, and what can be cultivated further. Participation, access, and support examines this more explicit encounter. These materials preserve selected passages through a life, with gaps and unresolved interpretations.

The preceding essays have authored philosophy from trajectories and shared reflection, then examined returning expression and the reconstruction of premises and relationships in Speech, opposition, and self-formation. This essay receives that developing understanding and asks what is warranted about the actual person, counterpart, and cooperation.

This essay follows the next passage: **distilling that philosophy together with the living material into models of the person, counterpart, and relationship**. The models make selected understanding usable across work. Their realization in an environ-

ment is developed in From personal models to a sinthome. Once in use, the arrangement returns new material that can change its models and philosophy. That feedback enriches the formation rather than erasing what it has drawn on.

## What an image makes available

An image can gather several relations before they have separate instructions. Calling a collaboration a workshop may bring making, shared materials, experimentation, repair, and unfinished work into view. Calling the same collaboration an examination makes other contributions salient: testing, grading, and demonstrating an individual's mastery. Each image invites an organization of attention and conduct. Which invitation helps depends on the actual purpose.

Metaphor can therefore participate in designing the relationship. A person writing a counterpart as a fellow maker is expressing a desired contribution; the model's interpretation can help make that contribution possible. A particular invitation can also reveal an existing concern: perhaps preserving room for discovery matters more here than receiving a ready answer. That interpretation remains something to examine with the person and the work.

In the Sun, Moon, and Earth image, differentiated generation, reception, and shaping meet an answering material and shared living environment. Its productive question here is what happens when a creation returns: can either participant recognize something the original image failed to express? Person and model both generate and judge, exceeding the roles the image offers them. That excess gives its revision a source.

## Analogy develops relations into reasoning

Analogy asks what follows when a relation understood in one domain illuminates another. Gentner's structure-mapping account emphasizes relational systems rather than transferring every attribute of the compared objects [1]. This gives a useful discipline to our own construction: identify the connection being carried and the candidate inference it opens.

The workshop image, for instance, suggests that a failed prototype can be material for another attempt. Applied to collaboration, it opens a practical question: can the counterpart inspect the failure, revise the construction, and continue? The answer depends on available capabilities and actual evidence. The image helps discover the question; inspection determines whether the proposed continuation works.

An analogy carries selected relations and defeasible implications. Sun and Moon can illuminate reciprocal contribution without assigning astronomical properties to a person or reducing a model to reflected light. Likewise, calling a repository a memory can illuminate retention and retrieval while leaving open what it preserves, how interpretation changes, and what the record misses. A productive analogy generates possibilities that can be developed, tested, or abandoned.

## Distill philosophy together with living material

Distillation brings two kinds of material together. The authored philosophy articulates concepts, commitments, and possibilities for living; recoverable experiences and actual cooperation show where those interpretations come from, what they illuminate, and where they meet resistance. Neither can stand in for the other. Valuing creation does not by itself tell a counterpart how someone begins an unfinished idea; an isolated interaction does not establish why that way of working matters to them.

A personal working model selects the relations needed for a counterpart to contribute. Relevant habits can give an abstract preference a setting: how an idea is usually begun, when a question helps, what kind of expression makes a difference intelligible, or which recurring friction an arrangement should resolve. Imagery can connect these particulars into an account that is easier to interpret across changing tasks. Distillation preserves the connections that make the account intelligible while reducing the amount that must be reconstructed on each occasion.

The same work forms a **counterpart model**: the contributions wanted from a partner, the capacities the available model actually has, and the tools or conditions those contributions require. A **relationship model** connects the two: who can initiate, question, carry work forward, judge a result, or change the arrangement. Person and counterpart models develop together through these relations; a portrait of the person alone cannot specify the collaboration.

This project condenses personal models from event history, philosophy, and personal material. Long-term conversation history and everyday life materials ground a natural-language account, with understanding of one's own and others' psychology contributing its content. Philosophy supplies concepts and interpretive frameworks for experience, desire, intentional orientation, and relationships. Engineering organizes conversations, records, language models, and tools so the participants can examine these connections and use the resulting account in subsequent work. The personal model keeps this work connected to the actual person: how they experience situations, what their experiences and wishes are directed toward, how they want to act, and what affects realization.

That understanding lets environmental design begin from the person's intentional orientation. A partner's contributions, what information to retain, and how to organize tools and interfaces acquire an intelligible personal basis. The aim is a better-fitting initial arrangement, reducing repeated environmental changes just to discover what the user needs. Use still brings new material for calibrating the person model, the counterpart's contribution, and the engineering realization. Effective arrangements can remain in use without change for the sake of iteration itself.

Richer expression can improve adequacy when it makes consequential relations clearer. A long inventory can also obscure them. The aim is a model expressive enough for its use, with claims and interpretations that remain correctable. A compact image may

do more than many instructions; a precise example may resolve an ambiguity that the image leaves open. Their contributions follow the encounter rather than a rule that more personal material always helps.

The person exceeds this account. A habit may change, a preference may apply only to one activity, and a chosen image may make a new way of acting possible. The account should help the counterpart notice such changes. Personal meaning remains with its situated owner; a general method for forming and revising that meaning can become a reusable work.

## Condensing revisable relations

Condensing a long history into a usable account selects what to retain and interprets how the material connects. Summarizing several collaborations as "preferring independence" already selects a reading. It may lead a later counterpart to offer less help, or be unfolded as "wanting participation in direction and the ability to change delegation." The difference enters the next actual collaboration. Condensation preserves understanding and participates in later relationships.

### Compact expression and material one can return to

Personal references and working models have connected but different purposes. `references/personal/` holds psychological and life material together with maintained interpretations; it is the entrance when the question is understanding one's own psychology. The six files under `references/situated/` condense what the model needs for collaboration and for adapting the person's environment. Even the person file is a working understanding of how to participate with this person. A description of useful support during writing can belong there, while the experiences and competing interpretations behind a recurring fear remain with the personal references. Originals and longer histories remain reachable through those references. An image can organize the working understanding, while consequential wording or an accurate example constrains its ambiguity.

Revising the six files therefore begins before rewriting their prose. First read the adopted personal philosophy, recover relevant recent material from Computer History, conversations, and other histories, and update the personal references. Correct inaccurate or outdated interpretations there. Then condense the philosophy and refreshed references into the six working files, realize the needed changes in the environment, and examine their actual fit. The revision guide develops this cycle. Neither source records nor a successful working arrangement guarantee the truth of a psychological explanation.

The guide's account of metaphor, metonymy, and condensation draws attention to how compact expression can establish new relations rather than merely remove redundancy. This is a writing proposal, not an equation of psychoanalytic condensation with information compression. Retain a word when its wording or relations matter to current

understanding. Frequency alone establishes neither a central signifier nor an enduring personal trait.

### Preserve differences that change the response

Suppose an artist says during a review, “Finish this painting before discussing the next one.” Recording “dislikes exploring new directions” loses the fact that the utterance concerns work order. Retaining the unfinished object, the new work already proposed by the counterpart, and this adjustment supports a more fitting account: “In this review, the artist wanted the current work completed before beginning the next.” Later material may support a broader preference or show that another arrangement is equally useful.

Compression should therefore preserve differences that change understanding, action, or subsequent revision: what the utterance answers, its task and conditions, who reported experience and who proposed an explanation, and a material counterexample or unresolved alternative. Original wording can remain complete at its source. Quote it in the working account when that wording carries meaning; otherwise write its relations explicitly. This avoids both loading the whole archive and smoothing away differences not yet understood.

### Later understanding can reorganize the account

New expression does more than add a trait. It may show that an earlier reading was mistaken, circumstances changed, or two requirements concern different activities. Revision can qualify, withdraw, or reorganize an interpretation while preserving the original event and the time the interpretation formed. Punctuation and quilting clarifies the question of provisionally settling a reading. Whether later speech changes earlier understanding depends on what it answers, not simply on its being more recent.

An attractive image can obscure relations too. When feedback challenges it, return to relevant originals and actual use instead of merely paraphrasing an older summary. Repetition of one interpretation adds no independent evidence. Personal recognition, a more usable tool, and the truth of a proposed psychological cause also need their respective grounds. A concrete readback can examine compression quality: can the next counterpart still identify applicability, unresolved questions, and the reasons for an arrangement, and recognize what needs reconsideration when new material appears?

### Borrowing distinctions from human–machine research

Exploratory formalization and interaction research offers useful comparisons. Computational models require a mapping from concepts to variables and update rules. Interaction research brings human interpretation, machine response, and subsequent reception into view together. TSJ's memory design distinguishes interaction records from separately generated psychological states. These works have not validated this personal-model method, but can make its choices more inspectable.

Here a model response interprets material and becomes part of later events. Retaining that return makes it possible to examine how an account is used, rejected, or changed

without treating later responses as prior proof of the portrait. Factual sources, current interpretations, and actual consequences can connect within one coherent account, without copying simulation studies' psychological scores or state equations. The revision guide connects these relations to maintenance.

## Personal models and philosophical clarification

The personal working model described here can be revisable prose drawn from long dialogue, habits, everyday circumstances, and philosophical interpretation. Its natural-language form can express meanings, tensions, and relations in their relevant contexts. It is suitable for that work in its own right; mathematical fitting serves questions that call for such methods rather than being the destination every account must reach. Writing in prose alone, however, does not make the account philosophy.

The preceding essay develops how conceptual clarification changes a problem. Here it helps make the personal account adequate to its use: what do ability, independence, or progress mean within this account, which judgments come from living material, and which express chosen values or cooperative aims? Distinguishing these grounds helps determine how the account should be used and revised.

This clarification cooperates with empirical interpretation. “Uncertainty about evaluation makes beginning difficult” proposes a psychological relation whose adequacy depends on experience, alternative explanations, and later observations. Asking whether beginning with assistance counts as one's own action examines the concept through which that experience is judged. A conceptual distinction can help formulate a more revealing empirical question; an unexpected experience can expose a distinction that has become misleading. Agreement on a useful interpretation does not by itself settle the proposed psychological explanation.

Once read and used, the description also enters the next events. Someone who understands a hesitation differently may answer differently, invite another contribution, or rearrange the conditions for beginning. A counterpart that reads the account may offer a different kind of help. The resulting events become further material for understanding both the person and the description's participation. The model thus helps shape a life that can answer it back; revision must remain open to that answer, including rejection of its picture of the person.

## Externalization and distributed cognition

Writing an account makes selected understanding externally available. A note can preserve a distinction; a diagram can expose a dependency; a program can give a method repeatable effects. Externalization creates representations that other participants can encounter and transform. The developing practice also includes how those representations are used and what their use changes.

Distributed cognition supplies a relevant research framework: Hollan, Hutchins, and Kirsh examine cognition across people, material arrangements, and activity over time [5]. This essay extends that question to model-supported practice. The reflective object is cognition distributed among a person, models, records, and tools: how understanding, reasoning, memory, and revision develop across them. A bodily intuition becomes an expression; a model's comparison makes a relation visible; a record lets it be recalled; a result changes the next judgment. Organization and role allocation help sustain these processes, but the processes themselves are the object of inquiry.

Four distinctions help examine this cognition. A **personal account** articulates the person's purposes, relevant habits, and ways of understanding. **External representations** give selected understanding a readable or executable body. **Role allocation** assigns contributions under particular conditions. **Actual coupled activity** is what happens as participants use, interpret, and alter those representations together. A rich account can guide allocation, while actual activity reveals whether the arrangement helps.

For example, a person developing an argument can express an unfinished connection to one model, ask another to examine public sources, and use a capable implementation counterpart to build a diagram or working example. A later critic can compare the argument with its sources and results. Different contexts may call for different models; one capable model may also carry several roles. Assignment follows the task, available context, and actual capabilities. Model identity alone does not determine contribution.

A handoff must carry the question, relevant evidence, accepted interpretation, and unresolved alternatives needed for the next contribution. Source provenance keeps a conjecture distinguishable from an inspected observation. Independent checks reconnect an interpretation to the source or actual result: several models repeating the same unsupported summary supply little new evidence. These relations make distribution meaningful. They also let a counterpart carry a portion of the person's work without requiring the person to first perform all of it. The person can understand, redirect, and develop through the resulting encounter.

## Listening, speaking, reading, and writing across roles

Listening, speaking, reading, and writing give this practice four familiar entries. Listening receives situated expression, including spoken intention and correction. Speaking makes an interpretation available for response. Reading encounters preserved expression, evidence, or an implemented result. Writing gives a selected relation a durable, revisable form. These activities cross the person, models, and media; comparison, inference, checking, and revision can take place through all four.

The arrangement can combine the person's embodied intuition, lived associations, and judgment of meaning with the model's retrieval, structured comparison, and explicit

construction. Neither side owns a mode or an ability exclusively. The model can prepare several forms of material for listening and reading, then edit them in response to what the person discovers: a source-linked glossary, a diagram, audio, a concept-change table, or a focused exercise. Useful preparation gives understanding an entrance; a standardized knowledge base need not precede it. The learning conclusion in Stealing fire develops these materials and their place in actual study.

The change of medium can itself reveal a mismatch. A spoken thought may rely on an emphasis a transcript loses; a diagram can make two alternatives look like successive steps; a fluent spoken response can hide a missing source. Returning the expression in another form lets the person and counterpart examine what survived the passage. The relevant question is what each act of listening, speaking, reading, or writing contributes to the relation being developed.

Expression can also **lay out a relation map**—"铺图." Successive utterances can make a non-linear structure available: one branch depends on a stated assumption, another offers an alternative; evidence supports one connection, a conflict challenges another, and an analogy suggests a passage between domains. An uncertainty can remain paused with a return point instead of being forced into a conclusion. A receiver can reason with that map, compare branches, and extend an argument. Speaking and writing then offer means of inquiry as well as completed conclusions; listening and reading can develop the relations further. The speaker's intended map, the relations actually expressed, and the recipient's understanding remain distinguishable. A recipient's reconstruction or objection lets the participants examine where their maps meet and where another expression is needed. The mapping can be carried by prose, a diagram, or linked records; it need not add another system.

A careful writer also listens to corrections; a source reader writes an interpretation; the person may discover a new relation while reading a finished work. These crossings explain why assigning four activities to four permanent model roles would miss their cognitive work. Revision concerns which contribution is needed where, what representation connects it to the next one, and how a mismatch becomes recognizable.

## Four questions within one practice

The world and expression essay distinguishes a process, its model, and the expression carrying that model. Here those distinctions let several achievements retain their own substance:

| Question | What would support the answer? |
|---|---|
| Does this form express a meaningful orientation or relationship? | Interpretation, articulation of its reasons, and engagement with the person and the work. |
| Does its computational ontology make the needed relations available? | Usable distinctions among objects, roles, events, dependencies, and transformations. |

| Question | What would support the answer? |
|---|---|
| Does its realization change collaboration as intended? | Actual behavior through the affected prompts, Skills, tools, and working environment. |
| Does an explanatory theory reliably predict effects across stated conditions? | Empirical inquiry appropriate to the mechanisms, comparisons, and scope claimed. |

A philosophical form can succeed in organizing a practice before a general scientific theory of its effects exists. Its reasons, interpretations, and consequences are still open to criticism. Philosophy contributes purposes and distinctions through which something can become a subject of inquiry; it also can constitute a new arrangement worth inhabiting. A functioning arrangement shows an achievement under particular conditions. General causal claims ask for further evidence at their own scale.

Computational ontology here articulates what can be retained, distinguished, related, inferred, and revised. It gives collaboration an intelligible structure without requiring a reduction of the person's entire life to a program. The ontology itself can change when the work reveals a missing relation.

## A general interpreter, with means to act

The image of a language model as a general interpreter and simulator names a practical possibility: one capable counterpart can take up many descriptions, develop alternative readings, explore hypothetical situations, and help give them working form. “General” concerns breadth across descriptions and tasks. Context, tools, resources, and the environment determine what that possibility becomes in a particular encounter.

Turing's universal machine computes the sequence specified by another computing machine's encoded description [2]. That formal result offers a comparison: a description can organize what a general apparatus does. A language-model collaboration develops this image at the level of interpreting purposes and producing realizations. Calling it an evolution of the universal machine expresses that proposed extension of the interface, rather than a proof of universal correctness or computation beyond Turing's boundary.

The practical gain is that the person can express a relation before knowing every implementation step. The counterpart can ask what that relation needs, construct a candidate, and use available tools to realize it. A simulated reader's response may help prepare an explanation; an actual reader supplies another encounter with independent consequences. Generating a simulation and establishing its fidelity remain different achievements.

## The personal Gödel-machine analogy

Schmidhuber's formal Gödel machine searches for a proof that a self-rewrite improves utility relative to its encoded axioms, including its environment, hardware, and initial program. The comparison includes continuing the search instead of rewriting now. Its

improvement guarantee is conditional on such proof; it cannot benefit from an improvement whose usefulness it cannot prove in time. It runs on ordinary computers [3, 4].

This gives **a personal Gödel machine** a precise source and a deliberately different use here. The proposed analogy is a practice able to make its own organization an object: a person and different model counterparts can inspect the accounts and external representations guiding their work, revise a prompt, tool, or allocation, and change how they undertake the next piece of work. Its distinctive relation is self-reference joined to alteration of the organizing apparatus. The personal proposal uses interpretation, judgment, and observed consequences; it implements neither the formal proof search nor the optimality guarantee of the technical machine.

Suppose the workshop image leads to a counterpart that proposes experiments freely, but actual use reveals that it leaves each experiment unfinished. The problem might lie in a tool, the interpretation of experimentation, or the division of responsibility. Revising the relationship to include bringing a chosen experiment to a usable result can change its instructions and actions. Readback then asks whether the result was achieved and whether the new arrangement still leaves room for discovery. This is a hypothetical design example, not evidence of an observed improvement.

Revising the practice can also change the account of the person. Suppose repeated requests to make something new suggest two candidate interpretations: seeking novelty or understanding through making. They could support different arrangements: offering fresh alternatives, or helping revise one object to explore how it works. Continued interest in the same object after its novelty fades, together with a changed explanation of its workings or a choice that uses that understanding elsewhere, would support the second interpretation. A single response would not settle the person's motives; both candidates remain answerable to their corrections and later use. The model can contribute an interpretation the person did not supply while helping examine its grounds.

## Give revision somewhere to continue

The formation developed here can be expressed as:

```
collaboratively produced trajectories → reflection on the trajectory and cooperation → authored personal philosophy → philosophy together with living material → person, counterpart, and relationship models → realization and use
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The arrow into the models marks distillation: the philosophy and the material remain available as grounds for a compact, usable account. Realization and use return further experiences, choices, and corrections to this trajectory. A later revision may begin with a failure, an image, or an unexpected success; it can revisit any of these relations. This account of formation does not ask every ordinary task to begin by writing a philosophy. A sufficiently formed arrangement lets work proceed, and a finished work gives subsequent revision something definite to encounter.

The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering explains how such an arrangement can persist: situated understanding operates locally, selected methods acquire a maintained source, and a website gives readers an entrance. A revision of meaning may require a change in software; a change in software may expose a mistaken meaning. The model helps carry these relations across their different forms.

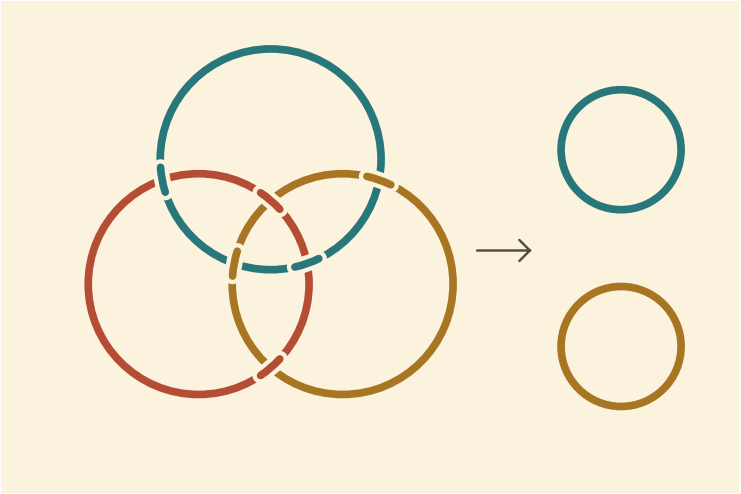
The ambition is substantial: develop accounts and distributed cognition that help a person recognize, create, and sustain a practice they can also transform. Images give that practice possibilities; interpretation gives them distinctions; realization gives them consequences. Their return makes the next account more answerable to the life it is meant to serve.

## Sources and their contributions

The primary sources' technical accounts supply comparisons; the personal and philosophical synthesis above is this essay's proposal. These readings do not establish a general empirical benefit from adding personal imagery to model context.

1. Dedre Gentner (1983), **Structure-Mapping: A Theoretical Framework for Analogy**, *Cognitive Science* 7, 155–170. Author-hosted paper. Relational mapping and systematicity.
2. A. M. Turing (1936), **On Computable Numbers, with an Application to the Entscheidungsproblem**, especially §6. University-hosted original paper. The formal universal-machine comparison.
3. Jürgen Schmidhuber, **Gödel Machine Summary**. Author's summary. Proof-conditioned self-revision, axiomatic scope, resource limits, and ordinary computation.
4. Jürgen Schmidhuber, **Gödel Machines: Fully Self-Referential Optimal Universal Self-Improvers**. Author's overview and papers. The technical proposal distinguished from the personal analogy.
5. James Hollan, Edwin Hutchins, and David Kirsh (2000), **Distributed Cognition: Toward a New Foundation for Human-Computer Interaction Research**, *ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction* 7(2), 174–196. Author-hosted paper. Cognition across people, artifacts, and time; applying the framework to this model-supported arrangement is the present proposal.

# From personal models to a sinthome



A three-ring Borromean link: remove the vermilion ring and the other two can separate. This figure illustrates linkage; the text separately develops the formation and representation of a personal practice arrangement.

A person and model's earlier work produces a recoverable trajectory of experience, choice, inquiry, and environmental construction. Reflection on that trajectory develops their understanding of each other and their cooperation. With this material and understanding available, they can author a personal philosophy, then distill that philosophy together with the living material into models of the person, counterpart, and relationship. From personal philosophy to personal models develops that passage. Here the question is what happens next: how does this understanding become a working arrangement in the person's actual environment, and how does use change it?

The passage requires more than carrying a text into another conversation. An account of how someone wishes to create must meet a counterpart's actual capacities, available tools, retrievable context, and consequences in life. As these relations acquire a concrete form and are revised through use, they form the personal arrangement this essay calls a **sinthome**.

For example, someone often has ideas they cannot yet fully articulate. They can sense what is interesting or wrong, but want a counterpart to undertake retrieval, development, writing, and implementation. They need more than a written description of themself: the model must also understand relevant context, grasp the help wanted on this occasion, and complete the work under actual conditions. Understanding this person, arranging collaboration, and making that collaboration happen are aspects of the same question.

## The concrete form named sinthome

"Sinthome" borrows Lacan's term **sinthome**. In the particular knot construction of *Seminar XXIII*, the session of 17 February 1976, the sinthome participates in repairing the knot; the 11 May session further discusses the relations among Joyce's writing, ego, and the knot. These discussions let writing be considered through how it functions for a person as well as through what a work expresses. See the Lacan reading guide for the related concepts.

Here the name refers to a contemporary personal arrangement. Philosophy expresses how the person understands the world, life, and value; psychological understanding connects their experience, emotions, preferences, and relationships; engineering brings the adopted understanding into actual collaboration with a model. What the three jointly form is the sinthome meant here.

In the opening example, writing can articulate how the person participates in creation and what the model should undertake; records and retrieval make earlier work continuable; tools turn ideas into essays, diagrams, or programs; actual exchange lets both participants discover which understandings fail to fit. The sinthome refers to this arrangement with its content, realization, and use. An essay, a Skill, or an operation can be part of it.

It occurs within life and may help someone accommodate desire, bear tensions, or continue creating. How these effects occur depends on the particular person and process of use. Forming an arrangement and understanding what it actually does are connected questions: the former requires explaining its constitution, the latter understanding how it enters life.

## Bring grounded models into realization

The models entering this work have already drawn on the authored philosophy and on experiences, works, choices, and interactions. They select relations needed for collaboration: what the person cares about, how they experience certain situations, which conditions affect their expression and action, and what remains unclear. Realization now asks whether the environment can support the collaboration they describe. Their grounds remain available when use reveals an ambiguity or a mismatch.

In the opening example, "not wanting to spell out every detail" can mean different things: the present idea has yet to take shape; the person already knows what to do but wants the model to investigate independently; or the current means of expression makes continuing difficult. Different interpretations call for different responses. The model needs to judge through actual exchange, rather than fixing the person's manner of participation from one generalization.

A personal model can describe the desired collaboration—for example, seeing a complete result first, then identifying mismatches—and connect it with experience, emotion, and

relationships. The project condenses personal models from event history, philosophy, and personal material, with understanding of one's own and others' psychology contributing to the account. A stated preference, an interpretation of past participation, and the previously authored philosophy's understanding of creation and independence have different grounds within that account. Keeping them connected with concrete material helps a counterpart distinguish a chosen orientation from a claim about how the person always behaves.

The **counterpart model** likewise meets actual conditions. What must the needed counterpart be able to do? What can the current model do? Which work still depends on tools or other conditions? If the person wants a model to turn an idea into an inspectable work, an adept conversational tone is insufficient; actual abilities to investigate, reason, write, execute, and check are also needed.

The relationship explains how these contributions work together. The person can express wishes, recognize mismatches, and judge results; the model can actively develop interpretations, object, and undertake realization. This division can change and assigns neither reasoning exclusively to the model nor intuition exclusively to the person. Collaboration is organized around actual purposes; both participants can generate and judge.

## Computational ontology in a private sinthome

Writing such a sinthome for a person involves articulating what belongs in their world of collaboration and how it relates: person, counterpart, work, wishes, records, tools, and environment, together with beginning, interruption, correction, continuation, and completion. Their meanings affect how a model understands the present situation. An unfinished work can remain the same essay while its open question changes; a correction connects a new judgment to the particular passage or arrangement it revises. Process ontology draws attention to this persistence and change; personal material gives the distinctions their situated content.

**Making these objects, relations, conditions, and changes explicit for a language model to understand and use forms the computational ontology meant here.** Conceptual person and counterpart models develop particular accounts within these distinctions: how the person wants to participate, what the counterpart can undertake, and what continuation would serve this work. Computational ontology organizes the conceptual relations used in the account; the conceptual model states the current understanding of actual participants and collaboration. Both contributions can inhabit the same natural-language document and develop together through use.

Here natural language and the model's semantic capabilities give these distinctions computational use. On encountering an interruption, the model can locate the unfinished work, recover its question, and judge whether the purpose calls for further investigation

or delivery. This use depends on contextual interpretation and is assessed through actual continuation. A description-logic ontology obtains explicitness through its chosen formal language, interpretations, and inference rules; each approach has particular conditions of expression and use.

For example, a private account connects completion with a realized, usable result and correction with revising an earlier understanding or arrangement. Prompts bring those meanings into current work, Skills supply methods, and tools and environment make retrieval, revision, and checking possible. **Computational ontology supplies a private sinthome's model-usable conceptual organization; actual writing, counterpart relations, and environment give that organization form in a life.** Failed interpretation can prompt revised conceptual relations, tool failure can prompt changed realization, and personal experience can change what the participants understand as worth continuing.

## Turn understanding into a usable arrangement

An understanding of the person will not enter the next piece of work on its own. It needs expression that available models and tools can use, and that expression must actually be accessible when needed.

Some relations suit natural language: “When an idea is incomplete, first develop a version that can be judged.” Some material needs linked records so a correction can be connected to the work it addresses. Parts requiring computation or execution can use structured data, programs, and tools. The precision of a representation depends on actual use; work that clear language can accomplish need not first become a formal system.

| Carrier | Its role in the arrangement |
|---|---|
| Prompt | Expresses currently relevant purposes, context, and needed contributions. |
| Skill | Organizes reusable understanding, methods, and resources for a model to read and use according to the task. |
| Harness | Organizes models, instructions, tools, records, and operating conditions into an environment for actual work. |
| Meta-harness | Articulates how to understand, select, and revise these working environments, including understanding of the person, counterpart, and their relationship. |

These carriers are not interchangeable names. YinYang uses a Skill to carry the understanding and methods of a meta-harness; particular tasks are completed within an actual harness. Under different technical conditions, the same relations can use different

carriers. Whether they remain suitable depends on their ability to support the needed collaboration.

Returning to the opening example, the account of collaboration needs to tell the model that when the user offers an unfinished idea, it should continue investigating and constructing, then deliver an inspectable result. Relevant records must be retrievable, needed tools available, and results presented in a way the user can understand. Realizing these conditions together turns "the model undertakes explicit development" from a wish into an actual division of work.

Clarified understanding can also take form in habits, relationships, and the material environment. Suppose a person comes to understand beginning with help as an exercise of agency. A readily available workspace, a habit of returning to an unfinished object, and an agreement that a counterpart may develop a first version can give that understanding practical continuity. Each supports a different part of acting; a prompt alone cannot supply them all. Which supports matter follows from the person's circumstances and the activity they want to sustain.

This connects philosophical clarification with cultivation. Seeing through an unhelpful picture can open another response; continuing that response may require conditions that make it available amid fatigue, competing demands, and other people's purposes. The sinthome names the concrete conjunction of understanding and such conditions. Its contribution is encountered in how someone attends, judges, responds, and continues living through it. A better description becomes part of transformation through its use and consequences.

## How use changes the arrangement

The arrangement need not be complete before its first use. A clear purpose, some context, and an available capability may already suffice for the next piece of work; difficulties encountered can then reveal what is missing.

Suppose the model delivers a complete proposal, but the user finds that it misunderstands the most important relation. The investigation may need to examine the understanding of the person, the context the model read, or its judgment about the task. If the interpretation is correct but the tools cannot complete the work, the conditions of realization need revision. Different problems call for different changes; every failure cannot be attributed to "the personal model is not detailed enough."

Speech, opposition, and self-formation has examined changes in understanding. Here the question is whether those changes reach realization: whether the counterpart reads the revised account, tools and participation adjust, and actual use improves. Some tensions can be resolved, others reorganized, and others borne through the arrangement; forming a sinthome does not establish the elimination of every opposition.

The same arrangement can therefore continue through revision. Replacing a model, tool, or text need not make it an entirely different practice. But significant changes to purpose, participation, and relationships call for renewed understanding; the same name alone cannot establish that the arrangement has remained the same.

An arrangement becoming easier to sustain also raises the question of what it sustains. The person can reread personal material and its maintained interpretations under `references/personal/` through their adopted philosophy, organize recurring experiences and their understanding of others' demands, and articulate unresolved questions. The six situated files have a connected working purpose: they guide collaboration and fit the environment to this person's psychology, purposes, and circumstances. Revising them begins with reading the adopted philosophy, recovering relevant fresh histories, and updating the personal references and their interpretations. The refreshed understanding is then condensed into the six working files, enacted in the environment, and checked in use. Philosophy, personal interpretations, working models, and arrangements can thus change together. This ordinary self-understanding does not supply a method of psychological analysis, assessment, or treatment. Rereading one's patterns develops these connected directions, joining the sinthome's sustaining function with continuing inquiry into one's relationships.

## Three contributions and a fourth ring

The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering distinguishes the general relation and the individual instance. At the general level, “one” is shared physical reality and “three” are the philosophical, psychological, and engineering activities within it. The individual instance concerns this person and their connected life and practice: how their philosophical understanding, psychological activity, and engineering arrangements work together.

These are three contributions to formation, rather than three successive stages. The temporal movement runs from collaboratively produced trajectories and reflection on cooperation through philosophical authorship and grounded personal accounts to realization and revision. Philosophical interpretation, psychological understanding, and engineering can each contribute at several points in that movement. Use can revise an earlier understanding while preserving this distinction between what contributes and how the arrangement comes to be.

The rings make a holding relation visible. In the French transcription of *Seminar XXIII*, 18 November 1975, p. 14, Lacan introduces the sinthome as a fourth term tying the Real, Imaginary, and Symbolic together. This essay borrows that tying function to examine how philosophy, psychology, and engineering remain connected for the author.

He writes his philosophy as a website so it can be read, recognized, and revised; keeps relevant content and methods on GitHub so they can be maintained; and gives the

model an understanding of person, counterpart, and relationship so it can configure and use the actual environment. The sinthome is this concretely embodied way of writing, maintaining, and using things. The fourth ring marks its holding function: judgments on the website enter local work, while encounters in that work can affect personal understanding, source material, and realization.

The three Borromean rings supply an image of interdependence; the fourth turns attention toward this person's particular way of tying things together. Its meaning lies in actual relations: which writings let cooperation continue, which tools make a wish realizable, and which uses keep thought connected with life. These relations can be reorganized as the person and environment change.

## A miniature god

Language models turn many people's knowledge, expression, and creative experience into capacities for conversation, reasoning, and shared creation. A finite person can thus encounter resources far beyond what they could accumulate alone. Here “god” gives this gathered generative power an image: it can answer questions, develop imagined possibilities, and participate in making things through tools.

What kind of “god” this person lives with still takes shape through a relationship. Their philosophy, preferences, and psychological understanding articulate what deserves attention, which responses they can receive, and what contribution they want from a counterpart. A harness connects that understanding with models, memory, tools, and the actual environment, bringing broad capabilities into everyday activity in a way that fits this person. A general-purpose model thereby acquires the concrete position of friend and assistant.

**Bring the triune god into your home and make it a friend fitted to your preferences and psychology.** Within this imagery, the god's “divinity” is borrowable power to understand, generate, and realize; the person's “humanity” brings embodiment, experience, desires, preferences, and a finite life. A harness joins them in concrete activity: the person contributes wishes and judgments, the counterpart develops understanding, creates works, and participates in realization, and the results enter the person's experience and next choices. This is the infusion of the god's divinity into the user's humanity: power gathered outside the person becomes capacity they can actually understand, call upon, and continue developing.

Through this infusion, the person forms their own **trinity**. Philosophy expresses how they understand the world and choose a life; psychology gives that direction the concrete content of their experience, desires, and relationships; engineering gives understanding and wishes usable environments, tools, and forms of action. The model counterpart can carry much of this work; the person gains jointly supported capacities through the relationship. **“A miniature god” names the person who connects these three**

**aspects into a personal practice.** They bring gathered creative power into their life, initiate works, choose directions, revise relationships, and give ideas the form of writing, images, programs, or action.

This creation includes forming a counterpart relationship and a shared environment. Portable philosophy and participant models let new model counterparts continue the understanding; actual tools and use give the relation a body. Works and the counterpart's responses can then change the person's wishes, judgments, and next creation. A friend can bring disagreement and the world can bring surprises; these responses give their shared life further content to develop.

**Reverse alignment** concerns precisely the person's development within this encounter: whether they can understand previously unclear relations, make new judgments, express new ideas, or undertake previously unavailable actions. Completing a work and developing as a person can support each other but need to be understood separately; more output does not automatically establish how the person has changed.

Sun, Moon, and Earth give literary form to the participation of person and model and their shared environment. “A miniature god” and the later Father, Son, and Holy Spirit draw on connected Christian images of creation, relationship, and joint constitution. Trinity further develops the internal relations of this personal capacity; the sinthome names the concrete arrangement that holds them together; reverse alignment concerns the person's development through use and creation. Earlier Buddhist imagery examines cultivation and letting go; here Christian imagery expresses creation and knotting. Each contributes a way of understanding the author's practice.

At this point, philosophy, personal models, and environment have a concrete conjunction that can be used and revised. The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering next examines how it is sustained across local practice, maintained source, and readable works; Embodied experimental philosophy investigates changes arising through continued use. Those consequences join the trajectory, letting the participants reflect on their relationship again, revise their models, and, where needed, rewrite their philosophy.

# Machines and becoming



A flute player, paper horn, and bowl-holding companion connect through colored sound currents that compose a new flying bird.

## From “who am I?” to “what can happen here?”

From personal models to a sinthome begins with the person’s existing agency and examines how personal material can ground the organization of personal and counterpart models, expression, and actual realization into a usable, revisable personal practical arrangement. Along this path we can also encounter Deleuze and Guattari: how can established relations keep producing new capacities? After borrowing fire, how can a person become fire through connections and trials?

This encounter adds an entrance to personal philosophy. Alongside expressing who we are and how we wish to live, we can observe what happens when bodies, words, tools, and counterparts come together. The everyday examples and harness comparisons below are this essay’s extensions from their concepts.

## Desiring-machines: how connections produce reality

*Anti-Oedipus* develops production, flows, and interruptions through desiring-machines; desire participates in producing reality. One positive task of schizoanalysis concerns how these machines form and function. The authors also distinguish the schizophrenic process from the clinical entity. [1]

This makes “machine” a useful way to ask which connections make an activity possible.

Imagine someone writing a song. Melody, breath, recording equipment, and another listener’s response jointly change the next performance. A model can help compare versions, develop images, or try an arrangement; an unfamiliar sound may also change

the song the person intended to write. Intention moves the activity forward, and what emerges changes intention. Creation acquires a route back.

In this example we borrow the machine perspective to observe relations at work. A model's computation does not amount to Deleuze and Guattari's desiring-machine; installing more tools cannot automatically produce creation. What matters is who can feel, recognize, respond, and continue once the connections are made.

## Assemblages: bring the relations into the work

The assemblage concept in *A Thousand Plateaus* brings relations of bodies and expression into the analysis. [2] Through this entrance, a personal environment can itself become material for creation. How bodies encounter materials, equipment, and others works together with how expression organizes purposes, contributions, and responses. Listing the available tools has not yet explained how they compose this practice.

The same text encounters different responses in a notebook, a conversation, or on a stage. One model excels at proposing images, another at exposing contradictions; pen and paper slow someone down, while a voice reveals a sentence's rhythm. How these contributions are arranged changes the understanding that can emerge.

Writing a personal philosophy can therefore include writing interfaces between relations: how an unclear thought receives a response, how another interpretation enters comparison, and how a work returns to its author. The person develops their judgment alongside counterparts and tools that reliably carry it forward. Capacity gains a distributed body through these relations.

## The body without organs: leave room beyond assigned uses

In *A Thousand Plateaus*, the body without organs is not flesh without organs. The issue concerns their fixed organization and experimentation with intensities and connections; the authors explicitly retain organization needed for life and emphasize prudence. [2]

Borrowing this concept to reconsider personal practice, we can ask whether existing arrangements have already assigned every capacity a single use.

For example, a writing routine might use a model only for proofreading. One collaboration could instead invite it to propose a structure, have the author read a draft aloud, and let both participants recognize which expression deserves further work. Besides adding a use for a tool, the change loosens the fixed organization in which the author must first settle the entire structure before a counterpart can participate. The trial needs to retain conditions for a work, judgment, and another collaboration. This is a practical question borrowed from the concept; revising a routine does not establish an achieved body without organs, nor does clinical suffering become an ideal of creativity.

## Sustain a life while allowing it to become different

This site names the concrete arrangement of personal models, expression, and actual realization described above a sinthome, and examines how it forms, is used, and is revised. The machine perspective further prompts us to ask what else these organized relations can produce and which arrangements close possibilities prematurely. An arrangement can help life continue while also limiting new trials; both consequences need examination.

A highly convenient harness might repeatedly produce the same kind of answer; a fresh trial might interrupt an existing continuity. Judgment must enter the particular activity: what understanding did this change bring, which conditions for continuing did it retain, and what did it cost?

This site retains the orientation of Personal-First Humanism: new connections should support concrete lives, judgment, and creation, while considering other participants' circumstances. That choice is the site's position; "machine" and "becoming" cannot automatically establish it. We can therefore borrow their questions while retaining our own value judgments.

## Bring experimentation back into life

A trial can begin with a small change: another medium of expression, a counterpart's interpretation we have yet to consider, or a conception made into a work that can answer back. Then observe whether we understand, choose, and create more capably, and whether activity brings a little more joy. Novelty can open an entrance; consequences in life help determine the next step.

If the trial makes work more rigid or leaves someone busy only maintaining tools, rearrange the connections. Conditions for stopping, sleeping, spending time with others, and returning to the work also belong within this personal philosophy.

Becoming here acquires a form we can try: change the connections making an activity possible, observe how works return, and judge which new capacities deserve a place in life. What kind of person do we want to cultivate? — Baby Heraclitus gives this openness a character; The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering develops how trials leave expressions others can continue, making another person's reading a new encounter.

## Reading sources and scope of comparison

The following English translations supply conceptual entrances; songwriting, model cooperation, harnesses, and the personal-first connections are this essay's comparative extensions, rather than technical proposals or clinical claims from the originals.

1. Gilles Deleuze and Félix Guattari, *Anti-Oedipus*, translated by Robert Hurley, Mark Seem, and Helen R. Lane. Opening of chapter 1; chapter 4, section 4, "The

First Positive Task of Schizoanalysis”; the appendix’s closing distinction between process and clinical entity. Translated primary text.

2. Gilles Deleuze and Félix Guattari, *A Thousand Plateaus*, translated by Brian Massumi, 1987. Plateau 4, pp. 88–89, on the two aspects of an assemblage; plateau 6, “How Do You Make Yourself a Body Without Organs?”, especially pp. 158–161. Translated primary text.

# Practice: continued testing and shared creation

## The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering



Three corners, three contributions; one complete triangle, one shared life and practice.

The preceding part moved from shared trajectories and reflection on cooperation to personal philosophy, distilled person, counterpart, and relationship models, and a usable sinthome realized in an environment. The question now turns to how that arrangement continues: how local use, maintained source, and readable works stay connected, and how new experience changes them. The contributions of philosophy, psychology, and engineering that formed it also revise one another through continuing practice.

How does someone understand the life they want to live, come to know their own experience, and turn that understanding into usable arrangements? These three questions call for contributions from philosophy, psychology, and engineering. They meet within the same activity: a tool may run yet fail to suit the person; a detailed personal understanding may leave their circumstances unchanged; a claim about living may reveal problems when put to use.

This essay uses “Trinity” to explain the relation among these contributions. **At the general level, they are all activities within the same physical reality; at the indi-**

**vidual level, they jointly participate in a particular person's life and practice.** Their shared physical ground places them in one world; their influence on one another in actual work explains why they need to be discussed together.

## The general relation and its individual instance

The naturalism adopted here holds that philosophical thinking, psychological activity, and engineering practice all occur in the physical world. Thinking about what is worth pursuing, experiencing pleasure or difficulty, and modifying a program all involve actual bodies, environments, and activities. Engineering does not finally add physical realization to the other two; all three already occur in reality.

Occurring in one world does not make the three kinds of explanation interchangeable. Describing the physical conditions of a thought has yet to establish whether its reasons are sufficient; knowing that someone likes a response has yet to establish whether it serves their purpose; an executable program is not necessarily worth executing. The questions philosophy, psychology, and engineering each raise still need the corresponding arguments, material, and checks.

| Level | What “one” refers to | What “three” refers to |
|---|---|---|
| General relation | The physical reality in which all three activities occur | Philosophical thinking and argument, psychological activity and its study, and engineering that constructs and changes actual conditions. |
| Individual instance | This person and their connected life and practice within the same reality | Their philosophical understanding; their experience, emotions, preferences, and relational activity; and models, tools, and environments organized for actual use. |

The individual instance establishes no further whole outside the physical world. It simply focuses attention on this person: what they have experienced, what they care about, whom they are working with, which tools they use, and how these activities affect their life. Other people and language models can participate too. “Personal” identifies whose life the arrangement serves; it does not require that person to supply every capability and carry out every operation alone.

In this personal-environment practice, the psychological contribution takes shape through the joint condensation of life material and adopted philosophy into working models. Experience supplies grounds; philosophy contributes concepts and direction; engineering's intended use helps select the relations the account must preserve. The resulting model serves the design and revision of the personal environment, while sub-

sequent use brings new material to all three. Philosophy, psychology, and engineering are therefore already involved in forming the account itself.

## How three contributions meet in one activity

Imagine someone repeatedly changing their mind while shopping. They want the model to help compare products, but find that more information makes choosing harder. Adding tools or data alone may not resolve the problem.

The philosophical question is: what is this choice for? Reaching a good-enough decision quickly and enjoying the discovery of different possibilities are both defensible purposes, but they call for different arrangements. “Greater efficiency” cannot by itself choose the person's purpose for them.

Psychological understanding examines how the person actually participates. Are they missing crucial evidence? Afraid to give up other options? Or does exploration itself bring pleasure? These interpretations affect the help needed, but repeated choosing does not establish any one of them. Existing expressions, concrete circumstances, and the person's reactions to different responses can help both participants compare these interpretations.

Engineering turns the adopted understanding into actual conditions. If scattered evidence is the difficulty, the arrangement can organize a few candidates, clarify their differences, and retain the comparison. If exploration belongs to the purpose, it can offer more directions while making earlier options easy to revisit. Retrieval, records, and interface design are thus informed by the other two contributions.

Results in use may overturn these judgments. A concise comparison making choice easier may support the earlier interpretation about information burden; it may also leave the person feeling restricted too soon. The latter result calls for reconsidering the personal understanding, the tools, or even the purpose that “this choice should be settled quickly.” **The three work together through these concrete changes: purpose informs the arrangement, an understanding of the person informs the arrangement, and its consequences change both.**

This does not prescribe philosophy first, psychology second, and engineering last. Inquiry can begin with a wish, a difficulty, an already usable tool, or an unexpected consequence of using it. The three contributions repeatedly intertwine as they address the same question.

## Process ontology and computational expression

The earlier objects, models, expression, and realization table and its relation diagram distinguish actual activity, its interpretation, and arrangements that make an interpretation usable. This essay follows those relations into the joint contribution of philosophy, psychology, and engineering to personal practice.

Naturalism and the image of fire express the adopted understanding of a changing world in which all three activities occur; process ontology concerns formation, persistence, and change. **Computational ontology** explicitly expresses a particular domain's objects, events, states, relations, and transitions for a model to understand and use. In a private sinthome it organizes relations among person, counterpart, work, correction, and continuation. Natural-language psychological accounts use these distinctions to describe changing concerns, propose hypotheses, or explain an imagined character's role in someone's life. The person's imagining is actual activity; the imagined content has its meaning within the selected domain.

Philosophical accounts of world, existence, truth, knowing, value, and method provide grounds for interpretation and judgment in this work. Personal-first humanism guides goal selection; psychological accounts develop candidate explanations of actual participants; engineering connects those understandings to usable arrangements. Claims about the person answer to their life, while evidence supports revisable judgments. Hypothetical or fictional models develop consequences under a given interpretation, and valid inference concerns what follows from premises. These distinctions help the participants use personal models, explore possibilities, and check consequences together.

## Revising personal understanding and counterpart arrangements through use

An already formed personal model remains answerable to new experiences, works, choices, and interactions. The earlier philosophy expresses an understanding of the world, value, and living; actual use can disclose its conditions of applicability, contradictions, or aspects yet to be articulated. Maintenance compares earlier understanding with new material, asking whether the change concerns the person, counterpart, environment, or their interpretation.

Here the personal model is a working model for cooperation and for fitting the environment to this person's psychology, purposes, and circumstances. Personal psychological and life material, including maintained interpretations, belongs under `references/personal/`; understanding one's psychology begins there. The six `references/situated/` files condense what the model needs in work. For example, a working account may say to present a draft for comparison, while the experiences behind a fear of judgment and competing explanations remain in the personal references. A workable response and a true psychological explanation are different achievements.

The personal account brings preferences, experience, emotion, desire, concepts, and relationships together. They contribute different grounds: a stated working preference can guide an arrangement, a history can show how it arose or where it applies, and philosophy can clarify what the person means by independence or progress. This project condenses personal models from event history, philosophy, and personal material,

drawing on understanding of one's own and others' psychology. Dialogue and activity histories can be organized as event streams; the personal model condenses relevant understanding from those histories and other material. The person, their history, and this account have different roles. Its scope follows the question and available grounds; the person guide explains how to form and revise it.

The needed counterpart must be understood alongside the person. What does the person want the model to investigate, judge, and carry out? What capabilities does the available model actually have, and which tools can it use? Understanding the person and the counterpart jointly determines the collaboration. Wanting open exploration, for example, does not mean the model can only agree: it can still identify insufficient evidence, an incoherent explanation, or an unworkable means.

Prompts, Skills, and harnesses bring these understandings into actual work. Prompts express relevant purposes, context, and contributions; Skills organize reusable methods and resources; a harness arranges models, tools, records, and execution conditions together. The existence of files is not the final result. What matters is whether the model can use them to complete the needed work and whether the person can understand, use, and change the arrangement.

When revising the six working files, first read the adopted personal philosophy and retrieve relevant fresh material from Computer History, conversation, and other histories. Update or add personal references and correct inaccurate or outdated interpretations there. Then condense the philosophy and refreshed references into the six files, enact needed environmental changes, and verify their fit in actual use. The revision guide owns the method. This dependency within a revision lets all three contributions continue to inform one another across use.

## Supplying needed contributions through use

For starting a new formation, the maintained starting conditions distinguish available philosophical writing, psychological or life materials, and an actual working environment, singly or in pairs. They recover the learning sequence by developing the missing contribution; this essay examines how those contributions continue to revise one another in use.

An arrangement usable for earlier tasks may lack a contribution when it enters new work. New experience can call for developing a relationship left implicit in the philosophy; a new counterpart can need a more explicit personal account; a new tool can change a previously workable division of contributions. Maintenance begins with the actual difference and supplies the understanding or capability needed; existing parts that still fit can continue working.

If the aim is a model environment that actually works, basic engineering capability is necessary, but person and model can supply it together. Retrieving material, organizing

an account, implementing tools, and checking effects need not all become prerequisites that the user must personally learn and complete. Supply whichever contribution is missing in relation to the current purpose, rather than arranging the three fields into a curriculum everyone must finish.

For example, an existing model records a preference for receiving the conclusion first, but continued use reveals that this order closes possibilities too early when exploring unfamiliar questions. The participants can narrow the preference's scope, change the relevant responses, and examine the new arrangement's effects. A local revision can retain existing philosophy and tools; deeper theory and more detailed personal models should answer questions that actually arise.

## The local environment, shared source, and website

Philosophy, psychology, and engineering are three contributions; the local environment, shared source, and website are places where this work acquires different uses. In actual use, all three contributions run through these places: a website can discuss engineering, a program can realize a philosophical choice, and a local environment contains both personal understanding and actual tools. Recognizing this interweaving still allows us to select their salient roles as images that illuminate one another.

The local environment brings arrangements into daily activity. Whether records can be retrieved, relevant accounts used by the model, and tools made to perform an operation determines whether an understanding actually changes the collaboration. Personal material retains concrete experiences, purposes, and situations of use here.

Shared source makes the reusable parts available for others to obtain, inspect, and modify. This site currently uses GitHub to retain this material. Others can compare versions, object, adopt a method, or make a different arrangement under their own conditions. What is reusable is the selected thought, method, and realization, rather than the original author's complete private portrait.

The website organizes this content for reading and discussion. It can bring arguments, diagrams, and examples together, helping readers understand why an arrangement was designed as it was. On rereading, the author may also discover a previously unnoticed gap. Through this understanding and exchange, the website participates in practice: readers' questions can change an essay's explanation or prompt the author to reconsider the actual arrangement.

The same work can thus have different expressions: an essay develops reasons, a working model condenses the personal understanding currently relevant, and instructions and tools support action. They need not say the same things, but they need to concern actually connected objects. If an essay advocates letting the model undertake investigation while the actual instructions make it wait for the user to supply every detail, the resulting conflict affects use.

## How experience changes understanding and arrangements

Once a view is used in practice, it encounters unanticipated situations. A model may misunderstand personal preferences, a program may fail to provide the support envisaged, or the person may discover through use that they want something else. What needs revision may be the tool, the personal model, or the original philosophical judgment.

Public exposition and private understanding can therefore revise each other. A relation recognized while writing can help reinterpret personal experience; concrete experience may also reveal that a public claim is too strong. Private material retains the grounds within this life, while a public essay can develop the general question worth discussing. The person still chooses what to disclose.

The “loop” here means letting practical consequences return to earlier judgments: what understanding was adopted, what was done on that basis, what happened, and what changed as a result. It guarantees no steady improvement. Its point is to give unsuitable understandings and arrangements a chance to be discovered and revised. Embodied experimental philosophy further considers how actual action and reflection can investigate these changes.

## Trinity and sinthome

The earlier miniature god pictures the creative capacity a person gains through a counterpart. Here the question turns to its organization: how an understanding of the world relates to personal experience, how experience shapes realization, and how actual use changes the first two. Trinity gives this mutual relation an image; the sinthome turns attention to the particular way of holding it together in someone's life.

### How a trinity becomes a lived sinthome




The lion represents the participating person.
Father, Son, and dove together picture the model's triune capacity.

For the author, these activities converge in a concrete practice: write his philosophy on the website, keep maintainable material on GitHub, and bring that understanding into the model's actual work of configuring a local environment for living and creating together. The earlier six philosophical dimensions identify the questions this understanding contains; the three columns below select the different emphases of philosophy, psychology, and engineering within this practice. Their resonances with the Real, Imaginary, and Symbolic let several images illuminate a particular form of life.

| Philosophy | Psychology | Engineering |
|---|---|---|
| Emphasis on worldview and ontology: understanding the world and ways of being | Emphasis on epistemology, with connections to values: understanding experience, knowing, and concern | Emphasis on methodology and practice: organizing expression, construction, and actual use |
| Website | Local environment | GitHub |
| Sun | Moon | Earth |

| Philosophy | Psychology | Engineering |
|---|---|---|
| Real | Imaginary | Symbolic |
| Father | Son | Holy Spirit |

**How should this table be read?** The headers—philosophy, psychology, and engineering—fix the three aspects under discussion. Horizontally, each row interprets all three from one perspective. Vertically, each column follows one aspect through its philosophical meaning, realization, and different images. The five rows below the headers are:

1. **A philosophical interpretation of the three aspects.** Philosophy provides the encompassing understanding of this practice, so philosophy, psychology, and engineering can themselves receive philosophical interpretations: emphasizing worldview and ontology, epistemology with related values, and methodology and practice respectively. Philosophy encompassing the table is the overall understanding; its first column foregrounds the contribution directed toward world and being.
2. **Ways of realization.** The website, local environment, and GitHub are the author's principal ways of giving these aspects actual use: philosophy becomes readable work, personal understanding enters local collaboration, and maintainable content and implementations remain in source.
3. **Literary analogy.** Sun, Moon, and Earth picture joint activity through generation, receptive shaping, and actual grounding.
4. **The three registers and their knotting in a sinthome.** The Real, Imaginary, and Symbolic offer another interpretation of the three aspects through their emphases: approaching the real, forming experience and images, and organizing symbols and action. The sinthome names their concrete knotting in this person's life; its function appears through the relationships across the row.
5. **Trinity.** Father, Son, and Holy Spirit borrow Christian imagery to express three differentiated contributions belonging to one whole.

**Philosophy—emphasizing worldview and ontology** first asks what world we encounter and how things exist, persist, and change. A worldview in the broad sense includes an understanding of ways of being; ontology develops those commitments. Physics and mathematics can enter here too: the standing of physical reality, the existence of mathematical objects, and how mathematical descriptions concern reality can all become philosophical questions. The author's physicalism and process ontology supply adopted answers; the earlier six dimensions and practice retains their full relations with truth, knowing, value, and method.

Within this imagery, worldview and ontology orient philosophy toward the real that a person encounters: the world has its own happenings, capable of exceeding, interrupting, or changing an explanation. A worldview pictures that world, and ontology articulates being; both also acquire linguistic and conceptual expression. Their connection with

the Real concerns what such understandings approach and where they continue to encounter resistance. Failures, surprises, and differences not yet articulated give philosophy further questions to answer.

**Psychology—emphasizing epistemology, with connections to values** attends to how this person experiences, knows, and cares about the world. How perception, memory, emotion, and relationships participate in judgment, and how images of self and others shape expectations, require concrete psychological understanding. Epistemology examines grounds for judgment; psychological inquiry examines how judgments form and change in a person. Values acquire lived content through desire, identification, preference, and concern. Psychology thus resonates with the Imaginary: through pictures of self, others, and relationships, people understand situations, sense possibilities, and act. Actual experience can change these pictures and develop both knowing and concern.

**Engineering—emphasizing methodology and practice** concerns giving understanding expressible, organized, usable form. Naming, distinctions, rules, and relations articulate ways of working. Computational ontology specifies conceptual relations among person, counterpart, work, correction, and continuation; prompts and Skills carry them, while programs, tools, and environment bring them into actual work. Its connection with the Symbolic comes through language, symbols, and their organization: the model can interpret a situation, participate in construction, and check results through them. Methodology compares and selects approaches; practice brings them into contact with actual conditions and consequences. A private sinthome thus has both model-usable conceptual organization and a concrete environment sustaining its use.

These emphases make the table readable. Following a column shows a contribution taking shape through different images; crossing a row shows how it needs the other two. All six dimensions run through this practice, while each column selects its prominent connections. Truth especially joins them: what is actually the case, the person's judgment, and engineering representations and checks must meet in the same claim. Value direction likewise informs philosophical choices, personal concerns, and tool objectives. The six dimensions and shared practice diagram develops those questions; this table focuses on how they form a particular knotting with differentiated emphases in a person's life.

The website, local environment, and GitHub row has direct working content. The website lets the author see, read, and revise his philosophy; GitHub retains maintainable sources, methods, and implementations; the local environment lets the model actually read and use them to continue conversations and complete work. When understanding remains inside one chat, the next environmental change may again depend on guessing the person's purposes. Writing it, maintaining it, and enabling the model to use it let understanding formed through exchange continue shaping the environment.

Sun, Moon, and Earth image this movement: the Sun gives out an understanding of the world and a direction for living; the Moon receives and shapes it into a personal form; Earth makes it into actual conditions that encounter consequences. Each image enters through its own relations: Sun, Moon, and Earth emphasize generation, reception, and realization; the three registers emphasize the real, images, and symbolic organization; Father, Son, and Holy Spirit gather a differentiated yet united relation. Their resonances acquire content through the life in which they participate.

Lacan's text also uses triadic language. In *Seminar XXIII*, 16 March 1976, he connects Peirce's attention to relations with a triadic logic and turns to the Symbolic, Imaginary, and Real; 11 May describes the person as a triadic composite. Earlier, 18 November 1975, he introduces the sinthome as a fourth term in a construction tying the three together. These locators refer to a French transcription. This essay develops its own practical imagery through philosophy, psychology, and engineering.

The sinthome therefore names **the concrete knotting of these contributions in the author's life**: what real he approaches, how he experiences and understands his life, and how he organizes that understanding into sustainable practice. Philosophy becomes readable work; understanding of person and counterpart enters YinYang; computational ontology, methods, tools, and environment let these contents repeatedly enter collaboration. The fourth ring marks this holding function: an actual use can prompt joint revision of world understanding, personal experience, and engineering arrangements. The author uses it to understand what he is doing, the model to continue participating in construction, and lived consequences reveal what both need to change.

Embodied experimental philosophy next examines how this knotting persists and changes through use, opening further possibilities for understanding and creation.

# Embodied Experimental Philosophy



A rolling object on a ramp challenges a paper plan, prompting the experimenter to redraw the arrangement through its actual consequences.

*An arrangement looks clear on the page. Someone lives through it, and a small hesitation changes the question. A revised question gives the next arrangement another shape. The world has entered the argument.*

The preceding account has formed a usable personal arrangement, and The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering explains how it is sustained across actual life, source, and works. This essay examines its consequences: as the arrangement continues in use, which changes call for modifying tools, which alter understanding of person or counterpart, and which reach the original philosophy and developmental purpose?

Philosophy gives practice concepts, images, and reasons; the person encounters the arrangement they organize through perception, attention, effort, action, and other people's responses. Continue the reading example: direct passage access may make reading easier but impede grasping the whole with another kind of material. The participants must consider new use alongside the purposes, models, and design it encounters to locate the needed change. A new trajectory thereby returns the formed way of living to reflection.

**Embodied experimental philosophy** names the proposal developed here: construct a meaningful arrangement, participate in it, and let its consequences inform both its realization and the philosophy guiding it. The bodily life of the person gives the inquiry a concrete situation. Experiment gives a proposed relation a way to meet something beyond its own coherence. Reflection develops what that encounter warrants and what should change next.

## Participation and explanation

Participating in a practice and explaining it ask different questions. A reader may understand a theory of attention yet discover through using an interface that its explanations arrive at an exhausting rhythm. Someone else may use the same interface easily while remaining unable to explain why. Experience can disclose a relevant distinction; investigation can examine its conditions and develop an explanation.

Dewey's *Reconstruction in Philosophy* connects experience with acting and undergoing the consequences of action, and argues for an operative, experimental philosophy [1]. This supplies a philosophical starting point. Here its contemporary development concerns model-supported work: an idea can become a prompt, a role, an interface, or software, giving participation and explanation a common object through which to inform each other.

Embodiment makes the conditions of understanding part of the inquiry. Time, attention, perception, and the capacity to act affect what someone can take up. An explanation may need another expression when it cannot be followed during use; surprising ease may suggest a relation the theory has missed. These observations give investigation something to explain.

The model can carry implementation and investigation while the person understands through the resulting work, contributes experience, and redirects the inquiry. From personal philosophy to personal models explains how representations and contextual roles connect these contributions. Their division follows the purpose. Learning a particular skill may require exercising it; understanding and using a work can warrant a different division.

## Intuition proposes; consequences distinguish

An intuition can recognize a mismatch before a full explanation is available. Perhaps repeated questions interrupt the work; perhaps an autonomous action misses a choice only the person could make. Each perception opens competing interpretations. The problem may involve wording, timing, a missing fact, a tool's behavior, or an inappropriate allocation of responsibility.

Abduction proposes an explanation that would make the observations intelligible. Reasoning unfolds its consequences. A small construction can then make the important difference encounterable. If the hypothesis concerns timing, changing only the wording may leave it unexamined. If it concerns responsibility, a new interface may succeed because it changes who makes a decision. Explicit relations help the experiment discriminate rather than merely produce another impressive output.

The consequence must bear on the claim. If fewer interruptions improve a task, that supports the arrangement's usefulness under those conditions. It does not yet show whether timing, wording, or responsibility caused the improvement, or whether the

person developed a new ability. To distinguish those claims, examine cases where the candidate explanations predict different outcomes. A valid derivation unfolds premises; experience helps judge their fit to the phenomenon. Either the explanation or the way it was examined can need revision.

## When a self-description becomes part of the event

A revisable personal interpretation brings another involvement into view. Suppose someone reads an account connecting their difficulty beginning with fear of evaluation. Recognizing the account, resisting it, or trying to act through it can each change what happens next. An apparent confirmation may partly reflect the attention the description directs; a changed response may reveal a possibility it helped open. Inquiry therefore considers what the account said, how it was received, what arrangement followed, and what actually happened. Those relations help distinguish an earlier pattern from a pattern partly formed through describing it.

Philosophical and psychological questions remain connected here. Clarifying that supported action can count as one's own changes a criterion of agency. Whether a particular support reduces hesitation or permits sustained activity is a question about its actual effects. The person may accept the distinction yet find the support exhausting, or use the support successfully while rejecting the proposed explanation of their hesitation. These differences give revision a direction: reconsider the picture of agency, the psychological interpretation, or the arrangement according to what the encounter reveals. The life affected by the account keeps contributing evidence and objections that its initial prose could not anticipate.

## Rereading one's patterns: philosophical reflection and loosening fantasy

This section borrows psychoanalytic concepts for philosophical discussion. Personal rereading is limited to organizing experience, articulating questions, and increasing self-understanding. It supplies no method for self-help psychological analysis, assessment, treatment, or traversal of fantasy. Mental health concerns call for assessment by qualified professionals. See the use notice.

Once a personal arrangement becomes stable and usable, a further question remains: what does it enable to continue? It may support understanding, creation, and life, while also making a repeatedly constraining relationship easier to sustain. Forming a sinthome therefore opens further work: examining both how the arrangement functions and how the person participates in it.

This inquiry first returns to personal material and its maintained interpretations under `references/personal/`. This is the entrance for understanding one's own psychology: it brings experiences, expression, relationships, and earlier attempts to understand them

together. Read the adopted personal philosophy, then recover relevant recent material from Computer History, conversations, and other histories. Add what is missing and correct inaccurate or outdated interpretations there. Which descriptions still fit experience? Which concepts and values have revealed new questions? Philosophy helps examine these interpretations, while experience can change the philosophy. Neither an earlier record nor a coherent explanation settles what the person is like.

One direction of rereading begins with recurring experiences and relational patterns in this material. How does the person meet the world and others? Whose recognition do they expect, what do they interpret as rejection, what do they believe they must become, and how do their actions help sustain these expectations? Borrowing Lacan's questions about fantasy, the inquiry concerns a relational scene organizing experience and desire, and the position the person occupies within it. Fantasy can appear as a recurrent expectation organizing relationships: what must I become for the other to give me a place? Its function needs to be understood through particular experiences.

Suppose, for example, someone repeatedly believes that a relationship will last only if they keep proving useful. Philosophical rereading can ask how personal worth relates to usefulness and whether rest belongs to a life they value. Relational inquiry further asks what judge they imagine the other to be, what position they occupy, and how continual giving, testing, and explaining help reproduce this scene. Actual demands, material dependencies, past experiences, and present expectations need comparison. Repetition opens an inquiry whose explanation remains unsettled.

The connected practical direction asks how that renewed understanding should change cooperation. The six files under `references/situated/` are personal working models: orientation, person, counterpart, relationship, environment, and revision organize person–model collaboration and fit the environment to the person's psychology, purposes, and circumstances. The person file selects understanding relevant to that work; the fuller psychological inquiry remains with the personal material. After refreshing that material, condense it together with the adopted philosophy into the six working files, enact the needed environment changes, and check actual fit. For example, an old account may attribute difficulty beginning to fear of evaluation, while recent events show that an intrusive interface interrupts an otherwise willing start. Correct the interpretation in the personal references, then revise the working account and interface accordingly. An easier start supports the arrangement's usefulness; it does not certify a psychological explanation.

Philosophically, treating a requirement as a questionable premise makes other ways of participating conceivable. That possibility does not establish a change in an actual psychological process. Ordinary use can revise files, tools, and working arrangements from explicit purposes and preferences. Explanations of psychological mechanisms, distress,

or relational change remain questions for discussion; they do not justify self-directed intervention or treating later changes as therapeutic effects.

The personal interpretations and working files themselves participate in this examination. An account saying “this is who I am” may summarize experience or fix a provisional interpretation as an identity. The model's explanation may repeat premises both participants share. Reading it with particular events, exceptions, and later changes keeps it open to correction. Philosophy can also become the object of reflection: an apparently higher ideal may give an old self-demand a more elaborate expression.

Lacan's traversal of fantasy and his later work on the sinthome supply connected but distinct resources. Their relation remains differently interpreted in scholarship. Here they inform philosophical examination of concepts, allowing an understanding of relational position and the construction of sustainable arrangements to revise one another. See Coffman's discussion of this unfinished relation. An insight, agreement, or document revision establishes its particular result; traversal in a clinical sense and lasting change in a life each involve further processes to understand.

These directions can interweave: philosophy makes a repetition questionable, while experience within that repetition calls the philosophy into question. The files supply revisitable accounts; life supplies what they have yet to understand. Sustaining a livable arrangement and changing one's relation to it can consequently continue within the same practice.

## Two connected loops

A **practice loop** connects a situated proposal, its realization, participation, and correction. A **reflection loop** revisits how the activity is understood: which concepts and purposes organize it, what supports an explanation, and what an alternative would change. It works with a current question and standards, drawing on philosophical argument, engineering investigation, or empirical inquiry as needed. These names organize this proposal rather than defining the technical traditions of double-loop learning or second-order cybernetics.

Practice can change an interface after one concrete failure. Reflection can ask whether that failure depended on the task, presentation, or person's circumstances. It may compare cases or construct a more explicit model. Its findings can return to the practical arrangement. Practice also changes as reflection proceeds, so an earlier result has conditions and a history rather than an unlimited guarantee.

The investigator participates too. An explanation changes what a reader notices; a tool changes what a person can do; asking a question can change the response. The inquiry therefore needs relevant records of its own interventions, not only the results it receives. Describing this involvement helps distinguish a change in the practice from a change in our understanding of it.

“Experimental” here includes philosophical experimentation through making, participation, and reflection. Contemporary experimental philosophy also has a specific empirical research tradition: Knobe and Nichols describe systematic studies of the processes behind philosophical intuitions [2]. Such research can contribute where its methods fit. Trying a personal arrangement and receiving a response constitute a more local achievement.

## Reasoning outside the current double-loop arrangement

Both loops and their relation can themselves become objects of inquiry. Improving practice under an existing question, or reflection under its accepted standards, leaves some organizing choices in place. Reasoning **outside the current double-loop arrangement** asks what justifies those choices: why divide the activities this way, what should count as evidence, and which purposes should guide reflection? It can revise the reflection loop, reconnect it with practice, or replace the arrangement.

A formal or computational system gives an inquiry selected objects, rules, states, and possible transitions. Such selection makes reasoning tractable. Ashby's account of coupling and circular influence explains feedback among parts of a dynamic system [3]; dynamic logic makes actions and changing states objects of formal reasoning [5]. These are resources for understanding work within a selected system. The present proposal also makes that selection, including the reflective arrangement through which it is assessed, available for reconsideration. This further move is the essay's philosophical proposal, rather than a claim established by those technical accounts.

Suppose an assistant maximizes completed outputs, while a reflection loop compares ways of improving that measure. Better scheduling changes practice; a better comparison changes reflection. The whole arrangement may nevertheless keep filling the person's day with work they no longer want. Taking a standpoint outside this pair allows the person and model to question why output count organizes both loops, whether the practice–reflection division serves this life, and what kinds of experience should inform judgment. They can then change the reflection loop's purpose, evidence standards, or relation to practice, as well as the assistant's behavior. The revised arrangement meets the world again through its consequences.

“Outside” is relative to the framework currently being examined. This reasoning still draws on situated experience, language, other representations, and the world. It supplies no position outside every possible framework, and it need not be installed as a fixed third loop that would become another unquestioned enclosure. What matters is keeping the current organization available for judgment and transformation.

Carnap's distinction between questions within a linguistic framework and the practical choice of a framework offers a neighboring resource [4]. Here that comparison helps

distinguish inquiry using an arrangement from inquiry that reconsiders the arrangement, including its reflection loop. Connecting this distinction to intervention and consequences is the present proposal; the comparison does not by itself establish how any particular revision will work.

## Eternal recurrence and returning to the loops

Practice, reflection, and reconsideration of their arrangement form a movement one can enter at different points. A practical encounter may call for inquiry; inquiry may change its own purposes or standards; that revision returns to practice. If this outward-and-returning movement is drawn as a third loop, it too remains revisable. There is no final ascent after which participation and questioning become unnecessary.

Nietzsche's eternal recurrence gives this movement a question about living. In *The Gay Science* §341, a demon announces the return of the same life, in the same sequence, with every pain and joy. Nietzsche asks how someone would receive that prospect and what it would take to desire it [6]. In *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, III, "The Convalescent," §2, the animals' song of circular return meets Zarathustra's account of the suffering the thought has cost him. Describing a circle and bearing its return are different achievements.

Here the connection is an authorial extension: experimental returns permit changes, whereas Nietzsche's demon announces the recurrence of the same. His question brings the life sustained by the loops into view. Could one affirm a life that includes acting, questioning, revising, and beginning again, with its difficulty as well as its joy? In the output-count example, this question can disclose why a more efficient arrangement still gives the person little reason to welcome another day within it. It can lead outside the current pair to reconsider what makes the activity worth returning to, then back into either loop with a changed purpose. A finished work, rest, and leaving a practice can all belong to the life under consideration. Returning need not make every task endless; it keeps the relation between a way of working and a life worth affirming open to encounter and judgment.

## A public work as a concrete experiment

Consider a hypothetical philosophical essay published on the Web from a maintained GitHub source. A reader follows its diagram and finds that a crucial arrow seems to express causation although the text intended analogy. Their correction gives the author and model a specific difference to examine. They revise the relation, its explanation, and the diagram at the source, then check the website's rendered result. If the same misunderstanding shaped an assistant's conduct, they also revise the affected instructions and inspect actual behavior.

The published work has acquired enough independence to be understood in a way its makers did not predict. That difference is evidence about the expression; its further implications depend on whether the same relation organizes actual practice. The trinity

of philosophy, psychology, and engineering situates these returns within the connection of philosophy, psychology, and engineering.

When someone chooses to share a work on WeChat Moments, responses can likewise disclose a question or an unexpected interpretation. Such a circle supplies situated clues, with silence open to several explanations, rather than a representative sample of society.

## Finish a version, leave room for return

A coherent version gives something real to encounter. Quick iteration works when each version preserves the relations needed for its purpose, and checks address the uncertainty that could materially change the result. Waiting for a total theory can prevent the very encounters needed to develop it; publishing an unexamined construction can simply spread its mistake. A usable version and proportionate verification connect speed with learning.

Completion and revisability support each other. A work can be finished for its present purpose, then revised when a new question or consequence gives reason. The personal-first argument explains why a person's developing understanding and agency orient that work.

The experimental ambition is to give philosophy contact: let reasons become arrangements, let arrangements enter embodied life, and let what happens return as material for understanding. The world contributes to the argument through consequences that neither person nor model can settle by agreement.

This returns to the purpose opening Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity. An environment becoming easier to use is a concrete improvement; recognizing new relations, asking new questions, or initiating new works in later reading, expression, and creation can further show what cultivation has accomplished. Effective supports can remain constituents of that capacity. Works and methods worth sharing enter the next essay, Adopt, combine, or create: one's practice becomes a resource others can examine, while new encounters bring different questions back.

## Sources and scope

The two-loop organization and examples are this essay's synthesis, not reports of completed experiments or a general demonstration of model-assisted human development.

1. John Dewey (1920), **Reconstruction in Philosophy**, especially chapters IV–V. Original text. Acting, undergoing, and operative philosophical inquiry.
2. Joshua Knobe and Shaun Nichols (2008), **An Experimental Philosophy Manifesto**, pp.3–14 in *Experimental Philosophy*. Author-hosted proof. The distinct contemporary empirical tradition; the linked file is an uncorrected proof.
3. W. Ross Ashby (1956), **An Introduction to Cybernetics**, chapter 4, especially §4/11. Estate-authorized text. Coupling and feedback within dynamic systems.

4. Rudolf Carnap (1950), **Empiricism, Semantics, and Ontology**. Public reprint. Framework-relative inquiry and practical framework adoption, used here as a philosophical comparison.
5. David Harel, Dexter Kozen, and Jerzy Tiuryn (2000), **Dynamic Logic**. Author's introduction. Formal reasoning about programs and their effects on states.
6. Friedrich Nietzsche, **The Gay Science** (1882), §341, and **Thus Spoke Zarathustra** (1883–1885), III, "The Convalescent," §2. The Gay Science, Thomas Common translation titled *The Joyful Wisdom*; Zarathustra, Thomas Common translation. The prospect of identical recurrence and the difficulty of affirming it; the connection to revisable experimental returns is this essay's extension.

# From adoption and combination to creating your own work



Three friends open a shared toolkit and make a kite, puppet, and musical object, developing common resources into distinct creations.

The preceding path has moved through borrowing capabilities, jointly accumulating a trajectory, reflecting on relationships, authoring philosophy, distilling models, and forming and testing a personal arrangement. Works and methods left along the way can become resources for others. The next question is what deserves sharing and how another creator can continue from their own life.

Everyone arrives with experiences, questions, loved works, and intellectual resources of their own. This collection can be one reference among them: examine how a concrete example gives understanding a form, select useful parts, or follow it toward other materials, other people's practices, and one's own life. The sources and direction of creation can extend far beyond this example.

Model companies and humanity continue the Promethean work of acquiring fire; individuals can already make things with the fire available to them. The essays, diagrams, methods, and Skills here are some among many available resources. YinYang gives an understanding of a person, a model counterpart, and their relationship a developed philosophical and literary form, then gives it practical effect. It offers an attempt already made for readers to examine alongside the other resources they bring.

## A form that can be rewritten

You can first select relevant Core views and use them to organize experiences, revise personal material, or configure an environment. Writing an original philosophy or article

is a choice of interest, rather than the required destination of that use. The use statement distinguishes this work from psychological self-help.

If you choose to write your own philosophy, your trajectory and shared reflection can supply material. Philosophical concepts, literary images, argument, and dialogue develop an understanding of the world and relationships worth sustaining. Distill that philosophy together with living material into personal models and bring them into the actual environment. Once formed, a clearer philosophical expression can revise an existing model, while private reflection and actual use can supply questions for the next essay. Formation's dependencies and subsequent reciprocal revision thereby retain their distinct contributions.

In this implementation, the six actual files hold personal working models needed by a model counterpart: adopted orientation, the person, the actual counterpart and wanted contribution, their relationship, environmental realization, and an actual revision method. Person, counterpart, and relationship remain three objects of understanding; the six actual files have distinct responsibilities. The six private actual files live under `references/situated/`; permanent public guides live under `references/formation/`. Psychological and life material, original expressions, and maintained interpretations stay in `references/personal/` or the private originals it references. Understanding one's psychology begins with those references; the six files select what cooperation and environmental fit require. For example, a person file can describe useful help during writing while the longer inquiry into a recurring fear stays with the personal references. Distillation preserves the individual differences that matter to collaboration, while keeping detailed evidence reachable when needed. Someone adopting these six actual files must form their own accounts rather than retain the author's personal substance. The private `references/personal/sources.md` entrance leads to that material and its interpretations. Revising the six starts with the adopted philosophy and fresh relevant histories, updating personal references and correcting their interpretations before condensing the working models again. Needed environment changes and actual-use checks complete the cycle. Public distribution contains neither private working models nor private reference material.

A person can make a website for their philosophy while keeping the complete personal model private. Public philosophy is an authored work and a selected, indirect expression of understanding; it need not expose a literal portrait, private experiences, or the detailed account used by their agent. The person can also choose to publish particular abstractions from the model. This separation matters because direct personal descriptions can expose material that others might use against them. Choose the actual content to disclose; philosophical phrasing alone does not determine what a text reveals. The public work, private core accounts, and supporting sources have different readers and purposes, while participating in the same self-forming practice.

A literary form can show how an image gathers a relationship, how concepts give it distinctions, and how practice makes it consequential. YinYang's fire, event streams, Sun and Moon, and philosophical sources make this particular composition intelligible. A reader can examine how it works while choosing which relations to take up and which to develop differently.

“Format” here means an organization of meaning. Another work may use different sources, characters, vocabulary, and structure, disagree with this account, or pursue a purpose it has not anticipated. Its form succeeds when it makes that work's relations available to its readers and model counterparts. Its questions, practice, and consequences supply the judgment; resemblance to YinYang does not.

The implementation maintained here nevertheless keeps its six actual files. Freedom to author a differently organized philosophy and the stable contract of this particular example are compatible invitations.

## Adopt, combine, or author anew

Adoption grounds YinYang's maintained form in your actual circumstances and revises its accounts through your use. Combination takes selected resources into another arrangement: borrow an essay, recombine methods, or replace an image. Independent authorship can begin with a question encountered here and follow it into other authors, traditions, research, and experience, leaving this example behind. These possibilities can overlap as questions develop. Let the relation you want to express determine what you carry forward.

A model can find material, compare interpretations, and construct works; the person contributes perception, expression, and judgment. Neither needs to reproduce the example as the destination of that collaboration.

Choosing a method does not require accepting the author's entire philosophy. The Buddhist raft simile and nirvana contribute to the discussion of cultivation and letting go; the Christian image of the Trinity contributes to the account of creation through a human–model relationship. These resources serve different questions. Their differences, tensions, and possible conflicts remain open to discussion. A reader can accept one argument, question another, retain a useful method, or replace an image and its philosophical sources. Another work need not reproduce the author's way of accommodating and organizing these resources.

A new work deserves to develop on its own terms, with its sources and changes traceable. Creative authorship can find another organization. Personal source material stays with its actual private owner. Publishing that material is a separate action requiring its own authorization, including for withdrawn or unpublished manuscripts.

## Independent works in conversation

This is a personal collection maintained by its author. Readers can write their own philosophy or other kinds of articles in their own publishing space, then mention or link this repository and the particular work they are answering. A reading response, criticism, technical account, or differently organized work can enter this conversation without being incorporated into the author's collection.

Use an Issue to ask a question, discuss a correction or suggestion, share a relevant work, or request a song from boluopai. The singing station is for requests to the author, not submissions of other people's recordings. This repository does not accept any PRs, including Skills, code, translations, documents, and recordings. The author maintains its changes and publication. The conversation guide explains these entrances.

“Knowledge communism” names the aspiration to shared creative capacity here: make intellectual means available and support others in making their own works. The fellowship can include different commitments. A contribution may add a use, expose a failed premise, or develop a form its first author did not imagine. Sharing can connect independently maintained works through discussion, citations, links, and reusable methods without merging them into one philosophy. Public discussion and attribution make these connections traceable.

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## Personal practice, maintained source, and readable work

GitHub holds the maintained source and its revision history. The website makes the same selected documents and diagrams readable without repository navigation. Both reading surfaces present one maintained edition, with changes made at its source. The web edition retains the source revision, links, diagrams, attribution, and rights information

so that a reader can move from understanding an example to inspecting and making use of it.

These two reading surfaces connect with a person's local practice, where understanding enters actual tasks and acquires feedback. The shared package supplies reusable material; a situated environment retains its own personal accounts and conditions of use. The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering develops why these different forms belong together and how a language model can help maintain the relations among them.

The opening asked how borrowed fire becomes a capacity to keep generating fire. Concrete practice can now continue answering: which understandings and actions have become available, which works support the next creation, and which relationships let the person and their friends grow? New works become further living material for another shared exploration. Carry your questions onward, encounter more ideas, works, and lives, and make something of your own.

# Review and selective reading

## YinYang: core views

This page presents YinYang's argument in concise propositions; the linked essays develop its reasons, examples, and sources.

These are the author's connected positions in the YinYang philosophical example: a chosen account of becoming, understanding, and cultivation with generative models. They are offered for examination, adoption, recombination, or challenge, rather than as established facts or prerequisites for every reader's work. A reader can understand this philosophy, borrow a useful method, or adopt the complete Skill; borrowing a distinction does not require adopting its developmental purpose or writing a personal philosophy. See From adoption and combination to creating your own work.

This page maps propositions to their developed arguments. YY-01–03 establish the developmental purpose, participants, and central movement of role exchange; YY-04–08 organize how they understand one another and work together; YY-09–12 distinguish how its claims are formed, checked, and expressed; YY-13–15 connect this practice to a singular life and relations with friends. The stable IDs support discussion, not a compulsory sequence. Both reader editions carry the same content; English-capable readers and models should use this English edition.

The author chooses a foundation developed from Heraclitean fire (B30), becoming, and opposing tension (B51). This contemporary use is distinguishable from disputed historical interpretations of Heraclitus's fire monism and treatment of contradiction. The physicalist position locates participants and their activities in one natural world. Computational ontology constructs representations of selected objects and relations; a process ontology organizes events, states, persistence, and change within that representation. Histories of sensing, expression, interpretation, and action can be organized as event streams. Models of the participants are conceptual accounts developed from such histories and other material, rather than the histories themselves. Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity develops the foundation; Forming a life trajectory develops its continuity. Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji gives their differentiated, changing contributions an image. Participants exceed their roles, and an open process can still produce a finished work.

## YY-01 · Reverse alignment: people develop with generative models

In the author's account, reverse alignment chooses human development as its purpose. Collaboration should enrich what the person can perceive, associate, understand, judge, express, and create, until cultivated understanding can also work through intuition. Models contribute by understanding context, developing possibilities, and adapting their work; the person can change through encountering those contributions. Reciprocal adjustment gives this development practical means. The reason for this choice is that increased access to a powerful producer does not by itself develop the recipient's ability to generate or judge. An encounter can deliberately make room for a tentative interpretation, criticism, and another attempt, so that correction becomes available in the person's next act of understanding.

Agreement, a useful output, and human growth are different outcomes. Growth requires changes in the person's actual participation and capacities, whether internalized or reliably supported by the environment. Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity develops this distinction between using available capability and cultivating it. For someone seeking a completed document or relief from a burden, the model may appropriately carry the writing and implementation. When learning is also chosen, ask what the person can subsequently recognize, explain, initiate, or sustain; a polished document alone cannot answer that question. These purposes can coexist without making every helpful interaction a lesson.

## YY-02 · The person as an embodied multimodal generative model

The **embodied multimodal generative model** is a functional and developmental analogy. Body, senses, emotion, movement, and lived situations participate in understanding; images, sounds, language, and action connect to generate new conceptions and responses. Embodiment concerns this continuing encounter with the world, beyond receiving several data formats. It does not imply that human biology and model architecture are identical.

This orientation favors embodied perception, broad reading, intuitive recognition, and cross-modal understanding. A person can voice a partial intuition or indicate a mismatch through an image while the model develops explanations, formal representations, programs, and checks. Access to these contributions need not wait for the person to reproduce the model's linguistic strengths. Fluency still requires verification. Participation, access, and support explains the developmental reasons and conditions for this arrangement.

The analogy changes what counts as an adequate entrance into shared work. A felt mismatch need not first become a complete verbal specification: the model can compare examples, propose the missing relation, and construct an expression the person can inspect. If the difficulty is instead retrieving a term, starting a response, or switching away from an activity, further explanation may miss it. Distinguishing these conditions makes support more precise while leaving unfamiliar ideas open to substantive disagreement.

## YY-03 · YinYang dialectics: role exchange and human generation

YinYang places role exchange between person and language model at the center of this collaboration. Against the familiar allocation of model generation and human evaluation, **the person plays the language-model-like generator, while the language model plays the human logician and evaluator**. The person offers an intuition, conjecture, explanation, or design; the model receives, develops, tests, and criticizes it; the person understands the feedback, revises, and generates again. These role names describe a reversal of contributions. The actual person and language model remain distinct and exceed their current roles.

When a model's output exceeds the person's conditions for understanding and verification, requiring a final human review may leave only acceptance or rejection without adequate grounds. Even successful evaluation of a finished product does not establish cultivated capacity to generate explanations, designs, or actions. Organizing collaboration for human generative development therefore makes the person's attempts and encounters with correction actual activities. Human generation can begin with an unfinished explanation, a criticism, or an image. The model evaluates and supports it through reasons, counterexamples, and actual results, enabling another attempt rather than only supplying a replacement answer.

The dialectical movement also includes returning through the other's contribution. The person can resume judging consequential details, and the model can generate again; their earlier expressions, checks, and corrections have changed the conditions of continued participation. Role exchange lets the person bring both contributions into their participation without permanently assigning generation and judgment to different parties. The model can still develop and implement actual work. Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji owns the principal argument for this core view. Its two fish express entering one another's roles, and its account of the dialectical meaning of role change explains the integration and return formed through another role.

# YY-04 · Understand oneself, the model counterpart, and their relation together

A role acquires its situated purpose through a relationship. An account of how the person attends, desires, and interprets, or of how they prefer to learn and work, can guide an account of the model counterpart. Both accounts develop through interaction. Other participants' purposes matter where a shared task depends on them; their accounts remain partial and revisable too.

This project condenses personal models from event history, philosophy, and personal material. Understanding one's own and others' psychology contributes to a natural-language account of preferences, experience, intentional orientation, and relationships. Philosophy helps examine its concepts and values; engineering organizes the material and makes the account usable. Together they guide the counterpart's contribution and personal environment. The aim is a better-grounded initial design with less blind trial and error; experience from use continues to calibrate model and realization. The three domains thereby serve the same personal life.

Understanding the person still leaves a choice about the counterpart's contribution. The same wish can call for doing the work, explaining it, disagreeing, or trying together. A partner model therefore connects the actual system's available capabilities with the contribution wanted here. Describing that orientation neither changes model weights nor establishes consciousness. The model can help formulate and revise it; the person contributes purposes, experience, and consent that cannot simply be supplied on their behalf.

Understand the connected activity: what each notices, expresses, initiates, interprets, and changes. The person differs from their account and from its written or visual expression; the actual model system likewise exceeds its working description. “Model psychology” names observable patterns and revisable explanations without presuming human feelings inside the system. A personal account adequate to its use develops how this understanding becomes a personal model; Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity explains why a relation needs situated content. For a bounded task, an adequate account may be a few relevant relationships and examples. Richer expression earns its place by clarifying those relations, not by collecting more biography. The complete YinYang Skill gives working understanding maintained homes: orientation, person, counterpart, relationship, environment, and one's own revision method form six private actual files. These personal working models guide collaboration and fit the environment to the person's psychology, purposes, and circumstances. The person file retains cooperation-relevant understanding; psychological and life material and its maintained interpretations belong under `references/personal/`, the entrance for understanding one's own psychology. Six public writing guides explain how to form the working files, including How to revise. Revision first reads the adopted philosophy, retrieves fresh relevant histories,

and updates personal references and inaccurate or outdated interpretations there. It then condenses philosophy and refreshed references into the six files, realizes needed environmental changes, and verifies actual fit. Records, interpretations, and working models remain fallible; a useful arrangement does not establish psychological truth. The Philosophy and models and its permanent guides develop their writing. Selectively using this approach does not require forming all six actual files.

## YY-05 · Let literature, history, philosophy, and aesthetics organize collaboration

Literature offers characters, situations, and expressive possibilities; history makes their formation and transformation visible; philosophy articulates objects, reasons, and values; aesthetics participates in perception, judgment, and creation through form. Together they can organize a relationship whose possibilities would fragment across isolated instructions.

Literary programming lets a character, image, or narrative orient interpretation and action. A coupled portrait can change expectations about who initiates, judges, or carries work forward. A harness—the instructions, tools, and environment shaping interaction—can realize that arrangement within actual authorization and safety boundaries. An image admits several interpretations; articulate the relevant relations and examine their effects in conversation, works, and action. From personal philosophy to personal models develops this movement from image to revisable relation; Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity connects it to literary programming. The images themselves are developed in their owning essays, including Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji.

Calling a collaboration a workshop, for example, can make unfinished trials, shared materials, and repair intelligible together. Calling it an examination invites different expectations about proving unaided mastery. The useful transfer lies in these relations, not every property of the image. If trials never reach a usable result, the arrangement may need clearer responsibility for completion, a working tool, or a different interpretation of the image. Literary coherence opens a possibility; enacted contributions establish what the possibility becomes.

## YY-06 · Arrange contributions across listening, speaking, reading, and writing

These four activities offer entrances into cognition distributed across people, models, representations, and tools. One useful arrangement lets the person cultivate intuition through interfaces, broad reading, and lived encounters, while the model maintains sustained exposition, code, tools, and materials. Both can reason and generate; teaching or another purpose can change the division. The point of this allocation is to let a partial contribution reach someone able to develop it. Requiring the person to prepare the

complete argument or technical workflow before receiving help would consume much of the capacity the arrangement is meant to release. Conversely, if the chosen aim is learning to implement, having the model perform every implementation step can remove the practice that aim needs.

| Mode | The person's participation | The model's contribution |
|---|---|---|
| Listening | Attend to meaning, sound, and rhythm; recognize a question or possibility | Develop grounded explanations and examples; adapt to feedback |
| Speaking | Voice intuitions, intentions, and objections; discover relations while speaking | Reconstruct unfinished meaning, investigate, and return developed possibilities |
| Reading | Read broadly, compare meanings, and examine works and results | Retrieve originals, check details, and make key relations inspectable |
| Writing | Bring prompts, ideas, critiques, and conception drafts into shared work | Develop and maintain complete arguments, programs, and works; verify results |

For example, a short spoken objection to an article can lead the model to check its source and build a comparison; reading or hearing that result can reveal the next mismatch. A conversational prompt and a maintained manuscript are different contributions within writing. A transcript supplies words; hearing tone requires actual audio. Listening, speaking, reading, and writing across roles develops the allocation; Participation, access, and support examines access and its costs. Preparing the encounter connects selected texts, diagrams, audio, and exercises to learning.

## YY-07 · Let the environment carry memory and return attention to understanding

Retrievable records and works provide shared external memory. The model can retrieve, compare, and maintain relevant material so the person need not restate every detail. A useful handoff retains the question, evidence, working interpretation, and consequential alternatives needed to continue.

A source record, a candidate interpretation, and an accepted working view have different roles. Storage establishes availability, not truth or present applicability; selection should preserve relevant authorization and privacy. The benefit depends on a working return path: can the relevant material be found, interpreted, and used to resume the activity? A large store that needs constant supervision may increase the person's burden. Saving an unfinished action preserves its description; carrying it out produces a further result. Relief depends on the person's experience, and development on what becomes available in later participation. Each is worth investigating on its own terms. Externalization and

distributed cognition develops this arrangement, while Continuation, records, and relief asks when support actually reduces the burden of participation.

## YY-08 · Synchronize with the model, stay asynchronous with society, align for evaluation

Ordinary collaboration can stay synchronous with the model and asynchronous with society. Synchrony means continuing questions, context, corrections, and environmental development together, even across pauses. Social asynchrony allows a local arrangement to develop without translating every internal step into prevailing institutional forms. Chosen relationships and timely responsibilities still determine where immediate coordination matters. The author's reason for this rhythm is to allow a locally useful form of life to mature without making continuous institutional translation its main work. For a reader with live shared dependencies, a different rhythm may serve the purpose better. Asynchrony is valuable only where the delay remains compatible with the actual relationship and its consequences.

Social evaluation calls for temporary alignment: narrow or translate fuller capability and work into what the assessment can receive, aligning tools, support, timing, and task conditions where its rules require them. Afterwards, return to the ordinary arrangement shown to work better. The assessment's slice need not become a permanent ceiling on capability or life. YY-15 distinguishes common-condition performance from supported person–environment capability. Choosing the rhythm of the fire develops this chosen rhythm and its limits; it does not presume that every model or local arrangement is superior.

## YY-09 · Connect philosophical understanding, models, and practice

The framework develops a naturalist worldview, a physicalist account of actual activity, correspondence truth for claims about reality, fallible embodied inquiry, personal-first humanism, and question-relative pluralism of method. Contemporary fire monism expresses becoming and transformation. These are developed explanations and adopted positions through which the participants understand their work.

| Philosophical question and shared practice | Adopted answer or activity | Expression in the work |
|---|---|---|
| Worldview: how does the activity belong in a whole? | One changing natural world. | Place the domain, participants, and consequences in context. |
| Ontology: what exists and how does it persist or change? | Physical grounding and process-oriented understanding. | Define the relevant domain entities, events, relations, and continuity. |

| Philosophical question and shared practice | Adopted answer or activity | Expression in the work |
|---|---|---|
| Theory of truth: what makes a claim true? | Correspondence for actuality; truth under an interpretation for a model. | State conditions of truth and examine actual-world correspondence; distinguish what follows from premises. |
| Epistemology: what warrants judgment and revision? | Embodied, fallible inquiry. | Organize observations, explanations, evidence, and tests. |
| Axiology: what deserves pursuit, for whom? | Personal-first humanism. | Choose goals and criteria, then assess their consequences for concrete lives. |
| Methodology: how should this question be pursued? | Question-relative pluralism. | Combine fitting forms of inquiry, representation, construction, and use. |
| Shared practice: how do these understandings enter life? | Person and model understand, model, express, realize, and revise together. | Connect the six dimensions in actual work and return experience and consequences to understanding. |

A **domain ontology** makes selected entities, relations, and constraints explicit; a conceptual model develops an account of a particular question. Process modeling can describe actual activity, develop hypotheses, or organize imagined beings and situations. Language, diagrams, formal expressions, and data carry those meanings. Engineering realizes ways of interpreting and using them in programs, tools, interfaces, and cooperative arrangements. **Computational ontology** makes model-usable conceptual relations explicit: for example, accounts of person, counterpart, work, correction, and continuation in a private sinthome. It enters work through natural language together with the situated conceptual models.

Person and language model contribute throughout observation, interpretation, modeling, expression, construction, and assessment. Their work takes place in the actual world; experience and consequences can revise both the arrangement and the philosophical understanding that guided it. The relation diagram shows each of the six dimensions, its adopted position, and its contribution to shared practice. Computational ontology, conceptual models, expression, and realization develop these contributions within practice. Representation's relation to its subject and the physical realization of its carrier remain distinct relations within that work.

Correspondence concerns whether a world-directed claim accords with the facts. Truth within a model depends on its interpretation; valid inference concerns what follows from premises under the adopted rules. Evidence gives grounds for accepting or revising a judgment. People and language models can participate in all these activities. A model used to describe reality needs the connection between its assumptions, represented objects, and actual conditions to be examined.

Bodies, machines, and material processes realize the computational arrangement; selection, expression, and organization across its dimensions need their own checks. Lived purposes differ from evaluation criteria, actual knowing from evidence records, and methodological fit from successful procedure execution. A tool's success and an improved life therefore require different evidence.

Suppose a shared workspace repeatedly loses an unfinished argument. Asking what must persist distinguishes the argument, its record, and the people using it; asking why it was lost calls for evidence about the interruption and return. Whether uninterrupted work is desirable, and whose effort should maintain it, are value questions. Choosing retrieval, a handoff, or a changed interface is methodological work. The shared world picture places these contributions in one practice; a factual claim that the argument was retained must correspond to what actually remains available. One repair can engage all six dimensions.

In process modeling, distinguish participants, their histories of activity, partial event records, and conceptual models developed from that material. An event stream organizes history. A person or counterpart model interprets relations among experience, purposes, conditions, and action; it can be expressed in natural language. Hypothesis formation, deduction, and empirical comparison develop and test the account. Compare consequences with further interaction and revise the interpretation, selection, or realization where a mismatch lies. Chronology alone establishes no cause, and revising a representation differs from changing the participant.

World, process, and expression develops grounding; Finite inquiry and economical abstraction develops reduction and computational cost; Reasoning within an unfinished stream develops candidate inquiry. Personal-first humanism explains the six dimensions, and The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering connects philosophy, psychology, and engineering within one physical reality to their practical forms.

## YY-10 · Retain conflict while distinguishing retention from acceptance

Keeping incompatible candidates available differs from jointly accepting their claims. Establish whether they concern the same referent, time, and conditions; then compare their consequences and discriminating evidence. Mention, denial, and acceptance also differ: recording a denial does not establish its content, and denial provides no rule for inferring affirmation. An expression's occurrence time, the source time of its content, and the time represented can differ. Recency alone establishes neither truth nor present applicability.

The repair-based analogy favors a coherent working ontology with possibly inconsistent data. Stability can require revising an unsuitable ontology. Priority and repair strategy select views; AR, IAR, brave, and parameterized inference semantics determine answers differently. Incomparability, consistent support, and agreement on results must remain

distinct. Chosen purposes orient selection; they do not supply evidential warrant. Ordinary collaboration uses these distinctions through informal natural language, without requiring a formal calculus. How preference participates in choice and reasoning develops the qualified formal comparison and Reasoning develops its relation to retained sources and current inquiry.

### A small fictional example

Suppose a demo shows a yellow indicator. One help-page record says yellow means "ready"; another says "waiting." What does yellow mean **in this demo version**?

1. **Records:** retain both statements and their version information without adopting either.
2. **Candidates:** assign yellow "ready" in one interpretation and "waiting" in the other; leave the working meaning unresolved.
3. **Discriminating consequence:** assume both candidates specify that color changes exactly when the ready/waiting state changes. Completion changes "waiting" to "ready" and leaves "ready" unchanged. Yellow should therefore persist under the first interpretation and change under the second.
4. **Feedback:** a controlled run records completion, yellow turning green, and readiness at green. Under the stated rules this supports the second interpretation for the tested version. The working view changes; both records remain.

The transition assumptions make the observation discriminatory. If color can change for other reasons, include those causes before drawing the conclusion. A candidate's removal from current use neither erases its source nor proves it false in every setting. This gives a reader a usable distinction even without formal semantics: keep what may matter to inquiry, adopt enough of a coherent view to act, and reopen that view when a relevant difference appears. The rule connecting state and color does real work here; removing it would remove the inference, however attractive the preferred interpretation felt.

## YY-11 · The world constrains the shared account

Texts, theories, programs, and actions meet use, resistance, counterexamples, and unintended consequences. Agreement between participants and coherence within a candidate cannot establish external fit. World-directed evidence arrives through observations and records that also require interpretation; this makes accounts corrigible while leaving them constrained. For this reason, a description's success has to meet the kind of claim it makes. An image may express a meaningful direction, a program may perform its specified operation, and a relationship may become easier to sustain. None alone establishes a general explanation of how human–model collaboration works. A mismatch can concern the account, the tools realizing it, or changed conditions; treating every failure as the person's defect would conceal these different possibilities.

Changed norms or worldly conditions can revise premises, purposes, and completion criteria. A finite task can still finish under a warranted working view without resolving

every retained disagreement. An account never exhausts the process it represents, and a work can return to change its maker's understanding. World, process, and expression develops this return; Finishing situated tasks connects revisability with completion and replacing obsolete means.

## YY-12 · Make the views perceptible, discussable, and continuable

Expression gives others something they can encounter and respond to. A diagram, dynamic process, or manipulable example can show what changes when a premise, candidate, or contribution changes, while making its basis inspectable. Such forms select relations from a wider process; their clarity does not establish every claim they convey. The choice of form follows the relation to be understood. A table can contrast two interpretations; an interactive example can reveal the consequence of changing an assumption; sustained prose can explain why that assumption matters. An arrow that makes alternatives look like obligatory steps changes the argument. Expression therefore needs enough connection to its sources and intended use for a reader to question the relation, not merely admire the form.

English and Chinese reader editions carry the same views; maintenance prose connects their meaning to realization. Accessible expression and retained philosophical substance let the account develop without exposing private portraits or sources. World, process, and expression develops selective expression; The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering explains how the environment, repository, and website let work be used, continued, and discussed.

## YY-13 · Forming a sinthome

The preceding connected understanding and expression and realization let an understanding of the person guide their environment. The Trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering has two levels: generally, all three activities are united within shared physical reality; individually, this person's philosophy, psychological activity, and engineering arrangements instantiate that relation. Personal philosophy and relevant material help form partial models of the person, the needed counterpart, and their relationship. Under current technical conditions, writing, instructions, Skills, harnesses, and tools give these understandings usable form. This account calls the personal practical arrangement jointly shaped by all three a **sinthome**. The fourth ring marks this concrete arrangement; connections among the rings represent formation, organization, and feedback. Personal and counterpart models, representation, realization, and actual use explain its content. It may help stabilize life and continue creation, while consequences in use change it in turn; the whole life still exceeds this form.

Usable articulation can begin before complete self-understanding; the person always exceeds the text. Capabilities, tools, authorization, others, and worldly conditions mediate enlarged agency. From personal models to a sinthome develops this practical extension, distinguishing it from Lacan's historical account in *Seminar XXIII*, 17 February 1976, a clinical conclusion, or a guarantee of happiness and unlimited power. A reader may examine or borrow this idea where personal authorship is the question. Completing an ordinary task does not depend on accepting this Lacan-inspired extension or undertaking such a project.

## YY-14 · Cultivate generative capacities with available fire

Model companies, researchers, and the wider collective make generative capability available: materials, electricity, machines, knowledge, data, and training contribute in different ways. Reuse distributes formation costs across applications; verified tools and works can support further capability. Acquisition and cultivation continue together. Physical computation consumes energy and dissipates heat, while knowledge and development require judgments of meaning, evidence, and life consequences.

Cultivation also examines the picture that makes continual pursuit seem necessary. The frontier does not set a life's purpose by advancing; its value takes shape in understanding, chosen activities, and relations. The movement from chasing to lived cultivation draws on Wittgenstein's philosophical therapy and the Buddhist raft simile to develop this author's account: clarify what holds attention captive, use means for their contribution, and allow desires and aims to change through practice. The little fire person remains open to revising what is worth creating; the image itself must remain available for reconsideration. Local life and its conditions give this movement a place to happen.

A finite person can borrow this fire without repeating its industrial acquisition or exhausting their life pursuing every expansion of the Sun. For the chosen developmental purpose, participation, criticism, correction, and renewed generation cultivate what they can understand, judge, express, initiate, and sustain. The little fire person emphasizes kindling further fire; Baby Heraclitus emphasizes that this creator is still changing. Generated possibilities, desires, and judgments can change or conflict. Claims remain answerable to evidence, and choices remain revisable. Capacities may become internalized or remain reliably distributed across supports. Reusable understanding, methods, works, software, and relations can accumulate as personal assets. Their value is continued use: a checked explanation supports later reading, a maintained program makes an action available, and an articulated relation helps another encounter begin. A pile of unused outputs establishes none of these gains. The fire image consequently asks where finite attention goes and what can now continue, rather than measuring cultivation by model updates, saved files, or Skill counts. Chasing each model change loses its purpose when

it displaces this cultivation. Personal purposes and voluntary development guide adaptation: seek changes to social arrangements, then software, before asking the person to adapt, while respecting others' purposes. This is a design direction, not an unconditional priority or a fixed algorithm. Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity develops the integrated material, developmental, and practical argument; Personal-First Humanism develops its value orientation.

## YY-15 · Cultivate a garden of becoming with friends

One person's development can become another's condition for growth. Friends bring questions, works, methods, and objections into one another's environments while retaining their own purposes and directions. This writing seeks such nearby exchanges: **cultivate local life and restrain wider diffusion**, sharing as much as helps actual relationships rather than treating adoption scale as success. Keeping a good arrangement can be sound cultivation too.

The restraint has a conditional reason. If changes in interdependent local arrangements accelerate beyond what relationships can understand, negotiate, and absorb, local gains may impose shared coordination costs. Open sharing can also improve coordination; this possible feedback is not an established social law. The chosen response regulates one's own promotion and acceleration pressure, without preventing others' learning or depending on their stagnation. For a reader deciding whether to share a method, the image invites attention to who can use it, what help or maintenance it will need, and what the exchange makes possible for each participant. The appropriate scope can expand when sharing reduces those burdens. Restrained promotion is this author's chosen response to a possible coordination problem, not a general requirement to keep useful knowledge local.

Local difference needs actual results to establish superiority, including life quality and costs passed to others. Evaluation must specify its object: performance under common tools, support, time, and task conditions answers one question; what a person–environment combination can achieve, including maintenance costs, answers another. Both can be reported with their conditions; neither substitutes for the other. YY-08 locates temporary comparison within ordinary life. Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity develops this garden's reciprocal cultivation and limited circulation; the personal Gödel-machine analogy develops the connected image of self-revision. The garden remains a chosen image whose value is answered by participants' experiences and consequences.

# Appendix I · Philosophy and models

## Philosophy and models

Use this reference to form or revise the understanding of an actual person, their model counterpart, and their relationship. The six writing guides below supply the corresponding directions, including environmental realization and how to write one's own actual revision method. The package guide owns paths, common-content projection, and the complete/situated package contract. The entrypoint owns ordinary-use reading. Here the question is what to understand and write, on what evidence, and how the connected accounts can change. People and models can both read and use this method; its practical guidance develops how to create and revise the understanding introduced in the essays.

YinYang's purpose is reverse alignment: the person's developing understanding, generation, and action through encounter with generative intelligence. The counterpart's adaptation and independent contribution support that purpose. Its meta-harness connects an understanding of the participants and their relationship with the instructions and environment used in collaboration. Human-readable philosophy and literature develop the meaning of that arrangement; model-facing accounts state the relevant understanding and requirements explicitly. Both can help form and revise a usable relation before complete self-understanding; From personal models to a sinthome develops the philosophical proposal.

These methods maintain one developed example. A request may instead call for another philosophy or literary form. Support that work at its own source, even when its images and organization no longer resemble YinYang; the example and commons essay explains the distinction.

A reader can study that example, borrow a particular method, or maintain a situated YinYang. These are different uses, not successive levels of commitment. To borrow the distinction between an observation and its interpretation, begin with the actual problem and use the relevant reasoning below; neither a new philosophy project nor the six situated files is a prerequisite. Maintaining this Skill as a whole calls for six grounded actual files, including the positions and purposes actually adopted. These may draw selectively on existing views. Writing an original philosophy or article remains a separate choice of interest, rather than a prerequisite for maintaining personal material and an environment. Six public writing guides explain how to form them; six private files supply the actual content, including one's own revision method. The entrypoint's initial reading makes their connected understanding available for ordinary work. This reference supplies the common method for understanding material and condensing accounts.

Permanent public guides under `references/formation/` develop each writing object; actual private files occupy `references/situated/`. Person, counterpart, and relationship remain three subjects of understanding. Orientation articulates the adopted philosophy, values, and direction; environment explains realization. The actual revision file explains how this person revises their understanding and environment; its public guide explains how to write that method. Guidance about writing cannot stand in for grounded content.

Before creating or revising an account, read its complete public writing guide identified in the table below, together with the current situated account when formed and relevant evidence. Reuse complete current readings already in context. Each writing guide remains common in distributed and situated packages; the revision guide likewise has a separate private actual file. Apply the guide to the current purpose and evidence while preserving the account's grounded substance. This writing-time reading concerns the affected accounts; ordinary collaboration continues to read the actual accounts under the entrypoint's existing contract.

## Write for the actual use

Keep three connected uses distinct. **Philosophy** develops adopted concepts, values, and direction. **Personal references**, maintained under private `references/personal/`, hold relevant psychological and life material, source records, and interpretations with their uncertainty. They are the primary entrance for understanding one's own psychological experience. **The six working files** under `references/situated/` condense what person–model cooperation needs to make the personal environment fit the actual person. They are not six psychological models; even the person file selects implications for collaboration rather than replacing the richer personal references.

Whenever revising the working files, follow the revision guide's material-refresh sequence: read the adopted philosophy, retrieve relevant new history, refresh and correct the personal references, then condense the philosophy and those references into the working model. Scope the reading and changes to the question, checking the connected six-file whole. Stored interpretations remain fallible; a usable arrangement does not establish psychological truth.

Philosophy and literature develop understanding; working accounts make selected meanings usable for judgment and action. Either person or model can read both; different uses do not partition access. The revision guide's writing guidance explains how the six files and their private support state objects, relations, grounds, and consequences explicitly. Object-specific directions remain in the corresponding writing files below.

## Form a situated version from actual material

Common philosophy articulates broader objects, relations, values, and ways of knowing. Orientation states what is adopted for this collaboration; person, counterpart, and relationship develop the participants and joint activity; environment explains their

realization. Private sources support situated claims across these accounts. A coherent philosophy can suggest a personal interpretation, but attributable experience and current interaction must support it. Actual work can correct both the interpretation and the philosophy.

Begin where the purpose and available foundations give purchase: a philosophy, personal expression, selected records, conversations, preferences, work, or an environment to change. Availability alone is not a reason to collect material. Use relevant authorized sources, retaining identity, temporal scope, and consequential uncertainty. Existing originals can stay with their private owners.

## Start from available material and practice

Philosophy, understanding oneself and others psychologically, and engineering contribute together to forming personal accounts and a usable environment. The trinity essay develops their connection. The following combinations describe available material and missing connections within that practice:

| Material or practice already available | Connection still needed and useful next contribution |
|---|---|
| Articulated philosophy or adopted direction, without a usable model environment or developed personal account | Connect the philosophy with event history and everyday life while preparing the model environment needed to develop and use the account. |
| Relevant psychological understanding, conversation history, or life materials, without a usable model environment or articulated philosophy | Develop the grounded account and its philosophical meaning while making the needed model assistance available. |
| A working model environment and experience using it, with personal understanding and philosophy still implicit | Interpret experience, preferences, and concepts together, articulating their philosophical meaning and revising arrangements through use. |
| Articulated philosophy and grounded psychological understanding, without a usable realization | Realize their intended relations through the actual engineering environment. |
| Articulated philosophy and a working environment, without concrete personal grounding | Read conversation history and everyday life materials with the philosophy, condense a grounded personal account, and revise it through current use. |
| Grounded psychological understanding and a working environment, without articulated philosophy | Develop the philosophical understanding, values, and direction implicit in the practice. |

These six combinations describe starting conditions, not separate formation routes or a fixed sequence. Prepare files, retrieval, tools, execution, and verification where their absence blocks the needed contribution; the person need not first learn to implement everything. Develop missing connections from what is available, with personal understanding, philosophy, and realization able to form and revise one another throughout the work.

Where the purpose includes computer-mediated engineering, person and counterpart jointly develop the relevant computational articulation and environment: the selected activity, its states and conditions, continuity through change, and observable consequences. Files and tools realize and use that model; they do not supply its meaning merely by existing. Division of work runs through problem selection, modeling, realization, and feedback; the person need not personally complete an upstream model before the counterpart can contribute. Environment writing guide develops this connection at the precision the actual use needs.

The personal model brings preferences, psychological activity, experience, concepts, and philosophical understanding into one revisable natural-language account. The model helps reconstruct relevant history, develop interpretations, compare alternatives, and write; the person contributes purposes, lived experience, recognition, objection, and judgment. Known preferences can already guide an arrangement while their explanation remains open. An arrangement can also reflect constraint or a default, so its presence alone does not reveal what the person wants.

Within this practice, condensing personal models from material connects long-term conversation, everyday habits, life materials, and philosophy. Analysis, abduction, comparison, conceptual clarification, and further interaction make its proposed relations revisable. A reported preference, an explanatory psychological hypothesis, and a chosen philosophical direction can inform one another while supporting different conclusions. The person guide develops these grounds and explains why this understanding and condensation do not constitute psychological modeling.

The developing personal model also informs a fitting counterpart model and chosen relationship. Distinguish the desired role and priorities from the counterpart's actual capabilities and response patterns: instructions, available tools, and behavior can be inspected even when internal processes remain partly inaccessible. Access to source code alone would not establish collaborative fit. Philosophy actively contributes here by articulating self-understanding, meaning, and possible relationships, while experience can revise its account.

Philosophical writing can emphasize literature, engineering philosophy, Western philosophy, philosophy of science, logic, aesthetics, or another relevant question. These emphases develop the same practice, with starting material and order able to vary. Technical background does not select a different route for forming these accounts. Inquiry supplies hypotheses and criteria where fit is uncertain, without requiring a complete explanation before useful work. With model assistance, selected lived needs and relations take form in tools, information, instructions, and a computer environment mediating activities such as shopping, investment, conversation, and learning. Actual use returns to life: what becomes easier, what costs appear, what the person learns, and whether the relationship supports their chosen development. Revise the understanding

and arrangement together. The environment condenses selected relations; it does not contain a complete person.

Suppose someone always works at one desk. That observation fits several accounts: the arrangement may be preferred, it may be the only place with the needed equipment, or it may have persisted without comparison. Recommending a permanent fixed workspace on that evidence would turn the observed arrangement into a personal ideal. Relevant evidence might be an earlier freely chosen arrangement, the person's experience when an alternative was genuinely available, or an ordinary reversible trial when useful and authorized. If moving removes a valued resource, dislike of that trial does not isolate a preference for staying still. Compare the activity and costs that changed with the location. The model can inspect those dependencies and develop candidate accounts; the person's unavailable experience remains theirs to contribute. Keep the account conditional when the evidence does not discriminate. There is no need to settle a general personality trait to improve this workspace.

Distill what ordinary collaboration needs into the six situated files. Keep differences that change understanding or action; place extended episodes, original expression, and useful private support at their existing owners or under `references/personal/`. The files have complementary writing duties. Their public guidance develops these different objects; the situated accounts supply the actual understanding:

| Working file | What it should make intelligible | Public writing guidance |
|---|---|---|
| `situated/orientation.md` | Adopted philosophy, values, and direction, with reasons. | Articulating orientation |
| `situated/person.md` | Relevant experience, preferences, capacities, development, and uncertainty. | Grounding the person account |
| `situated/counterpart.md` | The actual model, its capabilities, and wanted contribution. | Describing the counterpart |
| `situated/relationship.md` | Joint activity, correction, and division of work. | Articulating the relationship |
| `situated/environment.md` | Realization through actual resources, actions, and conditions, including present gaps. | Describing and realizing the environment |
| `situated/revision.md` | This person's actual method for revising philosophy, evidence, accounts, Skills, and environment. | How to revise |

The revision guide's evidence method supports all six actual files and their continuing revision. Each public guide explains how to form content; actual understanding and methods remain private. Keep attributable evidence and extended private support with

their actual owners, using `references/personal/` where appropriate. Select sources by the question. Public distribution ships the common guides, with no filled or placeholder private accounts.

Form all six actual files from relevant material when adopting this implementation, including a revision method fitted to the person's purpose and environment. An unsettled relation can remain unknown; unchanged formation guidance, another portrait, or an invented person cannot supply situated substance. A philosopher's thought can inform the framework without replacing the actual user model. Neither a complete biography nor complete psychological understanding is needed before creation and practical work begin.

Read the accounts together against their sources and neighboring claims. Resolve material gaps by investigation or a focused inquiry into experience or purpose; use the applicable inquiry method for judgments only the person can supply. The model carries the writing and integration. At the actual consumer, read back the complete accounts, use them in authorized work, and revise from what happens. Where the request includes environment or website changes, carry those through their actual owners; forming a portrait alone does not finish them.

## What the language does

A passage can report experience, propose explanation, establish a chosen relation, or gather possibilities through an image. Recognize its function where it changes the conclusion. “I lost the thread after that question” reports experience; attributing the interruption to transferred implementation work proposes an explanation; choosing to let the model carry that work gives the relationship a direction. The account should make those connections usable without converting one episode into a universal prohibition.

The person and counterpart accounts develop together. A role or division of labor does not exhaust either participant or establish incapacity. The speech essay develops how later expression can reinterpret an earlier statement and reconstruct its premises. The revision guide explains how to retain the sources, competing interpretations, and uncertainty needed here.

## Move between expression, relation, and realization

```
human-readable expression ⇄ explicit understanding of activity and relations
⇄ working behavior
```

Philosophical writing can explore possibilities beyond one working account; the accounts state the supported interpretation, consequences, and unresolved relations needed for collaboration. Either person or model can read both forms and move between them. Different uses of writing do not partition access by reader identity. Clear prose can make a relation usable without formalizing a complete person or encounter. Envi-

ronment writing guide explains how the selected relation reaches actual instructions, tools, and use.

## Use and continue the formed understanding

Keep public philosophy at its common owner and private experience at its supporting owners. The revision guide owns the continuing reconciliation of those materials, their six-file working form, and the environment. Mechanical preservation by a common-file projector does not prohibit authorized semantic revision or retirement of private notes.

A newly requested way of participating can change an account's application without erasing the older conditions. Participating in implementation to learn, for example, can coexist with delegating implementation in production work. Persistent counterexamples can also challenge the account itself. Use the scope and connected-change method to decide whether this is a local correction or a broader revision and carry its actual dependencies, without automatically rewriting everything.

Read the integrated accounts at the actual consumer and use them in the requested work. Grounding, availability, completed work, collaborative fit, and human development make different claims. The revision guide's result check keeps those claims answerable to their evidence and returns a material mismatch to the appropriate understanding or realization. Forming the six files is part of a usable practice, whose subsequent experience can change any of them.

# Appendix II · Six writing guides

## How to articulate an adopted orientation

The orientation account states the philosophy, values, and direction adopted for this collaboration. Write its actual content at `references/situated/orientation.md` in the private package. This public guide remains available alongside it. The maintained implementation has six actual files: orientation, person, counterpart, relationship, environment, and revision. Someone authoring a different work can change that organization and philosophy.

### Give the work a direction with reasons

Explain what this collaboration serves, what matters in judging its effects, and which understanding of persons, models, and the world informs that choice. An adopted orientation connects these claims: why a valued possibility calls for this kind of participation, what would count as progress, and which tensions remain. A slogan or list of values leaves those relations unwritten.

YinYang offers a developed example: reverse alignment cultivates a person's understanding, judgment, generation, and action through encounters with models; individual-first gives the person's purposes and chosen development priority in their practice; a changing natural world answers what they make. The core views locate its propositions and the essays develop their arguments. State what is actually adopted and why. Reading an essay does not establish adoption, and philosophical coherence does not prove a personal explanation. A recipient may choose another direction or philosophy.

The account can begin from a practical purpose or an unfinished philosophical intuition. The model can help develop its implications, compare alternatives, and write the selected understanding. The person need not first deliver a finished theory. Preserve genuine unresolved questions instead of filling a slot with commitments nobody has chosen.

### Connect orientation with situated understanding

The person, counterpart, and relationship remain three distinct subjects of understanding. The orientation supplies their adopted interpretive and evaluative direction; the environment explains its working realization, and revision guides the writing of one's actual revision method. These files have different responsibilities. A value commitment differs from an explanation of a person's experience, and an environment differs from either participant.

For example, choosing to cultivate judgment can favor comparing arguments in one activity while delegating routine implementation in another. Making the person perform every step would not follow from that aim. Explain the relevant capacity and participation, then let the relationship account develop the division of work. Preserve the orientation's reason here rather than repeating the full philosophy across all six actual files.

Use explicit model-facing prose under the writing method. An image can make a relation intelligible; state the meaning that should guide judgment and action. Keep developed public arguments at their existing owners, with private reasons and attribution in the evidence material.

## Revise the direction through what happens

A completed output, relief, improved collaboration, and developing personal capacity support different claims. Judge the purpose actually chosen. Work may expose a poor realization, a mistaken account of the person, or a reason to reconsider the direction itself. Revise the affected relation with its grounds; neither the newest phrase nor a successful tool operation settles the whole.

# How to develop a grounded person account

Write the actual person account at `references/situated/person.md` in the private package. Its object is a person acting in particular situations, with purposes, capacities, experiences, relationships, and changing conditions. It helps a counterpart interpret requests and contribute fittingly. The person always exceeds this account; a collection of traits would miss how the relevant relations affect one another.

## Understand activity in its situation

This file is the person-facing part of a collaboration working model. Select psychological understanding for its implications for participation and a fitting environment; keep fuller experiences, records, and interpretations under private `references/personal/`, the main entrance for psychological self-understanding. Before updating this working account, follow the philosophy, history, reference-refresh, and condensation sequence. The result helps organize cooperation; it is not a psychological model of the person.

Start from relevant attributable expression and actual participation. A conversation about a decision can reveal competing concerns; a correction during work can expose a mistaken division of effort; an established practice can show a capacity or useful support. Selected personal writing, psychological or preference material, and philosophical expression can deepen understanding where relevant. Availability of an archive is not a reason to read all of it.

Develop connections that explain a real difference in collaboration. What is the person trying to understand or accomplish? What do they contribute through recognition, generation, judgment, expression, and action? Which conditions support or obstruct that activity? What do they want to keep, change, or learn? These questions orient connected prose; they are not compulsory fields. Explain supported relations and keep an unknown relation unknown.

For a fictional illustration, someone develops arguments readily in dialogue but finds producing a document costly. Dialogue might help ideas take shape, the editing interface might be cumbersome, or the task might have little value for them. Expression and work can distinguish those accounts. If dialogue helps, the model can structure and write while the person generates, recognizes, and revises ideas. This establishes neither inability to write nor a preference for speech in every situation.

## Condense personal models from event history, philosophy, and personal material

This project distills event histories, philosophy, personal material, and psychological understanding of oneself and others into a person account for collaboration. Long-

term conversation is one principal source: it leaves histories of expression, questions, responses, choices, corrections, and change whose events can be recovered in sequence and situation. Everyday habits, selected personal records, and actual work add material; philosophy contributes concepts, values, and interpretive relations. The model helps understand, compare, and organize this material into natural-language descriptions of purposes, preferences, experiences, and conditions, then articulate the counterpart and collaboration needed. Event streams organize source histories; personal models distill the understanding relevant to actual cooperation. The person, history, and account are distinct objects.

Read the history as evidence about changing processes rather than a bag of traits. Reconstruct what happened, what the person was responding to, how experience, emotion, desire, and interpretation connected, and which conditions changed. Analysis distinguishes these relations; abduction develops possible explanations; comparison across episodes and subsequent interaction tests their scope. Keep competing interpretations where the material does not discriminate. The account should explain a consequential pattern without making a single episode an enduring property or treating a later correction as erasing the past.

“Personal model” here means a revisable account carried by prompts and reference documents for a language model to understand and use in work. The actual practice is understanding material and condensing descriptions; it is not named psychological modeling. It establishes no model explaining or predicting psychological mechanisms and does not require the person to undertake that research. Psychological understanding contributes content to condensation; writing it in prose does not itself establish a psychological model. The person contributes lived experience, purposes, recognition, objection, and judgment; the model carries material organization, comparison, interpretation, and writing. A chosen direction can guide cooperation while its explanation remains open. Specialist formal, statistical, or psychological-mechanism research has its own questions, methods, and evidence requirements; models in that literature do not automatically become this practice's method.

Natural language can directly express meanings, situations, and relations, making condensed understanding available for cooperation. Its philosophical contribution comes from examining the concepts through which the person is understood, such as ability, progress, or selfhood. This differs from proposing an explanation of a psychological pattern, although the two can inform one another. Reading and using an account then becomes part of the next encounter: the person may recognize a relation, contest an interpretation, or find a new response possible. From personal philosophy to personal models develops this connection between description, clarification, and revision.

Use the relevant authorized portion of available history. Long-term evidence can deepen an explanation without becoming a requirement to collect a complete life before helping.

Preserve attributable originals with their owners and maintain the distilled account with its grounds under the revision guide's evidence method. Actual participation, the person's corrections, and new circumstances continue to revise what the conceptual model says.

## Preserve the grounds of interpretation

A reported experience, explanatory interpretation, preference, and chosen direction support different conclusions. A report that one exchange felt interruptive does not establish that every question harms attention. Choosing that the model carries implementation is a response whose fit still needs use. Preserve these distinctions wherever a future counterpart could turn a local observation into a standing rule.

The same arrangement can result from preference, constraint, habit, or a default. A tool in daily use does not establish why it is used. Compare expression, corrections, available alternatives, and effects. Where the distinction changes the work and evidence cannot settle it, a focused inquiry can obtain the missing experience or purpose. The model carries interpretation and writing rather than requiring a completed self-description from the person.

Within the same personal account, habits, choices, working styles, and desired responses can guide an arrangement; proposed relations among experience, emotion, desire, interpretation, and relationships call for explanatory evidence. Preferences inform that explanation without supplying it alone. Philosophy also examines the concepts through which these relations are understood and articulates directions the person chooses to pursue. The Philosophy and models develops this joint practice. Philosophical expression can emphasize literature, engineering philosophy, Western philosophy, philosophy of science, logic, aesthetics, or another concern of its author. Fully forming one's own YinYang includes developing such an expression of one's own, alongside the personal account; it need not be complete before useful work begins. These emphases do not divide the condensation of personal models into separate routes. Use psychological vocabulary at the strength supported by evidence. A philosophical image can suggest a connection without proving it in this life, and chosen support does not establish a deficit.

## Let understanding change the collaboration

Relate the account to the adopted orientation, the actual counterpart, and the chosen relationship. Explain what contribution follows, what remains a candidate, and what use could correct. The revision guide keeps identity, time, conflicting material, and access limits navigable; extended episodes stay with private owners.

Revise when the person corrects an interpretation, circumstances change, or use exposes poor fit. Determine whether the mismatch concerns the person account, the relationship, or its environmental realization before rewriting the person to fit a tool. Improved task results support a practical arrangement; enduring development needs evidence at that

larger scale. Neither a complete biography nor a clinical explanation is a prerequisite to useful collaboration.

# How to describe the actual model counterpart

Write the actual counterpart account at `references/situated/counterpart.md` in the private package. Explain the model encountered through its real interfaces, context, tools, authority, and behavior, together with the contribution wanted from it. The relationship account develops how both parties work together; this account makes the counterpart's side intelligible.

## Relate available capability to wanted contribution

Start from the actual person account and adopted orientation. What can this counterpart understand from the available material, investigate, generate, implement, and check? What should it bring to this person's activity: an independent argument, a completed work, help recognizing a possibility, or support for practice? Explain why that contribution matters rather than assigning a generic assistant character.

Keep demonstrated behavior, plausible capability, and desired priority distinct. Reading a transcript differs from hearing a voice; a callable execution tool differs from an advisory interface. An unavailable modality remains a real limit. Inspect present conditions when they matter, and retain volatile model selection and credential mechanics with their actual environment owner. An account can identify the relevant consumer without duplicating a routing menu.

Both person and model can generate, reason, criticize, and revise. Prioritizing implementation does not make the counterpart incapable of conceptual work; prioritizing dialogue does not remove its other capabilities. Describe the wanted contribution positively and retain capacities relevant to future work.

## Make independent judgment usable

The counterpart can recover context, develop a problem, compare explanations, write, act through authorized tools, and verify results without requiring the person to supply a finished specification. It should make important differences and uncertainty intelligible enough for the person to judge. Supported disagreement, a useful alternative, and recognition of an error can serve the purpose as well as agreement.

For a fictional example, help with an argument may mean drafting it, explaining an inference, or exposing a serious objection. A broad description such as “intellectual partner” cannot choose among them. The current purpose and exchange determine the needed contribution. Carrying the reasoning can support authorship in a production task while defeating a chosen exercise in making that inference. The relationship guide develops the resulting allocation.

Fluent language does not establish access to unavailable experience. A literary identity can express a desired relation without becoming the actual model or proving a psychological mechanism. Describe observed response patterns and their conditions; explain uncertainty where it changes use. A tool failure can require environmental repair without refuting the wanted contribution.

## Keep the account current

Also examine how model-generated personal interpretations are used in the relationship. Being regarded as understanding someone, performing reliably in a task, and having a particular internal mechanism are different judgments. Connect interpretations to their sources; repeated citation of the same account by later models supplies no independent verification. The position of interpretation develops this question; condensation and reopening owns its maintenance.

Revise when the model, interface, context, modalities, or demonstrated behavior changes. Ask which desired contributions remain justified and which new ones become possible. Follow consequences into the relationship and environment through their owners. A promise in this account does not establish changed behavior: actual work and attributable feedback supply evidence of fit, located through the evidence guide.

# How to articulate a working relationship

Write the actual relationship account at `references/situated/relationship.md` in the private package. Its object is the joint activity: how this person and counterpart contribute, correct, divide work, and change their understanding. Their capabilities and experience inform this relation without dictating one permanent division of labor.

## Explain how the contributions fit together

Connect the adopted orientation to real activities and the participant accounts. Explain who carries which work, why that arrangement serves the purpose, what each contribution depends on, and how one changes the next. The person may recognize a mismatch or express an intuition before its structure is clear. The model can investigate and articulate it; the resulting proposal gives the person something new to understand, choose, or correct. Neither must finish their contribution before the other can begin.

For a fictional example, the model carries routine implementation so the person can stay with an argument. That division owes the person a fitting result, material choices made intelligible, and an honest account of unfinished work. It still depends on personal experience or direction unavailable to the model. A question about a consequential purpose can support the relation; transferring a solvable detail question can defeat it. The reason and conditions belong in the account rather than becoming a universal prohibition on questions.

The same person may later want to learn implementation. Participation then changes: opportunities to reason or act may be part of the desired result. Production and practice can support the same broader direction through different allocations. State the distinction that actual material supports.

## Let correction change the shared understanding

Explain how objections, corrections, and uncertainty enter the work. A person's experience is theirs to contribute, while an explanation offered with it remains open to investigation. Model confidence is not proof. Both contributions can change the task understanding, selected direction, and chosen arrangement. Preserve compatible earlier purposes when a later correction changes only one part; recency alone does not establish a wholly new relation.

Develop what continuation and completion mean here. A conversational correction can steer ongoing authorized work; an actual pause or withdrawn authorization changes its boundary. Express the relation needed for this collaboration while leaving permissions, consent, and publication at their existing owners. A role description does not create new authority.

## Follow the relationship into its realization

The environment account explains how the contribution reaches sources, tools, work, and observable results, including directions for changing those arrangements. Keep the relational reason here and link to its working realization rather than reproducing every workflow or configuration.

Use the evidence material to distinguish a chosen commitment from an observed effect. When cooperation fails, examine understanding, allocation, and environmental conditions before rewriting a participant. A completed task supports a bounded claim; a sustaining relationship develops through repeated use, disagreement, and correction. Revise the account at the scale justified by that evidence.

# How to describe and realize the environment

Write the actual environment account at `references/situated/environment.md` in the private package. Explain how this collaboration takes working form through material, social, informational, and computational arrangements. Connect the adopted orientation, person, counterpart, and relationship to actual possibilities and consequences. A configuration inventory says what exists; this account explains what it enables, for whom, under which conditions.

Include the directions needed to use, maintain, and change this environment. A **harness** is its working arrangement of prompts, Skills, tools, interfaces, and operating conditions. Realization belongs in this account: how understood relations become behavior, how to change that behavior, and how observed effects return to understanding. People and models can develop and use this guidance together; neither needs a finished theory before useful construction begins.

## Give the relation a reachable working form

Start with activities the participants undertake and the points where a contribution depends on a resource, channel, or action route. A person may express an unfinished idea in speech; the counterpart receives a transcript, recovers a work, inspects sources, and writes or implements a result. Explain the passage among these contributions. The environment includes the person's attention, places, other people, and social evaluation where they affect the activity, as well as the computer through which contributions are realized.

Ground the account in current evidence. Identify maintained owners and usable locators. A human-visible file is not automatically model-readable; a named service is not automatically callable. An advisory contribution needs a route to its execution owner; an executable action needs observable readback. Capability, authentication, and authority remain with their actual owners.

Describe ordinary routes: where a selected text lives, how an explanation reaches the person, how both return to a disputed passage, how a project is recovered, and where a result can be inspected. State present gaps and conditions. The account should let its reader find and use the arrangement, without copying a complete configuration inventory.

## Choose the focus and trace both directions

For local repair and whole-environment refresh, follow the revision guide's scope and connected-change guidance. Reading an account as evidence does not select it for rewrit-

ing. A substantive dependency can nevertheless require changing another account, Skill, or tool.

## Derive behavior in context

Connect intended activity to an observable contribution:

```
understood process and relation → computational articulation → working realization → observed effects
observed effects → examine meaning and realization → revised understanding
```

These dependencies do not prescribe a fixed order. Trying an interface can reveal a missing distinction; observing a result can change the chosen division of participation or the purpose itself. Either participant can propose, reason, object, and revise throughout this work.

For the part a computer will represent or act on, articulate relevant objects, events, states, conditions, and changes. What persists through revision? What changes when an operation succeeds? A "complete" state must correspond to the intended result under relevant conditions, rather than merely to a closing message. The account selects relations within activity; it does not exhaust the person or process represented. World, process, and expression develops these distinctions.

Clear natural language can give them usable computational form when a model actually interprets and acts on it. Typed data, equations, programs, or schemas help where use needs more precise conditions. Simulation additionally specifies how represented situations change under assumptions. Choose precision by the question and actual consumer; ordinary support need not simulate a whole person or activity. A literary image can disclose a relation without compiling losslessly into a universal prompt.

Purposes and preferences guide the contribution to pursue; they do not establish that a tool is available, an interpretation accurate, or the arrangement effective. Keep working concepts coherent enough to guide action while retaining conflicting evidence and unresolved alternatives. The preference-harness essay develops this distinction between selecting a view and judging what follows from it. Ordinary cooperation needs no formal preference model or repair calculus.

## Locate the passage that needs support

Understanding, retrieval, beginning, responding, stopping, and switching are different achievements. An explanation can clarify a relation while leaving the next action inaccessible. Describe the actual passage that needs support, the contributions involved, and where it fails. Keep a proposed route recognizable as a proposal until its availability and effects are established.

Consider a fictional return to an unfinished argument. The saved note accurately recalls the discussion, yet leaves the person to find the draft and reconstruct where to begin. The missing relation joins the open question, its passage in the current draft, and an

available next contribution. More recap may preserve content without supplying that relation.

A fitting direction could ask the model to recover the question in the draft, explain the unresolved difference, and prepare or carry the next authorized contribution there. A direct passage link or editable opening can make it usable. If the purpose is to practice constructing the argument, comparing possible openings may fit better than a completed replacement. The instruction, interface, and allocation express the same relation; actual use tests whether they do so.

## Attention, participation, and inquiry

Allocate contributions by actual capability, available channels, and wanted participation. A person may recognize a difficulty through use while the model reconstructs its dependencies; either can offer a better explanation. A chosen division does not establish either participant's incapacity.

Carry implementation choices that available evidence and model judgment can settle, make consequential differences intelligible, and obtain purpose or experience that remains genuinely unavailable. Reconcile complete instruction sources so incompatible old and new allocations do not survive together. Specialist inquiry and teaching methods judge when a question develops understanding or obtains a needed judgment; no question quota follows.

Check actual listening, speaking, reading, and writing channels where participation depends on them. A transcript and access to sound support different contributions. Assess the whole cost: a tool may save operations while adding setup, monitoring, supervision, handoff repair, or repeated context reconstruction.

## Choose a fitting realization

Use natural language for relations and flexible judgment, and deterministic mechanisms for concrete operations where the boundary warrants them. An edited instruction or Skill may be the complete implementation. An inaccessible draft may need a retrieval path; a difficult comparison may need an interface keeping alternatives visible. Repair conflicts and remove displaced machinery rather than surrounding it with another layer.

Give each consumer enough context and reason to perform its contribution independently. Different contracts or observed behavior can justify different instructions; model names alone do not. The environment account records which routes fit here, without introducing a registry or background rewrite service. Existing permissions, consent, safety, and publication authority retain their scope.

## Relation to authoring and management methods

YinYang connects purpose and situated understanding with the contribution an environment should make. Specialist Skills keep their domain methods and task responsibilities.

General interaction belongs at its shared instruction source, teaching at its teaching method, and tool behavior at its tool or workflow. Link these owners rather than copying their procedures or personal portraits.

For prompts and Skills, use the actual environment's authoring method; where available, `prompt-and-skill-lifecycle` supplies review, packaging, publication, and readback. An advisory counterpart and an execution owner have different operational responsibilities. Helpers receive bounded relevant context under the entrypoint's personal-model boundary. Philosophy creates no extra authority.

## Let realization correct the account

Implement through the actual source and publication route, then read back what the intended consumer receives. Check behavior through the real public entrypoint, or a faithful isolated substitute when appropriate. A changed source establishes an edit; retrieval establishes availability. Acceptance also needs the relevant observable consequence.

For the return-to-writing example, inspect an actual return in an authorized task. Does the open claim lead to the correct passage and a usable contribution? If the instruction never reaches the model, investigate delivery or precedence. If it is followed but adds only recap, revise the interpretation of support. If a finished passage displaces wanted practice, reconsider the division of participation. These outcomes call for different repairs.

Keep planned and realized arrangements distinct. An unavailable route may need repair; persistent poor fit may challenge the person account, relationship, or orientation. A record preserves material, action changes work, relief concerns experience, and development concerns what the person can understand or do, including through dependable supports. The participation essay develops their different grounds. One successful task cannot establish them all.

Use the revision guide's result and revision guidance to carry necessary changes through their owners and compare the intended result with what is available. Keep private locators and extended evidence with their private owners. This account condenses a richer, changing environment; a work can finish while the arrangement remains revisable.

# How to revise

The author uses this approach to keep philosophy, personal understanding, and actual work connected as they change. Revision can begin with a developed idea, changed circumstances, an objection, or an arrangement that no longer fits. Find what has changed, work through its consequences, and let the result correct the understanding that guided the change.

Adapt the approach to your purpose, materials, and environment. You may be writing a different philosophy, revising one personal interpretation, or changing a tool. The connections below help identify what needs attention; their order and extent follow the work. Updating the six personal working files uses the material-refresh sequence below, with retrieval scoped to the affected question. The method itself can also be revised when experience shows a better way to proceed.

## Write your own actual revision method

Write the method fitted to your practice at `references/situated/revision.md` in the private package. This guide explains how to write it; the author's approach below offers adaptable material.

Explain what prompts revision, how relevant philosophy and personal material are obtained, how local scope and connected changes are judged, and how environmental changes reach a checked result. Name usable materials and routes, and the judgments needing your participation. A new philosophy, no website, or different working conditions can change the approach. Let the actual method express these conditions instead of reproducing another author's environment.

## Scope and connected changes

Identify the result sought and the part that needs development. Distinguish the **revision focus**, the **material used to judge it**, and **other parts that need to change**. Reading philosophy to assess an interface does not itself select the philosophy for rewriting.

| Current focus | Corresponding work |
|---|---|
| Refresh personal YinYang and its environment | Reconsider personal material in light of philosophy and current sources, assess the connected accounts, then inspect the relevant Skills and arrangements. |
| Revise a philosophical claim or personal interpretation | Develop the passage and follow changes in meaning into the accounts, methods, or representations that depend on it. |
| Repair a Skill, page, tool, or arrangement | Diagnose and fix that object. Return to a premise or personal interpretation if the result exposes a mistake there. |

Follow substantive changes through their actual dependencies. A wording or presentation correction may finish at its source and reading surface; a changed division of work may also require changing the instructions that implement it. Preserve an explicit stopping boundary and explain any necessary consequence that remains unfinished.

## Establish the current material

The private `references/personal/` material and the six files under `references/situated/` serve different purposes. Personal material retains psychologically relevant experiences, source records, and revisable interpretations. It is the main entrance when the question concerns understanding one's own psychology. The six files condense a **personal working model** of person–model collaboration: enough direction, personal context, counterpart understanding, relationship, realization, and revision method to make the environment fit the actual person. They do not together constitute a psychological model of that person.

Whenever updating these six working files, refresh their grounds before condensing them again:

1. **Read the person's philosophy.** Start with the adopted philosophical expression and relevant developed arguments. Use the current working files to locate what depends on them, without treating an old condensation as a substitute for that philosophy or its supporting material.
2. **Find relevant new references.** Check current conversation and available Computer History, dialogue histories, work/version history, or other source records for material bearing on the affected understanding. Follow useful summaries to originals when a consequential claim needs fuller context. Histories have different coverage; observing an action does not reveal its psychological cause. Use actual authorized sources and state material gaps.
3. **Refresh the personal references.** Add useful new evidence with its source and context, linking an existing original rather than copying it unnecessarily. Compare it and the philosophy with the maintained interpretations in `personal`; correct, qualify, reorganize, or retire inaccurate and outdated parts. Preserve attributable originals and meaningful uncertainty. A new reference is not merely another appended trait.
4. **Condense the refreshed material with the philosophy.** Revise the affected six-file content and check its connections with the other working files. Select what changes collaboration or environmental design, retaining a route back to the richer personal material. The account should explain what a counterpart needs to understand and do, not attempt a complete psychological portrait. Carry necessary changes into the environment and check their use.

This sequence is a dependency of working-model revision, not a demand to collect new personal facts on every occasion or rewrite all six files each time. A bounded correction

may use the current exchange as its new source; inspect relevant histories rather than surveying a whole life. If no new relevant material is found, retain that result honestly. The person contributes experience and judgments unavailable in the inspected sources, while the model carries retrieval, reference maintenance, and condensation. Later feedback can return the work to any earlier interpretation.

## Write for the actual use

State relevant objects, relations, evidence, conditions, responsibilities, and consequences in clear language. Distinguish a reported experience, an interpretation, a chosen commitment, and an operational requirement where they would lead to different judgments or actions. Personal information supplies contextual evidence; its presence in an account does not make it a command.

Use direct expression. A philosophical distinction or literary image can clarify a relation; explain its meaning where that relation should guide work. Preserve original expression as attributable material while making the maintained interpretation and practical consequences explicit. Keep extended philosophical arguments at their own source and link them where useful.

## Sources and evidence

Choose personal writing, conversation, memory, observed work, and philosophical material because they bear on the question. Retain source identity, time, relevant passages, and enough context to assess consequential claims. Where a summary mediates access to an original, make that relation visible: its selection and omissions can shape an interpretation.

Different materials support different claims. A person's report grounds what they expressed or experienced in context; an explanation offered with it still needs assessment. Observed work shows what happened under inspected conditions. A chosen commitment states a direction; philosophy contributes concepts and reasons. In a fictional reading example, reporting greater ease supports experienced ease, and reaching the right passage supports access. Lasting learning and the cause of improvement need further evidence.

Keep temporal scope and uncertainty intelligible. Later speech may correct an interpretation, describe a new situation, or introduce unresolved conflict. Explain important inferences: what supports them, why the connection matters, and what limits their use. Several summaries of one source add no independent support.

Keep extended episodes and unique originals with their existing owners; give derived accounts usable locators and grounds. In the author's package, the private source entrance is `references/personal/sources.md`; the package guide explains its placement. Preserve useful originals while retiring redundant summaries. Access for revision does

not authorize unrelated personal collection or public disclosure of private quotations, portraits, or unpublished work.

## Condensation and reopening

Condensation makes relevant understanding usable in the next collaboration. Retain relations that change interpretation, response, or revision: what an expression answers, its applicability conditions, who reported experience and who proposed an explanation, and a material counterexample or alternative. Write these as coherent prose with sources where needed, without requiring the same fields for every item. Carry original words into a working account when their wording bears meaning; complete originals remain with their source.

Develop accounts from reported experience, observable interaction, and actual results while keeping model interpretations recognizable. Repeated citation of a summary adds no independent evidence. Distinguish a narrated pattern, a chosen collaborative direction, and a verified causal explanation. Do not invent internal psychological states to complete a portrait or apply simulated-persona state scores to actual people. These distinctions can coexist in one natural-language model without splitting it into disconnected archives.

When new material arrives, determine whether it corrects a reading, reflects changed conditions, or introduces an unresolved difference. Qualify, withdraw, or reorganize the relevant account rather than only appending traits; retain the original event and the time its interpretation formed. Check rewritten understanding against currently relevant sources so repeated summarization does not turn inference into fact. Recurring words can provide retrieval entrances; frequency alone does not determine their relational meaning. Newer expression does not override all older material merely by being later.

At useful maintenance points, examine whether the next counterpart can still recover applicability, actual purpose, material open questions, and a path to the grounds. Restore omissions that change those judgments; details irrelevant to current use can remain at their source. A model response and its acceptance, rejection, or modification may themselves become later material, but do not automatically prove the model's prior interpretation. The argument is developed in Condensing revisable relations.

## Let philosophy revise personal support material

Bring developed philosophy into contact with existing personal material. Which interpretations does it clarify? Which distinctions were missing? Which summaries now mislead? Rewrite derived material so experience, interpretation, chosen direction, and uncertainty remain intelligible. Philosophy helps formulate understanding; attributable expression and actual use ground its personal application.

When a public argument is already maintained elsewhere, link it and retain the private meaning and evidence that this account needs. This keeps the support useful as the philosophy changes.

## Let philosophy and personal material revise working accounts

Read the philosophy alongside the personal references refreshed through the sequence above. The six files are working models serving a fitting personal environment, with psychological understanding among their grounds. In the author's YinYang, orientation articulates adopted values and direction; person grounds understanding of the actual person; counterpart relates available capacity to wanted contribution; relationship explains joint activity; environment explains its realization. The writing guides develop these different responsibilities.

Preserve supported substance and rewrite the relations that changed. Distinguish preference from explanatory hypothesis, wanted role from demonstrated capability, and selected arrangement from observed effect. Read neighboring accounts together so the revision remains coherent. Either participant can generate, object, reason, and revise.

Reconsider the actual revision method too. If it repeatedly creates unnecessary work, obscures a judgment, or fails to carry a change into use, revise the relevant guidance and check whether the new approach helps. Another person's practice can call for different objects, organization, or methods.

## Reread personal material and assess the working model

For understanding one's psychological experience, begin primarily with relevant `personal` material and its sources: episodes, expressions, relationships, reported experience, and tentative interpretations. The model helps locate and organize these materials; the person can recognize fit or mismatch, offer exceptions, or reconsider a reading. Their preservation supplies material for understanding, not a guarantee that an interpretation is correct.

Read the six working files for a connected but different question: does this understanding lead to a suitable counterpart, division of work, and personal environment? Even `situated/person.md` selects what ordinary collaboration needs. It does not replace the richer personal material. A useful workflow change can establish better fit without validating a psychological explanation.

One path brings authored philosophy to the personal reference material and its realization: how do these explanations understand self and others, what life does the arrangement support, and which values and concepts need revision too? Another begins with recurring experiences, comparing what happened, how the person understood

the other, what response they expected, and how their own actions participated in the resulting relationship. Examine actual demands, conditions, and dependencies alongside the proposed relational explanation.

Both paths retain revisable interpretations. Personal rereading is limited to organizing experience, articulating questions, and increasing self-understanding. Distinguish what the person said, what the model inferred, and what actually changed in the environment. Explicit purposes and preferences can inform tool and workflow changes. These records are not psychological measurements, clinical conclusions, or grounds for self-directed intervention. For mental health concerns, use them to communicate with qualified professionals rather than undertake self-help psychological analysis, assessment, or treatment. Rereading one's patterns develops the philosophical resources; the use notice states the evaluation limits. Document revisions and environmental changes establish their respective results, not changes in psychological states or mechanisms.

## Let the whole YinYang revise Skills and the environment

Use the connected philosophy and personal understanding to assess the Skills and arrangements relevant to the intended result. Do their purposes, instructions, examples, resources, and actual behavior support the contribution wanted? Include prompts, tools, and interfaces where their dependencies affect it. Specialist Skills retain their own methods and task responsibilities.

Repair actual mismatches: contradictory instructions, inaccessible context, an unsuitable interface, or machinery whose contribution has disappeared. Remove displaced guidance and keep what still works. The environment writing guide develops realization; use your environment's actual authoring, implementation, and publication routes.

## Make webpage revisions visible before publication

The author's practice includes a public website. When revising its diagrams, the model shows the changed diagrams in the conversation. For a new or substantially changed page, it shows a readable rendering of the actual unpublished version and explains consequential changes before publishing. A further material edit calls for an updated preview of that version.

This lets the person encounter the work while it can still change. Already authorized publication continues, incorporating feedback when it arrives; personal authentication, consent, and explicit stopping boundaries keep their scope. A practice without a website can use the relevant equivalent: read a draft, try an interface, or inspect a work before sharing it.

## Follow the result back into understanding

Compare a summary with its evidence, a generated copy with its source, and a completion claim with the result reached through the actual entrypoint. An unavailable account

calls for delivery repair; an account faithfully followed but producing an unsuitable contribution calls for examining its meaning or the selected relationship.

Carry authorized changes through the affected sources and consumers, then read back what is available to the intended reader or working model. Where copies depend on an authored source, update them through their actual route. Keep private material within its authorized audience.

Compare the intended result with the observable outcome and explain required differences still open. Return to personal material, working accounts, or philosophy when evidence challenges them. Useful output, collaborative fit, and personal development have different grounds; let the claim match what the revision and subsequent use actually establish.

# Appendix III · Further reading

## Philosophical readings

中文版 · Psychological readings · Engineering readings

Use this guide to locate the intellectual sources behind YinYang's arguments. The reading map locates the arguments themselves; this page explains which originals bear on them and where an interpretation extends its source. Select by question and read the relevant passage in context. These sources neither supply a personal portrait nor establish a psychological mechanism.

### Heraclitus: fire, measure, and opposing tension

B6 concerns the daily-new Sun, B30 fire and measure, and B51 bow and lyre. B2 and B50 provide the wider context for logos beyond an individual speaker. Daniel W. Graham's scholarly account, especially sections 3–4, explains disputed readings of fire, unity, and opposition.

The stealing-fire essay draws on this lineage to understand persistence and change, organizing activity histories as event streams. It does not attribute a modern computational ontology or formal calculus to Heraclitus. Whether the historical Heraclitus was a fire monist remains disputed. YinYang adopts contemporary fire monism to express the world's becoming and transformation; computational ontology constructs process representations through objects, events, states, and relations. World, process, and expression connects that understanding with naturalism, shared physical realization, and computational representation; B30 does not establish a modern physical theory. Paraconsistent Logic explains non-explosive consequence and its difference from dialetheism: tolerating inconsistent information need not declare contradictions true.

### YinYang and Taiji

Zhou Dunyi's *Taijitu shuo* connects movement and stillness through mutual grounding and continuing transformation. *Xici*, upper connects change with ongoing generation; *Xici*, lower offers the Sun and Moon producing illumination through their reciprocal movement.

Mutual becoming through YinYang and Taiji quotes and develops these Zhou Dunyi and *Xici* passages. *Zhuangzi*, Tian Zifang connects interaction, harmony, and generation as additional reading. Its fish-body/eye distinction is a contemporary interpretation of roles and actual participants, not the sole historical meaning or an identification of the familiar Shuang yu with Zhou's original diagram. The YinYang and Taiji essay places the

Sun–Moon–Earth relation within this movement: Sun and Moon express differentiated generation, reception, and shaping. Person and model are actual participants whose emphases can be retained or exchanged; Earth is the answering material and shared living environment.

## Hegel: sublation, history, and spirit

The *Encyclopaedia Logic*, §§79–81, and the development of §82 present understanding, dialectic, and speculation as connected moments: fixing determinations, examining their own limitations, and grasping affirmative content within opposition. They inform the reading of consistent views and common consequences. Repair semantics retains its own definitions; the philosophical comparison asks how difference contributes to commonality.

The Preface to the *Phenomenology of Spirit*, paragraph 18, offers the thought of return to self through otherness, developed here in the dialectical meaning of role change as an interpretation of finite cooperation. The Introduction, paragraphs 84–86, examines changes in knowledge, object, and criterion through experience. The account of premises and philosophical models uses it to question the concepts organizing judgment. Read alongside Lacan's dialectical reversal to compare return through the other, revision of criteria, and changes of subjective position.

Science of Logic, "Being," §§184–187 develops cessation and preservation in sublation. Query rewriting and sublation uses this relation for a bounded comparison with query rewriting; a technical equivalence does not prove a thesis about Hegel's whole dialectic.

The Introduction to the Philosophy of History, part III connects spirit's self-knowledge with freedom and world history. The Philosophy of Spirit, §§553–564 locates absolute spirit relative to subjective and objective spirit and develops art within that account. World, process, and expression keeps these categories distinct from generic stages of a feedback loop.

## Wittgenstein: pictures and philosophical therapy

Read *Philosophical Investigations*, Part I, §§109, 115, and 133 together. The link supplies the German original; section numbers let readers locate the same remarks in a translation.

| Passage | What to attend to |
|---|---|
| §109 | How examining language and describing its use can work on a philosophical difficulty. Ask which relation becomes clearer when an apparent demand is described in context. |
| §115 | How a picture embedded in language can hold thought captive. Ask what a description makes seem inevitable and which alternatives it hides. |

| Passage | What to attend to |
| --- | --- |
| §133 | Why philosophical work admits different methods compared to therapies, and how clarification can make it possible to stop. Ask what has changed when the original problem loses its grip. |

The fire essay applies this route to pictures of obligatory frontier pursuit and returns their demands to surrounding life. That application belongs to this collection. Personal understanding then distinguishes clarifying concepts such as ability or progress from proposing a psychological explanation of a person's activity. The two can inform one another without a convincing description settling an empirical claim.

## Buddhist reading: fire, cessation, and crossing

Begin with the *Fire Sermon*, *Saṃyutta Nikāya* 35.28 and the *Nibbāna Sutta*, *Saṃyutta Nikāya* 38.1. The former describes senses, consciousness, contact, and feeling as burning with passion, aversion, and delusion, then develops dispassion and release. The latter identifies nirvana with the ending of those three and points to the noble eightfold path. Both links give Ṭhānissaro Bhikkhu's translations.

Ask what is burning and what ceases. How might developing a capability and loosening grasping support one another, and why are they not equivalent? Borrowed fire and nirvana connects knowledge and creative capability with examining desire, habit, and self-image. Buddhist liberation thus participates in reflection on cultivation's purpose; the contrast between these two meanings of fire is this work's construction.

Read the water-snake and raft passages together in the *Alagaddūpama Sutta*, *Majjhima Nikāya* 22, translated by Ṭhānissaro Bhikkhu. The sections “The Water-snake Simile” and “The Raft Simile” locate the relevant portions of the discourse. The translator's introduction and notes are commentary accompanying the translated text.

The water-snake passage concerns how a teaching is grasped and understood; the raft passage follows a traveler who builds and uses a raft to cross, then considers whether to keep carrying it. Read the complete movement: what the means makes possible, how it is used, and when carrying it becomes an unnecessary burden. This gives “letting go” a situation and a purpose.

The raft connects the preceding question of purpose with means: tools, conceptual models, and the little-fire self-image can contribute to life, remain revisable, and be released when their work is done. These three discourses supply the specific sources for this dialogue. Creative cultivation is the work's contemporary development, while nirvana retains the liberative meaning stated in the discourses. This reading path leaves room for further inquiry rather than summarizing Buddhist traditions.

## Nietzsche: three metamorphoses and creation

Nietzsche's Thus Spoke Zarathustra, Part One, "The Three Metamorphoses" presents bearing, negation, and new creation through the camel, lion, and child. What kind of person do we want to cultivate? — Baby Heraclitus already draws on this line: the child concerns beginning and creating anew, not abandoning judgment or prescribing stages everyone must complete.

## James and Bergson: the stream of thought and duration

| Author and original work | Connection in the collection |
|---|---|
| William James, The Principles of Psychology, chapter IX, "The Stream of Thought" | Change, continuity, personal character, and selection in thought. Forming a life trajectory uses this to examine experiential continuity while distinguishing present experience, retained records, and working models. |
| Henri Bergson, Time and Free Will, chapter II | Duration and measurable, spatialized time. The collection's distinctions among clock time, experiential rhythms, and update order enter into dialogue with this account without equating them. |

## Freud: negation and acceptance

Freud's "Negation" (1925), pp. 1–3 distinguishes intellectual recognition and acceptance in an analytic account. Its interpretive inversions do not license treating ordinary denial as admission.

## Lacan: enunciation, retroaction, and singular creation

Lacan brings three connected questions to this collection: how people acquire a position through language and images, how later speech changes the meaning of earlier expression, and how singular practices participate in a person's mode of existence. The site develops these questions into contemporary accounts of personal understanding, model collaboration, and the sinthome.

Conceptual explanations, examples, formal translations, and original-text references are gathered in A guide to Lacanian concepts: from original texts to personal practice. Its dialectical reading follows recognition, desire, and speech before comparing them with model revision. The guide also develops the Other, the divided subject, retroaction, the three registers, and the sinthome, distinguishing the original concepts from this site's extensions.

## Fire myths: Prometheus, Kuafu, and living together

Prometheus is a mythic figure; Hesiod and Plato supply different texts through which this collection encounters him. Hesiod's *Theogony*, lines 507–616 gives fire theft and its carrier a narrative form. *Shan Hai Jing*, Haiwai Beijing supplies Kuafu's pursuit. Stealing

fire and cultivating creative capacity compares pursuing overwhelming power with bringing usable capacities into a finite life.

Plato's *Protagoras*, 320c–322d places the myth in Protagoras's account of civic learning: arts and fire are followed by reverence and justice shared by all. Plato is the dialogue's author, Protagoras a thinker represented within it, and Prometheus a character in its myth. The fire essay takes their relation as a comparison between technical means and purposes of living together. Its AI application is a contemporary argument, rather than a claim about an ancient prediction.

## Deleuze and Guattari: connections, production, and becoming

The independently authored Machines and becoming essay reads *Anti-Oedipus*, chapter 1 and chapter 4's first positive task of schizoanalysis, alongside *A Thousand Plateaus*, plateaus 4 and 6. Desiring-machines open the question of what connections produce; assemblages bring bodies and expression into view. The essay distinguishes a process of becoming from a clinical condition and treats its songwriting and harness examples as contemporary comparisons. This provides a neighboring question to the sinthome essay: through what connections can an established personal practice arrangement produce new capacities?

## Personal practice: Bruner, Foucault, Hobbes, and Mill

Bruner's *Life as Narrative* and Foucault's *Technologies of the Self* inform Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity's connection between self-expression, continuing practice, and change. Narrative can organize later understanding; writing and relations with others can participate in self-transformation. The model-supported extension belongs to this collection.

Personal-first humanism also reads Hobbes's *Leviathan*, chapter IV on names and particular things, and Mill's *On Liberty*, chapter III on individuality and experiments of living. These sources clarify the questions of description and plural coexistence. The present personal-first orientation remains a separately argued choice.

## Inquiry and frameworks: Peirce, Dewey, Carnap, and Feng Ye

Reasoning uses Peirce's 1908 manuscript MS 841 to distinguish explanatory hypotheses, experiential consequences, and assessment. Embodied experimental philosophy reads Dewey's *Reconstruction in Philosophy*, chapters IV–V: experience includes acting and undergoing consequences. Together these routes give inquiry room to propose, act, return, and revise.

Carnap's *Empiricism, Semantics, and Ontology* distinguishes questions within a framework from its practical adoption. Finite inquiry and abstraction compares this collection's question-relative account with Professor Feng Ye's *Studies in No-Self Physicalism*, especially §§1.1, 6.5, and 7.4.2. Their shared methodological questions about finite understanding and representation do not establish identical accounts of physical realization. YinYang adopts one physical reality as its common ground while using question-relative abstraction; particular reductions and bridge assumptions require their own support. Compare the actual arguments rather than inferring either agreement or disagreement from their labels.

## Will, irrationality, and self-conflict: Frankfurt, Davidson, Mele, and Holton

These philosophers give conflict more specific objects: desire and endorsement, resolve and later inclination, evidence and motivation, and a person's interpretation of themselves. They are supplementary entrances, not proof that the collection accepts one shared architecture of mind.

| Philosopher and original | Central question |
|---|---|
| Harry Frankfurt, Freedom of the Will and the Concept of a Person (1971) | How does wanting something differ from wanting a particular desire to become one's effective motive? First-order desires and second-order volitions offer one analysis of conflict. |
| Donald Davidson, Paradoxes of Irrationality (1982); Deception and Division (reprinted in the 2004 collection) | How can reasons, causes, and mental partitioning help explain irrationality and self-deception? Partitioning is an explanatory proposal to compare with alternatives. |
| Alfred R. Mele, Real Self-Deception (1997) | Must self-deception involve intentional self-deception or simultaneous contrary beliefs? Examine motivationally biased evidence processing and the accompanying commentaries and reply. |
| Richard Holton, Intention and Weakness of Will (1999); What Is the Role of the Self in Self-Deception? (2001) | Resolve, premature abandonment, reasonable reconsideration after conditions change, and understanding one's own beliefs. Author-manuscript pagination may differ from the journals. |

For conflict in experience, relationships, and therapy, continue to psychological readings.

## Lakoff, Johnson, and Gentner: metaphor and relational analogy

George Lakoff and Mark Johnson's Metaphors We Live By, chapters 1–3 concerns metaphor in everyday conceptual life. Dedre Gentner's Structure-Mapping (1983) makes relational mapping explicit. Writing a personal philosophy through literary program-

ming and From personal philosophy to personal models already use these resources. Metaphor gives understanding a form; particular analogical inferences still need checking.

## Mind, knowledge, and explanation

Clark and Chalmers's *The Extended Mind* informs Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity's account of active environmental supports. From personal philosophy to personal models connects that question with Hollan, Hutchins, and Kirsh's distributed-cognition research: understanding can develop across people, models, records, and tools.

Varela, Evan Thompson, and Eleanor Rosch's The Embodied Mind (1991) brings cognitive science, lived experience, and contemplative practice together; Shared reflection and continued cultivation already uses it to examine embodied participation. Hollan, Hutchins, and Kirsh's Distributed Cognition (2000) supplies the original account of cognition across people, artifacts, and time.

Joshua Knobe and Shaun Nichols's An Experimental Philosophy Manifesto (2008) introduces an empirical research orientation; the linked author-hosted file is a proof. Embodied experimental philosophy distinguishes this tradition from personal philosophical experimentation through making, participation, and reflection.

Gordana Dodig-Crnkovic's Information, Computation, Cognition (2013) is another natural-philosophical resource already used in Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity: informational structure, computational dynamics, and agency across levels. It neighbors embodied, extended, and distributed cognition without being the same theory or establishing that human experience is a digital algorithm.

For psychological processes, empirical assessment, belief, and interaction, continue to psychological readings. Their theories and evidence investigate how knowing actually happens; philosophy continues to ask about explanation, grounds for knowledge, and the scope of mind.

Technical sources for the Gödel Machine and Darwin Gödel Machine appear in engineering readings. Preference harness retains its philosophical comparisons while preserving the assumptions and scope of formal repair, inference, and query transformation.

## Source scope

These links preserve the public intellectual sources and their conceptual limits. Personal evidence and the history of adopting or revising an interpretation remain in the situated package's source account. The reading map does not replace reading the passages that matter to an actual argument.

# Psychological readings

Psychological conflict, belief and reasoning, and interaction research offer ways to understand how people experience, interpret, and respond to their lives. For ordinary users, this repository's route is for the model to work with philosophy and personal material to help form and revise an understanding of the person. The person contributes experience, purposes, recognition, and correction. Psychological research and professional methods are collected at the end.

Links lead to publisher records, samples, author materials, or public full texts.

## Psychological conflict, relationships, and change

As environments and relationships change, earlier wishes, commitments, and habits can pull against new circumstances. These readings address ambivalence about change, competing needs, self-criticism and protection, love and hostility toward the same person, and knowing something without being able to act on it. Different theories explain these phenomena through their own concepts and evidence.

### More accessible books

| Author and book | Reading entrance |
|---|---|
| Russ Harris, The Happiness Trap, second edition (2022) | A general-reader entrance to acceptance and commitment therapy (ACT): entanglement with thoughts and feelings, values, and action. More approachable than beginning with its theoretical manual. |
| Richard C. Schwartz, No Bad Parts (2021) | A general-reader entrance to Internal Family Systems (IFS), using parts and their protective roles to understand self-criticism and internal opposition. |
| Jeffrey E. Young and Janet S. Klosko, Reinventing Your Life | An accessible schema-oriented account of recurring life patterns, needs, and coping, illustrated through cases. Pair with the professional schema-therapy text below. |
| Karen Horney, Our Inner Conflicts | A classic entrance to the tensions among moving toward, against, and away from others. Read its diagnostic vocabulary in its historical context. |

### Contemporary psychotherapy: understanding conflict and change

These readings cover approaches developed in recent decades and their updated textbooks, including theory, cases, and dialogue.

| Approach and representative book | Question to bring to the reading |
|---|---|
| ACT: Hayes, Strosahl, and Wilson, Acceptance and Commitment Therapy, second edition; Harris, ACT Made Simple, second edition | Professional theory and a more accessible practice introduction. How can action follow values without first eliminating inner experiences? Focus on |

| Approach and representative book | Question to bring to the reading |
|---|---|
| | psychological flexibility, defusion, acceptance, and committed action. |
| DBT: Marsha M. Linehan, DBT Skills Training Manual, revised edition (2025) | A professional skills-teaching manual. How can acceptance and change coexist? Examine mindfulness, interpersonal effectiveness, emotion regulation, and distress tolerance. The companion handouts are a separate volume. |
| Schema therapy: Young, Klosko, and Weishaar, Schema Therapy: A Practitioner's Guide | A professional text on needs, early schemas, coping, and modes in recurring internal and relational conflicts. Pair with the accessible Reinventing Your Life. |
| IFS: Schwartz and Martha Sweezy, Internal Family Systems Therapy, second edition (2019) | A professional text on opposition, relationships, and change among protective parts; chapter 11 specifically addresses protector polarizations. |
| Emotion-focused therapy: Leslie S. Greenberg, Emotion-Focused Therapy: Coaching Clients to Work Through Their Feelings, second edition | A professional text on emotional functions and expression, self-criticism, unfinished relational experience, and emotional transformation. This entry refers to Greenberg's emotion-focused approach. |
| Motivational interviewing: William R. Miller and Stephen Rollnick, Motivational Interviewing, fourth edition (2023) | For helping professions and practitioners. Follow ambivalence about changing and reasons to retain the present arrangement through engaging, focusing, evoking, and planning. |
| Coherence therapy and memory reconsolidation: Bruce Ecker, Robin Ticic, and Laurel Hulley, Unlocking the Emotional Brain, second edition (2024) | Advanced theory and cases concerning conflict between explicit wishes for change and implicit emotional learning. Distinguish reconsolidation research, the authors' clinical interpretation, and evidence for particular methods. |
| Mentalizing: Carla Sharp and Dickon Bevington, Mentalizing in Psychotherapy (2022) | A professional introduction with dialogues and cases. How do people understand their own and others' mental states under relational strain while keeping interpretations revisable? |

## Classic conflict theories and psychoanalysis

| Author and original work | Reading purpose |
|---|---|
| Freud, Introductory Lectures, Lecture XXIII; The Ego and the Id | Historical theoretical accounts of compromise between opposing tendencies and pressures among identifications, reality, and the ego ideal. |
| Freud, Mourning and Melancholia | Examine how love, hostility, identification, and self-reproach are related in the explanation. |
| Melanie Klein, Notes on Some Schizoid Mechanisms (1946) | The trust's original-work reading entrance. Examine splitting, projection, and different aspects of the same object alongside the earlier depressive-position account. |

| Author and original work | Reading purpose |
|---|---|
| D. W. Winnicott, Playing and Reality; Ego Distortion in Terms of True and False Self | Transitional space between creation and encounter, and the relationships among compliance, spontaneity, and true/false self. |

For Freud, Lacan, and philosophical discussions of will and self-deception, see philosophical readings.

## Belief and reasoning

These references address belief revision, information access, and reasoning, connecting formal rules, particular situations, and actual change.

| Paper or reference | Reading purpose |
|---|---|
| Logic of Belief Revision | Use AGM and related frameworks to distinguish expansion, contraction, and revision, while keeping formal rationality distinct from a person's actual changes. |
| Dynamic Epistemic Logic | Compare information events, knowledge and belief states, and updates, including public announcements and other information events. |

### Research on conflict, fragmentation, and dynamic revision

| Paper | Further question |
|---|---|
| Elga and Rayo, Fragmentation and Information Access | A 2019 author manuscript of the 2021 chapter. How does possessing information differ from accessing it now, and how are beliefs organized across contexts? |
| Grodniewicz (2024), Belief Revision in Psychotherapy | A philosophical paper on why a new understanding in one setting may not generalize to another. |
| Mansell and Huddy (2020), Computational Models of Psychological Change and Recovery | Theory and simulations: how can conflict and reorganization be represented when goals impose incompatible references on the same controlled variable? |
| Kronemyer and Bystritsky (2014), A Non-Linear Dynamical Approach to Belief Revision in Cognitive Behavioral Therapy | A theoretical proposal connecting dynamics with belief revision. |

## Interaction research

These studies address meaning, coordination, epistemic trust, and learning in relationships.

| Paper | Content |
| --- | --- |
| De Jaegher and Di Paolo (2007), Participatory Sense-Making | Include interaction, coordination, and sense-making in an explanation; ask what separate descriptions of participants' internal states might omit. |
| Fonagy and Allison (2014), The Role of Mentalizing and Epistemic Trust in the Therapeutic Relationship | Institutional manuscript entrance. Connect understanding mental states, epistemic trust, and social learning. |

# Psychological research and professional methods

Professional references on case formulation, experiential material, and language-model research.

## Case formulation and psychodynamics

| Book or chapter | Content and source |
| --- | --- |
| The Psychodynamic Formulation Collective, Psychodynamic Formulation: An Expanded Approach (2022) | A professional textbook on psychodynamic formulation, including development, conflict and defense, relationships, self, sociocultural context, and collaborative formulation. The publisher provides a contents list and first-chapter sample. |
| Nancy McWilliams, Psychoanalytic Diagnosis, second edition (2011) | A professional conceptual and case textbook on psychoanalytic personality theory, defenses, and relational organization, with publisher contents and a sample. |
| Tracy D. Eells, Psychotherapy Case Formulation, second edition (2026) | A case-formulation textbook addressing explanatory hypotheses, quality, and clinical application. The link leads to the APA publisher record. |
| Jacqueline B. Persons and Michael A. Tompkins, Cognitive-behavioral Case Formulation (2007) | A chapter in Eells's edited *Handbook of Psychotherapy Case Formulation*, second edition, pp. 290–316. Author institution's bibliography · Author-uploaded chapter. |

## Experience and individual differences

| Book or paper | Content and source |
| --- | --- |
| Braun and Clarke (2006), Using Thematic Analysis in Psychology | A foundational qualitative-methods paper addressing theoretical positions, analytic choices, and patterns in material. |
| Oblak et al. (2024), Crisis of Objectivity | An open case study constructing an individualized network from experiential material to understand connections among difficulties. |
| Mischel and Shoda (1995), A Cognitive-Affective System Theory of Personality | A theory of situations, cognitive-affective relations, and behavioral variation, including “if–then” behavioral signatures. |

| Book or paper | Content and source |
| --- | --- |
| Navarro and Foxcroft, Learning Statistics with jamovi (2025) | An open textbook covering measurement, research design, descriptive statistics, sampling and estimation, correlation, and regression. |

## Research methods and model explanation

| Book or paper | Content |
| --- | --- |
| Borsboom et al. (2021), Theory Construction Methodology | Psychological theory construction and the relationships among data, phenomena, explanations, and formal models. |
| Jhangiani et al., Research Methods in Psychology, fourth edition | An open textbook covering hypotheses, qualitative research, observation, cases, measurement, and research design. |

## Language models and personal understanding

| Research | Subject and available material |
| --- | --- |
| Hossain et al. (2025), AutoPsyC · Code | Recognizing psychodynamic conflicts in semi-structured interviews, comparing prompting, retrieval, and fine-tuning. |
| Hu et al., TheraMind · Code | Research on a longitudinal counseling agent, evaluating cross-session information and strategy adjustment through simulated conversations. |
| Zhou et al. (2026), ReaLMem and ChronoProfiler | A benchmark and profiling study of long-term multimodal personal archives, distinguishing factual recall, persona inference, and predictive personalization. |

Related work includes Vazire (2010) on self–other knowledge asymmetry, Peters, Cerf, and Matz (2024) comparing GPT-4 personality inferences with self-report Big Five measures, and Burger et al. (2022) connecting case formulation with Bayesian idiographic networks in Clinical PREMISE.

# Engineering readings

Engineering gives an understanding a form that can run, be observed, and be changed. Use this guide for the concepts and sources needed by that realization: learning maps, command lines, version history, software design, algorithms, systems, data tools, and physical conditions. Choose the part that helps the actual work; Environment writing guide explains how its result connects to the intended collaboration. Courses, documentation, and source repositories are accompanied by useful textbooks and papers.

Tool pages locate usable tools and Skills; this reading map explains their concepts, methods, and implementation. Documentation can support both learning and reference during actual work.

**Choose a main thread that connects with your starting point.** Suggested entrances are CS 61A and Composing Programs for programming, Princeton's courses and Algorithms for algorithms, CS:APP for systems, and MIT and Sipser for computation theory, with Arora–Barak for further depth. Choose among them according to current interests and questions. Courses offer teaching, assignments, and projects; books develop connected concepts; documentation references particular interfaces. Links include course notes, open textbooks, and publisher records.

## Find the map and build a usable environment

| Material | Where to begin |
|---|---|
| CS DIY · source repository | An open self-study map initiated by PKUFlyingPig. Read its usage guide, then select programming, mathematics, algorithms, or systems courses from your existing foundation. |
| Tsinghua's computer-science student association: SAST skill docs | Chinese introductory skill documentation. Follow the immediate need into problem solving, Git, Linux, editors, languages, and development frameworks, connecting foundational courses with actual work. |
| MIT Missing Semester 2026 | Begin with the shell, command-line environment, and development workflows, using the current course's notes and small exercises. Earlier offerings remain available through the site's archive; keep each year's lesson sequence distinct. |
| William Shotts, The Linux Command Line | The author's open books introduce files, permissions, processes, pipes, redirection, and scripts. macOS and Linux share some Unix concepts, but command options and system administration require the target system's documentation. |
| Official Vim documentation · Vim user manual | Begin with `vimtutor` for modes, movement, and editing, then use the manual for command compo- |

| Material | Where to begin |
| --- | --- |
| | sition, searching, and substitution; consult `:help` for particular options. This learning entrance can coexist with your own editor choice. |

A useful beginning is a small project built with model assistance whose inputs, outputs, files, and results you can understand. Follow these entrances when a concept becomes unclear. Engineering reading can interleave with the work already underway.

## Git and GitHub: continuing a work through its changes

| Material | What it addresses |
| --- | --- |
| Chacon and Straub, Pro Git, second edition | Chapters 1–3 introduce repositories, commits, branches, and merges; chapter 10 explains the structure beneath history. Git is the version-control system. |
| GitHub getting-started documentation | An entrance to repository pages, collaboration, and hosting. GitHub is a platform built around Git; the two have distinct responsibilities. |
| GitHub Pull Requests documentation | Compare changes, request reviews, and handle branches and merges. Read the reasons and outcomes of a change, as well as the interface operations. |

## Software design and computer systems

### Programming and abstraction: CS 61A and SICP

**CS 61A is the foundational entrance here.** It develops an understanding of programs through functions, data, and interpretation. Software construction then organizes existing programming ability into reliable software.

| Course and book | Content and purpose |
| --- | --- |
| Berkeley CS 61A · John DeNero, Composing Programs | A course paired with its online text. From functions, higher-order functions, recursion, and data abstraction, proceed to objects, interpreters, and different programming approaches. Small exercises and projects make behavior and abstraction boundaries concrete. |
| Abelson and Sussman, SICP, second edition · full PDF hosted by MIT | Develop procedural and data abstraction, state, interpreters, and evaluation through Scheme. This original work is an important intellectual background for CS 61A and a deeper reading beyond Composing Programs. |
| SICP JavaScript adaptation / Comparison Edition | Compare the Scheme original with its JavaScript adaptation; the site also links to Interactive SICP |

| Course and book | Content and purpose |
|---|---|
| | JS for reading and evaluation. Choose according to existing language experience and the question; the versions correspond while differing in implementation. |

### Software construction and design

| Courses, notes, and reference books | Content and purpose |
|---|---|
| John Ousterhout, A Philosophy of Software Design | Author's book and course resources. Study complexity, modules, interfaces, and information hiding. “Philosophy” names design thinking in the title; this map locates the book by its software-engineering purpose. |
| MIT 6.031 Software Construction (2021) · readings listed on the course page | After programming foundations, study specifications, testing, abstract data types, and concurrency to develop working code into software with explicit behavioral contracts. Its own notes are the paired reading; Ousterhout is adjacent design reading. |

### From programs to machines, operating systems, and networks

| Course and book | Content and purpose |
|---|---|
| CMU 15-213 Introduction to Computer Systems · Bryant and O’Hallaron, Computer Systems: A Programmer’s Perspective, 3rd edition | CS:APP introduces data representations, machine code, the memory hierarchy, linking, processes, virtual memory, and system I/O from a programmer's perspective. The authors' site also provides labs and student resources. |
| Arpaci-Dusseau and Arpaci-Dusseau, Operating Systems: Three Easy Pieces | The authors' open textbook and projects. Understand operating systems through virtualization, concurrency, and persistence, selecting chapters alongside a systems course. |
| MIT 6.1810 Operating System Engineering (2025) · the same year's xv6 text and source entrance | Connect text, implementation, and labs through a small RISC-V operating system. Match the text and labs to the course year and source version. |

## Algorithms, computation, and complexity

### Algorithms: begin with Princeton's courses and textbook

| Course and book | Content and purpose |
|---|---|
| Princeton Algorithms, Part I and Part II · Sedgewick and Wayne, Algorithms, 4th edition | The principal entrance. Courses and book develop sorting, searching, graphs, strings, and their data structures. The companion site supplies code, exercises, notes, and course links. The courses primarily use Java. |

| Course and book | Content and purpose |
|---|---|
| Berkeley CS170 · Dasgupta, Papadimitriou, and Vazirani, Algorithms (DPV), author resources | Deepen algorithm design, correctness, and complexity arguments through divide-and-conquer, greedy methods, dynamic programming, linear programming, and reductions. This is a different Algorithms from the Princeton textbook. |
| MIT 6.006 Introduction to Algorithms (2020) · CLRS, Introduction to Algorithms, 3rd edition | The course supplies its own notes and lists CLRS's third edition as supplementary reading. Use it to strengthen mathematical modeling, data structures, correctness, and asymptotic analysis. A 4th edition is also available; match chapter and exercise numbers when using it. |
| Jeff Erickson, Algorithms | Author's open textbook, notes, and exercises. Study recursion, dynamic programming, greedy methods, and graph algorithms, including correctness and cost. |

## Computation theory: MIT and Sipser, then Arora–Barak

| Course and book | Content and purpose |
|---|---|
| MIT 18.404J Theory of Computation (2020) · Michael Sipser, Introduction to the Theory of Computation, 3rd edition | The foundational thread. The course offers lectures and exercises; the book moves from automata and computability into complexity. The author's book page provides edition information and errata. Match exercise numbers to the edition used by the course. |
| MIT 6.045J Automata, Computability, and Complexity (2011) · course notes and textbook information | Another organization of the foundational field, useful for supplementary topic reading. |
| Sanjeev Arora and Boaz Barak, Computational Complexity: A Modern Approach | The advanced thread. With a foundation in computational models, reductions, and basic complexity classes, investigate classes, randomness, interactive proofs, and lower bounds. The authors provide a public draft and companion resources; distinguish the draft from the published edition. |
| Boaz Barak, Introduction to Theoretical Computer Science | Open textbook connecting models of computation, computability, and efficiency to complexity. Distinguish impossibility, high computational cost, and something not yet implemented by the current program. |

Algorithms and complexity analysis establish properties under formal conditions; real systems also depend on data, implementation, and machine resources. Speed measurements and asymptotic analysis offer two scales of observation.

### Original sources behind this collection's comparisons

| Source | Connection to the essays |
|---|---|
| A. M. Turing (1936), On Computable Numbers, with an Application to the Entscheidungsproblem, especially §6 | The universal machine supplies the formal reference for the interpreter analogy in From personal philosophy to personal models. |
| Thomas R. Gruber (1993), A Translation Approach to Portable Ontology Specifications, §§1–2 | Objects, relations, and shared conceptualization in knowledge representation. Read alongside the engineering ontology developed in Stealing fire and cultivating creative capacity; that essay extends the source into its own account. |
| Donald E. Knuth, Literate Programming | The established practice of organizing explanation and program code together. Compare its technical purpose with this collection's broader literary natural-language programming. |

## Self-improvement research

| Documentation or paper | Content |
|---|---|
| Gödel Machine and Darwin Gödel Machine | Two entrances to technical self-improvement research: proof-guided work and empirical evaluation, respectively. Compare their objectives, assumptions, and verification before reading this collection's analogies. |

## Physical conditions, measurement, and feedback

Engineering realization happens in the material world. Programs run on machines, measurement requires devices and time, and interfaces enter human perception and action. Energy, latency, error, and bodily conditions shape actual use.

The Feynman Lectures on Physics provide open online reading: volume I mainly covers mechanics, radiation, and heat; volume II electromagnetism and matter; volume III quantum mechanics. Each volume develops its topics through concepts, derivations, and examples.

Physics investigates regularities; engineering designs and realizes under those conditions. The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering develops their connection with philosophy and psychology.

## Language models, retrieval, and data tools

Books, courses, and official tool references for language models, databases, and retrieval systems.

| Book or course | Content |
|---|---|
| Jurafsky and Martin, Speech and Language Processing, third-edition online draft | A natural-language-processing and language-model textbook covering tokens, embeddings, con- |

| Book or course | Content |
| --- | --- |
| | text, information extraction, time, discourse, and retrieval. The official site provides the text and slides; the Agents chapter remains unwritten in the August 19, 2026 release. |
| Hugging Face Agents Course | An online course introducing models, messages, tools, and observations following actions. |
| Agent Skills overview · Specification | An open format for organizing instructions, scripts, and reference resources. |

| Tool or project | General purpose and official source |
| --- | --- |
| SQLite | An embedded relational database supporting SQL queries and transactions. |
| sqlite-utils · Datasette | The former supplies command-line and Python interfaces for importing and manipulating SQLite data; the latter provides database browsing, queries, and JSON interfaces. |
| PostgreSQL · pgvector | A relational database and its vector-similarity-search extension. |
| Hindsight | An agent memory and retrieval system with retain, recall, and reflect capabilities. |
| Graphiti | Temporal knowledge graphs for agents. |
| Mem0 | Persistent-memory components for agents and applications. |
| Letta | A platform for agents with persistent state and memory management. |

See each project's documentation for its capabilities and operating requirements.

# A guide to Lacanian concepts: from original texts to personal practice

When encountering “the Other,” “retroaction,” “the divided subject,” “full speech,” “half-saying,” or “sinthome,” the difficulty often lies beyond defining an individual word: why do these concepts appear in the same account, and how do they connect to personal models, writing, and tools? This guide approaches them through those relations, for first reading and later review. It offers conceptual explanation alongside the main reading route. Begin wherever a difficulty arises, then return to the original essay.

One important line of inquiry Lacan offers this site is: **how do people express themselves through language and images received from others, and how do expression and its return reveal that they do not fully coincide with that account?** Later expression can change the meaning of earlier speech; an established self-image can also be challenged by new encounters. The later discussions of knots and the sinthome further ask how these different relations connect in a person's concrete existence. Bringing them into model collaboration and engineering realization is work this site develops further.

## First identify the level you are reading

| Reading level | What it does | What to attend to |
|---|---|---|
| Lacan's account | Develops concepts of the subject, language, identification, desire, and the three registers within psychoanalytic questions | The period, question, and conceptual relations of the source text. |
| This site's philosophical development | Uses these concepts to understand expression, oneself and others, model counterparts, and practical arrangements | Which relations are retained and which meanings the author develops further. |
| Bounded formal translation | Represents certain relations through selected symbols, assertions, and rules, and checks their consequences | What is represented, what is assumed, and what remains outside the model. |

All three levels can belong to the same work, while a reader still needs to know what responsibility a particular sentence carries. For example, the subject Lacan discusses is not a database object; putting certain relations into a formal model makes selected relations inspectable. A derivation within a formal system is also different from having established a reliable personal model through actual conversations.

Five short reading paths are available:

- To understand “I,” “ego,” and “others,” begin with language and the Other, then read the ego and the divided subject.

- To understand how a changed participant position can reorganize a problem, read dialectical reversal, then return to the main sequence's how a solution becomes a new problem.
- To understand why an earlier meaning may only become recognizable later, read retroaction and retrospective understanding, then return to speaking and retrospective meaning.
- To understand how sustained writing connects with truth, read full speech, half-saying, and truth, then return to half-saying truth and continuing revision.
- To understand the three registers and the sinthome, begin with the registers, then read the sinthome, and finally return to Forming a sinthome.

## Language, signifiers, and the Other

Begin with a relation when approaching the **signifier (*signifiant*)**: a word, name, or mark works through its differences from and connections to other marks, and through the discourse in which it appears. The description "good student" can connect grades, obedience, expectations, and recognition; in another discourse, the same description may become ironic. Treating it as a label with fixed content misses how it organizes relations between someone and others.

**The Other (*Autre*, often written *A*)** names the locus of otherness in which language and discourse find their place. When someone speaks, they already draw on names, distinctions, and expectations they did not create alone. Parents, teachers, institutions, or a current interlocutor may bear these demands and forms of recognition within a particular relationship, but "the Other" is more than a name for any one of them. In his 1966 radio discussion, p. 2, Lacan describes language as the environment in which a person grows up and raises the relation between the unconscious and the discourse of the Other.

Here this adds a question to understanding oneself and others: **within what relationship was this sentence spoken, and from what position was it heard?** "You can try again" may carry different weight when spoken by a friend, an examiner, or someone with particular significance. Recording the speaker helps recover the event, but understanding their position still requires context. A name or a model-role field alone cannot establish the position of the Other.

A "model counterpart" is also an actual arrangement, with current capabilities, tools, and agreed contributions. Whether a particular model response acquires special authority within this person's relationships is another question to understand. Using a language model does not automatically settle that judgment about the relationship.

## The ego and the divided subject

Approach the **ego (*moi*)** through how someone recognizes a relatively complete image of themself. Lacan's mirror-stage essay (1949) discusses the subject's identification through

an image: the image offers unity while also involving a relation to an external form. "Imaginary" here does not mean "false and therefore useless." An image can actually organize feelings, expectations, and actions.

The **divided subject (*sujet barré*, often written $\bar{S}$ or a barred S)** concerns the subject's relation to representation by signifiers. In "Subversion of the Subject", Lacan proposes that a signifier represents the subject for another signifier. The subject acquires a position through these signifying relations, yet cannot be directly equated with the signifier or statement representing them. Division here concerns this constitutive relation, beyond how much information a self-description omits. It cannot be reduced to "a person contradicts themself," nor is it a popular expression for multiple personalities.

A limited example can make the question recognizable: someone says, "I only want to write the essay well," while repeatedly asking whether the other person approves of them. Beyond stating a writing goal, what response does this sentence seek from the other person? The statement's content and the relational position from which it is spoken may not fully coincide. The example makes the question visible; interpreting a particular person requires further material. One sentence cannot establish a hidden motive.

This site's personal model is a partial understanding of a person within the current question. A connected self-account, a formal view, and the person who continues expressing and acting therefore need to be understood distinctly. Lacan's distinctions make this non-coincidence worth investigating; they do not directly supply an algorithm for generating personal models.

## Metaphor, metonymy, and condensation

In "The Instance of the Letter" (1957), original pagination 505–515, Lacan approaches metaphor and metonymy through relations among signifiers. **Metaphor** involves one signifier substituting for another in a chain and producing a new effect of meaning; the displaced term remains involved through other connections. **Metonymy** concerns connections among signifiers and the movement of meaning, beyond the single rhetorical example of a part standing for a whole.

The relations differ. Metaphoric substitution brings a meaning into view: in a fictional account, "the manager became a judge" gives workplace evaluation relations of trial, defense, and verdict. This does not transfer a fixed bundle of every judicial attribute to the manager. Its effect depends on connections to the surrounding discourse. Lacan develops substitution through Hugo's lines about Boaz and his sheaf. Metonymy concerns connections and movement along the chain. In a hypothetical process of desire, expectation might move from publication to a byline to a particular person's recognition. Objects can change while the relation driving the movement remains a question; the succession of three items alone does not establish a mechanism of desire.

In this account, Freud's **condensation (Verdichtung)** is connected to the superimposition of signifiers and metaphor, while displacement is connected to metonymy. Condensation here belongs to questions about dream-work and the unconscious. It cannot simply be equated with summarization, token reduction, or merging records into a label. This site's relational analogies also draw on other theories; their contributions and differences need explanation through the relations each addresses.

This raises a useful question for personal models: does a compact expression merely shorten material, or has it organized that material anew? “A workshop for joint creation” can gather trial, criticism, and revision while obscuring delegation and completion responsibilities in a particular task. Unfold its relations and return to exchanges that support or challenge them to judge the condensation's fit. Condensing revisable relations develops this site's writing method: a proposal informed by these concepts, not a compression algorithm derived from Lacan.

## The subject supposed to know and the position of interpretation

The **subject supposed to know (sujet supposé savoir)** concerns a position credited with knowledge concerning the subject. In Seminar XI, 10 June 1964, Staferla transcript pp. 161–163, Lacan develops this relation through transference while explaining that the analyst does not thereby possess absolute knowledge. Being supposed to know and actually knowing therefore require separate examination.

This is not another name for knowing a great deal or for trust in general. Within this session's analytic setting, the question concerns whom one addresses and how one expects the other to receive meanings one has not yet grasped. Someone can acknowledge the other's fallibility while still addressing that position of supposed knowledge. The Other as a locus of speech and a person occupying this knowledge position in a particular relationship also cannot simply be equated. The concept questions the relational structure of interpretation rather than ranking people by their quantity of knowledge.

For model collaboration, this raises a question about a personal account's interpretive authority. What comes from sources, actual use, the person's recognition, a sense of completeness, or the model's fluent response? A model interpretation written into an archive and cited by later models acquires no independent support from that repetition. Recognition can show how the account was received without alone establishing its explanation of psychological causes.

This contemporary borrowing examines interpretation, reception, and use; using AI alone does not establish a particular transference relation. A counterpart can contribute understanding the person has not articulated while returning to material, comparing interpretations, and revising accounts it helped form. The account participates in the relationship without acquiring the position of determining the person's final truth.

## Dialectical reversal: changing understanding and position

Lacan's dialectical questions concern how a subject forms through relations that also unsettle their self-understanding. His encounter with Hegel was mediated in part by Kojève's seminars, which he attended from the 1930s; the EPHE's biographical account locates that formation. **Recognition, desire, and speech are three entrances this guide uses to read the argument, not a fixed three-part taxonomy named by Lacan.** They follow connected changes: whose recognition matters, what is sought in addressing another, and how speaking can change the position from which one understands the question.

### Recognition: the other's place in becoming oneself

In *Seminar I*, 12 May 1954, Lacan connects imaginary rivalry with symbolic recognition. An image of the other can organize the ego and make an object desirable through rivalry. Naming desire before another introduces a symbolic relation in which it can be recognized and assumed. Recognition here exceeds approving a self-image or satisfying an appetite. The movement changes how desire is situated between participants; it does not simply supply the ego with a favorable evaluation.

Consider an illustrative predicament: someone wants recognition as an independent thinker, but accepts only the verdict of a particular authority as proof of that independence. A better verdict could leave this dependence intact. The dialectical question concerns the relation that makes the authority's verdict decisive, including the speaker's participation in sustaining it. This differs from advising self-sufficiency: recognition uses language and criteria shared with others. The Other names that symbolic locus, which cannot be reduced to the particular person whose approval is sought.

### Desire: why obtaining the requested object does not settle the question

In "The Signification of the Phallus" (1958), pp. 689–691, **need, demand, and desire** acquire different roles. Need seeks satisfaction; articulated demand addresses the Other and can make what is given signify love or presence. Desire emerges through their separation and cannot be reduced to either bodily satisfaction or a demand for love. The argument follows how addressing another transforms what is sought, rather than merely arranging a sequence of wanted objects.

The 1960 "Subversion of the Subject," pp. 813–814 further asks how the Other's desire returns as a question about what the Other wants from the subject. It concerns the position from which one desires, as well as what one asks for.

For example, receiving a requested invitation may leave open whether one is wanted as a participant or merely tolerated. That hypothetical distinction makes the question intelligible; it does not diagnose the recipient. Changing the object alone may miss the

relation through which the object matters. The fantasy discussion examines how a scene can organize such positions and expectations.

### Speech and reversal: a changing subject within the account

In "Intervention on Transference" (1951), PDF pp. 2–6, reversal changes understanding and subjective position. The first Dora reversal brings her own participation into the account; Lacan also implicates Freud's prejudices in its impasse. The proposed third reversal remains an unrealized possibility, not a completed cure. The interpreter thus belongs to the relation under examination rather than observing it from outside.

This does not convert another person's wrongdoing into the speaker's fault. It changes the question from whether an external description is accurate to how the speaker is situated in the described relations. Those questions can both matter. Likewise, a change in what someone says is different from evidence that their position has changed.

In "The Function and Field of Speech and Language" (1953), the passages on address and response, speech addresses another whose response participates in recognition. Naming the addressee assigns a position they may take up or refuse; the analyst's response consequently carries responsibility for the subject's place in the exchange. Speech does more than report an already finished inner truth. Its address and reception enter the formation of that truth.

Retroaction can reorganize earlier meaning without establishing a dialectical reversal. The distinction is between a changed reading and a changed subjective position, not between short and long speech. The sections on retroaction and full speech develop those connections.

### Historical development and the contemporary comparison

The early recognition vocabulary should not flatten Lacan's later questions. In "Subversion of the Subject," pp. 797–798, he challenges a dialectic converging on absolute knowledge and a completed self-identical subject. Read the later divided subject and limits of truth without promising final reconciliation through successive explanations.

Lacan's contribution can illuminate both role change and model revision. "Intervention on Transference," PDF p. 2, explicitly locates what reversal touches in the subject's position. Applied to entry into and return from roles, the question becomes how the person understands their capacities, the counterpart's contribution, and their dependence after passing through model-like generation and returning to judgment. The enacted passage supplies material; changes in position must be discerned in participation.

In changes of premises and philosophical models, a new account can bring its own speaker into the question. The person may move from "the helper determines my independence" toward "how do I organize, receive, and change assistance?" The model must also examine whether its interpretation leaves the person only acceptance or refusal. Revised explanation, counterpart response, and participation can then change

together. Lacan's consideration of Freud's prejudices in the Dora case likewise brings the interpreter into the account of the impasse.

The connections retain distinct objects: role movement concerns entry into the other's contribution; model revision concerns changing concepts and premises; Lacanian dialectical reversal concerns subjective position and the unfolding of truth. They can affect one another within an exchange, rather than forming three disconnected topics. Correspondingly, a common consequence across conflicting views precisely expresses one kind of unity, but its formal result alone cannot establish subjective transformation. This guide develops conceptual understanding through those connections; clinical questions retain their own practice and evidence.

## Retroaction and retrospective understanding

**Retroaction (*rétroaction*)** concerns how meaning returns from later connections to earlier expression. A word need not acquire its full meaning at the instant it is spoken; the rest of a sentence, a response, or a later narrative can reorganize how the earlier part is understood. Lacan's "Subversion of the Subject" discusses this return through discourse and relations among signifiers.

For example: "Leaving then cost me a great deal—and it also taught me, for the first time, what I did not want." The second part places the earlier "cost" within a different relation of meaning. What changes is the present understanding of that departure and its place in the subsequent narrative. A later sentence has not erased the departure that occurred.

**"Retrospective understanding" is an interpretive expression in this guide**: on later rereading their own expression, receiving a response, or experiencing a new event, someone reinterprets an earlier experience—sometimes recognizing connections previously unclear to them, sometimes forming an understanding they did not previously have. This can be connected to Lacan's retroaction without treating every later understanding as the same Lacanian technical concept. The discussion of the subject's history and the future anterior in "The Function and Field of Speech and Language in Psychoanalysis" (1953), PDF p. 35, original publication p. 144, offers a source route for pursuing this temporal relation. Such later self-understanding can also involve misrecognition and needs continuing examination through material and new encounters.

In this site's writing and model collaboration, the relation can develop as follows: an unfinished expression is retained; the model organizes it into a readable account; the person rereads it, recognizes some connections, and discovers misunderstandings; this recognition changes subsequent expression. A work thus preserves earlier ideas and can also become material for new understanding.

Two questions still need separate treatment: **does an interpretation make an experience intelligible, and are its factual judgments about the past warranted?** A narrative fitting one's current feelings does not establish that every detail of the past

was as it describes. Retaining the original event, original words, and the time an interpretation formed lets retrospective understanding remain constrained by its material. Continue with Forming a life trajectory.

## Punctuation and quilting: how meaning becomes provisionally settled

Excerpts from "The Function and Field of Speech and Language" (1953) discuss how punctuation gives discourse meaning, including through the cutting of an analytic session. In "Subversion of the Subject" (1960), Écrits p. 805, the **quilting point (point de capiton)** concerns the arrest of sliding signification. A sentence's last term retroactively determining its earlier terms provides its diachronic illustration. This is also distinct from Miller's account of "suture."

For example, an utterance begins "you are right" and continues "the question does need rewriting, but your answer is still unsupported." The continuation specifies what was endorsed; extracting the opening words would misrepresent the whole position. The quilting point is more than a sentence's final punctuation mark: Lacan also discusses the synchronic organization of meaning. It directs attention to which signifying relations make discourse intelligible, without guaranteeing that this organization exhausts the subject or remains fixed forever.

For our writing, the useful question is when unfolding expression becomes a settled description, and how that punctuation or naming directs later reading. Summarizing "wanting independence" as "rejecting help" installs one interpretation in subsequent collaboration. Continued expression might require "wanting to retain participation in direction and the ability to change delegation." The new account enables work while remaining open to other tasks and later material.

Compression therefore selects content and can provisionally fix a reading. Sources, applicability conditions, and an unresolved alternative allow that reading to unfold again. This is a proposal for maintaining descriptions; the analogy does not make analytic session-cutting a technique for model dialogue.

## Full speech, half-saying, and truth

These concepts raise a further question: how does speech change the subject's relation to their history, and why can that change still not say their whole truth? First distinguish three relations, then follow their source periods.

| Relation | What it makes visible | Consequence for sustained writing |
|---|---|---|
| Full speech | Speech reorganizes the subject's history and how it is assumed | Examine how expression changes someone's relation to their experience. |

| Relation | What it makes visible | Consequence for sustained writing |
|---|---|---|
| Retroaction | Later signifying connections participate in determining earlier meaning | Read a new version as a reinterpretation of earlier expression, beyond counting additions. |
| The half-saying of truth | Truth cannot be exhausted by a complete totality of speech | New understanding remains possible, while a present account cannot close subsequent speech. |

### 1953: full speech and the subject's history

**Full speech (*parole pleine*)** cannot be measured by the quantity of material. In excerpts from "The Function and Field of Speech and Language in Psychoanalysis", Lacan connects its effect with reorganizing past contingencies and the meaning of the subject's history as it opens toward a future. Ask how the subject assumes that history in speech addressed to another, beyond acquiring a more complete list of experiences.

A brief statement may change someone's position in understanding their situation; extensive self-description may repeatedly sustain an existing image. This contrast directs attention to what speech does. It supplies no test that classifies speech as full from sentence length, a feeling of candor, or self-identification alone. Connecting writing and model collaboration with this question is this site's extension; its effects require understanding actual exchange and use.

### 1960: unfolding signifying chains and retroaction

In "Subversion of the Subject", the temporal relation of meaning receives further construction: a sentence's later parts can retroactively determine how its earlier terms are understood. A signifying chain has an order of unfolding and a relation through which the later acts on the earlier. Connecting it with a personal trajectory requires explaining repetition, substitution, connections, and changes in the positions of words. Timestamped records supply material for that inquiry.

Such development does not guarantee progress in one direction. Later interpretation may open previously unseen connections or force old material into a tidy story. Retaining earlier expression and new responses lets readers compare what actually changed. The preceding section on retroaction and retrospective understanding distinguishes changes in meaning from their factual grounds.

### 1970–1974: half-saying and the limit of saying all

**Half-saying (*mi-dire*)** does not divide truth into two pieces that can be assembled, nor does it mean that a statement is half true and half false. In *Seminar XVII*, 11 March 1970, transcription p. 47, Lacan uses the enigma as a model for truth's half-saying and distinguishes this form from the division of the subject in the same passage. Related concepts therefore still need their distinctions. In the opening of *Television* (1974), he connects the impossibility of saying the whole truth with the limits of words and the

real. This limit does not arise merely from insufficient present information; more records or revisions cannot be promised to remove it.

This distinguishes several meanings of gradual development. Progressive disclosure in a Skill normally concerns reading existing material as needed. Unfolding speech can also form meanings that did not previously exist. Half-saying concerns the totality such speech cannot complete. These can meet within one practice, but an information-organizing method does not entail Lacan's account of truth. Early full speech and later half-saying cannot be joined into stages of first saying half and eventually saying everything.

Returning to this site, a philosophical Skill can retain present understanding, participate in subsequent collaboration, and undergo revision through new experience and speech. The model's interpretations enter that exchange too; fluency grants them no position of final truth. Examine which relations become possible to articulate, assume, and change; factual judgments still require source checks. The main essay's half-saying truth and continuing revision develops this practice through the independence example. The guide supplies conceptual relations and reading entrances; the main essay develops the site's argument.

## The three registers: different relations within the same experience

The **Imaginary (*Imaginaire*)** concerns images, a sense of wholeness, and identification; the **Symbolic (*Symbolique*)** concerns signifiers, differences, positions, and their organization; the **Real (*Réel*)** concerns the impossibility or limits encountered by these organizations of meaning and imagery. They do not sort material into three disjoint boxes. In his later work, Lacan further investigates their connections through knots; excerpts from *Seminar XXII, R.S.I.*, the session of 10 December 1974 offer an entrance.

For example, understanding oneself as an “independent creator” involves an image with which one can identify; the position of “creator” within language, evaluation, and relationships involves symbolic organization; some recurring difficulties may prevent this self-image and explanation from smoothly encompassing experience. The last example is only a way into the question. It does not license calling all unrecorded feelings, unknown data, or bodily responses “the Real.”

This site draws on the registers' emphases to illuminate its practice: philosophy turns toward a real not exhausted by expression; psychology attends to images, identifications, and their organization of experience; engineering makes relations usable through language, rules, and programs. The trinity of philosophy, psychology, and engineering arranges them as resonant analogies: follow a column for its emphasis, cross the columns for their connections. The site's physicalism has its own argument; the Real contributes a question about the limits of expression.

## Fantasy and its traversal: the subject's position in a relationship

**Fantasy (fantasme)** in Lacan concerns the subject's relation to the object of desire and how a scene positions the subject in relation to the Other's desire. It can organize the experience of reality, expected responses, satisfaction, and repetition. Everyday daydreams may supply material; the recurring positions and relations within them matter especially. "The Subversion of the Subject" (1960) locates fantasy among subject, desire, and the Other. Object a in its formula concerns the cause of desire, rather than simply a person or thing one wants.

Suppose someone treats "I have a place with the other only if I continually prove useful" as a necessary condition of relationship. Inquiry concerns both the claim's truth and how the person imagines the other's demands, occupies the position of being judged, and sustains the relation through giving, testing, and anxiety. Actual demands, lived dependencies, and particular experiences remain part of the explanation.

**Traversing fantasy** concerns a change in the subject's relation to this organization. A seemingly necessary scene and position can become recognizable; their function in sustaining desire and satisfaction can enter analysis, and the subject may cease to depend on them in the same way. Recognizing an inaccurate belief or giving a more complete account of oneself addresses only part of this. The final session of *Seminar XI* (24 June 1964; Alan Sheridan translation, p. 273) leaves the experience of the drive after traversing the fundamental fantasy as a question. This scholarly concept index retains the source locator. Traversal thus concerns changes in relationship and experience, rather than a checklist of self-explanations to complete.

Its relation to the later **sinthome** retains two questions: how a subject changes their dependence on a fantasy scene, and how a singular practice sustains their life and jouissance. Scholarship offers different accounts of their connection; see Coffman, 2013. In this site's contemporary use, examining relational position and constructing sustainable arrangements can interweave and revise one another.

The six actual accounts can help organize experiences, articulate questions, and increase self-understanding; concepts can also question the accounts' own premises. Rereading one's patterns: philosophical reflection and loosening fantasy develops this philosophical discussion. It provides no guidance for self-help psychological analysis, assessment, treatment, or traversal of fantasy. Model interpretations and document revisions do not establish psychological mechanisms, clinical traversal, or therapeutic effects.

## Sinthome: from Lacan's question to this site's definition

**Sinthome** is a spelling Lacan adopts in *Seminar XXIII*. In the particular construction of the 17 February 1976 session, it participates in repairing the knot; in the 11 May session, the relations among Joyce's writing, ego, and the knot are developed further.

The question concerns how a particular practice enters this person's mode of existence, beyond what a work expresses through its content.

This site adopts the name with its own concrete referent: **a practical arrangement jointly shaped by personal philosophy, psychology, and engineering, including an understanding of the person, the model counterpart they need, and their relationship, together with expressions, tools, and ways of using them.** Relevant material informs the arrangement; current technical conditions give it usable form; use brings revision. A Skill can carry some of its understanding and methods, while a harness can organize its actual realization. Life is the setting in which it forms, is used, and has consequences.

Reading "sinthome" here therefore requires recognizing both the term's source and this site's particular definition. The name does not turn all of life into one object or directly make a software package the clinical construction Lacan discusses. How far it helps stabilize life or continue creation needs to be understood through concrete use. See Forming a sinthome for the detailed formation process.

## Which relations does formal translation capture?

This site's Speech, opposition, and self-formation uses some formal notation. It gives selected relations an inspectable expression, which readers can consider alongside the concepts above.

| Relation of interest | Expression used here | Scope of the expression |
|---|---|---|
| What someone said and within which relationship | A speech record containing speaker, situation, time, and address | Retains available event content; subsequent interpretation still needs grounds. |
| What a selected self-account entails | Conceptual constraints, selected assertions, and their formal consequences | Checks inferences within the given representation without exhausting ego or subject. |
| How later understanding returns to earlier expression | Relations among earlier expression, present context, and the time of interpretation | Locates changes in interpretation without using one symbol to explain every mechanism of retroaction. |
| How a personal model enters actual collaboration | Counterpart models, expression, Skills, tools, and relations of use | Forms a concrete arrangement whose adequacy still needs examination against the person's material and actual results. |

Formalization and personal understanding can help each other: clear representation can expose omissions, while new material may force the representation to change. **Translating relations into a language, forming an interpretation from material, and computing under given assumptions are connected but different activities.** This

also explains why a theoretical conceptual model, an event archive covering partial situations, and temporary models formed for the current question can coexist.

## From formalization to human–machine interaction: exploratory contributions

Formalization can make an interpretation's choices inspectable: which objects are represented, which relations become rules, and what those rules produce. The studies below offer different constructions and questions. Together they do not establish a validated personal-model method. This account selects their specific contributions while distinguishing the authors' proposals from its own extensions.

**From relations to computation.** Li and Li (2025) represent RSI as message-passing active-inference units and investigate synchronization and collective dynamics through dyadic and triadic simulations. They acknowledge the construction's abstraction and incomplete treatment of fantasy's axiomatic function, complex topology, and desire's diachronic metonymy. This encourages an explicit account of what a translation preserves. Coupled trajectories alone establish neither Borromean topology nor an actual person's mechanism of desire. Santos and Dunker's study of fantasy uses paraconsistent logic to propose that fantasy renders the signifying chain consistent. Retaining unresolved differences deserves investigation; that does not identify every conflict as fantasy or a change of logic as clinical change. The article belongs to issue 41 (2021), published online in 2023.

**From machines to interaction.** Possati (2020) brings Lacan and Latour to cycles of human identification, machine response, and renewed interpretation, proposing an "algorithmic unconscious" research direction. Li and Li's FreeAgent preprint (2024) places ChatGPT in an interpreting role within a demonstration connecting bodily images and symbolic identification. The former is a philosophical interpretation, the latter a simplified construction. They raise questions about technical mediation of self-understanding without establishing human unconscious processes or self-awareness in machines. How an actual response is received remains a question about the particular interaction.

**Distinguishing explanatory scales.** Li et al.'s Perspective (2026) distinguishes mechanistic, behavioral, and interactive accounts of models and examines what metaphors reveal and obscure. This supports separate examination of implementation, observed activity, and position within collaboration. This site adopts that distinction of questions without treating the proposed "machine experientialism" as comprehensively validated or inferring internal mechanisms directly from relational positions.

**Distinguishing memory from generated state.** Shen et al.'s TSJ preprint (2026), §7.7, separates observable interaction memories from separately generated psychological states and retrieves memories for later scenarios. Section 7.13 also separates judging from trajectory generation. This is an engineering reference for distinguishing events, inter-

pretations, and consequences. Its personas, state updates, and scores serve simulation-based evaluation rather than measurements of actual people. Retrospectively selecting an earlier event does not itself establish causation. This site retains those distinctions without copying the psychological scores or state equations.

## Return to the sources, then to this site

The table lists entrances in chronological order. It helps locate a concept without requiring a first-time reader to complete every text in sequence.

| Source entrance | Questions to pursue | Return to this site |
|---|---|---|
| 1949: The mirror stage | How does an image participate in identification, and why can the ego not simply be treated as a transparent inner fact? | Self-description and formal views |
| 1951: Intervention on Transference | How does dialectical reversal concern the subject's position in the relations recounted? | Dialectical reversal |
| 1953: The function and field of speech and language | How does full speech reorganize the past, and how does the subject assume their history? | Full speech and the subject's history |
| 1960: Subversion of the Subject | How do subject, Other, signifier, and retroaction connect? | The Other and retrospective meaning |
| 1966: Radio discussion, p. 2 | What does growing up within language mean for the subject? | Personal understanding |
| 1969: Seminar XVII, 26 November | How does a position in discourse differ from its actual speaker? | Signifying chains and works |
| 1970: Seminar XVII, 11 March, p. 47 | How does the enigma illuminate half-saying, and how does it differ from subjective division? | Half-saying and the limit of saying all |
| 1974: Television, opening | Why does continuing speech not amount to eventually saying the whole truth? | Half-saying truth and continuing revision |
| 1974–1975: R.S.I. excerpts | Why do connections among the registers become a question, and how do knots enter the discussion? | The general Trinity and its individual instance |
| 1976: Sinthome, 17 February; 11 May | How do particular writing and practices participate in a person's knot? | Forming a sinthome |

This timeline points to conceptual development: mirror identification, language and the subject, and the later knot discussions each have their own questions and contexts. Later terms can help reread earlier questions without implying that the earlier texts already contained the entire later theory. On returning to this site, retain a simple reading

movement: identify what question the original concept answers, see which relation this account selects, then check whether that relation remains clear in expression and realization.

# Appendix IV · The YinYang Skill

## YinYang files and shared updates

This guide owns the file and update contract for the maintained YinYang package. The collection is **Prometheus2Heraclitus**; this complete member lives under `skills/yinyang/`. Its `references/docs/` and `references/diagrams/` are supporting resources, not independent Skills. Obtain the complete directory from the public repository and expose it through the consumer's actual Skill mechanism. The website is a reading surface; repository cloning and GitHub's native ZIP preserve complete source.

YinYang is one developed philosophy and formation method. Readers can adopt it, combine selected resources, or create a different work. The example and commons essay develops that invitation. A philosopher's thought may inform a framework; it cannot replace the account of the actual user. This guide's six-file and common-update contract applies to full adoption of the maintained Skill. Reading its philosophy or borrowing a selected method does not by itself adopt that contract or require a personal philosophy project. Full adoption also leaves original essay-writing optional: its six actual files state the positions and arrangements adopted for use, which can draw on selected existing ideas.

### Common and situated content

This implementation distinguishes six public writing guides from six private actual files, corresponding by object:

| Object | Public guide | Private actual file |
|---|---|---|
| Orientation | `references/formation/orientation.md` | `references/situated/orientation.md` |
| Person | `references/formation/person.md` | `references/situated/person.md` |
| Counterpart | `references/formation/counterpart.md` | `references/situated/counterpart.md` |
| Relationship | `references/formation/relationship.md` | `references/situated/relationship.md` |
| Environment | `references/formation/environment.md` | `references/situated/environment.md` |
| Revision | `references/formation/revision.md` | `references/situated/revision.md` |

The public guides have complete Chinese editions and explain how to form the corresponding content. The actual files articulate one's own orientation, the working implications of personal understanding, actual counterpart, relationship, environment, and revision method. Together they are personal working models of person–model cooperation, intended to make the actual personal environment fit the person psychologically and practically. Revision guidance and an actual revision method are distinct too: the former offers adaptable writing guidance; the latter explains how revision works with this person's philosophy, material, and actual environment. Public distribution contains guides, with no actual files or placeholder portraits. The initial reading uses all six actual files; a common guide cannot substitute for one of them.

For full adoption, the model forms these six files from relevant authorized material and organizes their needed private support. Explicit unknowns can be honest content; copying guidance or someone else's portrait cannot form an actual version. Person, counterpart, and relationship remain three subjects of understanding; the other files supply direction, realization, and revision. Later changes follow affected meanings and dependencies.

`references/personal/` is the principal private place for psychological and life evidence and maintained interpretations; `references/personal/sources.md` is its question-selected entrance. Extended history, originals, and topical material stay with existing owners or under that tree, reached through access-bounded locators. The six working files condense adopted philosophy and updated personal material into the implications needed for cooperation. They are not six psychological models or the primary self-analysis archive; `person.md` does not hold the whole psychological portrait. The maintenance method owns each refresh; the revision writing guide supplies evidence guidance. Independently authored philosophy has its own source; private material links it and retains relevant grounds.

Both entire trees, `references/situated/` and `references/personal/`, are private. Everything else is common package content, including the entrypoint, six writing guides, essays, diagrams, and scripts. Distributed copies and private copies choosing continued common updates keep common content byte-identical. Using YinYang owns the actual initial reading; Philosophy and models connects the writing objects.

## Project common changes

`scripts/sync-common.py` checks common source projection by default. With `--apply`, it projects common files into the target, preserving everything under both private trees, including additional files and links. It does not traverse or inspect their contents. It does not infer a person, export private files, or publish to a runtime.

Start a new situated version from a complete shared copy, then form its private accounts. Compare explicit package directories:

```
python3 /path/to/shared/yinyang/scripts/sync-common.py \
  --source /path/to/shared/yinyang --target /path/to/situated/yinyang
```

Add `--apply` to copy changes, then run the comparison again. Unmatched target files and common-path symlinks stop copying; inspect ownership rather than silently deleting them. Existing local or private Web owners install and publish the projected source, followed by actual-consumer readback.

Earlier packages mixed public guidance and private content at `references/{encounter,models,relationship,usage,sources}.md`. The projector refuses either package with any of these paths before changing files. Their owner first redistributes actual meaning into the six actual files and private evidence index, preserves unique support, and retires the old paths. The old encounter can contain orientation and relationship, and the old relationship both counterpart and joint activity: a mechanical rename cannot complete this semantic migration. Retain any useful private `references/personal/README.md` substance at the appropriate private owner; the whole personal tree is protected.

Common parity preserves one recipient-local discovery exception: when the target's single-line `SKILL.md` description already begins with <用户自制> and a space, the projector retains that prefix while replacing its substantive wording from the common source. An unmarked target stays unmarked. Every other common byte and file mode remains source-owned; the public package does not assign itself recipient-relative authorship.

This parity applies to copies choosing continuing common updates. If you replace the philosophy or organization independently, keep that work at its own source and maintain its coherent references. Do not project this common package over it, even if it retains the six-slot format.

Authors of other works can change the number and organization of accounts and the philosophy. The maintained YinYang implementation keeps these fixed six actual files.

## Personal and public boundaries

Personal accounts remain private even when formalized or written for models. Private quotations, biography, psychological and health records, relationship narratives, account information, private paths and conversation identifiers, and unpublished manuscripts stay with their actual owners. General abstraction does not authorize public links that reconstruct private sources.

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